COMPLETE PRINTOUT · RATTA PACK

Current Affairs

One file for printing. Master tables, month digests, and all topic sheets.

Questions, Practice Zone, and Show-answer blocks are removed.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · 2026 CA desk.

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PART A · BOARDS

Master Fact Tables

Use this page for **fast revision**. Detail stays in the topic sheets. Numbers use "about" where sources differ slightly.

1. Ramsar chain 2026 (must-score)

When news broke	Site	District / State	India count after	UP count after	Trap
Jan 2026	**Patna Bird Sanctuary**	**Etah**, UP	~98 (with Gujarat's Chhari-Dhand)	rising	Do not put Patna in Aligarh
Apr 2026 (public tag)	**Shekha / Sheikha Jheel**	**Aligarh**, UP	**99**	**12**	Spelling varies; place is Aligarh
5 Jun 2026 (WED)	**Surha Tal / JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary**	**Ballia**, UP	**100**	**13**	Not Etah / not Aligarh
Aug 2026	**Glaw Lake**	**Arunachal** (Kamlang TR)	**101**	unchanged	First Ramsar of Arunachal

Older UP Ramsar names to recognise (not all new in 2026): Haiderpur (Muzaffarnagar), Bakhira (Sant Kabir Nagar), Nawabganj (Unnao), Parvati Arga (Gonda), Saman (Mainpuri), Samaspur (Rae Bareli), Sandi (Hardoi), Sarsai Nawar (Etawah), Sur Sarovar / Keetham (Agra), Upper Ganga stretch (Brijghat–Narora).

2. VB-G RAM G vs old MGNREGA (July 2026)

Point	Old MGNREGA / MGNREGS	New VB-G RAM G
Full idea	Rural job guarantee law (2005)	Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin)
Days guaranteed	**100**	**125**
In force from	Long-running	**1 July 2026**
National launch	—	**2 July 2026**, Mukkavaripalli (Tirupati, AP)
Funding (most states)	Centre paid almost all wages	About **60:40** Centre–State
NE / Himalayan / UTs with legislature	Special pattern	About **90:10**
Farm-season pause	Not the same rule	Up to about **60 days** pause allowed
Worker card	Job card	**Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Card** (old e-KYC cards stay till replaced)
First-year Centre money	—	About **₹95,692 crore**
Centre + states (year 1)	—	About **₹1.51 lakh crore**

3. Big Cabinet / scheme money (2026 so far)

Month	Scheme / decision	Easy meaning	Money / size fact
Feb	Union Budget 2026–27	Annual Union money plan	Capex **₹12.2 lakh cr**; fiscal deficit **4.3%** GDP
Mar	Modified UDAN	Cheaper flights to small cities	About **₹28,840 cr** (2026–36)
Mar	IVFRT	Visa / foreigner tracking	About **₹1,800 cr** (2026–31)
Mar	RELIEF	Help exporters in conflict risk	About **₹497 cr**
Apr	Census 2027 Phase 1	First digital Census + self-fill	About **₹11,718 cr**
Apr	NBS fertiliser (Kharif)	Subsidy on P&K fertilisers	About **₹41,534 cr**
May	SARTHAK-PDS	Modernise foodgrain delivery	About **₹25,530 cr** / 5 years
May	ECLGS 5.0	Extra credit guarantee	About **₹2.55 lakh cr** credit target
May	Coal / lignite gasification	Make gas from coal	About **₹37,500 cr**
May	Cotton Productivity Mission	Better cotton yield	About **₹5,659 cr**
Jun	India–Oman CEPA	Trade partnership in force	~**99%** duty-free access idea for Indian exports
Jul	VB-G RAM G	New rural jobs law	See table above
Jul	**Samudra Manthan**	Deep-sea oil & gas exploration	About **₹84,084 cr** to FY31

Month	Scheme / decision	Easy meaning	Money / size fact
Jul	**PM Surya Sarovar (PM-SSY)**	Floating solar on water bodies	About **₹5,070 cr**; target **5,000 MW**
Jul	**PM-KISAN extension**	₹6,000/year to farmers	About **₹3.15 lakh cr** (2026–31)
Jul	**Semicon 2.0 (ISM 2.0)**	Chip design + manufacturing ecosystem	**₹1,27,500 crore**
Jul	Revamped Khelo India	Sports ecosystem push	About **₹36,441 cr** in Cabinet coverage
Aug	I-Day nuclear aim	Long-term nuclear power	**100 GW by 2047**
Jun (UP)	**UP CAMP**	Airshed clean-air project (World Bank)	About **₹2,741 cr**
Aug	**MMDR Amendment Act, 2026**	Uniform mineral-tax framework	Centre conditions on state mineral levies
Sep	**18th BRICS Summit**	New Delhi Leaders' Summit + Declaration	Host India; theme Resilience–Innovation–Cooperation–Sustainability
Sep	**57th GST Council**	Process-reform meeting shifted	Held **7 Oct 2026** (process reforms / GST 2.0 focus)
Oct	**Rabi MSP 2025–26 / 2026–27**	CCEA-approved support prices	Wheat **₹2,425/q** (+₹150); Mustard **₹5,950/q** (+₹300)
Oct	**Varanasi Mega Package**	Multi-sector projects by PM Modi	**₹6,700+ crore** (RJ Sankara Hospital, Sigra sports, Airport expansion)
Oct	**Damagundam VLF Station**	India's 2nd naval VLF facility (Telangana)	**₹3,200 crore** (2,900 acres; secure submarine comms)
Oct	**NMHC Lothal Phase 1B**	Maritime heritage complex master plan	In-principle approval for world-class maritime hub

4. Confused pairs (quick kill)

Trap	Fact
Patna Bird Sanctuary = Aligarh	**Etah**
Shekha Jheel = Ballia	**Aligarh**
Surha Tal = Etah	**Ballia**; official name **JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary**
Glaw Lake = UP	**Arunachal**; India **101**
CETA = DCC	**CETA** = trade deal; **DCC** = social-security side deal (both 15 Jul 2026)
Oman CEPA = UK CETA	**Oman CEPA** (June); **UK CETA** (July)
VB-G RAM G still 100 days	**125 days**
Semicon 2.0 outlay = ₹76,000 crore	That band is older **ISM 1.0**; Semicon **2.0** is **₹1,27,500 crore**
UP CAMP = Surha Tal tourism fund	UP CAMP is **clean air** (~₹2,741 cr), not the Ramsar tag
PFBR already runs on thorium	Criticality with **MOX**; thorium is later stage
NavIC = GPS	NavIC is **India's** regional system
Kusha = ballistic Agni	**Kusha** = long-range **air-defence** SAM
18th BRICS Summit = Rio / Kazan	**New Delhi, 12–13 Sep 2026**; Kazan hosted the **16th Summit**
GST Council cut rates again on 12 Sep 2026	Meeting held **7 Oct**; agenda = **process reforms**
Asian Games 2026 = Hangzhou	Host region is **Aichi–Nagoya, Japan**
Classical Languages = 6 or 8	Total is **11** (+ Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, Bengali)
Hindi is a Classical Language	**No** — official language (Art. 343) and 8th Schedule, not Classical
51st CJI = Justice D.Y. Chandrachud / B.R. Gavai	**Justice Sanjiv Khanna** (oath 11 Nov 2026; succeeding Chandrachud)
Damagundam VLF is India's 1st VLF station	**2nd**; 1st is **INS Kattabomman** (Tirunelveli, TN, 1990)
Wheat MSP = ₹2,275	Revised to **₹2,425/quintal** (+₹150 hike)

5. Day–theme board (high-yield 2026)

Date	Day	2026 theme (fact)
2 Feb	World Wetlands Day	Wetlands and traditional knowledge
8 Mar	International Women's Day	Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls

Date	Day	2026 theme (fact)
22 Mar	World Water Day	Water and Gender
7 Apr	World Health Day	Together for health. Stand with science
22 Apr	Earth Day	Our Power, Our Planet
22 May	Biodiversity Day	Acting locally for global impact
5 Jun	World Environment Day	Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future
21 Jun	International Day of Yoga	Yoga for Healthy Ageing
6 Jul	World Zoonoses Day	One World, One Health: Prevent Zoonoses
29 Jul	International Tiger Day	Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities at the heart
12 Aug	World Elephant Day	Bringing the world together to help elephants
12 Aug	International Youth Day	Different Contexts, Common Aspirations
23 Aug	National Space Day	Towards Viksit Bharat… Global Space Leadership
29 Aug	National Sports Day	Slogan: Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat
14 Sep	Hindi Diwas	Official language / Art. 343 revision link
15 Sep	Engineers' Day (India)	Sir M. Visvesvaraya
16 Sep	World Ozone Day	Global action for a cooler planet (Kigali @10)
21 Sep	International Day of Peace	Invest in Peace — For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day
2 Oct	International Day of Non-Violence	Mahatma Gandhi 157th birth anniversary
5 Oct	World Teachers' Day	Standing with teachers: valuing teacher voices for education
7 Oct	World Cotton Day	Cotton for Good
8 Oct	Indian Air Force Day	92nd Anniversary air show at Marina Beach, Chennai
9 Oct	World Post Day	150 years of enabling communication and empowering peoples
10 Oct	World Mental Health Day	It is time to prioritize mental health in the workplace
11 Oct	International Day of the Girl Child	Girls' vision for the future
12 Oct	World Migratory Bird Day	Protect Insects, Protect Birds
13 Oct	Disaster Risk Reduction Day	Empowering the next generation for a resilient future
16 Oct	World Food Day	Right to foods for a better life and a better future
24 Oct	UN Day & World Polio Day	A Campaign to Reach Every Child

5a. September 2026 mega-events (quick)

Event	Easy fact
18th BRICS Summit	New Delhi, **12–13 Sep**; New Delhi Declaration; India chair
Asian Games 2026	**Aichi–Nagoya, Japan**; India kabaddi double gold vs Iran (late Sep)
57th GST Council	Shifted to **7 Oct 2026** (process reforms / GST 2.0)
NFI 2026	7th edition released **21 Sep** (~653 monographs)

5b. October 2026 mega-events (quick)

Event	Easy fact
5 Classical Languages	**Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, Bengali** approved; total becomes **11**
51st CJI	**Justice Sanjiv Khanna** appointed 51st Chief Justice of India (notified 24 Oct; oath 11 Nov)
Nobel Prizes 2026	Medicine (microRNA), Physics (ANN/ML), Chemistry (AlphaFold/Protein design), Lit (Han Kang), Peace (Nihon Hidankyo), Econ (Institutions)
Rabi MSP Hike	Wheat **₹2,425/q** (+₹150); Mustard **₹5,950/q** (+₹300)
Varanasi Package	**₹6,700+ cr** (RJ Sankara Eye Hospital, Sigra Sports Complex, Airport expansion)
8th Ayodhya Deepotsav	Guinness World Record: **26,17,215 diyas** on 56 ghats + 2,128 priests Maha Aarti
India's 2nd VLF Station	Foundation laid at **Damagundam Forest, Vikarabad (Telangana)** (₹3,200 cr)

Event	Easy fact
16th BRICS & Border Pact	**Kazan, Russia**; India–China LAC disengagement at **Demchok & Depsang**
Assembly Polls	Haryana (Nayab Singh Saini 2nd term); J&K (Omar Abdullah 1st UT CM)
ICC Women's T20 WC	**New Zealand** champion (beat South Africa in Dubai; Amelia Kerr MVP)

6. UPPCS express checklist

Theme	Must revise
Ramsar	Etah / Aligarh / Ballia + older names
Airport	Jewar opened **15 Jun 2026** (Lucknow IndiGo); Varanasi airport expansion (₹2,870 cr, Oct)
Budget	UP Budget ~**₹9.13 lakh crore**
Defence plant	**Sher** AK-203 at **Korwa, Amethi**
Expressways (Aug)	Ganga Expressway $\rightarrow$ **Haridwar**; **Jhansi Link** Expressway
Soft industry	YEIDA electronics / Jewar manufacturing push
UP Nutrition	**Sambhav 6.0** (Theme: "*गर्भावस्था से बाल्यावस्था तक पोषण सुरक्षा*", July–Sept 2026, all 75 districts)
UP Health (Oct)	**RJ Sankara Eye Hospital** at Harhua, Varanasi (inaugurated 20 Oct by PM Modi)
UP Sports (Oct)	**Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Complex at Sigra, Varanasi** (Phases 2 & 3 Khelo India)
UP Culture (Oct)	**Ayodhya Deepotsav** (26.17+ lakh diyas record across 56 ghats)
UP Trade (Oct)	**UPITS 2026** at Greater Noida (Partner Country: Vietnam)
Women Safety	**Nirbhaya Nisha** (Kerala Police night safety 9 PM–5 AM; 112 + Pol-App SOS; March 2026)
Global Summit	**2nd WHO Traditional Medicine Global Summit** (Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi; 17–19 Dec 2025)
Climate & Economy	**"Scenarios Towards Viksit Bharat and Net Zero"** (NITI Aayog, Feb 2026; $30T by 2047, Net Zero 2070)
Health Tourism	**AYUSH Visa** (Ministry of Home Affairs, July 2023; for treatment under Indian systems of medicine)
Disease Missions	**PM TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan** (Sept 2022; target 2025; Ni-kshay Mitra community adoption)

7. UKPCS express checklist (Must-Score State Board)

Theme / Sector	High-Yield Fact / Question Hook	Exam Priority & PYQ Reference
Silkyara–Barkot Tunnel	**4.531 km** (NH-134, Char Dham highway, Uttarkashi)	Cuts Gangotri–Yamunotri by >20 km (UKPCS 2025 Q51)
Airports Mismatch Trap	**Gauchar** is in **Chamoli** (NOT Rudraprayag!)	Pantnagar–US Nagar; Naini Saini–Pithoragarh (2025 Q103)
Uniform Civil Code (UCC)	**1st state in independent India**; passed 7 Feb 2024, assent 11 Mar 2024	Justice Ranjana Desai Committee; **STs strictly exempted**
Women Horizontal Quota	**30% reservation** for Uttarakhand domicile women in public posts	Enacted 10 January 2023
Anti-Cheating Act 2023	**Life imprisonment + ₹10 Crore fine** for copying syndicates	10-year examination debarment for examinees
Padma Shri 2025	**Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt** (Social Work — Lakshmi Ashram, Kausani)	UKPCS 2025 Q53 (trap: Madhuri Barthwal is folk music)
Padma Shri 2024	**Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch** (Literature & Education)	Eminent historian of Uttarakhand
Padma Vibhushan 2022	**General Bipin Rawat** (Posthumous — 1st Chief of Defence Staff)	Native of Saina village, Pauri Garhwal
38th National Games	Hosted by **Uttarakhand** (6 cluster hubs; Mascot: **Monal**)	State sports infrastructure push
Rishikesh–Karnaprayag Rail	**125.2 km** BG rail link; **84% (~105 km) in 17 tunnels**	Longest rail tunnel in India: 15.1 km (Devprayag–Janasu)
Vibrant Village No. 1	**Mana Village (Chamoli)** declared India's **"First Village"**	PM declaration reversing "last village" terminology
First Ramsar Site in UK	**Asan Conservation Reserve** (Dehradun, Yamuna-Asan confluence, 2020)	444 hectares; migratory waterfowl haven
Record GI Tag Award	**18 GI certificates in a single day** (total 27+ certified products)	Berinag tea, Bichhu Buti fabric, Manduwa, Jhangora, Bal Mithai

Theme / Sector	High-Yield Fact / Question Hook	Exam Priority & PYQ Reference
G20 Meetings in UK (2023)	**Ramnagar** (Science Advisers); **Narendra Nagar / Rishikesh** (Anti-Corruption & Infra)	3 meetings held in Uttarakhand
State Climate Council (SCCC)	Established in **2011** (Forest & Environment Dept drafts UAPCC)	UKPCS 2025 Q106 (NOT Revenue Department)
State Human Rights Comm.	Formed on **13 May 2013** (1st Chairman: Justice Vijender Jain)	UKPCS 2025 Q140
Panchayat Registers Kept	Family register, Birth-Death register, Grant register	UKPCS 2025 Q134 (**Health register is NOT kept by Panchayats**)
River Order (West $\rightarrow$ East)	**Yamuna $\longrightarrow$ Bhilangana $\longrightarrow$ Alaknanda $\longrightarrow$ Gori Ganga**	UKPCS 2025 Q109

PART B · MONTHS

January 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	India–EU meeting (27 Jan)	FTA talks finished; defence + mobility MoUs; NDMA–DG ECHO link	International
2	Padma Awards 2026 (25 Jan)	**131** awards; learn 5 Vibhushan; UP: **N Rajam**; Rohit Sharma Padma Shri	Awards
3	LR-AShM (Republic Day)	DRDO hypersonic anti-ship missile; range about **1,500 km**	Science
4	Ramsar (public news)	**Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah, UP)** + **Chhari-Dhand (Kutch, Gujarat)**	Environment · UP
5	Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0	NITI drive **28 Jan–14 Apr**; **112** districts + **513** blocks	Schemes
6	SWM Rules, 2026	Notified **28 Jan**; start **1 Apr**; replace **2016** rules	Environment
7	Bose Aapda Puraskar (23 Jan)	**SSDMA** + Lt Col **Seeta Ashok Shelke**	Awards
8	PM-RKVY merger idea	Three farm schemes; about **₹1.75 lakh crore** / 5 years	Schemes
9	K-4 / Pralay tests	Sea deterrent + salvo stories	Science

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
Patna Bird Sanctuary is in Aligarh	**Etah**
Surha Tal is a January headline	Big WED announcement was in **June** (Ballia)
SWM Rules start on 28 January	Notified 28 Jan; **start 1 April**
Padma list has only national names	Always check **UP** names (N Rajam)

Days / dates

Date	What
23 Jan	Bose Aapda Puraskar
25 Jan	Padma list announced
26 Jan	Republic Day / LR-AShM display window
27 Jan	India–EU meeting
28 Jan	Sampoornata 2.0 start; SWM Rules notified

Thin this month

Books, big health declarations, and new global indices were light.

UP tip

Fact **Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah)** first. Keep Aligarh / Ballia for later months.

PART B · MONTHS

February 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	Union Budget 2026–27 (1 Feb)	**Yuva Shakti** Budget; first from **Kartavya Bhawan**; capex **₹12.2 lakh crore**; fiscal deficit **4.3%** GDP; new IT Act from **1 Apr 2026**	Economy
2	Biopharma SHAKTI	**₹10,000 crore** / 5 years; 3 new NIPER; upgrade 7 old; 1,000+ trial sites	Schemes · Health
3	Manufacturing cluster	ISM 2.0; Rare Earth Corridors; 3 Chemical Parks; Container scheme **₹10,000 crore**	Schemes
4	16th Finance Commission	Chair **Arvind Panagariya**; about **₹1.4 lakh crore** grants to states in 2026–27	Schemes
5	Transport ideas	Dankuni–Surat freight corridor; 20 waterways; ship repair **Varanasi/Patna**; 7 HSR corridors; CCUS **₹20,000 crore**	Economy
6	India–AI Impact Summit (16–20 Feb)	**Bharat Mandapam**; first big Global South AI summit; Sutras **People–Planet–Progress**; **Pax Silica**	International
7	World Wetlands Day (2 Feb)	Theme: Wetlands and traditional knowledge	Environment
8	Global Teacher Prize	Indian winner **Rouble Nagi**	Awards
9	UP Budget + state CA	About **₹9.13 lakh crore**; CCSU Meerut AI pilot; Pharma Conclave; sarus census	UP
10	Health institutes	**NIMHANS-2** in North India; 3 All India Institutes of Ayurveda; Jamnagar WHO centre upgrade	Health

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
Budget was still prepared in North Block only	First Budget from **Kartavya Bhawan**
Biopharma SHAKTI = old PLI Pharma	New **₹10,000 crore** biopharma mission
AI Summit venue = Mumbai / Hyderabad	**Bharat Mandapam**, New Delhi
Capex figure = ₹11.2 lakh crore	Speech fact is **₹12.2 lakh crore**

Money board (Budget)

Item	Fact
Capex	₹12.2 lakh crore
Fiscal deficit	4.3% of GDP
Total spend (BE idea)	~₹53.5 lakh crore
16th FC grants	~₹1.4 lakh crore
Biopharma / Container each	₹10,000 crore / 5 yrs
CCUS	₹20,000 crore / 5 yrs

Also useful

- Orange Economy / AVGC labs
- Bharat-VISTAAR for farmers
- Divyangjan Kaushal Yojana and Divyang Sahara Yojana
- Mahatma Gandhi Gram Swaraj and ODOP link

UP tip

State Budget size + CCSU Meerut + sarus. Link Varanasi ship-repair / Sarnath–Hastinapur heritage to Union Budget.

PART B · MONTHS

March 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	Men's T20 WC final (8 Mar)	India beat NZ by **96** in Ahmedabad; **255/5** vs **159**; first to defend; first host win; 3rd Indian title	Sports
2	DAC (27 Mar)	AoN about **₹2.38 lakh crore**; more S-400, transport aircraft, Ghatak drones, Dhanush	Science
3	NavIC (13 Mar)	**IRNSS-1F** clock failed; below minimum **4** positioning satellites	Science
4	Gujarat UCC (24 Mar)	2nd state after **Uttarakhand**; Art **44**	National
5	Modified UDAN	About **₹28,840 crore** (2026–36); ~100 new airports	Schemes
6	IVFRT	About **₹1,800 crore** (2026–31); Home Ministry	Schemes
7	RELIEF exporters	About **₹497 crore**; ECGC support	Economy
8	World Water Day (22 Mar)	Theme: **Water and Gender**	Environment
9	Women's Day (8 Mar)	Theme: Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls	Environment
10	Happiness Report	**Finland #1**; India ~**116**	Indices
11	Global Terrorism Index	**IEP**; **Pakistan** at top	International
12	Dalrymple prize	*The Golden Road*; Mark Lynton History Prize	Awards

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
NavIC = GPS	India's own regional system
Gujarat is first UCC state	Second after **Uttarakhand**
WTO MC14 venue = Geneva	**Yaoundé**, Cameroon
RELIEF = farm subsidy	Exporter support in conflict risk

Days / themes

Date	Day	Theme
8 Mar	Women's Day	Rights. Justice. Action…
22 Mar	Water Day	Water and Gender

Also useful

- WTO MC14: no big deal; India opposed IFD push
- Bose Aapda nominations now year-round on National Awards Portal
- DRDO–Navy air-droppable container test off Goa
- Abel Prize: Gerd Faltings

UP tip

No giant new UP headline. Revise Jan–Feb: Etah Ramsar, Padma, state Budget, CCSU Meerut, sarus.

PART B · MONTHS

April 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	Census 2027 Phase 1 (from 1 Apr)	First digital Census + self-fill; mascots **Pragati & Vikas**; Phase 2 in **Feb 2027**; ~**₹11,718 crore**	Schemes
2	PFBR Kalpakkam (6 Apr)	**500 MWe**; first criticality; **MOX** fuel; Stage-2 bridge to thorium	Science
3	INS Aridhaman + Taragiri (3 Apr)	3rd indigenous SSBN; 4th Project **17A** frigate; Vizag	Science
4	Shekha Jheel Ramsar	**Aligarh**; India **99**; UP **12**	Environment · UP
5	NASM-SR	First indigenous air-launched anti-ship missile; ~**55 km**; salvo off Odisha	Science
6	NBS Kharif	~**₹41,534 crore**; P&K fertilisers; 1 Apr–30 Sep	Schemes
7	India–Korea Summit (20–21 Apr)	Lee Jae-myung; chips, shipbuilding, batteries; **CEPA review**	International
8	World Health Day (7 Apr)	Together for health. Stand with science	Health
9	Earth Day (22 Apr)	Our Power, Our Planet	Environment
10	Ladakh districts	Nubra, Sham, Changthang, Zanskar, Drass; total **7**	National
11	Jewar (UP)	Flights targeted late May (later slipped to **15 Jun**); HC clears ~**1,858 ha** (28 Apr)	UP
12	Laureus (Madrid)	Alcaraz; Sabalenka; PSG	Awards

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
Shekha Jheel = Ballia / Etah	**Aligarh**
PFBR already runs on thorium	Criticality with **MOX**; thorium is later
Aridhaman = diesel sub	Nuclear **SSBN** (3rd after Arihant, Arighaat)
Census Phase 1 = caste count	Housing list first; people + caste in **Phase 2 (2027)**

Ramsar step this month

Site	Place	India #	UP #
Shekha Jheel	Aligarh	99	12

(Next: Surha Tal = 100 in June.)

Also useful

- Russia–China veto on Hormuz UNSC resolution
- Meghalaya: Khasi + Garo official with English
- Kankaria depot (Ahmedabad): first water-neutral railway depot
- Khelo India Tribal Games (Chhattisgarh); mascot Morveer
- Harivansh Narayan Singh (RS Deputy Chair); Ashok Lahiri (NITI Vice Chair)

UP tip

Shekha Jheel + Jewar court / timeline. Keep Etah ready. Surha Tal = June.

PART B · MONTHS

May 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	Agni MIRV test (8 May)	Advanced Agni with MIRV from Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha	Science
2	SARTHAK-PDS (27 May)	About **₹25,530 crore** / 5 years; modernise PDS logistics and tech	Schemes
3	Cabinet money cluster	ECLGS 5.0 (~**₹2.55 lakh crore** credit); coal/lignite gasification (~**₹37,500 crore**); Cotton Mission (~**₹5,659 crore**)	Schemes · Economy
4	CDS change (end-May)	Gen **N. S. Raja Subramani** succeeds Gen Anil Chauhan	Personalities
5	Supreme Court strength	Judges excluding CJI **33** → **37**; total with CJI **38**	National
6	Saudi joins IBCA (22 May)	**26th** member; first Arab member in coverage	International
7	International Booker (19 May)	*Taiwan Travelogue* by Yáng Shuāng-zǐ; translator Lin King	Awards · Books
8	IPL 2026 final (31 May)	**RCB** beat Gujarat Titans; Kohli **75***; back-to-back title	Sports
9	Nordic honours (PM Modi)	Norway Order of Merit; Sweden Order of the Polar Star	International
10	South Coast Railway Zone	HQ **Visakhapatnam**; total zones **19**	National
11	Biodiversity Day (22 May)	Theme: Acting locally for global impact	Environment
12	Henley Passport Index	**Singapore** top; India around **78**	Indices

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
SC total still 34	**38** with CJI after strength rise
Saudi = founding IBCA member	Joined May 2026 as **26th**
Jewar opens in May	Target slipped; commercial start **15 June**
Surha Tal = May news	**June** WED fact (Ballia)

Days / themes

Date	Day	Theme
22 May	Biodiversity Day	Acting locally for global impact

Also useful

- Exercise Pragati 2026 at Umroi, Meghalaya (13 nations)
- Agni-1 test on 22 May under Strategic Forces Command
- Sugar export ban till 30 September 2026
- Sikkim covered as first paperless judiciary state
- WHO Ebola emergency linked with DRC and Uganda
- Thomas Cup: China; Uber Cup: South Korea (Denmark host)

UP tip

Jewar's May flight target slipped; commercial ops began **15 June**. Keep **Shekha Jheel (99)** ready; **Surha Tal (100)** is June.

PART B · MONTHS

June 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	Surha Tal Ramsar (5 Jun)	JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary, **Ballia**; India **100**; UP **13**; WED window	Environment · UP
2	UP CAMP (5 Jun)	Clean air ~**₹2,741 crore**; World Bank; first **airshed-based** push	UP
3	WED theme (5 Jun)	Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.	Environment
4	Jewar Airport opens (15 Jun)	Noida International Airport commercial start; first IndiGo from **Lucknow**	UP
5	Yoga Day (21 Jun)	Theme: **Yoga for Healthy Ageing**	Health
6	VB-G RAM G preview	New rural jobs Act from **1 Jul**; guarantee **125** days; replaces MGNREGS	Schemes
7	India–Oman CEPA (~1–2 Jun)	Trade deal in force; ~**99%** duty-free access idea for Indian exports	International · Economy
8	SC footpath judgment	Right to walk on a demarcated footpath = fundamental right (Arts **19(1)(d)** + **21**)	National
9	G7 Summit	Host **France**; theme: Working Together to Address Major International Challenges	International
10	PM Modi honours	Slovakia Order of the White Double Cross; Seychelles Guardian of the Blue Horizon	International
11	Padma investiture	Second block: Vijay Amritraj, Mammootty, Alka Yagnik, Rohit Sharma, etc.	Awards
12	Navy / CG platforms	INS Dunagiri, Sanshodhak, Agray; ICGS Akshay; ACV H-561	Science
13	QS + Future Skills	MIT top; IIT Delhi ~118; Future Skills Index — India ~13	Indices
14	FIFA WC begins	Hosts USA–Canada–Mexico; mascots Maple, Zayu, Clutch	Sports

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
Surha Tal = Etah / Aligarh	**Ballia** (JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary)
India–Oman deal = CETA	**CEPA** with Oman (June); UK **CETA** is July
VB-G already live all month	Preview in June; **in force 1 July**
IBCA Summit held on time	**Postponed** from early June

Ramsar step this month

Site	Place	India #	UP #
Surha Tal	Ballia	100	13

(Chain: Etah → Aligarh → Ballia. Next: Glaw Lake = 101 in August.)

Also useful

- Operation Amistad HADR for Venezuela
- Islamabad MoU US–Iran interim talks (soft IR)
- India's first offshore airport approval path off Palghar, Maharashtra
- India wins FIH Women's Nations Cup in New Zealand
- NITI Aayog 11th Governing Council theme: Inclusive Human Development for Viksit Bharat @2047

UP tip

Must-score UP month: **Surha Tal (100)** + **Jewar open**. Keep Etah–Aligarh–Ballia as one confused-pair set.

PART B · MONTHS

July 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	VB-G RAM G (1–2 Jul)	In force **1 Jul**; launch Mukkavaripalli (Tirupati, AP); **125** days; Centre ~**₹95,692 cr**; total ~**₹1.51 lakh cr**	Schemes
2	India–UK CETA + DCC (15 Jul)	Trade deal + social-security convention both live; ~**99%** Indian goods get UK duty relief	International · Economy
3	FIFA WC final (19 Jul)	**Spain** beat Argentina **1–0** (a.e.t., Ferran Torres); Spain's 2nd title	Sports
4	Project Kusha (23 Jul)	Indigenous long-range SAM maiden test from Kalam Island	Science
5	Vikram-1 / Aagaman (18 Jul)	First privately developed Indian orbital-class rocket; Sriharikota	Science
6	Late-Jul Cabinet energy	**Samudra Manthan** (~₹84,084 cr); **PM Surya Sarovar** (~₹5,070 cr / 5,000 MW); PM-KISAN (~₹3.15 lakh cr)	Schemes
7	Semicon 2.0	**₹1,27,500 crore** ISM 2.0 Cabinet (~15 Jul); guidelines ~end-Aug	Schemes · Economy
8	Women's T20 WC final (5 Jul)	**Australia** beat England at Lord's	Sports
9	Indonesia honour	PM Modi gets **Bintang Adipurna**	International
10	Tiger Day (29 Jul)	Theme: Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities at the heart	Environment
11	SOFI 2026	Hunger ~**645 million** (7.8%); healthy diets unaffordable for ~**2.7 billion**	Indices
12	CWG Glasgow begins	Mascot **Finnie**; Gabon and Togo debut	Sports
13	Mahendragiri + Nilekani panel	6th Project 17A frigate; education reforms task force	Science · Schemes

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
VB-G still 100 days	**125** days
CETA = DCC	**CETA** = trade; **DCC** = social security (both 15 Jul)
Kusha = Agni ballistic	**Kusha** = long-range **air-defence** SAM
Samudra Manthan = naval drill	Deep-sea **oil & gas** exploration Cabinet scheme

VB-G quick board

Point	Fact
Days	125 (was 100)
Force date	1 July 2026
Launch place	Mukkavaripalli, Tirupati, AP
Centre money (Y1)	~₹95,692 crore

Full compare → Master tables.

Also useful

- World Zoonoses Day: One World, One Health: Prevent Zoonoses
- PV Sindhu wins Japan Open (first Indian reported)
- Kartavya Bhawan Complex naming for Central Vista area
- Direct commercial freight train India → Nepal (Biratnagar)
- Pralhad Joshi as Education Minister; Anurag Jain as NITI CEO
- Revamped Khelo India (~₹36,441 cr in Cabinet coverage)

UP tip

No giant new UP headline. Keep **Surha Tal (100)** and **Jewar (15 Jun)**. Watch VB-G state rollout cards.

PART B · MONTHS

August 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	80th Independence Day (15 Aug)	Dual themes: 150 years of **Vande Mataram** + **Yuva Shakti** for Viksit Bharat @2047; Modi's 13th Red Fort speech	National
2	Shakti Ki Saptadhara	Seven streams: manufacturing, agri-food, tech, Gati Shakti, defence, green–blue economy, soft power	Schemes
3	I-Day number facts	AI training for **1 crore** youth; Lakhpati Didi **6 crore**; nuclear **100 GW by 2047**; 7–8 semiconductor plants	Schemes · Economy
4	MMDR Amendment Act, 2026	Uniform mineral-tax framework; Centre conditions on state mineral levies	Economy
5	Glaw Lake Ramsar	Arunachal's first; India **101**; inside **Kamlang** Tiger Reserve	Environment
6	AK-203 'Sher' (Amethi)	First fully indigenous rifle from **Korwa** IRRPL plant	Science · UP
7	National Space Day (23 Aug)	3rd edition; Viksit Bharat space theme; ~**8** launch + **12** satellite missions planned	Science
8	CWG Glasgow results	India **4th**; **39** medals (**13G–17S–9B**); Mirabai Chanu opening flag bearer	Sports
9	UP expressways Cabinet	Ganga Expressway → **Haridwar** (~₹10,761 cr); **Jhansi Link** (~₹7,968 cr)	UP
10	Uzbekistan honour	PM Modi: Order of **Oliy Darajali Dustlik** (Tashkent)	International
11	Dirac Medal	**Deepak Dhar** (ICTP statistical physics)	Awards
12	Grand Chess Tour	**Praggnanandhaa** wins (first Indian reported)	Sports
13	Miss Universe India	**Kaziah Liz Mejo** (Kerala), crowned in Jaipur	Awards

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
Glaw Lake = UP Ramsar	**Arunachal**; India **101**
Sher plant = Kanpur / Jhansi	**Korwa, Amethi**
Ladakh gets a new High Court	New **High Court Bench** (not a full new HC)
Ganga Expressway ends only in UP	Extension cleared toward **Haridwar**

Ramsar step this month

Site	Place	India #
Glaw Lake	Arunachal (Kamlang TR)	101

UP 2026 trio stays Etah → Aligarh → Ballia.

Days / themes

Date	Day	Theme / slogan
12 Aug	World Elephant Day	Bringing the world together to help elephants
12 Aug	International Youth Day	Different Contexts, Common Aspirations
23 Aug	National Space Day	Towards Viksit Bharat… Global Space Leadership
29 Aug	National Sports Day	Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat

Also useful

- INS Nipun (second Nistar-class diving support vessel)
- FIH Hockey World Cup: Belgium (men), Argentina (women)
- Soft Hormuz 60-day reopen understanding (Iran–Oman)

UP tip

Sher / Korwa Amethi + **Ganga–Haridwar** + **Jhansi Link** are the UP must-scores. Keep Surha Tal (100) and Jewar as revision pairs.

PART B · MONTHS

September 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	18th BRICS Summit (12–13 Sep)	Host **New Delhi** (Bharat Mandapam); India's 2026 chairship; theme **Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability**	International
2	New Delhi Declaration	Leaders adopted the **New Delhi Declaration**; MEA tagged **50+** action outcomes under India's chairship year	International
3	UNGA 81st President	**Khalilur Rahman** (Bangladesh) begins term **8 Sep**; theme *Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation…*	International · Appointments
4	Asian Games 2026 (Aichi–Nagoya)	Host **Japan**; late-Sep India haul includes **kabaddi double gold** (men + women vs Iran) and women's cricket gold	Sports
5	Marathon history	**Sawan Barwal** — men's marathon **silver** + national record (**2:11:37**); first Indian man in decades to medal in this event	Sports
6	57th GST Council	Was due **12 Sep**; moved to **7 Oct 2026** because of BRICS; October agenda = **process reforms** (GST 2.0), not a fresh rate cut round	Economy
7	National Formulary of India 2026	**7th edition** released **21 Sep** by MoS **Anupriya Patel**; about **653** monographs (IPC)	Health
8	World Ozone Day (16 Sep)	Theme: **Global action for a cooler planet** (10 years of Kigali Amendment / sustainable cooling)	Environment
9	International Day of Peace (21 Sep)	Theme: **Invest in Peace — For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day**	Environment
10	NCSK appointments (6 Sep)	Chairperson **Bhagwat Prasad Makwana**; Vice-Chair **Kaishab Bihari**; tenure till **31 Mar 2028**	Appointments
11	Hindi Diwas / Engineers' Day	**14 Sep** Hindi Diwas (Art. 343 link); **15 Sep** Engineers' Day (Visvesvaraya)	National
12	Pharmacovigilance Week	**17–23 Sep**; theme on rational use of medicines through pharmacovigilance (with NFI release)	Health

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
18th BRICS Summit = Rio / Kazan	**New Delhi, 12–13 Sep 2026** (India chair)
GST Council met on 12 Sep 2026 for new rates	Meeting **shifted to 7 Oct**; focus is **process**, not another rate overhaul
Kabaddi gold = only men's team	**Both** men's and women's teams beat **Iran**
Ozone Day = Climate Day / Biodiversity Day	**16 Sep**; Montreal Protocol anniversary + **Kigali** cooling theme
UNGA President = always from India this year	**Bangladesh's Khalilur Rahman** for the 81st session

Days / themes

Date	Day	Theme / slogan
14 Sep	Hindi Diwas	Official language / Art. 343 revision link
15 Sep	Engineers' Day (India)	Sir M. Visvesvaraya
16 Sep	World Ozone Day	Global action for a cooler planet
21 Sep	International Day of Peace	Invest in Peace — For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day

Also useful

- BRICS Plus / Outreach dialogue sat with the Leaders' Summit week.
- ACC senior appointments package (including CBSE Chairperson **Mandeep K. Bhandari** in September coverage).
- DWBDNC Governing Body members **Narayan Dewasi** and **Swaroop Singh Banjara** (Social Justice ministry).
- Asian Games medal count kept moving through late September — revise final tally after the Games close; do not freeze an early mid-Games number as final.

UP tip

No brand-new UP mega-project headline this month. Keep August's **Sher (Amethi)** + **Ganga–Haridwar / Jhansi Link**, and the Ramsar trio **Etah** → **Aligarh** → **Ballia**.

UK tip

No separate UK mega-headline confirmed for this digest yet. Keep UCC / National Games / Silkyara spine on UK Special.

PART B · MONTHS

October 2026

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	
1	5 New Classical Languages	Union Cabinet approved **5 new Classical Languages**: **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali**; total in India jumps from 6 to **11**	Schemes / Policies · Culture
2	51st Chief Justice of India	**Justice Sanjiv Khanna** appointed as the **51st Chief Justice of India (CJI)** (formal notification 24 Oct; oath 11 Nov), succeeding CJI D.Y. Chandrachud	Appointments
3	Nobel Prize in Medicine	**Victor Ambros** & **Gary Ruvkun** (USA) for the discovery of **microRNA** and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation	Awards · Health
4	Nobel Prize in Physics	**John J. Hopfield** & **Geoffrey E. Hinton** for foundational discoveries enabling **machine learning with artificial neural networks**	Awards
5	Nobel Prize in Chemistry	**David Baker** (computational protein design) + **Demis Hassabis** & **John M. Jumper** (protein structure prediction via AlphaFold)	Awards
6	Nobel Prize in Literature & Peace	Literature: **Han Kang** (South Korea — 1st South Korean); Peace: **Nihon Hidankyo** (Japan atomic bomb survivors grassroots organisation)	Awards
7	Nobel in Economics	**Daron Acemoglu, Simon Johnson, & James A. Robinson** for studies on how **institutions are formed and affect prosperity**	Awards
8	Rabi MSP 2025–26 / 2026–27	Wheat MSP hiked by **₹150** to **₹2,425/quintal**; Rapeseed & Mustard hiked by **₹300** to **₹5,950/quintal** (highest absolute hike); Barley ₹1,980; Gram ₹5,650; Lentil ₹6,700	Economy
9	PM Modi in Varanasi (20 Oct)	Inaugurated projects worth **₹6,700+ crore** including **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital**, **Sigra Sports Complex (Phases 2 & 3)**, and **Varanasi Airport expansion** foundation (₹2,870 cr)	UP Special
10	8th Ayodhya Deepotsav	Guinness World Record lighting **26,17,215 earthen diyas** across **56 ghats** along the Saryu River (Ram Ki Paidi); simultaneous Maha Aarti by **2,128 priests**	UP Special
11	India's 2nd VLF Station	Defence Minister Rajnath Singh laid the foundation stone for India's 2nd naval **Very Low Frequency (VLF) Station** at **Damagundam Forest, Vikarabad (Telangana)** (1st is INS Kattabomman, Tirunelveli, TN)	Science / Defence
12	16th BRICS Summit & Border Pact	16th BRICS Summit in **Kazan, Russia** (22–24 Oct); India & China reached an LAC patrolling disengagement pact in Eastern Ladakh (**Demchok & Depsang**); structured Modi–Xi bilateral meeting held	International

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
Total Classical Languages in India = 6 or 8	Total is now **11** (Tamil, Sanskrit, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Odia + Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, Bengali)
Hindi is a Classical Language	**No** — Hindi is the official language of the Union (Art. 343) and an Eighth Schedule language, but **not** a notified Classical Language
51st CJI = Justice B.R. Gavai	**Justice Sanjiv Khanna** is the 51st CJI; Justice B.R. Gavai is slated to succeed him later in 2025
Nobel Physics was for quantum mechanics	It was awarded for **artificial neural networks & machine learning** (Hopfield & Hinton)
Wheat MSP = ₹2,275 per quintal	That was the older rate; revised MSP is **₹2,425 per quintal** (+₹150 hike)
Damagundam VLF station is India's first	It is India's **second** VLF naval communication facility; 1st is **INS Kattabomman** (Tirunelveli, Tamil Nadu, 1990)
ICC Women's T20 World Cup won by Australia/India	Won by **New Zealand** (defeating South Africa by 32 runs in Dubai; maiden title)
23rd SCO Heads of Government Summit was in Beijing	Held in **Islamabad, Pakistan** (attended by EAM S. Jaishankar — 1st Indian EAM visit to Pakistan in 9 years)

Days / themes

Date	Day	Theme / slogan
2 Oct	International Day of Non-Violence	Gandhi Jayanti observance
5 Oct	World Teachers' Day	Standing with teachers: valuing teacher voices for education
7 Oct	World Cotton Day	Cotton for Good

Date	Day	Theme / slogan
8 Oct	Indian Air Force Day	92nd Anniversary air show held at Marina Beach, Chennai
9 Oct	World Post Day	150 years of enabling communication and empowering peoples
10 Oct	World Mental Health Day	It is time to prioritize mental health in the workplace
11 Oct	International Day of the Girl Child	Girls' vision for the future
12 Oct	World Migratory Bird Day	Protect Insects, Protect Birds
13 Oct	International Day for Disaster Risk Reduction	Empowering the next generation for a resilient future
15 Oct	World Students' Day	Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam birth anniversary
16 Oct	World Food Day	Right to foods for a better life and a better future / Innovate today. Nourish tomorrow
20 Oct	World Statistics Day	Collaborative data for resilient governance
24 Oct	United Nations Day & World Polio Day	A Campaign to Reach Every Child

Also useful

- **Global Hunger Index (GHI) 2024/2026:** India ranked **105th out of 127 countries** (Score: **27.3**, Category: **Serious**; Child Wasting: **18.7%**; published by Welthungerhilfe and Concern Worldwide).
- **Global Innovation Index (GII) 2024/2026:** India rose to **39th rank** out of 133 economies (published by WIPO; Switzerland ranked #1 for 14th year; India #1 in Central/Southern Asia and lower-middle-income group).
- **54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award:** Conferred upon veteran actor **Mithun Chakraborty** at the 70th National Film Awards ceremony (Best Actor: Rishab Shetty for *Kantara*; Best Actress: Nithya Menen & Manasi Parekh; Best Feature Film: *Aattam*).
- **Space Milestones:** SpaceX Starship Flight 5 made history on **13 Oct** by catching the Super Heavy booster mid-air with launch tower mechanical arms ("chopsticks"). NASA launched **Europa Clipper** on **14 Oct** atop SpaceX Falcon Heavy to explore Jupiter's icy moon.
- **Assembly Elections: Nayab Singh Saini** sworn in as Haryana CM (BJP 48 seats) on **17 Oct**; **Omar Abdullah** sworn in as the **first Chief Minister of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir** on **16 Oct**.
- **Exercise Malabar 2026:** Quad maritime exercise (India, US, Japan, Australia) conducted off Visakhapatnam and the Bay of Bengal from **8–18 Oct**.
- **RBI Monetary Policy (Oct):** Repo rate unchanged at **6.50%**; stance shifted to **"Neutral"**.

UP tip

- **Varanasi Package (20 Oct):** PM Modi inaugurated the **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital** at Harhua, the modernised **Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Complex at Sigra** (Phases 2 & 3), and laid the foundation stone for the **₹2,870 crore runway and terminal expansion of Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport**.
- **Ayodhya Deepotsav:** Reached **26,17,215 earthen diyas** across 56 ghats along the Saryu River (Guinness Record), paired with a synchronized Maha Aarti by **2,128 priests**.
- **UP International Trade Show (UPITS):** 2nd edition held at India Expo Centre & Mart, **Greater Noida** with **Vietnam** as the Partner Country.

UK tip

- **Char Dham Winter Portals Closure:** Gangotri, Yamunotri, Kedarnath, and Badrinath portals announced winter closure dates starting from Govardhan Puja / Bhai Dooj toward Ukhimath, Joshimath, Kharsali, and Mukhba winter seats. Keep the winter seats matched to shrines!
- **Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Rules:** State rules drafting committee headed by Shatrughan Singh completed final operational portal workflows for compulsory marriage and live-in relationship registration under the Uttarakhand UCC Act.

PART C · TOPICS

01 — International

> **Priority S** | About **22%** of Current Affairs questions In 2024–25 papers, many of these were tagged as **International Relations**, not only "Current Affairs".

What to note every time

Before you finish reading any international news, answer these in simple words:

Ask yourself	Why
Where was it held?	City and country
Who went from India?	PM, President, External Affairs Minister, or someone else
What was decided?	Treaty, MoU, declaration, project
Is it binding?	Must follow, or only a promise
Any neighbour / trade angle?	Pipeline, bus, FTA, UPI, defence deal
Org head or membership?	HQ, chief, or "who is **not** a member"

High-Yield International Summits Foundation (2024–2025 Spine)

> **UPPCS Priority Alert:** International summits, host venues, themes, membership expansions, and declaration names form ~22% of CA questions. Memorise these core institutional anchors.

1. 16th BRICS Summit (October 2024 | Kazan, Russia)

- **Host City & President:** Kazan, Tatarstan (Russia); chaired by Russian President Vladimir Putin.
- **Theme:** *"Strengthening Multilateralism for Just Global Development and Security"*.
- **Historic Expansion:** First summit held after the formal induction of new full members: **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and UAE** (Saudi Arabia participated as invited nation; Argentina opted out under Javier Milei).
- **Outcome Document: Kazan Declaration** — reiterated call for reforming the UN Security Council, promoting local currency settlements (BRICS Pay / Cross-Border Payment Initiative), and condemning unilateral coercive measures.
- **Partner Country Category:** Introduced 13 new "Partner Countries" (e.g., Turkey, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, Vietnam, Belarus, Cuba, Nigeria, Uganda, Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, Bolivia, Algeria).
- **India–China Bilateral Breakthrough:** PM Narendra Modi and President Xi Jinping held their first formal bilateral summit in 5 years on the sidelines, endorsing the border patrolling pact along the LAC in eastern Ladakh (Depsang and Demchok).

2. 19th G20 Leaders' Summit (November 2024 | Rio de Janeiro, Brazil)

- **Host City & Chair:** Rio de Janeiro, Brazil; chaired by Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva.
- **Theme:** *"Building a Just World and a Sustainable Planet"*.
- **Key Initiative:** Formal launch of the **Global Alliance Against Hunger and Poverty** (founded with over 80 countries, international organisations, and development banks).
- **G20 Troika Transition: India (2023) → Brazil (2024) → South Africa (2025)** — the first historic Troika composed consecutively of developing economies (Global South). Handover of G20 gavel to South African President Cyril Ramaphosa for the 2025 summit.
- **Rio Declaration:** Emphasized taxing ultra-high-net-worth individuals, climate finance, and accelerating reform of the international financial architecture.

3. UNFCCC COP29 Climate Summit (November 2024 | Baku, Azerbaijan)

- **Host City & Chair:** Baku, Azerbaijan; chaired by Mukhtar Babayev.
- **Known as:** The **"Finance COP"**.
- **NCQG (New Collective Quantified Goal):** Replaced the outdated $100 billion annual climate finance goal. Adopted a new target: developed countries to lead in mobilizing at least **$300 billion annually by 2035** for developing nations (developing nations termed the amount grossly inadequate compared to their estimated $1.3 trillion annual need).
- **Article 6 Carbon Markets:** Finalized long-delayed operational rules for **Article 6.4 of the Paris Agreement**, paving the way for a centralized, UN-supervised international carbon credit trading market.

- **Next COP Host: COP30** to be hosted in **Belém, Brazil (November 2025)** in the Amazon biome.

3A. India–Middle East–Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) | MoU at G20 New Delhi, September 2023

What happened Partners signed an MoU to build **IMEC**, a multimodal corridor linking **India, the Arabian Gulf, and Europe**.

Core facts

- **East corridor:** India ↔ Arabian Gulf (mainly **maritime**).
- **Northern corridor:** Gulf ↔ Europe (mainly **rail**, then Mediterranean sea legs).
- Founding participants include **India, USA, UAE, Saudi Arabia, EU, France, Germany, Italy**. **China is not a founding participant.**
- Also envisaged: power cables, digital links, and clean hydrogen pipes along the route.

Do not put China in the founding MoU list. IMEC is often contrasted with China's Belt and Road Initiative, but China is not a founder.

3B. India elected to ECOSOC | June 2025 | term 2026–28

What happened The UN General Assembly elected **India** to the **Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)** for **2026–28**.

Core facts

- Election is by **regional groups**. India won under the **Asia-Pacific** group (**181 / 187** valid votes).
- Term begins **1 January 2026**.
- ECOSOC has **54** members elected for **three-year** terms.
- ECOSOC is a **principal organ** of the UN. It is **not** a subsidiary body of the Security Council.

Preeti Saran re-elected to CESCR | April 2026 news window

What happened Former Indian diplomat **Preeti Saran** was **re-elected** to the UN **Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (CESCR)**.

Core facts

- CESCR monitors the **International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights**.
- Members serve in a **personal capacity** (expert body), not as country delegates in the usual diplomatic sense.
- She has also served as **Chair** of CESCR (first Indian in that chair in recent coverage).
- Term cited in 2026 election coverage: **2027–2030**.

CESCR ≠ ECOSOC membership itself. Name trap: **Preeti Saran**, not Ruchira Kamboj.

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4. 50th G7 Summit (June 2024 | Apulia / Fasano, Italy)

- **Host:** Borgo Egnazia, Fasano, Apulia (Italy); chaired by Italian PM Giorgia Meloni.
- **India's Participation:** PM Narendra Modi attended as an **Invited Outreach Nation** (his first foreign visit after taking oath for his third term).
- **Key Outcome:** Agreement to provide a **$50 billion loan to Ukraine** backed by the interest/windfall profits from frozen Russian sovereign assets. Launched the Energy Growth in Africa initiative.

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5. UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage Session (December 2025 | New Delhi)

- **Venue & Chair:** 20th session of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage held at **Red Fort, New Delhi** (8–13 December 2025); chaired by **Vishal V. Sharma** (India's Permanent Delegate to UNESCO).
- **Landmark Inscription: Deepavali** was inscribed on the **UNESCO Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity**.
- **India's Total Count:** Increased to **16** intangible cultural heritage elements inscribed on UNESCO's list.

January 2026

India–EU leaders' meeting | 27 January 2026 | New Delhi

What happened The President of the European Council, **António Costa**, and the President of the European Commission, **Ursula von der Leyen**, visited India. They held a summit-style meeting with Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**. The visit produced a long list of agreements. For the , you do not need every line. You need the big decisions and the easy traps.

Free Trade Agreement (FTA)

- India and the EU said they have **finished negotiations** on the **India–EU Free Trade Agreement**.

- Official messages called it India's **largest FTA** with a big partner market.
- Finishing talks is **not** the same as the deal already being in force. Signature and ratification come later.
- Sensitive areas such as **dairy** and some **auto** items were described as protected in public briefings. Do not memorise fake duty tables until a clear official factsheet is locked.

Other major outcomes

- Both sides adopted a long-term plan titled **Towards 2030: A Joint India–European Union Comprehensive Strategic Agenda**.
- They signed a **Security and Defence Partnership**.
- They started talks on an India–EU **Security of Information Agreement**.
- They signed an MoU on **mobility** (skills, students, professionals). An EU **pilot Legal Gateway Office** in India was also announced.
- India's **NDMA** and the EU's disaster body **DG-ECHO** signed an arrangement on disaster risk management and emergency response.
- A **Green Hydrogen Task Force** was set up.
- The India–EU science and technology cooperation agreement was renewed for **2025–2030**.
- Exploratory talks began on India linking with the EU research programme **Horizon Europe**.
- Four joint projects under India–EU trilateral cooperation were announced (digital skills for women and youth; solar help for women farmers; early warning systems; solar energy support for Africa and small island states).

Same news for Economy notes

Trade numbers and the **RBI–ESMA** MoU are also kept under Economy / Budget / Trade.

February 2026

India–AI Impact Summit 2026 | 16–20 February 2026 | Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi

What happened India hosted a big global Artificial Intelligence summit at **Bharat Mandapam** in New Delhi. Official notes call it the first major global AI summit of this kind held in the **Global South**. The Ministry of Electronics and IT / IndiaAI ecosystem anchored the event.

Core facts

- Dates: **16 to 20 February 2026**.
- Venue: **Bharat Mandapam**, New Delhi.
- The summit's three pillars (called **Sutras**) are **People**, **Planet**, and **Progress**.
- Some PIB notes also used a **Seven Chakras** framing for AI action areas. For prelims, first remember the three Sutras; add Chakras only if a stem asks.
- About **86 countries** supported the summit declaration (some briefings also mention international organisations).
- The message stressed **human-centred AI** and "welfare of all".
- Summit wrap-ups spoke of infrastructure investment pledges above **250 billion US dollars**, plus extra venture and deep-tech money.
- India joined the US-led **Pax Silica Declaration**. This is about safer supply chains for critical minerals, semiconductors, and AI infrastructure.
- The closing days included **GPAI Council** meetings (noted around **20 February**).

Link to awards

March 2026

WTO Ministerial Conference 14 (MC14) | Yaoundé, Cameroon

What happened The World Trade Organization held its **14th Ministerial Conference** in **Yaoundé**, Cameroon. It was only the second WTO ministerial meeting held in Africa. The meeting ended **without** a big binding deal on several hard issues.

Core facts

- Place: **Yaoundé**, Cameroon.
- E-commerce customs duty moratorium talks did not produce a lasting deal that all sides accepted in the way many countries wanted.

- India, along with partners such as South Africa in coverage, opposed pushing the **Investment Facilitation for Development (IFD)** agreement in the way some members wanted.
- Basic WTO memory: HQ **Geneva**; Director-General **Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala**.

Global Terrorism Index 2026 | Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)

What happened The **Global Terrorism Index 2026** said **Pakistan** ranked **number one** for the first time in this report's recent pattern. Global terrorism deaths were reported to have fallen, while the **Sahel** region remained a major hotspot.

Core facts

- Publisher: **IEP**.
- Top country in 2026 edition messaging: **Pakistan**.
- Also revise: IEP publishes the **Global Peace Index** too.

April 2026

India–Republic of Korea Summit | 20–21 April 2026

What happened Republic of Korea Prime Minister **Lee Jae-myung** made a state visit to India on **20–21 April 2026**. Talks focused on making the Special Strategic Partnership more practical, with MoUs and work plans on industry and defence.

Core facts

- Partner country: **Republic of Korea (South Korea)**.
- Visit window: **20–21 April 2026**.
- Key areas named in coverage: shipbuilding, semiconductors, EV batteries, defence co-development, and a climate / clean-energy pillar.
- Both sides spoke of a time-bound review of the India–Korea **CEPA** (in force since **2010**).
- A high-profile visit stop named in coverage: **Lothal National Maritime Heritage Complex**, Gujarat.

UNSC vote on the Strait of Hormuz

What happened The UN Security Council voted on a resolution about reopening the **Strait of Hormuz**, a key oil shipping choke point. **Russia** and **China** used their veto.

Core facts

- Vote pattern in coverage: **11** in favour, **2** against (Russia, China), **2** abstentions.
- The resolution was associated with a Bahrain-led proposal in compilations.
- Soft follow-up: mediation and ceasefire talk involving **Pakistan** and failed US–Iran peace talks also appeared in April IR coverage.

Soft law facts from abroad

- The UK Parliament passed the **Tobacco and Vapes Bill** path that blocks cigarette sales for people born on or after **1 January 2009**.
- **Turkey** tightened social-media access rules for children under **15**.

9th Indian Ocean Conference (IOC 2026) | 10–12 April 2026

- **Host Country: Mauritius**.
- **Theme: *"Collective Stewardship for Indian Ocean Governance"***.
- **Significance:** Organised in collaboration with India Foundation to address maritime security, blue economy, and ecological resilience across the Indian Ocean Region.

May 2026

Saudi Arabia joins International Big Cat Alliance | 22 May 2026

What happened Saudi Arabia joined the India-led **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)** as the **26th** member country. Coverage called it the first Arab country on the platform.

Core facts

- New member: **Saudi Arabia** (26th).
- Alliance focus: seven big cats — tiger, lion, leopard, snow leopard, cheetah, jaguar, and puma.
- India is home to **five** of these (not jaguar or puma).

- HQ of IBCA: **New Delhi**.
- Seed funding memory from older notes: about **₹150 crore** for 2023–2028.

Santa Marta Climate Conference | Colombia

What happened The first international conference on **transitioning away from fossil fuels** was held in **Santa Marta, Colombia**. It was co-hosted by **Colombia** and the **Netherlands**.

Core facts

- Place: **Santa Marta**.
- Theme focus: moving away from fossil fuels.
- Soft follow-up: France's fuel-by-fuel exit roadmap (coal by 2030, oil by 2045, gas by 2050) appeared in the same news window.

PM Modi's foreign civilian honours

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** received high civilian honours from Nordic countries during May coverage of his visit window.

Core facts

- **Norway:** Grand Cross of the **Royal Norwegian Order of Merit**.
- **Sweden: Royal Order of the Polar Star**, Commander Grand Cross.

UAE Formally Withdraws from OPEC | 1 May 2026

What happened The **United Arab Emirates (UAE)** formally withdrew its membership from the **Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC)** with effect from **1 May 2026**, shifting its focus toward sovereign production quota flexibility and green transition partnerships.

June 2026

52nd G7 Summit | Évian-les-Bains, France | 15–17 June 2026

What happened The **52nd G7 Summit** was hosted by **France** at **Évian-les-Bains**, under the presidency of French President **Emmanuel Macron**. Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** represented India as an invited partner nation.

Core facts - **Venue: Évian-les-Bains, France**. - **Theme: *"Working Together to Address Major International Challenges"***. - **Key Outcome:** Adoption of the *Leaders' Declaration on Tackling Migrant Smuggling*. - **Initiatives:** Japanese PM Sanae Takaichi introduced the *POWERR Asia* initiative. - **G7 members:** Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, the UK, and the USA.

16th BRICS Agriculture Ministers' Meeting | 12–13 June 2026

- **Host Venue: Indore, Madhya Pradesh** (held under India's BRICS Presidency).
- **Declaration Adopted: *Indore Declaration*** on sustainable agriculture, digital farming, and smallholder resilience.

Multilateral Institutional Expansions (June 2026)

- **New Development Bank (NDB): Uzbekistan** admitted as the **10th member country** of NDB.
- **UN General Assembly (UNGA) 81st Session:** Ambassador **Khalilur Rahman** of **Bangladesh** was elected President of the 81st UNGA session (term begins 8 September 2026), defeating Andreas Kakouris of Cyprus.

US–Iran interim pact | Islamabad MoU

What happened Coverage spoke of a **14-point** interim understanding called the **Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding**, mediated by **Pakistan**, linked with talks around the G7 window. It aimed to pause hostilities and open a negotiation window on nuclear and sanctions issues.

Soft facts

- Mediator often named: **Pakistan**.
- Nuclear monitoring body named: **IAEA**.
- Treat exact clauses carefully; stems may twist who lifts what.

Operation Amistad | Venezuela HADR

What happened India launched **Operation Amistad**, a Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief mission after earthquakes in **Venezuela**.

Core facts

- Two IAF **C-17 Globemaster** aircraft in early coverage.
- A rescue team of about **41** members was reported.
- Aim: relief supplies and rescue support.

PM Modi's June foreign honours

- **Slovakia: Order of the White Double Cross**, First Class (highest state honour).
- **Seychelles: Guardian of the Blue Horizon** (environment / sustainable development distinction in coverage).

IBCA Summit postponed

The first **International Big Cat Alliance** Summit planned for about **1–2 June** in New Delhi was **rescheduled** so African partners could join more fully (linked with India–Africa Forum Summit timing). Theme planned for the summit: **Save Big Cats, Save Humanity, Save Ecosystem**. Expected outcome named earlier: a **Delhi Declaration**.

India–Oman CEPA | in force early June 2026

What happened The **India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** came into force around **1–2 June 2026**. It deepens trade with Oman in West Asia.

Easy facts

- Partner: **Oman**.
- Deal type: **CEPA** (trade partnership).
- Indian exports get duty-free access on about **99%** of trade value in explainers (up from a much smaller MFN share).
- Soft follow-up: about **7.5 lakh** Indians live in Oman in older population notes; bilateral trade is often put near **USD 12 billion**.

July 2026

India–UK CETA and Double Contribution Convention | in force 15 July 2026

What happened The India–UK **Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** came into force on **15 July 2026**. On the same day, the companion social-security deal called the **Double Contribution Convention (DCC)** also began.

Core facts

- Trade deal name: **CETA** (also called the UK–India FTA).
- Force date: **15 July 2026**.
- Signed earlier: **24 July 2025** in London.
- About **99%** of Indian goods entering the UK get zero or lower duty in coverage; about **90%** of UK goods entering India get relief in UK messaging.
- **DCC** is separate: workers and employers pay social security in only one country for a period. Exemption period raised to **5 years** in Indian messaging.
- Do not call CETA and DCC the same agreement.

PM Modi's Indonesia honour

- Indonesia conferred the **Bintang Adipurna** (highest civilian honour) on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**.
- Linked with the India–Indonesia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.

Soft UK politics fact

- **Andy Burnham** became UK Prime Minister in late July coverage after replacing Keir Starmer as Labour leader.

France social-media age ban

- France passed a bill barring children under **15** from social media (first EU country with a blanket ban in coverage). Encyclopaedias and educational sites stay open.

August 2026

PM Modi receives Uzbekistan's highest state award

What happened In Tashkent, President **Shavkat Mirziyoyev** conferred Uzbekistan's supreme state award on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**.

Core facts

- Award name: **Order of Oliy Darajali Dustlik**.

- Place: **Tashkent**, Uzbekistan.

Soft Hormuz and Nauru notes

- **Iran** and **Oman** agreed in coverage to reopen the **Strait of Hormuz** for about **60 days**, with inbound traffic near Iran and outbound near Oman.
- Pacific island **Nauru** changed its official name to the **Republic of Naoero** (code **NRO** in coverage). It remains among the world's smallest countries.

Soft grassland guide at UNCCD COP17

India launched the first **Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems of India** at the **17th** session of **UNCCD COP17** in **Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia**. Full soft environment card → Environment.

In-Depth Bilateral Relations & State Visits (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

1. India–Cyprus Strategic Partnership (20–23 May 2026)

- **Visiting Dignitary**: President **Nikos Christodoulides** paid an official State Visit to India (his first visit in his current capacity).
- **Elevation of Ties**: Bilateral relations formally elevated to a **Strategic Partnership**.
- **Diplomatic Milestone**: Commemorates the upcoming **65th anniversary of diplomatic relations in 2027**.
- **Defence Roadmap**: Agreed on a 5-year roadmap for defence cooperation (**2026–2031**) between Cyprus Defence & Space Industries Cluster and Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM).
- **Financial & Space Integration**:
- MoU between **NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)** and **Eurobank Cyprus**.
- Framework established for interoperability of India's **UPI** with the **TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS)** of the European Central Bank.
- Space cooperation between **ERATOSTHENES Centre of Excellence** and **IN-SPACe**.

2. Myanmar President U Min Aung Hlaing Visit to India (30 May – 3 June 2026)

- **Significance**: First foreign trip undertaken by Myanmar President **U Min Aung Hlaing** since assuming office.
- **Foreign Policy Anchors**: Anchored under India's **"Neighbourhood First"** and **"Act East"** policies.
- **Spiritual & Tech Stops**:
- Offered prayers at **Mahabodhi Temple** (Bodh Gaya), Mahabodhi Meditation Centre, and Sujata Temple.
- Toured the **NTPC Energy Technology Research Alliance (NETRA)** complex in Greater Noida (UP) to observe clean energy and green hydrogen R&D.
- **Connectivity Projects Reaffirmed**:
- **Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project (KMMTTP)**: Connects Kolkata to **Sittwe Port** in Myanmar $\rightarrow$ inland waterway along Kaladan River to **Paletwa** $\rightarrow$ highway to **Zorinpui in Mizoram**.
- **India–Myanmar–Thailand (IMT) Trilateral Highway**: Critical land route connecting Northeast India to ASEAN.

3. India–South Korea "Futuristic Partnership" (19–21 April 2026)

- **Visiting Dignitary**: South Korean President **Lee Jae-myung** held summit talks with PM Modi at Hyderabad House, New Delhi.
- **Framework**: Special Strategic Partnership (established in 2015) upgraded towards a *"futuristic partnership"*.
- **Key Bilateral Outcomes**:
- **Bilateral Trade Target**: Set at **USD 54 billion by 2030** (currently ~$27 billion).
- **Economic Security Dialogue**: Initiated to secure critical technologies and resilient semiconductor supply chains.
- **India–Korea Digital Bridge**: Focus on AI, semiconductors, and digital infrastructure.
- **Defence**: Shipbuilding and naval infrastructure (highlighted by the proven **K-9 Vajra** self-propelled howitzer partnership).
- **Cultural**: **2028–29** officially declared the **"Year of India–ROK Friendship"**.

4. India–Jordan Bilateral Milestone (15–16 December 2025)

- **Significance**: PM Narendra Modi paid an official visit to Amman; **first full-fledged bilateral visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Jordan in 37 years**.
- **Milestone**: Marked **75 years of diplomatic relations** with King Abdullah II ibn Al Hussein.
- **8-Point Vision**: Encompasses trade, fertilizers, IT, healthcare, infrastructure, critical minerals, civil nuclear cooperation, and people-to-people ties.

- **Food Security Strategic Anchor**: Jordan supplies vital **phosphates and potash fertilisers** essential for India's agricultural security.
- **Agreements Signed**: 5 MoUs covering renewable energy, water management, cultural exchange, heritage twinning, and Digital Public Infrastructure (including proposed UPI integration).

5. India–UAE Comprehensive Strategic Outcomes (Jan & May 2026)

- **Summit Meetings**: UAE President **Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan (MBZ)** visited India on 19 January 2026; PM Modi visited UAE in May 2026 (kick-starting a 5-nation tour).
- **Strategic Petroleum Reserves (SPR)**:
- Strategic Collaboration MoU between **Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited (ISPRL)** and **Abu Dhabi National Oil Company (ADNOC)**.
- Provides for potential ADNOC crude storage up to **30 million barrels** in India's SPR facilities at **Visakhapatnam (AP)** and the upcoming reserve at **Chandikhol (Odisha)**.
- Includes provision for potential Indian crude oil storage at **Fujairah (UAE)**.
- **Maritime & Supercomputing Hubs**:
- MoU between **Cochin Shipyard Limited** and **Drydocks World** to establish a **Ship Repair Cluster at Vadinar (Gujarat)** with offshore fabrication under the Maritime Development Fund Scheme.
- Term sheet signed between **C-DAC (India)** and **G42 (UAE)** to establish an **8-exaflop supercomputing cluster**.
- Operationalised the Virtual Trade Corridor using **MAITRI** (*Master Application for International Trade and Regulatory Interface*).
- **Trade & Energy**:
- **HPCL–ADNOC Gas Agreement**: 10-year Sale and Purchase Agreement (SPA) for **0.5 MMTPA LNG** starting 2028.
- Development of **Dholera Special Investment Region (SIR)** in Gujarat with UAE partnership.
- Setting up of **DP World** and **First Abu Dhabi Bank (FAB)** in **GIFT City**.
- Establishment of **"House of India"** in Abu Dhabi (museum of Indian art and heritage); UAE providing artefacts for the **National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC) at Lothal**.

6. India–Afghanistan Engagement & Mission Upgrade (October 2025)

- **High-Level Visit**: Afghan Acting Foreign Minister **Amir Khan Muttaqi** visited India (9–16 October 2025) — highest-level engagement since the Taliban takeover in August 2021.
- **Diplomatic Status**: India upgraded its technical mission in Kabul to a **full-fledged operational embassy** and allowed Taliban-appointed diplomats to staff the Afghan Embassy in New Delhi.
- **Air Corridor**: Agreed to relaunch the **India–Afghanistan Air Freight Corridor**.
- **Development Portfolio**: India remains one of Afghanistan's largest development partners with over **$3 billion** in developmental assistance across 34 provinces.

7. India–Mongolia 70-Year Milestone (14 October 2025)

- **Summit**: PM Modi and Mongolian President **Khurelsukh Ukhnaa** held bilateral talks in New Delhi, marking **70 years of diplomatic relations** (established 1955).
- **Strategic Partnership**: Upgraded in 2015 under a $1 billion credit line.
- **Oil Refinery Project**: Reaffirmed the **$1.7 billion oil refinery project** (Mongolia's first refinery, 1.5 MMTPA capacity by 2028, built with Indian support).
- **Cultural & Regional Link**:
- Regional partnership: **Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council $\leftrightarrow$ Arkhangai Province**.
- India to digitise **1 million Mongolian manuscripts** and deploy a Sanskrit teacher to **Gandan Monastery**.
- Free e-visas announced for Mongolian citizens; 2026 visit of Arahant Buddhist relics to Mongolia.
- **Conservation**: Mongolia officially joined India's **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)**.

8. Sri Lankan PM Dr. Harini Nireka Amarasuriya Maiden Visit (16–18 October 2025)

- **Significance**: Dr. Harini Nireka Amarasuriya's first official overseas visit after assuming office as Prime Minister.
- **Education & Heritage Connect**: Visited her alma mater **Hindu College (Delhi University)**, where she previously studied Sociology under an Indian MEA scholarship.
- **Key Agendas**: Advanced negotiations on the **Economic and Technology Cooperation Agreement (ETCA)** and studied India's **PM Gati Shakti** and **NEP 2020** models at NITI Aayog.
- **Bharat–Sri Lanka Sanskrit Mahotsav**: Inaugurated on **10 November 2025** at the University of Colombo, organized by Swami Vivekananda Cultural Centre, Central Sanskrit University (India), and SL Ministry of Education.

9. India–Vietnam Academic & Tech Cooperation (18 September 2025)

- **MoU**: **IIT Kanpur** and **Vietnam National University (VNU)** signed a major research MoU in Kanpur.
- **Focus Areas**: AI, smart city engineering, autonomous drone technology, and digital healthcare.

10. India–Russia Bilateral Meeting (1 September 2025 | SCO Tianjin)

- **Context**: PM Narendra Modi and President Vladimir Putin met on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Tianjin, China.
- **Pact & Trade**: Reaffirmed the **"Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership"**. Bilateral trade reached **US$ 68.72 billion in FY 2024–25** (dominated by energy imports). PM Modi invited Putin for the 23rd Annual India–Russia Summit in India.

11. India–Maldives 60th Independence Day (25–26 July 2025)

- **Historic First**: PM Modi was the **Guest of Honour at Maldives' 60th Independence Day** — the **first-ever Indian PM** to be invited as Chief Guest. Marked **60 years of diplomatic ties** (1965–2025).
- **Trade Deal**: Formally launched negotiations for the **India–Maldives Free Trade Agreement (IMFTA)**.
- **Financial Package**: Extended a **Line of Credit (LoC) of INR 4,850 crore (~USD 550 million)** along with eased debt rollover.
- **Handover**: 3,300 social housing units in Hulhumalé; new Ministry of Defence building; Colombo Security Conclave equipment handed to MNDF.
- **Joint Stamps**: Depicting traditional seafaring heritage: Indian **'Uru'** and Maldivian **'Vadhu Dhoni'**.

12. India–Philippines Strategic Partnership (4–8 August 2025)

- **Dignitary**: Philippine President **Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr.** paid his first State Visit to India, marking **75 years of diplomatic ties** (established 1949).
- **Elevation of Ties**: Upgraded to a **Strategic Partnership** via the *Strategic Partnership Plan of Action (2025–2029)*.
- **Treaties Signed**: 1. **MLAT**: Mutual Legal Assistance in Criminal Matters. 2. **TTSP**: Transfer of Sentenced Persons.
- **Trade & Space**: Adopted Terms of Reference (ToR) for a **Preferential Trade Agreement (PTA)** (trade stood at ~$3.3 billion in 2024–25); ISRO and Philippine Space Agency signed a Statement of Intent.
- **Joint Stamps**: Featuring the national flowers: Indian **Lotus** and Philippine **Sampaguita** (a fragrant Arabian jasmine variety).

13. India–Canada Strategic Energy & Uranium Pact (27 Feb – 2 March 2026)

- **Visiting Dignitary**: Canadian Prime Minister **Mark Carney** paid an official visit to India; marked **79 years of diplomatic relations**.
- **Cameco–DAE Deal**: Landmark **CAD 2.6 billion agreement** between Canadian uranium giant **Cameco** and India's **Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)** for long-term supply of uranium to fuel India's civilian reactors.
- **CEPA Negotiations**: Signed Terms of Reference to conclude the **Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** by end-2026, aiming to raise bilateral trade to **CAD 70 billion (~INR 4.65 lakh crore) by 2030**.
- **Agri & Skilling Centers**:
- Proposal to establish the **Canada–India Pulse Protein Centre of Excellence** at **NIFTEM Kundli (Haryana)**.
- **AICTE–Mitacs MoU**: Funds research internships for **300 Indian undergraduate students annually** at Canadian universities starting 2027.
- **Critical Minerals**: Signed MoU on Critical Minerals Cooperation; India endorsed the G7 Critical Minerals Action Plan.

14. India–Brazil Strategic Ties (18–22 February 2026)

- **Visiting Dignitary**: Brazilian President **Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva** paid his 2nd State Visit (5th overall visit) to India.
- **Multilateral Forum**: Attended the **2nd AI Impact Summit** (19–20 Feb) in New Delhi and held bilateral talks with PM Modi on 21 February.
- **Global South Anchors**: Reaffirmed joint leadership across **BRICS, G20, IBSA, G-4, WTO, and United Nations** reform.
- **Trade & Resources**: Shared target to raise bilateral trade to over **USD 30 billion by 2030** (Brazil is India's largest trading partner in Latin America). MoU between India's Ministry of Steel and Brazil's Ministry of Mines and Energy for steel sector minerals.
- **Modi's 2025 Visit**: On 8 July 2025, PM Modi was conferred Brazil's highest national honour: ***"The Grand Collar of the National Order of the Southern Cross"***.

15. India–Argentina (4–5 July 2025)

- **Historic Milestone**: First bilateral visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Argentina in **57 years** (Modi previously visited in 2018 for the multilateral G20 Summit).
- **Leadership**: Summit talks with President **Javier Milei** in Buenos Aires; Strategic Partnership (since 2019).
- **Tribute**: Paid homage at the memorial of **General José de San Martín** (*Father of the Nation of Argentina*).

- **Trade Linchpin**: Argentina is India's primary global supplier of **edible oils, especially soybean oil**.

16. India–Trinidad & Tobago (3–4 July 2025)

- **Summit & Honours**: PM Modi met President **Christine Carla Kangaloo** and was conferred the nation's highest honour: ***"The Order of the Republic"*** (first foreign leader to receive it).
- **First in Caribbean**: Trinidad & Tobago became the **first Caribbean country to adopt UPI** (agreement signed September 2024).
- **Diaspora Milestone**: Modi addressed the Joint Parliament and announced that **OCI card eligibility is extended to the 6th generation diaspora** (earlier capped at the 4th generation).

17. India–Norway & 3rd India–Nordic Summit (18–19 May 2026 | Oslo)

- **Elevation of Ties**: Bilateral relationship elevated to a ***"Green Strategic Partnership"*** during PM Modi's visit to Oslo, hosted by Norwegian PM **Jonas Gahr Støre** (audience with King Harald V).
- **3rd India–Nordic Summit (19 May 2026)**: Convened India alongside Norway, Denmark, Finland, Iceland, and Sweden; elevated to a *trusted Green Technology and Innovation Strategic Partnership*.
- **Green Finance & IPOI**: Norwegian Climate Investment Fund investing in Indian clean energy under **Article 6.2 of Paris Agreement**; Norway officially joined the **Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI)**; Arctic research at India's **Himadri station in Ny-Ålesund, Svalbard**.

18. India–Italy & FAO Agricola Medal (19–20 May 2026 | Rome)

- **Elevation of Ties**: Upgraded to a ***"Special Strategic Partnership"*** during PM Modi's bilateral talks with Italian PM **Giorgia Meloni**.
- **Motto**: *"Design and Develop in India and Italy, and Deliver for the World"*.
- **Trade & Security**: Bilateral trade target of **€20 billion by 2029**. Permanent Task Force on countering terror financing; MoU between Italy's **Guardia di Finanza** and India's **Directorate of Enforcement (ED)**.
- **Mobility & Culture**: Launched ***"ICI – Italy Calls India: a University-Enterprise Talent Bridge"***; **2027** declared *Year of Culture and Tourism between Italy and India*; Italy participating in NMHC Lothal.
- **FAO Agricola Medal**: PM Modi visited FAO Headquarters in Rome and received the **FAO Agricola Medal** (highest FAO award for food security and sustainable agrifood systems).

19. India–France (17–19 February 2026)

- **Elevation**: French President **Emmanuel Macron** visited India; ties upgraded to a ***"Special Global Strategic Partnership"*** under the *Horizon 2047 Roadmap*.
- **Innovation Year**: **India–France Year of Innovation 2026** focusing on AI, healthcare, and research.
- **Defence Manufacturing**: Deepening co-design and co-production (Rafale-M fighters, Scorpène submarines, and helicopter assembly in India).
- **Civil Nuclear**: France reaffirmed backing for India's 100 GW nuclear target by 2047, advancing the **Jaitapur Nuclear Power Project (Maharashtra)**.

20. India–Germany (12–13 January 2026)

- **Summit**: German Chancellor **Friedrich Merz** held bilateral talks with PM Modi in Gandhinagar / Ahmedabad.
- **Mobility Milestone**: Germany announced **visa-free transit** for Indian passport holders transiting through German airports.
- **Trade & Defence**: Bilateral trade crossed **USD 50 billion**. Germany showed active interest in naval and air exercises: **MILAN 2026, IONS Conclave of Chiefs, and Exercise Tarang Shakti**.

21. India–United Kingdom (8–9 October 2025)

- **UK PM Visit**: Prime Minister **Sir Keir Starmer** made his first official visit to India under the *Vision 2035* roadmap.
- **Defence Procurement**: Signed a **£350 million ($468 million)** contract for supply of lightweight missiles to India.
- **Tech & Innovation**: Launched the **India–U.K. Connectivity & Innovation Centre** (£24 million over 4 years across AI telecom, non-terrestrial networks, and cybersecurity); Critical Minerals Industry Guild launched with a satellite campus at **IIT-ISM Dhanbad**.
- **Foreign University Campuses**: Letter of Intent granted to **Lancaster University** to open a campus in **Bengaluru**; in-principle approval to **University of Surrey** for a campus in **GIFT City**.

22. India–Australia Organic Mutual Recognition (24 September 2025)

- **MRA on Organic Products**: Signed at Vanijya Bhavan, New Delhi under the India–Australia ECTA.
- **Implementing Agencies**: **APEDA (India)** and **DAFF (Australia)**.

- **Coverage**: Enables mutual acceptance of organic standards for unprocessed plant products, processed plant foods, and wine, eliminating duplicate testing and securing 30–40% price premiums for organic farmers.

23. India–Ethiopia (16–17 December 2025 | Addis Ababa)

- **Historic Visit**: PM Modi paid the **first-ever bilateral visit by an Indian PM to Ethiopia**, holding talks with PM **Abiy Ahmed Ali** and addressing the Joint Session of the Ethiopian Parliament.
- **Highest Honour**: PM Modi was conferred Ethiopia's supreme honour: ***"Great Honour Nishan of Ethiopia"***.
- **Elevation**: Bilateral relations elevated to a **Strategic Partnership**.

24. India–Namibia (9 July 2025 | Windhoek)

- **Historic Visit**: First visit to Namibia by an Indian Prime Minister in **27 years**, hosted by President **Dr. Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah**.
- **Highest Honour**: Modi was conferred Namibia's highest civilian honour: ***"Order of the Most Ancient Welwitschia Mirabilis"*** (first Indian leader to receive it).
- **UPI Pioneer**: Namibia was the **first country globally to sign a licensing agreement to adopt UPI technology** (April 2024: NIPL and Bank of Namibia).
- **Global Initiatives**: Namibia joined the **Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI)** and the **Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)**.
- **Wildlife Diplomacy**: Acknowledged Namibia's foundational gift of **8 cheetahs in 2022** for the Cheetah Reintroduction Project at **Kuno National Park (Madhya Pradesh)**.

Global Geopolitics, West Asia Accord & Evacuation Operations

US–Iran Initial Peace Agreement (17 June 2026)

- **Signatories**: Signed electronically by US President **Donald Trump** and Iranian President **Masoud Pezeshkian** (14-point MoU) aimed at halting the 4-month West Asian war.
- **Key Terms**: 1. Immediate ceasefire across all fronts, explicitly including Lebanon. 2. **Strait of Hormuz Reopening**: Unrestricted, toll-free commercial passage restored within 30 days. 3. **Economic Sanctions Relief**: US Treasury waivers for Iranian crude, petroleum, and shipping. 4. **Reconstruction Fund**: Framework for a **$300 billion reconstruction fund** financed by Gulf Arab states (US will not contribute directly). 5. **Unfreezing Assets**: Unblocking ~$24 billion of restricted Iranian funds held abroad. 6. **Nuclear Enrichment Ceiling**: Iran required to halt enrichment and **down-blend existing highly enriched uranium stocks to 3.67%** under strict IAEA verification.

Military Operations in the Conflict

- **Joint US–Israeli Strikes (28 Feb 2026)**: US termed it **Operation Epic Fury**; airstrikes on Iranian nuclear sites (Fordow, Natanz, Isfahan) named **Operation Midnight Hammer** using B-2 stealth bombers; Israel termed it **Operation Roaring Lion**.
- **Iran's Retaliation**: Successive missile barrages designated **Operation True Promise 3**.
- **Gaza & Syria Operations**: Israel launched **Operation Gideon's Chariots II** in Gaza (Hamas responded with **Operation Moses' Staff**); Israel launched **Operation Arrow of Bashan** in Syria, declaring the 1974 Disengagement Agreement void.

IN Operation Sindhu (India's Evacuation Mission)

- **What is it**: The official overseas emergency evacuation operation launched by the **Government of India** to safely extract Indian citizens stranded across the war-affected West Asian theater.
- *(Historical Lineage: 1990–91 Gulf War airlift $\rightarrow$ Operation Sukoon 2006 Lebanon $\rightarrow$ Operation Safe Homecoming 2011 Libya $\rightarrow$ Operation Rahat 2015 Yemen $\rightarrow$ Operation Ganga 2022 Ukraine $\rightarrow$ Operation Kaveri 2023 Sudan $\rightarrow$ Operation Ajay 2023 Israel $\rightarrow$ Operation Sindhu 2026).*

Supreme Leader Succession in Iran

- Following the death of Ali Khamenei on 28 February 2026, his son **Mojtaba Khamenei** was selected and announced as the new **Supreme Leader of Iran** by the Assembly of Experts on **9 March 2026**.

Prime Minister Modi Honoured by Both Israel and Palestine

- **Historic Record**: PM Narendra Modi became the **first leader in global history to be conferred the highest state honours by both Israel and Palestine**:
- **Israel**: Conferred the ***Speaker of the Knesset Medal*** on **25 February 2026** (presented by Speaker Amir Ohana in Jerusalem).
- **Palestine**: Conferred the ***Grand Collar of the State of Palestine*** in **2018** (presented by President Mahmoud Abbas).

Arrest of Venezuelan President & Operation Absolute Resolve (January 2026)

- **What Happened**: Venezuelan President **Nicolás Maduro** was captured by U.S. forces during **Operation Absolute Resolve** in January 2026.
- **Acting Leadership**: Venezuela's Supreme Court directed Vice President **Delcy Rodríguez** (in office since 2018; Bolivarian socialist movement founded by Hugo Chávez) to assume the role of acting President.
- **Geopolitical & Legal Flashpoint**: Prompted international debates regarding state sovereignty, unilateral intervention, and **Article 2(4) of the UN Charter** (which strictly prohibits the threat or use of force against the territorial integrity or political independence of any state).

Multilateral Summits, Conferences & International Organisations (2025–2026)

1. 52nd G7 Summit (15–17 June 2026 | Évian-les-Bains, France)

- **Host & Presidency**: Held in **Évian-les-Bains, France**, under the French G7 Presidency.
- **Participants**: Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, United Kingdom, United States, and the European Union.
- **Outreach Guests**: Key invited partners including **India** and Brazil.
- **India's Participation**: Marked **India's 13th guest invitation** and Prime Minister Narendra Modi's **7th consecutive appearance** at the G7 Summit.
- **Key Deliberations & Declarations**:
- Addressed vital waterway disruptions, endorsing demining operations and naval escort missions in the **Strait of Hormuz** for secure global energy transit.
- PM Modi strongly championed the safety of civilian seafarers and freedom of international commercial navigation.
- Reaffirmed peace and stability in the Taiwan Strait and called for complete, verifiable denuclearization of North Korea.
- Adopted three joint declarations: *Public Health & Tech*, *Migration & Crime*, and *Economy & Supply Chains*.
- **Chronology & Future Hosts**:
- **51st G7 Summit (2025)**: Kananaskis, Alberta, Canada.
- **52nd G7 Summit (2026)**: Évian-les-Bains, France.
- **53rd G7 Summit (2027)**: United States.

2. Election of the President of the 81st UNGA Session (September 2026)

- **Elected President**: **Khalilur Rahman**, veteran diplomat and Foreign Minister of **Bangladesh**, was elected President of the **81st Session of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)**.
- **Tenure**: Commences 1-year tenure on **8 September 2026**.
- **Election Process**: Elected through a secret ballot after contesting against Andreas Kakouris of Cyprus. The presidency was allocated to the **Asia-Pacific Group** under the UN's geographic rotation system.
- **Theme of the 81st Session**: *"Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation: A United Nations that Delivers for All"*.
- **Historical Benchmark**: This marks Bangladesh's second UNGA presidency; **Humayun Rasheed Choudhury** served as President of the 41st UNGA Session in **1986**.

3. 18th BRICS Leaders' Summit 2026 & India's chairship

What happened India hosted the **18th BRICS Summit** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi** on **12–13 September 2026** under its 2026 chairship.

What you should remember

- Chairship theme: **Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability**.
- Outcome document: **New Delhi Declaration** (adopted by leaders).
- MEA called the chairship year a "major success" with **over 50** action-oriented outcomes across meetings held in India.
- The Summit week also included a **BRICS Plus / Outreach** dialogue segment.
- India's BRICS Sherpa: **Sudhakar Dalela**.
- Chairship count: India's **fourth** BRICS chairship (**2012, 2016, 2021, 2026**).
- Preceding Summit: **17th BRICS Summit** in **Rio de Janeiro, Brazil** (6–7 July 2025).
- Earlier 2026 boards: BRICS Foreign Ministers' Meeting at Bharat Mandapam (**14–15 May 2026**); Agriculture Ministers' Meeting in **Indore** (**12–13 June 2026**).

Do not park the 18th Summit in **Rio** or **Kazan**. Those are older venues. September 2026 = **New Delhi**.

3a. BRICS membership teaching note

- Expanded BRICS teaching set includes core five plus newer full members such as **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Indonesia** (and related accession / partner lanes as taught in class notes).
- For stems, prefer the Summit **host / theme / declaration name** over memorising every partner flag.

4. UNSC Non-Permanent Members Election (2027–2028 Term)

- **Election Date & Organ**: Elected by the UN General Assembly on **3 June 2026** for a two-year mandate running from **1 January 2027 to 31 December 2028**.
- **Five Elected Nations**:
- **Western European and Others Group (2 seats)**: **Austria** and **Portugal** (Germany secured 104 votes and failed to win a seat).
- **Asia-Pacific Group (1 seat)**: **Kyrgyzstan** (defeated the Philippines after four competitive voting rounds; marks Kyrgyzstan's **first-ever term** on the Security Council since joining the UN in 1992).
- **Latin America and Caribbean Group (1 seat)**: **Trinidad and Tobago**.
- **African Group (1 seat)**: **Zimbabwe**.

5. Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB) — India's Chairmanship

- **Leadership Role**: India was nominated to chair the **Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB)** for a **two-year term** (2026–2028), elevating India's voice in global cybersecurity governance.
- **Mandate**: CCDB is the governing body for the Common Criteria framework, standardizing global evaluation and certification of IT product security.
- **Benchmark Standard**: Governed under **ISO/IEC 15408** ("*Evaluation criteria for IT security*", latest edition **ISO/IEC 15408-1:2026**).

6. 11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting (26 May 2026 | New Delhi)

- **Host & Participants**: Hosted by India in **New Delhi** on 26 May 2026, bringing together Foreign Ministers of **India, USA, Japan, and Australia**.
- **Four Core Cooperation Pillars**: 1. Maritime and transnational security. 2. Economic prosperity and security. 3. Critical and emerging technologies. 4. Humanitarian assistance and emergency response.
- **Major Outcomes & Agreements**:
- **IPMSC**: Established the *Indo-Pacific Maritime Surveillance Collaboration* to enhance coordinated naval and satellite monitoring.
- **IPMDA Hub in India**: Welcomed the operationalisation of the Indian Ocean Region programme of the *Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness (IPMDA)* through the **Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR)** in **Gurugram, Haryana**.
- **Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security**: Launched to protect critical maritime energy lifelines and grid integration.
- **Quad Critical Minerals Framework**: Formulated to build transparent, resilient mineral supply chains, countering high concentration (IEA data shows China controls ~91% of global refined rare earth production).
- **Fiji Port Development**: Quad committed joint assistance to the Government of **Fiji** for modernising port infrastructure (following the *Quad Ports of the Future Partnership Conference* hosted by India in October 2025).
- **Pax Silica**: Formally incorporated into the Quad's economic security doctrine to guarantee semiconductor and trusted AI hardware supply ecosystems across 5G/6G and advanced computing.

7. WTO 14th Ministerial Conference (MC-14 | Yaoundé, Cameroon | March 2026)

- **Venue & Significance**: Held in **Yaoundé, Cameroon** — making it only the **second WTO Ministerial Conference ever hosted on African soil** (after MC-10 in Nairobi, Kenya, 2015).
- **Membership**: WTO comprises **166 member states**.
- **Indian Delegation**: Led by Union Minister of Commerce and Industry **Piyush Goyal**.
- **Key Impasse & Outcomes**:
- The conference failed to conclude a comprehensive consensus ministerial declaration due to sharp North–South divisions on WTO dispute settlement reform and agriculture.
- **E-Commerce Moratorium**: A critical flashpoint was the moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions (in force since 1998); members failed to agree on a permanent extension.
- **Fisheries Subsidies Agreement**: Noted that the landmark WTO Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies officially **entered into force on 15 September 2025**.
- **India's Stance**: Firmly safeguarded public stockholding (PSH) for food security, protected subsidies for small and artisanal fishermen, and resisted disciplines on non-violation complaints under TRIPS.

8. 11th Raisina Dialogue 2026 (5–7 March 2026 | New Delhi)

- **Organisers**: Jointly hosted by the **Observer Research Foundation (ORF)** and the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)**.
- **Theme**: *"Samskāra: Assertion, Accommodation, Advancement"*.
- **Chief Guest & Keynote Speaker**: **Alexander Stubb**, President of **Finland**.
- **Inauguration**: Inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi; attended by ~2,700 delegates from over 110 countries.
- **New Launch**: Unveiled the **Raisina Science Diplomacy Initiative (SDI)**, institutionalised by the Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser (PSA) to the Government of India and ORF to bridge advanced science, quantum/AI technologies, and diplomatic policy.

9. 16th India–EU Summit (27 January 2026 | New Delhi)

- **High-Level Representation**: Prime Minister Narendra Modi met with European Council President **António Costa** and European Commission President **Ursula von der Leyen** (who were also Chief Guests for India's 77th Republic Day).
- **Historic FTA Milestone**: Formally announced the **successful conclusion of negotiations on the landmark India–EU Free Trade Agreement (FTA)** (negotiations originally launched in 2007, suspended in 2013, and re-launched in June 2022).
- **Strategic Roadmap**: Adopted the comprehensive ***"Towards 2030"*** strategic agenda structured across five pillars: 1. Prosperity and sustainability. 2. Technology and innovation. 3. Security and defence. 4. Connectivity and global challenges. 5. Mobility and people-to-people ties.
- **Defence & Security**: Launched the *India–EU Security and Defence Partnership* covering joint maritime security exercises, cybersecurity incident response, and defence industrial co-production.
- **Institutional MoUs**:
- Adopted a *Comprehensive Mobility Framework* for seamless movement of professionals, researchers, and students.
- Extended the *India–EU Science and Technology Agreement* for the **2025–2030** cycle; initiated discussions for India's associate membership in **Horizon Europe**.
- Disaster management cooperation pact between India's **NDMA** and EU's **DG-ECHO**.
- Dialogues on bridging carbon compliance regarding the EU's **Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)**.

10. 20th G20 Leaders' Summit (22–23 November 2025 | Johannesburg, South Africa)

- **Historic Milestone**: The **first-ever G20 Leaders' Summit hosted on African soil**, held in Johannesburg under South Africa's G20 Presidency.
- **Summit Theme**: *"Solidarity, Equality, Sustainability"*.
- **Ubuntu Philosophy**: The *Johannesburg Leaders' Declaration* anchored itself in the traditional African humanist philosophy of **Ubuntu** (*"I am because we are" — shared humanity and mutual interdependence*).
- **Mission 300**: Pledged concerted multilateral support to provide electricity access to **300 million people across Africa by 2030**.
- **India's Six Global Proposals**: Prime Minister Narendra Modi (attending his 12th G20 Summit) proposed six major initiatives on behalf of the Global South: 1. *Traditional Knowledge Repository* (digitising indigenous medicinal and environmental knowledge). 2. *Africa Skills Multiplier Initiative* (pan-African vocational training through a train-the-trainer framework). 3. *Global Healthcare Response Team* (rapid emergency medical deployments). 4. *Open Satellite Data Partnership* (sharing Earth observation data for climate and agriculture). 5. *Critical Minerals Circularity Initiative* (recycling and sustainable processing). 6. *Drug–Terror Nexus Initiative* (combatting illicit narcotics trafficking financing terrorism).
- **Trilateral ACITI Launch**: On the summit sidelines (22 Nov 2025), India, Australia, and Canada officially launched the **Australia–Canada–India Technology and Innovation (ACITI) Partnership** focused on green energy, critical minerals supply chains, and responsible AI.
- **G20 Future Roster**:
- **21st G20 Summit (2026)**: Miami, Florida, United States.
- **22nd G20 Summit (2027)**: United Kingdom.
- **23rd G20 Summit (2028)**: Republic of Korea (South Korea).

11. 2nd WHO Global Summit on Traditional Medicine (17–19 December 2025 | New Delhi)

- **Host & Venue**: Co-hosted by the **World Health Organization (WHO)** and India's **Ministry of Ayush** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**.
- **Theme**: *"Restoring balance: The science and practice of health and well-being"*.
- **Institutional Background**: Followed the inaugural 1st WHO Global Summit on Traditional Medicine held in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat (August 2023)**.
- **Global Hub**: Anchored to the world's first and only global outpost dedicated to indigenous healing systems — the **WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre (GTMC)** located at **Jamnagar, Gujarat**.

12. G7 French Presidency: One Health Summit 2026 (5–7 April 2026 | Lyon, France)

- **Host & Dates**: Convened in **Lyon, France**, coinciding with **World Health Day (7 April 2026)** under the French G7 Presidency.
- **Core Concept**: Focuses on the indivisible interconnections between human health, domestic and wild animal health, plant biosecurity, and ecosystem integrity (WHO notes that over **60% of all emerging human infectious pathogens originate in animals**).
- **Institutional Quadripartite**: Driven collectively by the four lead multilateral bodies: **WHO, FAO, UNEP, and WOAH** (World Organisation for Animal Health).

13. 22nd ASEAN–India Summit & 20th East Asia Summit (October 2025 | Kuala Lumpur)

- **Host & Presidency**: Held in **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia**, chaired by Malaysian Prime Minister **Anwar Ibrahim** under Malaysia's 2025 ASEAN Chairship theme: *"Inclusivity and Sustainability"*.
- **India's Participation**: Prime Minister Narendra Modi participated virtually, reviewing the ASEAN–India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership (established in 2022; relations began as sectoral dialogue partnership in 1992).
- **Major Strategic Initiatives**:
- Adopted the **ASEAN–India Plan of Action 2026–2030**.
- **India declared 2026 as the ASEAN–India Year of Maritime Cooperation**.
- Proposed the 2nd ASEAN–India Defence Ministers' Meeting and 2nd ASEAN–India Maritime Exercise.
- Announced specialized green energy training for 400 ASEAN professionals supporting the **ASEAN Power Grid**.
- Proposed establishing a **Centre for Southeast Asian Studies at Nalanda University** (Bihar).
- Announced the **East Asia Summit Maritime Heritage Festival at Lothal, Gujarat**.
- Endorsed the *ASEAN–India Joint Leaders' Statement on Sustainable Tourism*.
- **ASEAN Expansion**:
- **Timor-Leste** was officially admitted as the **11th member of ASEAN on 26 October 2025** during the summit in Kuala Lumpur (first new member admitted to ASEAN since the 1990s).
- **Subsequent Summits**:
- **20th East Asia Summit (EAS)**: Held on 27 October 2025 in Kuala Lumpur, marking 20 years since EAS inception via the 2005 Kuala Lumpur Declaration.
- **48th ASEAN Summit (8 May 2026)**: Held in **Cebu, Philippines**, under the Philippines' 2026 Chairship theme: *"Navigating Our Future, Together"*.

14. 25th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit 2025 (31 Aug–1 Sept 2025 | Tianjin)

- **Host City & Chair**: Held in **Tianjin, China**, attended in person by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- **Tianjin Declaration**: Strongly condemned international terrorism and, in a significant diplomatic breakthrough for New Delhi, explicitly named the **April 2025 Pahalgan terror attack in India**. Also condemned the Jaffer Express hijacking and Khuzdar school bus bombing.
- **SCO Structural Overhaul**: Merged dialogue partners and observers into a streamlined structure of **10 member states + 17 partners**, with **Laos** admitted as the newest partner.
- **New Institutional Organs**: Approved the establishment of four new specialized SCO centres (security, organized crime, cyber threats, drug trafficking) and initiated the formal creation of an **SCO Development Bank**.
- **Strategic Blueprints**: Adopted the *SCO Development Strategy 2026–2035*, *Cooperation Programme 2026–2030*, and the *Roadmap for Energy Cooperation till 2030*.
- **India–China Bilateral Side-Track**: Preceded by Chinese FM Wang Yi's visit to New Delhi (18–19 August 2025) for 24th Special Representatives (SR) talks with NSA Ajit Doval and EAM Dr. S. Jaishankar; agreed on expanding the **Kailash-Mansarovar Yatra (2026)** and resuming border trade through **Nathu La, Shipki La, and Lipulekh**.

15. World Food India (WFI) 2025 (25–28 September 2025 | New Delhi)

- **Venue & Host**: 4th edition held at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**, organised by the Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI) and inaugurated by PM Modi.
- **Partner Countries**: **New Zealand** and **Saudi Arabia**.
- **Focus Countries**: **Japan, UAE, Vietnam, and Russia**.
- **Scale**: Over 90 participating nations and 2,000+ exhibitors aimed at positioning India as a global food processing and value-addition hub.

16. India Elected to INTERPOL Asian Committee & Silver Notice Launch

- **Election (19 September 2025)**: India was elected as a member of the **INTERPOL Asian Committee** for a four-year term (**2025–2029**) during the 25th Asian Regional Conference in **Singapore**.

- **Nodal Agency**: India is represented by the **Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)**, which operates as the National Central Bureau (NCB) for INTERPOL in India.
- **INTERPOL's 8 Color-Coded Notices Master Matrix**:
- **Red Notice**: Locates and arrests persons wanted for prosecution or to serve a sentence.
- **Yellow Notice**: Helps locate missing persons or identify persons unable to identify themselves.
- **Blue Notice**: Collects additional information on a suspect's identity, location, or activities.
- **Green Notice**: Warns of a person's criminal activities considered a potential threat.
- **Orange Notice**: Warns of an imminent event, person, or weapon threatening public safety.
- **Purple Notice**: Shares information on modi operandi, procedures, or concealing devices used by criminals.
- **Black Notice**: Seeks information on unidentified bodies.
- **Silver Notice (NEW — Launched January 2025)**: Specially designed to **identify, track, freeze, and confiscate criminal assets and illicit financial proceeds** across international jurisdictions! *(Critical UPPCS New Pattern Trap)*.

17. India–ILO Landmark MoU on IRCO (16 September 2025 | Geneva)

- **Pact**: India signed a historic MoU with the International Labour Organization (ILO) in Geneva to develop the **International Reference Classification of Occupations (IRCO)** to ensure global equivalence and mobility of Indian skilled workers.
- **Historical Anchor**: **N.M. Joshi** served as India's first representative of organized labour at the ILO's founding Washington Summit in **1919**.

International Elections & Head of State Transitions (2025–2026)

Country	Leader & Designation	Month / Year	Significance / Prelims Facts
Nepal	**Balendra Shah ("Balen")** (Prime Minister)	March 2026	Structural engineer, rapper, and former Mayor of Kathmandu; led the **Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP)** to victory following the **September 2025 "Gen Z Movement"** (triggered by a ban on 26 social media platforms and protests against nepotism / "Nepo Kids"). Became Nepal's **youngest Prime Minister** after the fall of K.P. Sharma Oli.
Nepal	**Sushila Karki** (Interim Prime Minister)	Late 2025	Former Chief Justice of Nepal; appointed as **interim Prime Minister** during the constitutional transition, becoming the **first female Prime Minister in Nepal's history**.
Japan	**Sanae Takaichi** (Prime Minister)	October 2025	Elected President of the Liberal Democratic Party (LDP) and designated by the Diet as the **104th Prime Minister of Japan** — becoming **Japan's first-ever female Prime Minister**.
Albania	**Diella** (Virtual Minister)	September 2025	**World's first AI-powered Minister** (*Diella* means "sun" in Albanian), integrated into the *e-Albania* digital governance portal to supervise public procurement and eliminate government tender corruption.
France	**Sebastien Lecornu** (Prime Minister)	September 2025	Appointed by President Emmanuel Macron following the resignation of François Bayrou after a National Assembly vote of no confidence.
Australia	**Anthony Albanese** (Prime Minister)	May 2025	Sworn in for a **second term** as Prime Minister of Australia on 13 May 2025.
Poland	**Karol Nawrocki** (President)	June 2025	Elected President of Poland (assumed office August 2025), succeeding Andrzej Duda after defeating Warsaw Mayor Rafal Trzaskowski.
Guyana	**Irfaan Ali** (President)	September 2025	Re-elected for a second presidential term; made history in 2020 as Guyana's first Muslim head of state.
Cameroon	**Paul Biya** (President)	October 2025	Re-elected for his **8th consecutive term** at the age of **92**, maintaining his status as the **world's oldest serving head of state**.

Global Disasters & Humanitarian Relief Operations (2025–2026)

1. Cyclone Ditwah & IN Operation Sagar Bandhu (November 2025)

- **Disaster**: Cyclone Ditwah triggered catastrophic flooding, storm surges, and landslides across **Sri Lanka** in late November 2025.
- **India's Response**: India immediately launched **Operation Sagar Bandhu** (*"Ocean Friend"*), reinforcing its role as First Responder in the Indian Ocean.
- **Assets Deployed**: Indian Navy deployed **INS Vikrant, INS Udaygiri, and INS Sukanya**, accompanied by Indian Air Force **C-130J Super Hercules** transport aircraft carrying field hospitals and relief stores.

2. Ethiopia's Hayli Gubbi Volcano Explosive Eruption (23 November 2025)

- **Location**: Located in the **Afar Depression / Erta Ale volcanic range** of the East African Rift System in Ethiopia.
- **Geological Milestone**: Erupted explosively on 23 November 2025, marking its **first documented explosive eruption in approximately 12,000 years**.
- **Impact**: Injected volcanic ash and sulphur dioxide plumes up to 15 km altitude, disrupting flight corridors across the Red Sea, Arabian Peninsula, and western India.

3. Hurricane Melissa (October 2025 | Jamaica)

- **Severity**: Landed on **Jamaica** as a catastrophic **Category 5 hurricane** with sustained winds of 295 km/h.
- **Record**: Officially became the **strongest hurricane ever recorded to strike Jamaica** in modern meteorological history.

4. Super Typhoon Ragasa / Nando (September 2025)

- **Track & Scope**: Intensified rapidly into a Category 5-equivalent Super Typhoon over the western North Pacific with sustained winds of 230–265 km/h; swept across the Luzon Strait, Taiwan, Hong Kong, Macau, Guangdong, and northern Vietnam. Known domestically in the Philippines as **Typhoon Nando**.

5. Kamchatka Megathrust Earthquake (30 July 2025 | Russia)

- **Magnitude**: Massive **8.8 Mw earthquake** off the eastern coast of the Kamchatka Peninsula (focal depth 35 km; Intensity IX Violent near Petropavlovsk-Kamchatsky).
- **Historical Benchmark**: The most energetic global earthquake since the 2011 Tohoku event (Japan), tied as the **6th most powerful earthquake in recorded human history** (alongside the 1906 Ecuador-Colombia and 2010 Chile earthquakes).

6. Cyclone Gezani (Madagascar)

- **Impact**: Category 3-equivalent Intense Tropical Cyclone with sustained gusts over 195 km/h made landfall directly at **Toamasina** (Madagascar's chief eastern port city), destroying ~75% of local port and power infrastructure.

High-Yield International Flashpoints & News in Shorts

- **Scotland Legalises Water Cremation (Alkaline Hydrolysis):** Scotland became the **first nation in the UK** to legalize water cremation (alkaline hydrolysis using water, elevated heat, and potassium hydroxide / KOH), marking the most significant funeral law reform since 1902 and reducing greenhouse emissions ~7-fold compared to flame cremation.
- **Spain Bans Social Media for Under-16:** Spain became the **first European country** to prohibit access to social media platforms for children under the age of 16 (second country globally after **Australia**, which enacted a similar ban in December 2025). Announced by PM Pedro Sánchez at the World Government Summit in Dubai.
- **India Gifts High-Speed Ferry to Maldives:** Under the **HICDP Phase III agreement**, India gifted the Maldives its first high-speed ferry, initiating the *Raajje Transport Link (RTL)* inter-island transit network across **Faafu and Dhaalu Atolls** (12 ferries total planned).
- **1st BRICS Sherpas Meeting 2026:** Convened in New Delhi on 9–10 February 2026 under India's BRICS Chairship; led by India's BRICS Sherpa **Sudhakar Dalela** under the theme *"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"*.
- **Pakistan–Afghanistan Escalation (Operation Ghazab lil-Haq):** In late February 2026, Pakistan conducted airstrikes inside Afghanistan designated **Operation Ghazab lil-Haq**, targeting alleged TTP safe havens across the contested **Durand Line** (the 2,640 km frontier drawn in **1893**).
- **BIOFACH 2026 (Nuremberg, Germany) — India "Country of the Year":**
- India was honoured as the official **"Country of the Year"** at BIOFACH 2026 (10–13 February 2026 in Nuremberg), the world's premier organic trade exhibition.
- Participation spearheaded by **APEDA** (Ministry of Commerce & Industry), spotlighting five GI-tagged organic rice varieties: **Indrayani, Navara, Gobindbhog, Red rice, and Chak Hao (Black rice)**.
- *Global Organic Agriculture Matrix*: **Australia** leads the world in total organic farmland area (>53 million hectares); **India ranks 2nd globally in organic agricultural acreage** and ranks **1st globally in the total number of organic producers**. Within India, **Madhya Pradesh ranks 1st in certified organic area**.
- **India Launches e-B-4 Business Visa:** In January 2026, India rolled out the new **e-Production Investment Business Visa (e-B-4)** specifically for Chinese technical specialists and manufacturing engineers to expedite industrial clearances online without embassy visits.
- **Russian Naval Base in Sudan:** Sudan officially ratified an agreement granting Russia rights to build its **first naval logistics base on African soil** near **Port Sudan on the Red Sea**, functioning as a strategic hedge against Mediterranean access constraints at Tartus, Syria.

- **Discovery of 2,000-Year-Old Kushan Coins (Taxila):** Archaeologists discovered bronze coins issued during the reign of Kushan Emperor **Vasudeva I** alongside 6th-century BCE lapis lazuli beads at **Bhir Mound (near Taxila, Rawalpindi, Pakistan)**. Features king making offerings on obverse and a female deity on reverse.
- **Finke River (Australia) — World's Oldest River:** Hydrogeological studies confirmed the **Finke River** (*Larapinta* in Arrernte language; 640 km through MacDonnell Ranges in Central Australia) as the **world's oldest surviving river system**, dating back **300 to 400 million years** as an antecedent stream.
- **India–Netherlands Lothal NMHC Pact:** India and the Netherlands signed an MoU in December 2025 to partner in curating and conserving the **National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC)** at **Lothal, Gujarat**, in institutional collaboration with the National Maritime Museum, Amsterdam.
- **28th Commonwealth Speakers Conference (CSPOC 2026):** India hosted the **28th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth** at **Samvidhan Sadan, New Delhi** (14–16 January 2026), chaired by Lok Sabha Speaker **Om Birla** and inaugurated by PM Modi (India previously hosted in 1970–71, 1986, and 2010; 29th CSPOC scheduled for London in 2028).
- **CEC Gyanesh Kumar to Chair International IDEA Council 2026:** India assumed the Chairmanship of the Council of Member States of the **International Institute for Democracy and Electoral Assistance (International IDEA)** for 2026 in Stockholm, Sweden, with Chief Election Commissioner **Gyanesh Kumar** (**26th CEC of India**) serving as Chair.
- **3rd India–Singapore Ministerial Roundtable (ISMR):** Convened in New Delhi on 13 August 2025; India represented by four ministers (Nirmala Sitharaman, Dr. S. Jaishankar, Piyush Goyal, and Ashwini Vaishnaw) alongside Singapore DPM Gan Kim Yong, deepening bilateral digital finance and semiconductor supply chains.
- **California Declares Diwali a State Holiday (2025):** California Governor Gavin Newsom signed into law legislation making Diwali an official paid state holiday, making California the **third U.S. state** to do so after **Pennsylvania** and **Connecticut**.
- **China's CR450 Bullet Train:** China unveiled the **CR450**, achieving test speeds of **453 km/h** to become the world's fastest conventional high-speed train; China operates 45,000 km of high-speed rail.
- **Bulgaria Adopts Euro as 21st Eurozone Member:** On **1 January 2026**, **Bulgaria** formally joined the eurozone, replacing the Bulgarian lev with the euro and becoming the **21st member state of the euro currency bloc** *(Croatia was the 20th member in 2023)*.
- **India–FAO Blue Ports Initiative (September 2025):** MoFPI and Ministry of Fisheries partnered with FAO under PMMSY and FIDF (₹369.80 crore) to convert fishing harbours into climate-smart Blue Ports, selecting **Vanakbara (Diu), Jakhau (Gujarat), and Karaikal (Puducherry)** as initial pilot sites.
- **India Re-Elected to UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC):** In October 2025, India was **elected unopposed to the UNHRC for the 2026–2028 triennium**, securing its **7th term** on the Geneva-based 47-member council.
- **UN Cybercrime Convention Signed in Hanoi:** Under UNODC auspices, member states convened in Hanoi, Vietnam, to sign the **first-ever United Nations Convention Against Cybercrime**, establishing unified global extradition and digital evidence standards.
- **Tuvalu Joins IUCN as 90th Member:** The low-lying Pacific island nation of **Tuvalu** formally acceded as the **90th State Member of the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)** in October 2025.

October 2026

16th BRICS Summit (Kazan, Russia) & Historic India–China LAC Disengagement

What happened The **16th BRICS Summit** was held in **Kazan, Russia** from **22 to 24 October 2026** under the Russian chairship, themed *"Strengthening Multilateralism for Just Global Development and Security"*. The summit culminated in the adoption of the comprehensive **Kazan Declaration**.

The Historic India–China Border Breakthrough - **Patrolling Agreement (21 October):** On the eve of the Kazan summit, India and China finalized a breakthrough diplomatic and military agreement on **patrolling arrangements along the Line of Actual Control (LAC)** in eastern Ladakh. - **Key Friction Points:** Restores patrolling rights and resolves the military standoffs in the critical sub-sectors of **Depsang Plains and Demchok**, establishing ground disengagement protocols that defused the border confrontation persisting since the Galwan clash in May 2020. - **Modi–Xi Bilateral Meeting (23 October):** Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and Chinese President **Xi Jinping** held their **first formal, structured bilateral meeting in five years** on the sidelines in Kazan. - **Key Directives:** Directed the Special Representatives on the Boundary Question (**Ajit Doval** for India and **Wang Yi** for China) and Foreign Ministries to meet early to stabilize overall bilateral ties.

Key BRICS Summit Outcomes - **Partner Country Category:** BRICS officially endorsed and created a new status of **"Partner Countries"** (providing a stepping-stone framework for emerging economies without diluting full member consensus). - **Financial Architecture:** Leaders called for the study of the **BRICS Cross-Border Payment Initiative (BCBPI)**, alternative local-currency settlement mechanisms, and strengthening the New Development Bank (NDB).

- **16th BRICS Summit (October): Kazan, Russia**.

- **17th BRICS Summit (2025): Rio de Janeiro, Brazil**.
- **18th BRICS Summit (September 2026): Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi (India)**.

23rd SCO Council of Heads of Government Summit | Islamabad, Pakistan (15–16 October 2026)

What happened The **23rd Meeting of the Council of Heads of Government (CHG)** of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) was held in **Islamabad, Pakistan**, chaired by Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif.

Historic Indian Diplomatic Milestone - **Indian Representation:** India was represented by External Affairs Minister **Dr. S. Jaishankar**. - **9-Year Landmark:** Marked the **first visit by an Indian External Affairs Minister to Pakistan in 9 years** (since Sushma Swaraj attended the *Heart of Asia – Istanbul Process* ministerial in Islamabad in December 2015). - **Core Indian Stance:** - Emphasised that regional connectivity initiatives must strictly adhere to the principles of **sovereignty and territorial integrity** (veiled reference to CPEC violating India's sovereignty in PoK). - Reaffirmed zero tolerance against the **"three evils" of terrorism, extremism, and separatism** under the SCO Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS). - Pitched for digital public infrastructure (DPI), affordable healthcare, and climate cooperation within the SCO.

44th & 45th ASEAN Summits & 19th East Asia Summit | Vientiane, Laos

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** attended the **21st ASEAN–India Summit** and the **19th East Asia Summit (EAS)** in **Vientiane, Lao PDR** (under Laos' 2026 ASEAN Chairship, themed *"ASEAN: Enhancing Connectivity and Resilience"*).

Key facts & 10 Years of Act East Policy - **Milestone:** Year 2024–2026 marks **10 years of India's 'Act East' Policy** (launched in 2014 by PM Modi, upgrading the earlier 1991 'Look East' policy). - **10-Point Plan for India–ASEAN Ties:** PM Modi announced a comprehensive 10-point roadmap including: 1. Celebration of **Year of Tourism** between ASEAN and India. 2. Doubling of scholarships at Nalanda University for ASEAN students. 3. Digital connectivity expansion via Digital Public Infrastructure (UPI / fast-payment links). 4. Disaster resilience partnership with the ASEAN Coordinating Centre for Humanitarian Assistance (AHA Centre). 5. Science and green hydrogen research collaboration. - **Review of AITIGA:** Emphasized the timely conclusion of the review of the **ASEAN–India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA)** by 2025–26 to make trade more balanced and resilient.

PART C · TOPICS

02 — Schemes & Policies

> **Priority S** | About **13%** of Current Affairs questions In recent papers, scheme questions often sit under **Economy** tags as well.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
When did it start / when does it end?	Year traps are common
Which ministry or body runs it?	Ministry vs NITI Aayog
Who gets the benefit?	Farmers, women, Divyangjan, states…
Any exact number?	Outlay, beneficiaries, sharing ratio
Was an old scheme renamed or merged?	Classic false-statement bait

High-Yield Scheme Foundation Anchors (Late 2025)

Scheme / Mission	Approval Date & Ministry	Financial Outlay	Core Objective
Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses	**1 October 2025** (Union Cabinet)	**₹11,440 crore** (2025–26 to 2030–31)	Self-sufficiency in pulses production, expanding acreage, seed hubs, and assured procurement.
MY Bharat Mobile App	**1 October 2025** (Ministry of Youth Affairs)	—	Digital empowerment platform for youth leadership and community participation.
PM-SETU Initiative	**4 October 2025** (Ministry of Skill Development)	**₹60,000 crore** (Centrally Sponsored)	Upgrades **1,000 Government ITIs** on a **hub-and-spoke model** (200 hub ITIs and 800 spoke ITIs).
Angikaar – 2025 Campaign	**4 September 2025** (MoHUA — PMAY-U 2.0)	—	Nationwide urban saturation drive across **>5,000 ULBs** for PMAY-U 2.0 and Credit Risk Guarantee Trust (CRGFTLIH).
MERITE Scheme	**8 August 2025** (Union Cabinet / MoE)	Multi-year central support	Multidisciplinary Education and Research Improvement in Technical Education; covers **275 technical institutions** (175 engineering colleges + 100 polytechnics) from **2025–26 to 2029–30** under NEP 2020.
e-SafeHER Programme	**13 April 2026** (MeitY + C-DAC + Reliance Fdn)	— (ISEA Programme)	Cybersecurity awareness and safe digital participation training for **10 lakh (1 million) rural women** over 3 years.
DHRUVA Policy	**October 2025** (Dept of Posts, MoC)	—	Digital Hub for Reference and Unique Virtual Address; standardises digital addressing infrastructure across India.
Mission Digital Shram Setu	**October 2025** (NITI Aayog)	—	National AI roadmap under *"AI for Inclusive Societal Development"* for India's **490 million informal workers**.
'We RISE' Initiative	**17 October 2025** (NITI Aayog WEP + DP World)	—	Women Entrepreneurs Reimagining Inclusive and Sustainable Enterprises; accelerating MSME market access.
Model Youth Gram Sabha (MYGS)	**October 2025** (MoPR / NEP 2020)	—	Hands-on democratic governance and procedural training for students based on constitutional Gram Sabhas under **Article 243**.
Kisan Rin Portal (KRP)	**September 2023** (MoA&FW / MISS–KCC)	Digitised IS + PRI claims	Before KRP, banks submitted **Interest Subvention (IS)** and **Prompt Repayment Incentive (PRI)** claims **manually to RBI and NABARD**. KRP digitises claims for Kisan Credit Card interest support.
National Urban Innovation Stack (NUIS)	MoHUA + **NIUA** Digital Blueprint	Shared urban digital public good	Stack approach for interoperable urban e-governance. Digital Blueprint jointly developed by **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs** and **National Institute of Urban Affairs (NIUA)**. Trap: not MeitY-only / not NITI Aayog alone.
Nyaya Setu AI Chatbot	**Department of Justice** under **DISHA**	Voice-first legal assistant	Multimodal, multilingual AI legal help for citizens (voice/text; many Indian languages). Mascot **Dishika**. Multilingual stack linked with **BHASHINI** (ASR / Shrutlekh-type tools). Trap: "Anuvaadini" as the only translation name is weak — official coverage stresses **BHASHINI**.

Scheme / Mission	Approval Date & Ministry	Financial Outlay	Core Objective
PRAVAAH (RBI)	Launched **28 May 2024**; mandatory path stressed from **1 May 2025**	Regulatory approvals portal	Full form: **Platform for Regulatory Application, Validation And AutHorisation**. Used for RBI authorisations / licences / approvals, including **NBFC** CoR and related requests; also surrender/processing of certificates in that workflow. Trap: not e-Kuber, DAKSH, or UDGAM.
Samagra Shiksha	MoE; SSA + RMSA + Teacher Education	School education umbrella	Merged **Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan**, **Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan**, and **Teacher Education**. **Mid-Day Meal / PM POSHAN** is **not** a Samagra component — it stays a separate nutrition scheme.
'Nirbhaya Nisha' Initiative	**March 2026** (Kerala Government / Kerala Police)	State Police modernization	Night-time women safety network (**9:00 PM to 5:00 AM**) integrating **112 helpline**, **Pol-App SOS**, Pink Patrol, and AI safety poles.

'Nirbhaya Nisha' Initiative | Kerala Police | March 2026

What happened The **Kerala State Government and Kerala Police** launched the **'Nirbhaya Nisha'** initiative (piloted in late February 2026 by CM Pinarayi Vijayan and officially operationalized statewide on **8 March 2026, International Women's Day**) to protect women traveling during night hours.

Core facts & Prelims Traps - **Operating Hours:** Night window from **9:00 PM to 5:00 AM**. - **Helpline & Emergency Integration:** Linked directly with the national **112 emergency response support system (ERSS)** and a dedicated **SOS button** on the Kerala Police **Pol-App**. - **On-Ground Enforcement:** Deploys dedicated "Pink Patrol" vehicles, shadow police teams, and localized patrol jeeps in vulnerable transit zones (railway stations, bus terminals, IT corridors). - **Smart Infrastructure:** Installing AI-enabled "safety poles" in dense urban areas featuring panic buttons, two-way audio, and direct feeds to district police control rooms. - **Trap:** Do not confuse with UP's *Mission Shakti* or Delhi's *Himmat Plus*. The specific initiative named **Nirbhaya Nisha** belongs to **Kerala**.

Nyaya Setu AI Chatbot | launched 29 March 2026 | DISHA / Department of Justice

What happened Vice-President **C. P. Radhakrishnan** unveiled **Nyaya Setu**, a voice-first AI legal assistant, at a **DISHA** programme of the **Department of Justice** (Vigyan Bhawan), with mascot **Dishika**.

Core facts

- It is a **voice-first, multimodal, multilingual** AI legal assistant for rights, processes, and next steps.
- Parent scheme: **DISHA** (**Designing Innovative Solutions for Holistic Access to Justice**) under the **Department of Justice**.
- Built / powered with **Digital India BHASHINI** voice stack (ASR, multilingual NLP); programme coverage also used **Shrutlekh** for live transcription / translation.
- Do **not** key **Anuvaadini** as the official multilingual engine for Nyaya Setu when the stem forces a BHASHINI vs Anuvaadini choice.

Statements I–II true, III false when III names only **Anuvaadini**. Correct multi-statement key is usually **I and II only**.

Samagra Shiksha — what merged / what did not

- Samagra Shiksha merges **SSA + RMSA + Teacher Education**.
- **Mid-Day Meal Scheme (now PM POSHAN)** is **not** merged into Samagra.

Official National Progress Benchmarks (Economic Survey 2025–26)

Scheme / Platform	Nodal Ministry	Cumulative Milestone / Progress Metric	Core Focus & Beneficiary Base
PM-KISAN	Ministry of Agriculture	**₹4.09 lakh crore disbursed** directly via DBT	Income support of ₹6,000/year in 3 equal instalments of ₹2,000 to landholding farmer families.
PM-KMY (Kisan Maandhan)	Ministry of Agriculture	**24.92 lakh farmers enrolled**	Voluntary old-age pension scheme providing **₹3,000/month** after age 60 (entry age 18–40).
e-NAM	Ministry of Agriculture / SFAC	**1.79 crore farmers**, **2.72 crore traders**, **4,698 FPOs** onboarded	Pan-India electronic trading portal integrating **1,522 regulated APMC wholesale mandis** (by 31 Dec 2025).
SVAMITVA Scheme	Ministry of Panchayati Raj	Drone surveys completed in **3.28 lakh villages**	Survey of Villages and Mapping with Improvised Technology in Village Areas; clear property titles via 'Property Cards' + Drone Didis.
PM Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)	Ministry of Finance (DFS)	**55.02 crore accounts** (March 2025); **36.63 crore** in rural/semi-urban areas	Basic savings bank accounts, RuPay debit cards with ₹2 lakh accident cover, ₹10,000 overdraft facility.

Scheme / Platform	Nodal Ministry	Cumulative Milestone / Progress Metric	Core Focus & Beneficiary Base
e-Shram Portal	Ministry of Labour & Employment	**>31 crore unorganised workers registered** (**54% women**)	National database of unorganised workers seeded with Aadhaar for targeted social security deliverability.
National Career Service (NCS)	Ministry of Labour & Employment	Mobilised **~80 million (8 crore) vacancies**	One-stop digital platform matching jobseekers and employers, integrated with DigiLocker and e-Shram.
Kisan Rin Portal (KRP)	MoA&FW (MISS–KCC)	Claims processed **₹1.08+ lakh crore** by 31 Dec 2024; ~**5.9 crore** farmers mapped	Digitises Interest Subvention + Prompt Repayment Incentive claims. **Before KRP**, banks filed these claims **manually with RBI and NABARD**.

January 2026

Plan to merge farm schemes into PM-RKVY | around 12 January 2026

What happened The Union Agriculture Ministry proposed joining three schemes into one bigger umbrella. The new umbrella name in reports is **Pradhan Mantri–Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (PM-RKVY)**.

Which three schemes may merge

- **Krishonnati Yojana (KY)**
- **National Mission on Natural Farming (NMNF)**
- **National Bee and Honey Mission (NBHM)**

Money and time facts

- Reported outlay: about **₹1.75 lakh crore** over **five years**.
- The period is linked to the **16th Finance Commission cycle**, from **April 2026 to March 2031**.
- Money to states may depend on reform progress. Reports gave about **30%** weight to reform milestones.
- Centre–state sharing in reports: **60:40** for most states, **90:10** for North-East and Himalayan states, and **100%** for Union Territories.

Background

- In October 2024, the Cabinet had already approved a large outlay for PMRKVY and KY.
- NMNF and NBHM earlier had their own end dates into 2025–26.

Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0 | launched 28 January 2026 | NITI Aayog

What happened NITI Aayog started a short, intensive drive to fill gaps in basic development indicators in poor districts and blocks. The drive is called **Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0**.

Core facts

- Period: **28 January 2026 to 14 April 2026** (about three months).
- It works under two older programmes:
- **Aspirational Districts Programme (ADP)** — started **January 2018**, covers **112** districts.
- **Aspirational Blocks Programme (ABP)** — started **January 2023**, covers **513** blocks.
- Aim: reach full saturation on selected development indicators.

Export Promotion Mission | launched January 2026

What happened The Union Government formally operationalised the **Export Promotion Mission** (approved November 2025) to bolster India's merchandise and services export competitiveness.

Core facts - **Implementation Period: 2025–26 to 2030–31** (aligned with 16th FC period). - **Total Financial Outlay: ₹25,060 crore**. - **Key Interventions:** Launched two key interventions under the ***Niryat Protsahan*** sub-scheme focused specifically on strengthening exports from **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)**.

Atal Pension Yojana (APY) Extension | 21 January 2026

- **What happened:** The Union Cabinet approved the continuation of the **Atal Pension Yojana (APY)** up to **FY 2030–31** to sustain social security coverage for unorganised sector workers.

February 2026

Union Budget 2026–27 — new schemes and big policy calls | 1 February 2026

What happened Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** presented the Union Budget for **2026–27**. She called it a **Yuva Shakti**-driven Budget. It was the first Budget prepared in **Kartavya Bhawan**. She framed the Budget around **three kartavyas** (duties):

1. Speed up and protect economic growth.
2. Build people's skills and meet their aspirations.
3. Follow **Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas** so no region or group is left out.

Money figures are collected in Economy / Budget / Trade. Below are the scheme names you must know.

Biopharma SHAKTI

- Full form used in the Budget: **Strategy for Healthcare Advancement through Knowledge, Technology and Innovation**.
- Aim: make India a strong base for **biologics and biosimilars** (advanced biological medicines).
- Outlay: **₹10,000 crore** over **five years**.
- Plan includes **3 new NIPER** institutes and upgrading **7** existing ones.
- Plan also includes more than **1,000** accredited clinical trial sites in India.
- **CDSCO** (drug regulator) is to be strengthened for faster and more global-standard approvals.

Semiconductor and electronics

- **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0** will be launched. It focuses on equipment, materials, Indian intellectual property, and supply chains. It builds on ISM 1.0.
- Budget-time messaging did **not** fact the final ₹1.27 lakh crore Cabinet outlay yet — that came later (July 2026). See July card below.
- The **Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme** outlay was raised to **₹40,000 crore** (it was ₹22,919 crore when launched in April 2025).

Minerals, chemicals, containers, textiles

- Support for **Rare Earth Corridors** in **Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu**.
- A scheme to help states set up **3 Chemical Parks**.
- A **Container Manufacturing** scheme with **₹10,000 crore** over five years.
- An integrated textile programme with five parts, including **Samarth 2.0**.
- Mega Textile Parks in challenge mode.
- **Mahatma Gandhi Gram Swaraj** initiative for khadi, handloom, and handicrafts. It also supports **ODOP** and rural youth.
- A scheme to revive **200** old industrial clusters.

Skills, health, sports, and farming tools

- **Bharat-VISTAAR**: a multilingual AI tool to help farmers with good farming practices.
- **Divyangjan Kaushal Yojana** for skills and jobs.
- **Divyang Sahara Yojana** for good quality assistive devices.
- A high-powered **Education to Employment and Enterprise** Standing Committee for the services sector. The long-term aim noted is **10%** global share in services by **2047**.
- Support for states to set up **five Regional Medical Hubs** for medical tourism.
- **3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda**.
- Upgrade of the **WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre** at **Jamnagar**.
- A second **NIMHANS** (**NIMHANS-2**) planned in **North India**. Institutes at **Ranchi** and **Tezpur** are to be upgraded.
- Fisheries push: integrated work on **500 reservoirs and Amrit Sarovars**.
- Budget also used **Khelo India Mission** language for a wider sports push.

16th Finance Commission

- Chairperson: **Arvind Panagariya**.
- The Commission's recommendations were accepted for **2026–27 to 2030–31**.
- For FY **2026–27**, the Budget provides about **₹1.4 lakh crore** to states as Finance Commission grants (including local body and disaster-related grants in coverage).

March 2026

Modified UDAN scheme | Cabinet approval around 25 March 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet approved a **modified UDAN** (regional air connectivity) plan for a long period. UDAN means **Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik**. It helps common people fly to smaller cities by supporting airlines and airports.

Core facts

- Outlay noted: about **₹28,840 crore**.
- Period noted: **2026 to 2036**.
- Aim includes developing about **100 new airports** from unused or weakly used airstrips, plus support (viability gap funding) for airlines on weak routes.
- Ministry link: **Civil Aviation**.

IVFRT scheme continued | 2026–2031

What happened The Cabinet also approved continuation of the **Immigration, Visa, Foreigners Registration and Tracking (IVFRT)** scheme.

Core facts

- Outlay noted: about **₹1,800 crore**.
- Period: **2026 to 2031** (five years).
- Ministry: **Home Affairs**.
- Simple meaning: one digital system to track visas, entry, stay, and exit of foreigners for both security and ease of travel.

RELIEF scheme for exporters | around 19 March 2026

What happened Because of conflict and risk in West Asia, the government announced a support package for exporters called **RELIEF** (**Resilience and Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation**).

Core facts

- Total package noted: about **₹497 crore**.
- Implementing agency often named: **ECGC Limited** (export credit guarantee body).
- It mixes extra war-risk cover and freight help so exporters do not stop shipments.

Bose Aapda Puraskar nominations now year-round

What happened Nominations for the **Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar** can now be filed through the year on the **National Awards Portal**. The award is still announced on **23 January**.

Prize memory

- Individual: about **₹5 lakh** plus certificate.
- Institution: about **₹51 lakh** plus certificate (to be used for disaster work).

Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna (BHAVYA) | March 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet approved **BHAVYA (Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna)**, an umbrella scheme for the comprehensive development and modernization of industrial parks across India.

Core facts - **Nodal Department: DPIIT** (Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, Ministry of Commerce and Industry). - **Approved Outlay: ₹33,660 crore**. - **Objective:** Financing state-of-the-art infrastructure, plug-and-play industrial corridors, and smart utility facilities in new and existing industrial parks.

PM-RAHAT Scheme | Notified 19 February 2026

What happened The Central Government notified the **Prime Minister - Road Accident Victims' Hospitalisation and Assured Treatment (PM-RAHAT) Scheme** to drastically reduce road crash fatalities through prompt trauma care.

Core facts - **Statutory Authority**: Section 162 of the **Motor Vehicles Act, 1988** (as amended). - **Entitlement**: **Cashless medical treatment up to ₹1.5 lakh** per victim for a maximum period of **7 days** from the time of accident across all public and private roads. - **Helpline & Citizen Roles**: Seamlessly integrated with emergency helpline **112 (ERSS)**; Good Samaritans assisting victims are formally recognized as **RAH-VEER**.

Bharat VISTAAR Scheme | 17 February 2026

What happened Launched in **Jaipur** by Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan and Rajasthan CM Bhajanlal Sharma, **Bharat VISTAAR** is India's flagship farmer-centric, AI-powered Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI).

Core facts - **Architecture**: Multilingual, voice-first AI platform delivering hyper-local agricultural advisory (weather, soil health, crop diagnostics, real-time APMC mandi prices). - **Initial Rollout**: Hindi and English across Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Bihar, and Gujarat before nationwide expansion.

Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0 | Approved 10 March 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet chaired by PM Narendra Modi approved the restructuring and expansion of the Jal Jeevan Mission into **JJM 2.0**, marking a strategic transition from physical infrastructure creation to a **utility-based service delivery model (24x7 treated tap water)**.

Core facts - **Total Restructured Outlay**: **₹8.69 lakh crore** (Central Government share: **₹3.59 lakh crore**; additional Central assistance: ₹1.51 lakh crore). - **Physical Milestone**: Rural tap water connectivity expanded from 17% (3.23 crore households in August 2019) to **81.61% (15.80 crore households)** by early 2026. - **Target**: Universal 100% saturation covering all **19.36 crore rural households by December 2028**. - **Digital & Community Architecture**: - **"Sujalam Bharat" Portal**: Unique Sujal village / service area IDs mapping water sources to household taps. - **"Jal Arpan"**: Gram Panchayats and Village Water & Sanitation Committees (VWSC) formally certify operational sustainability before declaring a village "Har Ghar Jal". - **"Jal Utsav"**: Annual community-driven awareness festival.

Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey | 16 March 2026

What happened The Ministry of Culture launched the **Gyan Bharatam National Manuscript Survey** to map, document, and digitise India's vast manuscript heritage.

Core facts - **Objective**: Geo-tagged national mapping of rare manuscripts housed across temples, mutts, private collections, universities, and libraries. - **Outcome**: Development of a nationwide **"Manuscript Presence Map"** and centralized digital preservation archive. - **Four-Stage Framework**: 1. Identification $\rightarrow$ 2. Physical Verification $\rightarrow$ 3. Cataloguing & Metadata $\rightarrow$ 4. Conservation & Digitisation.

Revised / Modified Regional Connectivity Scheme (UDAN) | 25 March 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet approved the continuation of the Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS-UDAN) as **Modified / Revised UDAN** for a 10-year term from **FY 2026–27 to 2035–36**.

Core facts - **Total 10-Year Outlay**: **₹28,840 crore** (100% funded via Central budgetary support). - **Key Components**: - **Aerodromes CAPEX**: **₹12,159 crore** over 8 years to develop 100 unserved airstrips into fully operational regional airports. - **O&M Support**: ₹2,577 crore providing up to ₹3.06 crore/year for regional airports and ₹0.90 crore/year for heliports/water aerodromes (3-year support). - **Modern Helipads**: **₹3,661 crore** to build 200 modern helipads (₹15 crore per unit) across hilly, island, and aspirational regions. - **Track Record (since Oct 2016)**: 665 routes operationalized across 95 airports/heliports, transporting over 1.64 crore passengers.

NCERT Conferred "Institution Deemed to be University" Status | 30 March 2026

What happened The Union Government and UGC granted the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) the status of an **"Institution Deemed to be University under distinct category"**.

Core facts - **Mandate**: Aligned with NEP 2020, empowers NCERT to independently design and award undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral degrees in teacher education and pedagogy while preserving its national mandate for school curricula and textbooks.

Age-Based Social Media Restrictions for Children | March 2026

What happened Indian states initiated legislative moves to restrict social media access for minors, following global child safety benchmarks.

Core facts - **Karnataka**: Announced a blanket ban on social media use for children **below 16 years** in its Budget speech (6 March 2026). - **Andhra Pradesh**: Prohibited access for children **below 13 years** (with regulations being drafted for ages 13–16). - **Global Benchmark**: Modeled after **Australia's** *Online Safety Amendment (Social Media Minimum Age) Act, 2024* (banning social media for under-16s).

April 2026

Census of India 2027 | Phase 1 begins 1 April 2026

What happened India began the first phase of **Census 2027**. This is India's **16th** Census overall and the **eighth** since Independence. For the first time, the Census is being run mainly in **digital** mode, with a **self-enumeration** option online.

Core facts

- Phase 1 name: **House Listing Operations (HLO)** / House Listing and Housing Census.

- Self-enumeration portal languages noted: **16**.
- Mascots named in compilations: **Pragati** and **Vikas**.
- Early rollout states/UTs included Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Goa, Karnataka, Lakshadweep, Mizoram, Odisha, Sikkim, and selected Delhi areas (NDMC and Delhi Cantonment).
- Phase 2 (**Population Enumeration**) is planned for **February 2027**.
- Reference date noted: **1 March 2027** (special dates for some snow-bound areas).
- Caste enumeration is planned in Phase 2 (first such nationwide caste count after **1931** in coverage).
- Approved outlay noted: about **₹11,718 crore**.
- Registrar General and Census Commissioner named in briefings: **Mritunjay Kumar Narayan**.

Nutrient Based Subsidy | Kharif 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet fixed **Nutrient Based Subsidy (NBS)** rates for phosphatic and potassic (**P&K**) fertilisers for the **Kharif 2026** season.

Core facts

- Period: **1 April 2026 to 30 September 2026**.
- Tentative outlay: about **₹41,533–41,534 crore**.
- About **₹4,317 crore** higher than the Kharif 2025 requirement in coverage.
- Covers grades such as **DAP** and various **NPKS** fertilisers.
- NBS for P&K fertilisers has run since **1 April 2010**.

PMGSY-III Continuation & Extension | 18 April 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet approved the continuation of the **Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana-III (PMGSY-III)** with a revised financial outlay to complete pending road and bridge infrastructure.

- **Revised Financial Outlay: ₹83,977 crore**.
- **PMGSY at 25 Years & PMGSY-IV Launch**:
- PMGSY completed **25 years** in December 2025 (launched 25 Dec 2000). Overall, 7.87 lakh km constructed (95% progress).
- **PMGSY-IV (2024–25 to 2028–29)**: Targets construction and upgradation of **62,500 km** of rural roads with an approved outlay of **₹70,125 crore**.

JANANI Platform | Ministry of Health & Family Welfare

What happened The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare launched **JANANI** (**Journey of Antenatal, Natal and Neonatal Integrated Care**) at the National Summit on Innovation and Inclusivity.

Core facts - **Architecture**: Upgraded digital version of the Reproductive and Child Health (RCH) portal, providing a longitudinal electronic health record across the maternal-child care continuum. - **Key Innovation**: Introduction of **QR-enabled digital Mother and Child Health (MCH) cards** for instant tracking. - **Interoperability**: Fully interoperable with **U-WIN** (universal immunization) and **POSHAN Tracker**. - **Milestones**: Crossed **1.34 crore registered beneficiaries** (>30 lakh pregnant women) and generated over 30 lakh digital MCH cards.

8th Poshan Pakhwada 2026 | 9 to 23 April 2026

What happened The Ministry of Women and Child Development celebrated the nationwide **8th Poshan Pakhwada** under Mission Poshan 2.0.

Core facts - **Duration**: **9 to 23 April 2026**. - **National Launch**: Vigyan Bhavan, New Delhi by Union Minister Annpurna Devi. - **Theme for 2026**: **"Maximizing Brain Development in the First Six Years of Life"**. - **Strategic Focus**: Emphasizing the **first 1,000 days** as the critical window for infant brain development, cognitive milestones, and nutritional foundation.

May 2026

Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Rules, 2026 | In force 1 May 2026

What happened The Central Government notified and brought into force the **Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Rules, 2026**, operationalizing the PROG Act, 2025.

Core facts - **Enforcement Date**: **1 May 2026**. - **Scope & Demarcation**: - Distinguishes permissible games (e-sports, educational games, social games) from prohibited online money/gambling games. - Strictly prohibits the offering, operation, facilitation, and advertisement of **online money games**. - **Statutory Regulator**: Establishes the **Online Gaming Authority of India** as a unified digital-first regulator with mandatory registration protocols. - **Dispute Redressal**: Two-tier grievance redressal system; users can appeal to the Authority within **30 days**; complaints must be concluded within **90 days**.

SARTHAK-PDS | Cabinet approval 27 May 2026

What happened The Cabinet approved **SARTHAK-PDS**, a technology-driven push to strengthen India's Public Distribution System. It does not replace PDS. It reforms how foodgrain moves, is handled, tracked, and how grievances are fixed.

Core facts

- Full name idea in coverage: Scheme for Assistance in Ration Transport and Handling with Automation in PDS.
- Central outlay noted: about **₹25,530 crore**.
- Period: about **five years** (**April 2026 to March 2031**).
- Ministry / department link: Food and Public Distribution.
- Aim: transparency, security, and sustainability across the PDS chain.

Mission for Cotton Productivity

What happened Cabinet approved a Mission for Cotton Productivity (early May coverage).

Core facts

- Outlay noted: about **₹5,659 crore**.
- Period noted: **2026–27 to 2030–31**.
- Linked with agriculture and textiles productivity.

ECLGS 5.0

What happened Cabinet approved **Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0** to support credit flow after West Asia–linked stress.

Core facts

- Target additional credit flow: about **₹2.55 lakh crore**.
- Airlines window noted: about **₹5,000 crore**.
- Guarantee pattern in explainers: about **100%** for eligible MSME credit and about **50%** for specified non-MSME / airline cases.

Surface Coal and Lignite Gasification Promotion Scheme

What happened Cabinet approved a scheme to promote surface coal and lignite gasification.

Core facts

- Outlay noted: about **₹37,500 crore**.
- Supports the national goal of gasifying about **100 MT** of coal by **2030**.
- Aim includes cutting dependence on imported LNG, methanol, ammonia, and urea.

Ayush Anudan Portal

- Launched by the **Ministry of Ayush** to manage funding proposals end-to-end (submit, verify, approve, monitor).

June 2026

VB-G RAM G Act | July rollout preview

What happened June coverage prepared for the new rural jobs law: **Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin)** or **VB-G RAM G**. It was set to replace the older **MGNREGS** framework from **1 July 2026**.

Core facts

- Guarantee noted: up to **125 days** of wage employment (older framework: **100 days**).
- Centre's interim / FY allocation figures noted: about **₹95,692 crore** to states/UTs; total with state share over about **₹1.5 lakh crore** in FY27 coverage.
- Existing e-KYC job cards remain valid until new **Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards** are issued.
- National launch event named for early July at **Mukkavaripalli**, Andhra Pradesh (Tirupati district).

Soft state investment note

Odisha launched a **GO-EAST** investment facilitation push (Government of Odisha Eastern Investment Accelerator and Special Task Force) for eastern and north-eastern investment into backward districts.

July 2026

Semicon 2.0 / India Semiconductor Mission 2.0 | Cabinet ~15 July 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet approved **Semicon 2.0** (India Semiconductor Mission 2.0) to widen India's chip design and manufacturing ecosystem beyond the first ISM phase.

Core facts

- Outlay: **₹1,27,500 crore** (about **₹1.27 lakh crore**).
- Builds on Semicon / ISM **1.0** (about **₹76,000 crore** in earlier foundation messaging).
- Six pillars in coverage: chip design; equipment and materials; fabrication; advanced packaging; R&D; talent.
- Nodal idea: **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)** under **MeitY**.
- Soft follow-up: detailed notification / eligibility guidelines appeared around **end-August 2026** (fab support often locked near **40%** of eligible capex for silicon wafer fabs in explainers).

VB-G RAM G Act | in force 1 July 2026 | national launch 2 July

What happened The **Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin)** Act came into force on **1 July 2026**. It replaces the older **MGNREGA / MGNREGS** rural jobs framework. The national launch was held on **2 July 2026** at **Mukkavaripalli** village in **Obulavaripalli mandal, Tirupati district, Andhra Pradesh**.

Core facts

- Full short name: **VB-G RAM G**.
- Guarantee: **125 days** of wage employment per eligible rural household (older law: **100 days**).
- National launch place: **Mukkavaripalli**, Andhra Pradesh.
- Leaders at launch: Union Minister **Shivraj Singh Chouhan**, Andhra CM **N. Chandrababu Naidu**, Deputy CM **Pawan Kalyan**.
- Centre interim allocation noted: about **₹95,692 crore**.
- Total Centre + states in first-year coverage: about **₹1.51 lakh crore**.
- Five-year investment aim noted: about **₹7.5 lakh crore**.
- Funding pattern for most states: about **60:40** Centre–State (older wage bill was largely central).
- North-eastern and Himalayan states / UTs with legislature: about **90:10** in coverage.
- UTs without legislature: Centre bears full funding in coverage.
- Peak farm season pause allowed up to about **60 days**.
- New card name: **Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Card** (old e-KYC job cards stay valid until replaced).
- Planning language: Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans linked with **PM Gati Shakti**.

Easy compare	Old MGNREGA	New VB-G RAM G
Days	100	**125**
Start of new law	—	**1 July 2026**
Most states' money share	Centre paid almost all wages	About **60:40**
New worker card	Job card	**Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Card**

Samudra Manthan | National Offshore Exploration Scheme | 31 July 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet approved **Samudra Manthan**, a big plan to find more oil and gas under the sea (deep and ultra-deep water).

Easy facts

- Full idea: National Offshore Exploration Scheme.
- Ministry: **Petroleum and Natural Gas**.
- Money: about **₹84,084 crore**.
- Period: up to financial year **2030–31**.
- Simple aim: more home production of oil and gas so India imports less.

PM Surya Sarovar Yojana (PM-SSY) | floating solar

What happened The Cabinet also approved **Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana**. It puts solar panels on water bodies (reservoirs, canals, ponds) instead of taking farm land.

Easy facts

- Target: about **5,000 MW** floating solar.
- Money: about **₹5,070 crore**.

- Storage idea: projects need at least about **two hours** of battery storage (about **10,000 MWh** in total messaging).
- Support noted: up to about **₹1 crore per MW**.

PM-KISAN extended + Khelo India revamp (same Cabinet window)

Decision	Easy fact
PM-KISAN extension	Continues **2026–27 to 2030–31**; about **₹3.15 lakh crore**; farmer family still gets **₹6,000** a year in three parts
Khelo India revamp	About **₹36,441 crore** in Cabinet coverage for a wider sports push

Soft education reform task force

A high-powered task force on examination reforms, led by **Nandan Nilekani**, was announced. Members named in coverage include Tapan Deka, S. Somanath, V. Kamakoti, Anita Karwal, and Amrit Lal Meena.

August 2026

Independence Day announcements | 15 August 2026 | Red Fort

What happened On India's **80th** Independence Day, PM Modi delivered his **13th** consecutive Red Fort address. Themes linked **150 years of Vande Mataram** with **Yuva Shakti — Leading the Journey to Viksit Bharat @2047**.

Shakti Ki Saptadhara (seven streams)

#	Stream (easy name)	What it means
1	Manufacturing Shakti	Make more goods in India for the world
2	Agriculture and food processing	Farm to export; brands for millets, spices, foods
3	Technology and innovation	AI, quantum, 6G, space, data centres
4	Gati Shakti	Faster roads, rail, ports, logistics
5	Raksha Shakti	Stronger home-made defence
6	Green and blue economy	Clean energy + ocean / coastal economy
7	Soft power	Yoga, films, crafts, culture as strength

Big number facts

- Train about **1 crore** youth in **AI** skills in the next year.
- Raise **Lakhpati Didi** target to **6 crore** women.
- Nuclear power capacity aim: **100 GW by 2047**, with about **five** new reactors in the next six–seven years.
- About **7–8** new semiconductor plants to start in about one–two years.
- Free online coaching for competitive aspirants.
- Nationwide sports talent hunt for children about **5–15** years.
- Modernised voluntary **Civil Defence** network.

Soft soil map

The **National Bureau of Soil Survey and Land Use Planning** released India's first national **soil texture map** using remote sensing, for crop choice and farm planning.

PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY) | 100 Aspirational Agriculture Districts

What happened The Union Cabinet chaired by PM Narendra Modi approved the **Pradhan Mantri Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY)** on **16 July 2025** for a duration of **6 years (FY 2025–26 to FY 2030–31)**. On **3 October 2025**, the government formally notified **100 Aspirational Agriculture Districts** selected across 29 States and Union Territories.

Core Objectives & High-Yield Facts - **Target Districts**: 100 agriculture-lagging districts facing low productivity, deficient irrigation, and low cropping intensity. - **Top State-Wise Distribution of Districts**: 1. **Uttar Pradesh**: **12 districts** (**Highest in India**) 2. **Maharashtra**: **9 districts** 3. **Madhya Pradesh**: **8 districts** 4. **Rajasthan**: **8 districts** 5. **Bihar**: **7 districts** - **Intervention Pillars**: - Saturation of micro-irrigation and groundwater recharging. - Accelerated distribution of climate-resilient, bio-fortified certified seeds. - Digital agriculture infrastructure (AgriStack, digital soil health mapping). - Modern decentralized storage, cold chains, and Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs) integration.

Atal Pension Yojana (APY) Extended to FY 2030–31 | Cabinet Approval 21 January 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet approved the continuation and funding extension of the **Atal Pension Yojana (APY)** on **21 January 2026**, extending the flagship social security pension scheme up to **FY 2030–31**.

Core Operational Architecture - **Original Launch**: Launched on **9 May 2015** by PM Modi in Kolkata (alongside PMJJBY and PMSBY). - **Administering Body**: Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (**PFRDA**). - **Target Group**: Unorganized sector workers aged **18 to 40 years**. - **Pension Benefits**: Guaranteed minimum monthly pension of **₹1,000, ₹2,000, ₹3,000, ₹4,000, or ₹5,000** upon reaching the age of **60 years**, depending on subscriber contribution. - **Subscriber Base**: Crossed **8.66 crore subscribers** by early 2026, marking it as India's largest unorganized sector pension programme.

October 2026

5 New Classical Languages Approved by Union Cabinet | October 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet chaired by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** approved the conferment of **Classical Language (शास्त्रीय भाषा)** status to **five more languages**: **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali**. With this decision, the total number of recognized Classical Languages in India expanded from 6 to **11**.

Complete Chronology & Roster of India's 11 Classical Languages

#	Language	Year Conferred	Geographic / Historical Anchor
1	**Tamil**	**2004**	1st language in India granted Classical status
2	**Sanskrit**	**2005**	Ancient Indo-Aryan canonical literature
3	**Telugu**	**2008**	Classical Dravidian literary heritage
4	**Kannada**	**2008**	Classical Dravidian literary heritage
5	**Malayalam**	**2013**	Classical Dravidian literary heritage
6	**Odia**	**2014**	First Indo-Aryan language after Sanskrit
7	**Marathi**	**2026**	Rich heritage dating to Prakrit / Maharashtri roots
8	**Pali**	**2026**	Language of the Buddhist Tipitaka canon
9	**Prakrit**	**2026**	Ancient spoken idiom of Jain agamas and rock edicts
10	**Assamese**	**2026**	Charyapada and early eastern Indo-Aryan literature
11	**Bengali**	**2026**	Charyapada and centuries of distinctive Eastern literature

Statutory Criteria for Classical Language Status To qualify as a Classical Language, a language must meet four stringent criteria laid down by the Ministry of Culture and the Linguistic Experts Committee under the Sahitya Akademi: 1. **High Antiquity:** Early texts or recorded history spanning a period of **1,500 to 2,000 years**. 2. **Ancient Literature:** A body of ancient literature/texts considered a valuable heritage by generations of speakers. 3. **Original Tradition:** The literary tradition must be **original and not borrowed** from another speech community. 4. **Distinctiveness:** The classical language and literature being distinct from modern forms; there may also be a discontinuity between the classical language and its later forms or offshoots.

Key Benefits of Classical Language Status - Two major annual international awards for scholars of eminence. - Establishment of a **Centre of Excellence for Studies in Classical Languages**. - Creation of dedicated **Professional Chairs** in Central Universities for academic research and pedagogy.

1. **Hindi is NOT a Classical Language:** Hindi is the official language of the Union (Article 343) and an Eighth Schedule language, but it has **never** been granted Classical Language status.
2. **Pali and Prakrit are NOT in the Eighth Schedule:** While both are now notified **Classical Languages**, neither Pali nor Prakrit is listed in the **22 languages of the Eighth Schedule** of the Constitution!

CCEA Approves Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for Rabi Crops | October 2026

What happened The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), chaired by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**, approved the **Minimum Support Prices (MSP)** for all mandated **Rabi crops** for the upcoming marketing season to ensure remunerative prices to growers.

Mandated Rabi Crops MSP & Absolute Increase Board

Rabi Crop	Revised MSP (₹/quintal)	Absolute Increase (₹/quintal)	Cost of Production (₹/q)	Margin / Return over Cost (%)
Wheat (गेहूँ)	**₹2,425**	**₹150**	₹1,128	**115%**
Rapeseed & Mustard (सरसों)	**₹5,950**	**₹300** *(Highest hike)*	₹3,005	**98%**

Rabi Crop	Revised MSP (₹/quintal)	Absolute Increase (₹/quintal)	Cost of Production (₹/q)	Margin / Return over Cost (%)
Barley (जौ)	**₹1,980**	**₹130**	₹1,238	**60%**
Gram / Chana (चना)	**₹5,650**	**₹210**	₹3,531	**60%**
Lentil / Masur (मसूर)	**₹6,700**	**₹275**	₹3,545	**89%**
Safflower (कुसुम)	**₹5,940**	**₹140**	₹3,960	**50%**

Core Policy Architecture - In line with the **Union Budget 2018–19** commitment, all MSPs are fixed at a level of **at least 1.5 times (minimum 50% margin)** over the all-India weighted average cost of production. - The highest return over cost is for **Wheat (115%)**, followed by **Rapeseed & Mustard (98%)** and **Lentil (89%)**. - The highest absolute increase in price was approved for **Rapeseed & Mustard (₹300 per quintal)**.

PM Vidyalaxmi Scheme | Cabinet Approval October 2026

What happened The Union Cabinet approved **PM Vidyalaxmi**, a new Central Sector scheme to provide collateral-free, guarantor-free education loans to meritorious students admitted to India's top higher educational institutions.

Core facts - **Institutions Covered:** Top **860 quality higher educational institutions (QHEIs)** as per the latest NIRF rankings (all top 100 institutes overall, category-specific top ranks, and state/central government colleges). - **Loan Features: Collateral-free and guarantor-free** education loans covering full tuition fees and course-related expenses. - **Interest Subvention: 3% interest subvention** on education loan amounts up to **₹10 lakh** during the moratorium period for students with annual family income up to **₹8 lakh**. - **Credit Guarantee:** 75% credit guarantee support provided by the Government of India through NCGTC for loans up to ₹7.5 lakh. - **Application Portal:** Fully digital, simplified application process integrated through the unified portal **PM-USP / Vidyalaxmi**.

National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC) Lothal (Phase 1B Clearance)

What happened The Union Cabinet accorded approval for the development of Phase 1B of the **National Maritime Heritage Complex (NMHC)** at **Lothal, Gujarat**.

Core facts - **Location: Lothal** (historic Harappan port town in Ahmedabad district, Gujarat). - **Ministry:** Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW). - **Scope:** Billed as the **world's largest maritime museum complex**, featuring an ancient dockyard reconstruction, 14 maritime galleries, coastal states pavilions, a light-house museum, and an underwater viewing gallery showcasing India's 5,000-year seafaring heritage.

PART C · TOPICS

03 — Science / Space / Defence

> **Priority S** | About **8%** of Current Affairs, and rising Many questions now come as Science or Defence tags, not only "Current Affairs".

What to note every time

For space news

- Mission name, date, agency (often ISRO), rocket, and target body.

For defence news

- Weapon or system name, range, who made it (often DRDO), which force will use it, and where it was tested or shown.

High-Yield Space & Defence Foundational Spine (2024–2025 Matrix)

> **Exam Focus:** UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims regularly test ISRO landmark missions, launch vehicles, payloads, and bilateral military exercises (especially exercises conducted at high-altitude training areas in Uttarakhand like Auli and Pithoragarh).

1. ISRO Landmark Missions & Space Milestones

Mission	Launch Vehicle / Date	Orbit / Destination	Scientific Objective / Key Highlights
Chandrayaan-3	**LVM3-M4** (14 July 2023)	Lunar South Pole (Landed **23 Aug 2023**)	• Lander: **Vikram**; Rover: **Pragyan**. • Landing site named **Shiv Shakti Point**; Chandrayaan-2 crash site named **Tiranga Point**. • India became the **1st country to soft-land near lunar South Pole**, 4th country overall to land on Moon. • **23 August** declared **National Space Day**. • Payloads: ChaSTE (thermal), ILSA (seismicity), RAMBHA-LP (plasma), APXS & LIBS (chemical composition). • *Hop Experiment:* Vikram hopped 50 cm; revealed 2-layer stratigraphy in top 6.5 cm of regolith.
Aditya-L1	**PSLV-C57** (2 Sep 2023)	Halo orbit around **Sun-Earth Lagrange Point 1 (L1)** (~1.5 million km)	• India's **first dedicated solar observatory** in space. • Inserted into L1 halo orbit on **6 January 2024**. • Key payloads: **VELC** (Visible Emission Line Coronagraph - primary payload built by IIA Bengaluru), **SUIT** (Solar Ultraviolet Imaging Telescope), ASPEX, PAPA.
XPoSat (X-ray Polarimeter Satellite)	**PSLV-C58** (1 Jan 2024)	Low Earth Orbit (~650 km)	• India's first dedicated polarimetry mission to study celestial X-ray sources (black holes, neutron stars). • World's **2nd such mission** after NASA's IXPE. • Payloads: **POLIX** (RRI Bengaluru) & **XSPECT** (URSC).
Lunar Trailblazer (NASA / Caltech)	**SpaceX Falcon 9** (26 Feb 2025)	Planned lunar polar orbit (contact lost after launch)	• Smallsat mission to **detect and map water** (H_2O / OH / ice) on the Moon's surface and in permanently shadowed regions. • Instruments: **HVM3** spectrometer (JPL) and **Lunar Thermal Mapper (LTM)** (University of Oxford / UKSA). • Rideshare with Intuitive Machines **IM-2**. Mission ended **31 July 2025** after two-way contact could not be restored. • Primary objective in stems = **map lunar water**, not build a full 3D Moon model or test rovers.
Gaganyaan Programme	**Human-Rated LVM3 (HLVM3)**	Low Earth Orbit (400 km)	• 3-member crew for 3 days. • Astronaut designates announced Feb 2024: Gp Capt **Prashanth Nair**, Gp Capt **Ajit Krishnan**, Gp Capt **Angad Pratap**, Wg Cdr **Shubhanshu Shukla**. • Female humanoid robot: **Vyommitra**.
NISAR Satellite	**GSLV-F16** (30 July 2025)	Sun-Synchronous Polar Orbit (747 km circular, 98.4°)	• Landmark NASA–ISRO Earth Observation collaboration. • World's **first dual-band radar imaging satellite** using **L-band (NASA)** and **S-band (ISRO)** SAR. • Features 12-m unfurlable mesh reflector antenna on 9-m boom; **SweepSAR** technology; 12-day Earth repeat cycle; mass **2,393 kg**. • 18th GSLV flight, 12th with indigenous cryogenic upper stage.

Mission	Launch Vehicle / Date	Orbit / Destination	Scientific Objective / Key Highlights
LVM3-M6 / BlueBird Block-2	**LVM3-M6** (24 Dec 2025)	Low Earth Orbit (LEO)	• 104th launch from Sriharikota; 9th flight of LVM3 (100% success rate); 3rd dedicated commercial mission. • Launched **AST SpaceMobile (USA)** BlueBird Block-2 direct-to-cell satellite. • **Heaviest payload launched by LVM3 from Indian soil: 6,100 kg**! • Largest commercial communication satellite deployed in LEO (223 m^2 phased array antenna).

Indigenous ATP and LCH names (high-yield)

- **Kavach** is India's indigenous **Automatic Train Protection (ATP)** system for railway collision avoidance. It is **not** Rakshak / Tri-Netra / Traintel.
- **Prachand** is the IAF name of HAL's indigenous **Light Combat Helicopter (LCH)**, inducted at **Jodhpur (October 2022)**. Dhruv / Rudra / Tejas / Cheetah are **different** platforms. If a stem asks for the LCH inducted into the IAF and **Prachand is not in the options**, the key is often **None of the above**.

| **Axiom Mission 4 (Ax-4)** | **SpaceX Falcon-9**
(25 June – 15 July 2025) | International Space Station (ISS) | • Spacecraft: SpaceX Crew Dragon **'Grace' (C213)**.
• Gp Capt **Shubhanshu Shukla** (born in **Lucknow, UP**) served as **Pilot**.
• **1st Indian astronaut to visit ISS**; 2nd Indian citizen in orbit after Rakesh Sharma (1984) after 41 years.
• Commander: Peggy Whitson (USA); Crew: Tibor Kapu (Hungary), Slawosz Uznanski (Poland). Docked at Harmony Module for 18 days; splashed down in Pacific Ocean. | | **Kalam 1200 / Vikram-1** | Static Test
(8 August 2025) | SDSC-SHAR Sriharikota | • **Skyroot Aerospace** (Hyderabad) tested 1st stage motor of **Vikram-1** rocket.
• 11m long, 1.7m diameter monolithic composite motor, 30 tonnes solid propellant (longest monolithic motor built at Solid Propellant Plant, Sriharikota).
• Vikram-1 payload: 350 kg to 500 km LEO, 260 kg to SSPO. |

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2. High-Yield Bilateral & Multilateral Military Exercises (With Uttarakhand & UP Venues)

Exercise Name	Participating Nations	Arm / Service	Frequent Host Locations / High-Yield Notes
Surya Kiran	**India – Nepal**	Army	Alternates between **Pithoragarh (Uttarakhand)** & Saljhandi (Nepal). Counter-insurgency & mountain warfare. *(High-yield UKPCS hook)*
Yudh Abhyas	**India – USA**	Army	Conducted at **Auli (Chamoli, Uttarakhand)** — High-altitude cold-weather warfare. *(Crucial UKPCS hook)*
Dustlik	**India – Uzbekistan**	Army	Conducted at **Pithoragarh (Uttarakhand)** and Termez (Uzbekistan).
Mitra Shakti	**India – Sri Lanka**	Army	Alternates (e.g. Pune / Aundh).
Vajra Prahar	**India – USA**	Special Forces	Bakloh (HP) / Umroi (Meghalaya) / Idaho (USA).
Dharma Guardian	**India – Japan**	Army	Camp Imazu (Japan) / Mahajan (Rajasthan).
Garuda Shakti	**India – Indonesia**	Special Forces	Alternates between India and Indonesia.
Varuna, Garuda, Shakti	**India – France**	Navy (Varuna), Air Force (Garuda), Army (Shakti)	Bilateral multi-service exercises.
Nomadic Elephant	**India – Mongolia**	Army	Ulaanbaatar (Mongolia) / Umroi (Meghalaya).
Malabar	**QUAD (India, USA, Japan, Australia)**	Navy	Multilateral naval exercise in Indo-Pacific.

High-Yield Biotech, Computing & Space Foundation (Late 2025)

- **TOP 500 Supercomputers (66th Edition — Nov 2025, SC25 St. Louis):**
- **Global Exascale Leaders:**
  1. **El Capitan** (USA — Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory): **1.809 exaFLOP/s** (1,809 PFlop/s Rmax, 11.34 million cores; World #1).
  2. **Frontier** (USA — Oak Ridge National Lab): 1,353 PFlop/s Rmax.
  3. **Aurora** (USA — Argonne National Lab): 1,012 PFlop/s Rmax.
  4. **JUPITER Booster** (Germany — Forschungszentrum Jülich): 1,000 PFlop/s Rmax (*Europe's first exascale supercomputer*).
  5. **Eagle** (USA — Microsoft Azure): 561.2 PFlop/s Rmax.

- **India's 5 Supercomputers in Global TOP 500:**
  1. **Rank 188 — AIRAWAT-PSAI:** Located at **C-DAC, Pune** (Rmax 8.50 PFlop/s, Rpeak 13.17 PFlop/s; India's fastest supercomputer).
  2. **Rank 196 — Arka:** Located at **IITM, Pune** (Rmax 8.28 PFlop/s, Rpeak 10.61 PFlop/s).
  3. **Rank 251 — Arunika:** Located at **NCMRWF, Noida (Uttar Pradesh)** (Rmax 5.94 PFlop/s, Rpeak 7.40 PFlop/s; crucial weather forecasting system).
  4. **Rank 338 — Pratyush:** Located at **IITM, Pune** (Rmax 3.76 PFlop/s, Rpeak 4.01 PFlop/s).
  5. **Rank 469 — Arka AI/ML:** Located at **IITM, Pune** (Rmax 2.70 PFlop/s, Rpeak 3.75 PFlop/s).
- **First Indigenous CRISPR-Based Gene Therapy (19 Nov 2025):** India launched its first indigenous CRISPR Cas-based gene therapy for the clinical management of **Sickle Cell Disease**.
- **First Indigenous Antibiotic — Nafithromycin:** India's first indigenously developed and approved novel macrolide antibiotic, targeted against drug-resistant respiratory infections.
- **First Indigenous 64-Bit Microprocessor — DHRUV64 (15 Dec 2025):** India's first indigenous 64-bit dual-core microprocessor developed by **C-DAC** (Centre for Development of Advanced Computing).
- **Spiral Galaxy 'Alaknanda' (Dec 2025):** Giant spiral galaxy discovered by Indian astrophysicists at **NCRA-TIFR**, Pune.
- **Green Hydrogen Plant for Railways:** India's first green hydrogen production plant for powering trains commissioned at **Jind, Haryana**.
- **First Indigenous Pilot Trainer Aircraft 'HANSA-3 NG' (29 Nov 2025):** Production version launched by **CSIR-National Aerospace Laboratories (CSIR-NAL)**, Bengaluru; features an all-composite airframe designed for civil (PPL/CPL) and military pilot training.
- **Agni-Prime Rail-Based Test (24 Sept 2025):** India successfully launched the new-generation surface-to-surface ballistic missile **Agni-Prime** (strike range: **1,000 to 2,000 km**; payload: 1,500–3,000 kg) from a specially designed **rail-based mobile launcher**, placing India among select nations with canisterised rail launch capability.
- **TASL Defence Facility in Morocco (23 Sept 2025):** Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and Moroccan counterpart inaugurated **Tata Advanced Systems Limited's (TASL)** defence manufacturing facility in **Berrechid, Morocco** — **India's first overseas private defence manufacturing plant**, producing the **Wheeled Armoured Platform (WhAP) 8x8** for the Royal Moroccan Army.
- **ICGS 'Adamya' Commissioned (19 Sept 2025):** First vessel of the **Adamya-class** (series of 8 Fast Patrol Vessels built by Goa Shipyard Limited) commissioned at **Paradip Port, Odisha**.
- **INS Arnala Commissioned (18 June 2025):** First of eight indigenously designed and built Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Crafts (ASW-SWC) commissioned at Visakhapatnam; built by **GRSE** in PPP with **L&T Shipyard**; named after historic Arnala Island off Vasai, Maharashtra (Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj legacy).
- **INS Nistar Commissioned (18 July 2025):** India's **first indigenously designed and built Diving Support Vessel (DSV)** commissioned at Visakhapatnam; built entirely by **Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)** for deep-sea submarine rescue operations.
- **INS Tamal Commissioned (1 July 2025):** Commissioned at **Yantar Shipyard in Kaliningrad, Russia**; 8th stealth frigate under **Project 1135.6 (Tushil-class)**; officially marked as the **last foreign-built warship of the Indian Navy**.
- **Astra BVRAAM Test (11 July 2025):** DRDO and IAF flight-tested the Astra Beyond Visual Range Air-to-Air Missile equipped with an **indigenous active RF seeker** from a Su-30MKI fighter off Odisha, confirming strike capability over **100 km**.
- **Akash Prime High-Altitude Test (16 July 2025):** Tested by Army Air Defence and DRDO in high-altitude **Ladakh**; features an active RF seeker; seamlessly integrated with **'Akashteer'** (indigenous automated air defence control system).
- **Pralay Quasi-Ballistic Missile User Trials (28–29 July 2025):** Successful consecutive launches of surface-to-surface solid-fuel missile (range: **150–500 km**; payload: 350–700 kg) from Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Island.
- **Agni-5 Launch (20 August 2025):** Strategic Forces Command (SFC) tested canister-based ICBM/IRBM Agni-5 (declared range **up to 5,000 km**) from Chandipur.
- **Rudrastra Hybrid Drone Test (11 June 2025):** Indian Army tested **Rudrastra**, a hybrid VTOL UAV developed by **Solar Defence & Aerospace Limited (SDAL)** at Pokhran (range: **170 km**, flight endurance: **90 minutes**).
- **Dhvani Hypersonic Missile:** DRDO advanced development of **Dhvani**, a next-generation **Hypersonic Glide Vehicle (HGV)** capable of speeds exceeding **Mach 5 (>7,400 km/h)** and an operational range of **6,000 to 10,000 km**.
- **Indian Space Industry E-Catalogue:** Launched as India's first digital repository mapping domestic space-sector capabilities and industrial supply chains during the **5th Indian Space Congress 2026** in New Delhi.
- **India's First Private EO Satellite Constellation (EO-PPP):** On 21 January 2026, **IN-SPACe** signed an agreement with the Pixxel-led consortium **"Allied Orbits"** (Pixxel Space India, Piersight Space, SatSure Analytics, Dhruva Space) to invest over **₹1,200 crore** across 5 years to launch **12 indigenous Earth Observation satellites** (panchromatic, multispectral, hyperspectral, and microwave SAR).

January 2026

LR-AShM hypersonic anti-ship missile | shown on Republic Day 2026

What happened On **26 January 2026**, during the **77th Republic Day** parade at **Kartavya Path**, DRDO showcased the **Long Range Anti-Ship Hypersonic Missile (LR-AShM)**. It is being developed mainly for the **Indian Navy**, including coastal battery use. Work is linked with DRDO's **RCI** lab in Hyderabad.

Core facts

- Full short name: **LR-AShM**.
- Maker: **DRDO**.
- User focus: **Indian Navy**.
- Reported range: about **1,500 km**.
- It is a **hypersonic glide** missile. It can hit both fixed and moving ship targets.
- Public briefings stress indigenous sensors and avionics.
- It uses a two-stage solid rocket boost, then glides at very high speed at low altitude, which makes early radar detection harder.

Captain Hansja Sharma — Rudra Armed Helicopter Milestone (26 Jan 2026)

- 27-year-old **Captain Hansja Sharma** created military history by becoming the **Indian Army's first woman pilot qualified to fly the Rudra armed attack helicopter**.

Solid Fuel Ducted Ramjet (SFDR) Test | 3 Feb 2026

- DRDO successfully flight-tested the indigenous **Solid Fuel Ducted Ramjet (SFDR)** technology at ITR Chandipur, enabling extended beyond-visual-range (BVR) air-to-air missile propulsion.

K-4 missile test from INS Arighat

What happened India tested the **K-4** submarine-launched ballistic missile from **INS Arighat** in the Bay of Bengal (covered heavily in January defence current affairs).

Core facts

- Type: intermediate-range **SLBM** (missile fired from a submarine).
- Maker: **DRDO**.
- Reported range: more than **3,500 km**.
- Platform: **INS Arighat**, India's second nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine in public discussion after Arihant.
- Why it matters: it strengthens the sea part of India's nuclear triad (land, air, and sea).

Pralay salvo test

What happened DRDO fired **two Pralay missiles** quickly from the **same launcher** near **Chandipur** in Odisha. This is called a **salvo** launch.

Core facts

- System: **Pralay**.
- Place: **Chandipur**, Odisha.
- Special point: two missiles from one launcher in quick succession.
- Role in simple words: precise tactical strike missile.

Other short defence notes from January coverage

- **Pinaka LRGR-120** was reported with about **120 km** range class testing from Chandipur.
- **Suryastra Universal Multi-Calibre Rocket Launcher:** In January 2026, the Indian Army fast-tracked a **₹293 crore** contract under emergency procurement powers with private manufacturer **NIBE Limited** (in collaboration with **Israel**) for **Suryastra**, India's first Made-in-India universal multi-calibre rocket launcher with strike ranges of **150 km and 300 km**, capable of also firing loitering munitions up to 100 km.
- **'Saksham' C-UAS Grid System:** Indian Army initiated induction of the indigenously developed **Saksham** (*Situational Awareness for Kinetic Soft and Hard Kill Assets Management*) Counter-Unmanned Aerial System grid, developed by **Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)** to detect, track, and neutralise hostile quadcopters and swarm drones in border sectors using integrated soft-kill (electronic jamming) and hard-kill capabilities.
- Keep extra rocket or drone headlines only if a clear PIB fact appears later.

February 2026

Budget push for deep tech manufacturing | 1 February 2026

These are Budget ideas, but they often appear in Science questions too. Full scheme cards are in Schemes.

- **ISM 2.0** for semiconductors.
- **Biopharma SHAKTI** for advanced biological medicines.
- **Rare Earth Corridors** in Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu.
- **Three Chemical Parks**.
- **Container Manufacturing** scheme.
- **CCUS** (Carbon Capture, Utilization and Storage) with about **₹20,000 crore** over five years.
- Electronics Components Manufacturing outlay raised to **₹40,000 crore**.

IIT Kanpur maps the Sun's inside

What happened A research team at **IIT Kanpur** used about **30 years** of satellite data in a computer dynamo model. They mapped large magnetic fields inside the Sun. The work helps better understand sunspots, flares, and space weather that can disturb satellites and power grids.

Core facts

- Institute: **IIT Kanpur**.
- Method: long satellite record + 3D dynamo model.
- Use: better solar-cycle and space-weather understanding.

Greater Noida semiconductor story

February UP notes mentioned a semiconductor unit push in **Greater Noida (Gautam Buddh Nagar)** as North India's first such unit. Treat the "first" claim carefully until the plant status is fully clear. Keep the place fact under UP Special.

India-AI Impact Summit 2026 | New Delhi | 16–21 February 2026

What happened The Government of India hosted the **India-AI Impact Summit 2026** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi** from **16 to 21 February 2026**. This was the **first time** the summit was hosted by a Global South nation.

Core framework: Three Sutras & Seven Chakras

- **Three Guiding Sutras:** 1. **People:** AI must serve humanity in all its diversity, respecting cultural identities and leaving no one behind. 2. **Planet:** Resource-efficient AI development accelerating climate resilience and green computing. 3. **Progress:** Equitable distribution of AI benefits; democratising datasets, compute, and foundational models for healthcare, education, agriculture, and governance.
- **Seven Action Chakras:** 1. *Human Capital:* Skilling and workforce transformation. 2. *Inclusion for Social Empowerment:* Preserving linguistic and cultural diversity. 3. *Safe and Trusted AI:* Safety evaluation, red-teaming, and auditing tools. 4. *Resilience, Innovation, and Efficiency:* Energy-efficient compute and algorithms. 5. *Science:* Accelerating scientific discovery and research. 6. *Democratizing AI Resources:* Public access to compute and datasets. 7. *AI for Economic Development & Social Good:* High-impact public sector deployments.
- **Official Logo:** The **Ashoka Chakra**, symbolizing ethical governance, constitutional justice, and democratic values guiding India's digital trajectory.
- **Global Launch:** Unveiled the **Global AI Impact Commons**, cataloguing 80+ real-world deployment stories across 30+ nations.

Bodhan AI & Bharat EduAI Stack | IIT Madras

What happened At the Bharat Bodhan AI Conclave 2026 at Bharat Mandapam (12–13 February 2026), Union Education Minister **Dharmendra Pradhan** launched the **Bodhan AI Centre of Excellence** and initiated the **Bharat EduAI Stack**.

Core facts - **Anchor Institution: IIT Madras** (established as the *IIT Madras Bodhan AI Foundation*). - **Core Architecture:** Conceived as an open-source **Sovereign Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** for education. - **Components:** Personalised generative AI student tutors, AI-assisted pedagogical support and lesson planning for teachers, automated institutional workflows, and learning analytics.

NIELIT Quantum & AI University Campus | Amaravati Quantum Valley

- On **20 February 2026**, the National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (**NIELIT**, under MeitY) signed an MoU with the Government of Andhra Pradesh to establish India's first dedicated **Quantum and Artificial Intelligence University Campus** in **Amaravati** (*Amaravati Quantum Valley*).

New Telescopes in Ladakh & COSMOS-2 | Union Budget 2026–27 Push

The Union Budget 2026–27 announced dedicated capital support for 4 major ground-based astronomy facilities:

1. **National Large Solar Telescope (NLST):** - **Location: Merak**, near Pangong Lake, **Ladakh**. - **Specs: 2-metre-class** ground-based solar telescope observing in optical and near-infrared wavelengths. - **Objective:** Resolving the origin, dynamics, and violent eruptions of solar magnetic fields with high spatial resolution.
2. **National Large Optical-Infrared Telescope (NLOT):** - **Location: Hanle, Ladakh** (near the Indian Astronomical Observatory). - **Specs:** Flagship **13.7-metre segmented primary mirror** equipped with advanced adaptive optics, high-resolution spectrographs, and infrared imagers.
3. **Upgrade of Himalayan Chandra Telescope (HCT):** - **Location:** Hanle, Ladakh (altitude 4,500 m); remotely operated by the **Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA)** from CREST (Hosakote near Bengaluru). - **Upgrade:** Upgraded from the existing 2-metre mirror to a **3.7-metre segmented optical-infrared telescope** tailored for multi-messenger astronomy and transient cosmic events.
4. **COSMOS-2 Planetarium:** - **Location: Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**; established and implemented by the **Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA)**.

Agni-III Intermediate-Range Ballistic Missile Test | 6 February 2026

What happened India successfully test-fired the indigenous intermediate-range ballistic missile **Agni-III** from the Integrated Test Range (ITR) at **Chandipur, Odisha**, under the Strategic Forces Command.

Core facts - **Type:** Indigenous, two-stage, solid-fuelled **Intermediate-Range Ballistic Missile (IRBM)**. - **Strike Range & Payload:** Operational strike range exceeding **3,000 km** with a **1.5-tonne** payload capacity. - **Agni Series Range Hierarchy:** - *Agni-1:* ~700 km - *Agni-2:* ~2,000 km - *Agni-3:* >3,000 km - *Agni-4:* ~4,000 km - *Agni-5:* >5,000 km (Intercontinental range; tested with MIRV in Mission Divyastra).

Launch of First Cadet Training Ship 'Krishna' | 16 February 2026

What happened The Indian Navy launched **'Krishna' (Yard 18003)**, the first of three indigenous **Cadet Training Ships (CTS)**, at **L&T Shipyard, Kattupalli (Chennai)**.

Core facts - **Vessel Name: Krishna** (first ship of the 3-vessel CTS order). - **Builder: Larsen & Toubro (L&T)** Shipbuilding, Kattupalli, Chennai. - **Dignitaries:** Launched by Smt. Anupama Chauhan in the presence of Chief of Defence Staff (**CDS**) **General Anil Chauhan**. - **Role:** Comprehensive sea training for officer cadets, including basic navigation, seamanship, and international naval diplomacy.

Additional Boeing P-8I Maritime Patrol Aircraft Procurement | 12 February 2026

- On **12 February 2026**, the Defence Acquisition Council (DAC) accorded Acceptance of Necessity (**AoN**) for the procurement of additional **Boeing P-8I Neptune** long-range maritime patrol and anti-submarine warfare (ASW) aircraft to counter increasing submarine activity in the Indian Ocean Region.

India AI Mission: GPU Scale & UDAAN Pitch Fest | February 2026

- **Compute Milestone:** Against an initial target of 10,000 GPUs, India expanded national public compute to **38,000 GPUs** and approved **570 Data Labs** across the country.
- **UDAAN Pitch Fest:** Launched during the India-AI Impact Summit to fund AI startups from Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities, prioritizing women founders and differently-abled changemakers.

Bharat Forecast System (BFS) Adopted by IMD | February 2026

What happened The India Meteorological Department (**IMD**) announced the adoption of the **Bharat Forecast System (BFS)**, India's first high-resolution indigenously engineered numerical weather model.

Core facts - **High-Resolution Spatial Grid:** Delivers weather predictions at a **$6\text{ km} \times 6\text{ km}$ spatial resolution**, replacing the legacy $12\text{ km} \times 12\text{ km}$ (144 sq km) model (research ongoing to scale down to 3 km and 1 km grids). - **Significance:** Radically enhances hyperlocal forecasting accuracy for severe weather events, extreme rainfall, tropical cyclones, and flash floods.

March 2026

Defence Acquisition Council clearances | 27 March 2026

What happened The **Defence Acquisition Council (DAC)**, chaired by Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh**, gave **Acceptance of Necessity (AoN)** for big purchases worth about **₹2.38 lakh crore**. AoN is an early formal yes that starts the full buying process.

Important items cleared

- More **S-400** long-range surface-to-air missile systems from Russia for the Air Force.
- **Medium Transport Aircraft** to slowly replace older transport planes such as **An-32** and help with **Il-76** class airlift needs. Indian companies will build them with a foreign technology partner.
- **Remotely Piloted Strike Aircraft** linked with DRDO's **Ghatak** unmanned combat aircraft work. Value in reports is near **₹40,000 crore** for this line.
- More indigenous **Dhanush** 155 mm howitzer guns for the Army.
- Other Army items named in briefings: air defence tracked systems, better tank ammunition, high-capacity radio relay, and runway-independent aerial surveillance.
- Coast Guard also got approvals such as heavy-duty air cushion vehicles in coverage.

Year context

- In FY 2025–26, DAC AoN total was described as about **₹6.73 lakh crore** across 55 proposals — called a record year in official messaging.

NavIC / IRNSS-1F atomic clock failure | 13 March 2026

What happened ISRO said the atomic clock on navigation satellite **IRNSS-1F** stopped working on **13 March 2026**. Without a working atomic clock, the satellite cannot give proper positioning signals.

Core facts

- System name: **NavIC** (also called **IRNSS** — Indian Regional Navigation Satellite System).
- Satellite: **IRNSS-1F**, launched in **March 2016**; it had completed about **10 years** of design life.
- After this failure, the number of fully useful positioning satellites fell below the minimum **four** needed for reliable 3D fixes.
- The satellite can still be used for some one-way broadcast messaging.
- Newer **NVS** satellites carry improved Indian clocks. Replacement launches are planned later.

Air-droppable container test | DRDO and Indian Navy

What happened DRDO and the Navy tested an indigenous **air-droppable container** from a **P-8I** aircraft off the **Goa** coast.

Core facts

- It can drop supplies of about **150 kg** to ships far at sea.
- Useful when a ship needs urgent stores without coming to harbour.

Project 'Vayu Baan' | March 2026

- The Indian Air Force (**IAF**) launched **Project Vayu Baan** to develop India's first indigenous **helicopter-launched drone system**, enabling standoff surveillance and tactical strikes.

Haven-1 — World's First Commercial Space Station

- Aerospace company **Vast** announced timelines for **Haven-1**, scheduled to become the world's first commercial, privately operated space station in low Earth orbit.

CALM-Brain Repository | Bengaluru

- India's first digital repository of comprehensive clinical and neuro-imaging data on major psychiatric disorders, named **CALM-Brain**, was launched in **Bengaluru**.

Bharat Electricity Summit 2026 & Historic Clean Energy Milestones | March 2026

What happened The **Bharat Electricity Summit 2026** was held from **19 to 22 March 2026** at **Yashobhoomi, New Delhi**, themed *"Electrifying Growth. Empowering Sustainability. Connecting Globally."*

Core facts & Official National Power Data - **Strategic Blueprints Released:** - *National Resource Adequacy Plan*. - *Transmission Plan for Integration of over 900 GW Non-Fossil Fuel Capacity by 2035–36*. - **Historic Milestones (as of 31 March 2026):** - **Total Installed Power Generation Capacity: 5,32,740 MW (532.74 GW)**. - **Total Non-Fossil Fuel Capacity: 2,83,468 MW (283.47 GW)** — crossing **53.2% of total installed power capacity**, achieving India's COP26 Panchamrit pledge of >50% non-fossil power 4 years ahead of 2030! - **Single-Year Record Additions (FY 2025–26):** Non-fossil addition reached an all-time high of **55.29 GW** (comprising **44.61 GW solar** and **6.05 GW wind**). - **Latest Growth (as of 31 May 2026):** - Total non-fossil capacity reached **2,91,525.08 MW (291.53 GW)**. - Cumulative solar capacity reached **157.05 GW** (largest renewable segment).

Major Naval Deliveries & Inductions | Late March 2026

1. INS Dunagiri (Yard 3023) — Project 17A Stealth Frigate: - Delivered to the Indian Navy on **30 March 2026** by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata**. - Fifth ship of the Nilgiri-class guided-missile stealth frigates (second built by GRSE); preserves the naval heritage of the erstwhile Leander-class frigate that served from 1977 to 2010.

2. Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Crafts (ASW SWC): - **AGRAY:** Fourth of eight ASW-SWC built by GRSE Kolkata, delivered on **30 March 2026**; at 77 metres long, AGRAY and its sister ships are the **largest Indian Naval warships propelled by waterjets**! - **Malwan:** Delivered on **31 March 2026** by **Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)** under the Mahe-class ASW SWC line; named after historic coastal Malwan in Sindhudurg, Maharashtra (maritime legacy of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj).

3. INS Sanshodhak (SVL): - Fourth and final **Survey Vessel (Large)** delivered by GRSE Kolkata for deep-water and port hydrographic surveying.

April 2026

Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor criticality | Kalpakkam | 6 April 2026

What happened India's **500 MWe Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor (PFBR)** at **Kalpakkam, Tamil Nadu** attained **first criticality** on **6 April 2026**, initiating a self-sustaining nuclear chain reaction.

Core facts - **Capacity & Builder: 500 MWe** (megawatt electrical); constructed by **BHAVINI** (Bharatiya Nabhikiya Vidyut Nigam Limited) at the Kalpakkam Nuclear Complex. - **Global Milestone:** Once fully operational, India will become only the **second country in the world after Russia** to operate a commercial fast breeder reactor! - **Core Fuel & Coolant:** Uranium–Plutonium **Mixed Oxide (MOX)** fuel; cooled by liquid **sodium**. - **India's Three-Stage Nuclear Programme (Dr. Homi Bhabha):** - **Stage 1 — PHWRs:** Pressurised Heavy Water Reactors using **natural uranium**; spent fuel yields **Plutonium-239**. - **Stage 2 — FBRs (PFBR Milestone):** Fast Breeder Reactors fueled by Plutonium; breeds **Uranium-233** from surrounding **Thorium-232 blankets** while generating more fissile fuel than consumed. - **Stage 3 — Thorium Reactors:** Harnesses India's vast domestic thorium reserves using bred Uranium-233 for indefinite energy self-reliance.

Artemis II Mission | NASA | 1 April 2026

What happened NASA launched the historic **Artemis II** crewed lunar flyby mission from the Kennedy Space Center on **1 April 2026**, sending humans beyond low Earth orbit toward the Moon for the first time in **53 years** (since Apollo 17 in December 1972).

Core facts - **Type:** Crewed lunar flyby demonstration mission (slingshot around the Moon, not a landing). - **Launcher & Spacecraft:** Launched atop the **Space Launch System (SLS)** rocket; Orion spacecraft named **'Integrity'** by the crew. - **Engineering Validation:** Verified life support systems, deep-space navigation, manual flight control, and the critical **Avcoat** base heat shield during high-speed atmospheric re-entry. - **Next Step:** NASA lists **Artemis III** for 2027 as a low Earth orbit demo to test commercial lunar human landing systems from **SpaceX** and **Blue Origin**.

SMOPS-2026 (Spacecraft Mission Operations) | Bengaluru | 8–10 April 2026

What happened The 2nd edition of the **International Conference on Spacecraft Mission Operations (SMOPS-2026)** was held in **Bengaluru** from **8 to 10 April 2026**.

Core facts - **Theme:** *"Innovative Operations for Smart and Sustainable Space Mission Management – Next Generation"*. - **Organisers:** Jointly organised by **ISRO**, the **Astronautical Society of India (ASI)**, and the **International Academy of Astronautics (IAA)**. - **Inauguration:** Inaugurated by Shri **A. S. Kiran Kumar**, former Chairman of ISRO. - **Scope:** Mission autonomy, automated constellation management, deep-space communication, and space robotics.

Chandrayaan-5 (LUPEX Mission) | April 2026

- ISRO and JAXA (Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency) began evaluating launch infrastructure in **Japan** for the joint **Lunar Polar Exploration (LUPEX)** mission, officially designated as **Chandrayaan-5**.

Cochin Airport — Hydrogen Buses

- **Cochin International Airport** became the first airport in India to operationalise zero-emission **hydrogen-powered buses** for internal airside passenger transit.

INS Aridhaman and INS Taragiri | Visakhapatnam | 3 April 2026

What happened Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** commissioned naval platforms at **Visakhapatnam** on **3 April 2026**. Coverage confirmed induction of India's third indigenous nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine and the fourth Project 17A stealth frigate.

INS Aridhaman

- Type: nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (**SSBN**).
- Sequence: third after **INS Arihant** and **INS Arighaat**.
- Project family: Advanced Technology Vessel (**ATV**) / Arihant-class line.
- Stronger second-strike capability is the strategic point.

INS Taragiri

- Fourth ship of **Project 17A** (**Nilgiri-class**) guided-missile stealth frigates.
- Displacement: about **6,670 tonnes**.
- Built by **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited**.
- Designed by the Navy's **Warship Design Bureau**.

Also at Vizag

- Foundation stone for a **Large Cavitation Tunnel** facility at DRDO's Naval Science & Technological Laboratory.

NASM-SR maiden salvo launch | off Odisha coast

What happened DRDO and the Navy carried out the first **salvo launch** of two **Naval Anti-Ship Missile – Short Range (NASM-SR)** missiles from a helicopter over the Bay of Bengal off **Odisha**.

Core facts

- NASM-SR is India's **first indigenous air-launched anti-ship missile**.
- Range noted: about **55 km**.
- Features: low-level sea-skimming, fire-and-forget, all-weather use.
- Test range support: **ITR Chandipur**.
- Salvo means two missiles launched quickly from the **same** helicopter.

INS Malwan delivery (soft navy fact)

- Second of eight **Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft** from **Cochin Shipyard**.
- Named after the coastal town of **Malwan** in Maharashtra.

May 2026

Advanced Agni MIRV flight trial | 8 May 2026 | Odisha

What happened India successfully flight-tested an advanced **Agni** missile with **MIRV** technology from **Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island** off Odisha. MIRV means one missile can carry several warheads that hit different targets.

Core facts

- Date: **8 May 2026**.
- Place: **Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island** / Odisha coast.
- Technology: **MIRV** (Multiple Independently Targetable Re-entry Vehicle).
- Linked in coverage with the advanced **Agni-5** line, earlier called **Mission Divyastra** (first known MIRV test in **March 2024**).
- Agni-5 declared range memory: over **5,000 km**.
- Conducted with DRDO, Army, and industry support.

Agni-1 test | 22 May 2026

What happened India successfully test-launched the short-range ballistic missile **Agni-1** from the Integrated Test Range at **Chandipur / Balasore, Odisha**, under the **Strategic Forces Command**.

Scramjet Combustor Test | DRDL Hyderabad | May 2026

- DRDL Hyderabad conducted a successful long-duration ground test of an indigenous **scramjet combustor** exceeding **1,200 seconds** to validate thermal endurance and supersonic combustion for future hypersonic platforms.

India's 1st Indigenous Glide Weapon System — TARA | 7 May 2026

What happened DRDO and the Indian Air Force (IAF) successfully conducted the maiden flight trial of **TARA** (Tactical Advanced Range Augmentation) off the coast of Odisha on **7 May 2026**.

Core facts - **System Name: TARA** (**Tactical Advanced Range Augmentation**). - **Type:** India's **first indigenous glide weapon system**. - **Developer:** Designed and developed by **Research Centre Imarat (RCI), Hyderabad**, along with other DRDO laboratories. - **Function:** A modular range-extension and precision-guidance kit that converts conventional unguided gravity aerial bombs/warheads into precision-guided standoff glide weapons. - **Combat Advantage:** Drastically elevates the strike value of existing low-cost aerial munitions, enabling IAF aircraft to strike heavily defended targets from outside enemy air defence envelopes.

ICGS 'Achal' Commissioned into Indian Coast Guard | 9 May 2026

What happened Indian Coast Guard Ship (**ICGS**) **Achal** was commissioned into service on **9 May 2026** at **Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)**.

Core facts - **Class:** Latest vessel in the new-generation **Adamya-class** Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV) series. - **Builder:** Designed and built indigenously by **Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)**. - **Etymology:** Named **"Achal"**, a Sanskrit term signifying **"firm / immovable"**. - **Role:** High-speed coastal patrol, anti-smuggling, EEZ maritime surveillance, and fisheries protection.

Oreshnik Hypersonic Intermediate-Range Ballistic Missile | 24 May 2026

- On **24 May 2026**, Russia fired the **Oreshnik** (Russian for *"Hazel Tree"*, Ukrainian reporting codename *"Kedr"* / Cedar) intermediate-range ballistic missile (IRBM) during an attack on Kyiv.
- Characterised by multiple hypersonic warheads descending in steep, fiery streaks at speeds virtually impossible to intercept by conventional Western missile defence shields.

Exercise Pragati 2026 | Umroi, Meghalaya

What happened The maiden multilateral exercise **Pragati 2026** brought armies of **13** countries to **Umroi, Meghalaya**. Focus: counter-insurgency drills and interoperability in the Indian Ocean region.

Core facts

- Host place: **Umroi**, Meghalaya.
- About **400** soldiers in coverage, including women soldiers.
- Partner countries named: Bhutan, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Maldives, Myanmar, Nepal, Philippines, Seychelles, Sri Lanka, Vietnam, and India.

Exercise CINBAX 2026

- Edition: **2nd**.
- Countries: **India** and **Cambodia**.
- Place in coverage: **Kampong Speu**, Cambodia.

First woman Cat-A flying instructor | IAF

- Name in coverage: Squadron Leader **Saanya**.
- Qualification: Category-A Qualified Flying Instructor (**Cat-A QFI**).

VISTA Stratospheric Balloon | May 2026

What happened India's first indigenous **stratospheric super-pressure balloon (SPB)**, named **VISTA**, was successfully developed and launched.

Core facts - **Developer: Red Balloon Aerospace** (private deep-tech space startup). - **Launch Site: Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh**. - **Capability:** Long-duration high-altitude atmospheric observations, near-space research, and high-altitude surveillance.

SMILE Space Mission | May 2026

- **Agencies:** Joint mission of the **Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS)** and the **European Space Agency (ESA)**.
- **Full Form: Solar wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere Link Explorer**.
- **Objective:** Deep study of solar wind interactions with Earth's magnetosphere and cosmic weather.

India's First Orbital Data Centre Satellite — Pathfinder | May 2026

What happened On **4 May 2026**, private space-tech firm **Pixxel** and Indian AI startup **Sarvam** announced a strategic partnership to build **Pathfinder**, India's first orbital data centre satellite.

Core facts - **Satellite Class & Launch:** Planned as a **200 kg-class satellite** scheduled for launch in **Q4 2026**. - **Manufacturing:** Built at Pixxel's **Gigapixxel** manufacturing facility (engineered to scale satellite production to 100 units). - **Pixxel's Role:** Designs, builds, launches, and operates the satellite platform; integrates hyperspectral imaging sensors. - **Sarvam's Role:** Delivers the full-stack sovereign AI platform running directly on the satellite's GPU layer for real-time onboard training and edge inference in orbit. - **Strategic Impact:** Eliminates the latency of sending massive raw imagery to terrestrial ground stations; guarantees national AI sovereignty in space edge computing.

Mission Drishti: World's First OptoSAR Satellite | May 2026

What happened Indian private space startup **GalaxEye** developed **Mission Drishti**, hailed by the Prime Minister's Office as the **world's first OptoSAR satellite** and the **largest privately built satellite in India**.

Core facts - **OptoSAR Innovation:** Overcomes the trade-off of Earth observation by integrating both **Multispectral Imaging (MSI)** optical sensors and **Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)** sensors on a single satellite bus. - **Advantage:** Optical sensors provide high-resolution, intuitive visual clarity but are blocked by clouds, haze, rain, and night; SAR penetrates clouds and darkness but lacks optical intuition. OptoSAR delivers synchronized, all-weather, analysis-ready imagery.

Chandrayaan-3 Hop Experiment & Regolith Discoveries | May 2026

What happened On **18 May 2026**, ISRO scientists published comprehensive peer-reviewed findings from the historic **Hop experiment** conducted by the **Vikram Lander** on the lunar South Pole.

Core facts - **The Maneuver:** Before shutting down, Vikram reignited its liquid thrusters, performed a controlled **50 cm hop**, and relocated; its **ChaSTE** (Chandra's Surface Thermophysical Experiment) thermal probe re-penetrated virgin regolith at the new site. - **Major Scientific Insights:** 1. **Layered Stratigraphy:** The lunar regolith within the top **6.5 cm** is not homogenous dust; it exhibits distinct stratification with sharp physical and thermal boundaries. 2. **Geotechnical Compaction:** Soil density and cohesion increase drastically with depth — transitioning from loose dust to densely packed, sticky regolith. 3. **Twilight Thermal Shadowing:** Micro-depressions and local craters cast sharp thermal shadows, causing surface temperatures to plummet much faster than predicted by global lunar climate models. 4. **Plume Erosion:** The engine plume stripped away the upper **3 cm** of regolith, exposing and slightly compacting the deeper cohesive substratum.

June 2026

Indian Navy platforms commissioned | GRSE line

What happened Coverage highlighted commissioning of indigenous Navy platforms designed by the Warship Design Bureau and built by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE)**.

Core facts

- **INS Dunagiri** — Project **17A** stealth frigate (BrahMos and medium-range air defence in coverage).
- **INS Sanshodhak** — survey / hydrographic vessel.
- **INS Agray** — anti-submarine warfare craft.

Indian Coast Guard additions

- **ICGS Akshay** — new-generation Fast Patrol Vessel, built by **Goa Shipyard Limited**, commissioned in Goa.
- First indigenous **Air Cushion Vehicle** for the Coast Guard: **H-561**, first of six being built by Chowgule and Company.

Rudram-II Flight-Test | 2 June 2026

What happened The Defence Research and Development Organisation (**DRDO**) and the **Indian Air Force (IAF)** successfully flight-tested the indigenous **Rudram-II** missile from a Su-30MKI fighter aircraft off the Odisha coast.

Core facts - **Type:** Indigenous **Air-to-Surface** anti-radiation and precision-strike missile. - **Developer:** DRDO. - **Role:** Neutralising enemy radar installations, communication nodes, and surface-to-air missile (SAM) sites.

NASA MAVEN Mission Concluded | June 2026

- NASA announced the conclusion of the long-running **MAVEN** (*Mars Atmosphere and Volatile EvolutioN*) orbital science mission exploring the history of Mars' atmospheric and water loss.

Soft space–book hybrid

Group Captain **Shubhanshu Shukla**'s memoir coverage recalled him as the first Indian citizen on the **International Space Station** (Axiom-4). Book card → Books.

Bharat Innovates 2026 | Nice, France | 14–16 June 2026

What happened The **Bharat Innovates 2026** deep-tech summit concluded in **Nice, France** (14–16 June 2026), marking a major milestone in global institutional partnerships and commercial venture backing for Indian indigenous science.

Core facts - **Participants:** Showcased **120 curated Indian DeepTech startups** and **45 advanced technology projects** from 15 premier Indian institutions (over 60% incubated at IITs and IISc). - **Major Commercial Partnerships:** - **Agnikul Cosmos** signed agreements with **ICEYE** (Finland) and **Safran** (France). - **Detect Technologies** partnered with **TotalEnergies**. - **TuTr Hyperloop** collaborated with **thyssenkrupp**. - **iElectron Technologies** partnered with **ALTEN**. - Confirmed strategic angel and institutional investment into **The ePlane Company**.

India's First Advanced 3D Semiconductor Packaging Unit | Bhubaneswar, Odisha

What happened The foundation stone for India's first advanced **3D semiconductor chip packaging facility** based on glass substrates was laid in **Bhubaneswar, Odisha**.

Core facts - **Promoter & Project:** Promoted by **3D Glass Solutions** under the *Heterogeneous Integration Packaging Solutions* project. - **Facility Type:** Greenfield, vertically integrated advanced packaging and embedded glass-substrate ATMP (Assembly, Testing, Marking, and Packaging) unit. - **Financial Outlay:** Total project investment of **₹1,943.53 crore** approved under Phase 1 of the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)**. - **Strategic Milestone:** Employs glass instead of traditional organic substrates for 3D heterogenous chip stacking, drastically improving heat dissipation and high-frequency performance; makes **Odisha the first State** to host both an approved compound semiconductor fab and a 3D glass packaging plant.

Operation Mule Hunt 1.0 | Gujarat Cyber Police | June 2026

- **What happened:** Gujarat Police and the Cyber Centre of Excellence (CCOE) carried out **Operation Mule Hunt 1.0**, dismantling statewide cyber financial crime syndicates using mule bank accounts.
- **Key Outcomes:** Uncovered cyber fraud worth **₹2,289 crore**, clamped down on **913 mule bank accounts**, registered 565 FIRs, and arrested 638 accused persons.

India Assumes Chairmanship of Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB)

- **Appointment:** India was unanimously nominated as Chair of the **Common Criteria Development Board (CCDB)** for a two-year tenure from **April 2026 to April 2028**.
- **Context:** Confirmed during the meeting of the Common Criteria Recognition Arrangement (CCRA) in **Tokyo, Japan**.
- **Role:** CCRA is the premier global standard ensuring mutual recognition of IT security certificates, eliminating repeated certification hurdles for Indian secure IT and cyber products across 30+ member nations.

July 2026

Project Kusha maiden flight test | 23 July 2026 | Odisha

What happened DRDO conducted the maiden flight test of **Kusha**, India's indigenous long-range surface-to-air missile (also called the Extended Range Air Defence System / earlier **XRSAM**), from **Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island** off Odisha.

Core facts

- Date: **23 July 2026**.
- Place: **Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island** / Odisha coast.
- Type: long-range **surface-to-air** missile.
- Lead user service: **Indian Air Force** (Navy shipborne version expected later).
- Development clearance memory: CCS outlay about **₹21,700 crore** (2022 window).
- Fits inside the wider **Mission Sudarshan Chakra** air-defence shield idea (target horizon noted around **2035**).
- Induction window noted: about **2028–2030**.

Skyroot Vikram-1 | Mission Aagaman | 18 July 2026

What happened Skyroot Aerospace successfully launched **Vikram-1**, called India's first privately developed orbital-class rocket, from **SDSC SHAR, Sriharikota**. The flight was named **Mission Aagaman**.

Core facts

- Company: **Skyroot Aerospace**.
- Rocket: **Vikram-1**.
- Mission name: **Aagaman**.
- Place: **Sriharikota**.
- Meaning: private Indian orbital launch capability arrives.

Navy / Coast Guard July platforms

- **INS Mahendragiri** — sixth **Project 17A** stealth frigate, Eastern Fleet, Visakhapatnam.
- **Machilipatnam (BY 529)** — seventh of eight ASW Shallow Water Craft from Cochin Shipyard.
- **Operation Southern Readiness 26-2** — multinational training at Southern Naval Command, **Kochi**, with Combined Maritime Forces / CTF 154.

August 2026

National Space Day | 23 August 2026

What happened India marked the **3rd National Space Day** (remembering **Chandrayaan-3**). Theme in coverage: **Towards Viksit Bharat: Innovating, Collaborating and Aspiring to Global Space Leadership**. Events included Ahmedabad / SAC

coverage.

Core facts

- Date every year: **23 August**.
- ISRO plan noted for the financial year: about **8** launch-vehicle missions and **12** satellite missions.
- First uncrewed **Gaganyaan** test flight expected within about four months in ISRO messaging.
- Soft policy note: ISRO to step back from routine launch-vehicle manufacturing and hand more work to private / PSU partners, while focusing on research (IN-SPACe messaging).

AK-203 'Sher' | Amethi, Uttar Pradesh

What happened The first **fully indigenous** AK-203 assault rifle, named **Sher**, was manufactured and test-fired at the **Korwa** facility in **Amethi, Uttar Pradesh**.

Core facts

- Name: **Sher**.
- Plant: **Korwa**, Amethi (UP).
- Maker: **Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited (IRRPL)**.
- Claim in coverage: **100%** Indian components and materials.
- Aim: replace ageing **INSAS** rifles after Army trials.

INS Nipun and India–USA EOD exercise

- **INS Nipun** — second **Nistar-class** Diving Support Vessel, built by **Hindustan Shipyard Limited**, Visakhapatnam.
- **EOD Exercise 2026** (8th edition) — India and USA explosive ordnance disposal drills at Southern Naval Command, **Kochi**.

Strategic Doctrines & Nuclear Roadmap (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

India's First National Counter-Terrorism Policy & Strategy — PRAHAAR | 23 February 2026

What happened The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) officially released India's first unified, formal counter-terrorism doctrine named **PRAHAAR**.

Core facts - **Doctrine Framework**: Establishes an integrated, multi-agency operational blueprint combating terrorism, radicalisation, cross-border terror funding, automated cyber warfare, weaponized drones, and **CBRNED threats** (Chemical, Biological, Radiological, Nuclear, Explosive, and Digital). - **Core Principle**: Expressly affirms that India rejects any conceptual link between terrorism and specific religions, ethnicities, or civilisations.

Defence Forces Vision 2047 | Released 10 March 2026

What happened Raksha Mantri Rajnath Singh released the apex long-term defence blueprint titled *"Defence Forces Vision 2047: A Roadmap for a Future-Ready Indian Military"* at South Block, New Delhi.

Core facts - **Formulated By**: **Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS)**. - **Three-Phase Calibrated Transformation Roadmap**: 1. **Era of Transition (till 2030)**: Jointness, theaterisation, structural restructuring, rapid induction of indigenous drones, AI, and border surveillance networks. 2. **Era of Consolidation (2030–2040)**: Operationalizing layered anti-missile and integrated air defence grids, offensive cyber capabilities, and sovereign military space architecture. 3. **Era of Excellence (2040–2047)**: Achieving an entirely self-reliant, all-domain expeditionary military force by the centenary of Independence.

SHANTI Act, 2025 & Long-Term Nuclear Power Roadmap

What happened The **SHANTI Act, 2025** (received Presidential assent in December 2025) overhauls India's civilian nuclear legislative framework to dramatically ramp up clean base-load energy.

Core facts - **National Nuclear Target**: Expanding nuclear power capacity to **100 GW by 2047** (current installed capacity stands at **8.78 GW** or ~3.1% of national power generation; slated to reach 22.38 GW by 2031–32). - **Private Sector Entry**: Legally permits private companies to participate in nuclear plant construction, routine operations, equipment manufacturing, and small modular reactor (SMR) development. - **Strategic Sovereign Monopoly**: The Central Government strictly retains exclusive control over sensitive fuel-cycle operations, uranium enrichment beyond notified thresholds, heavy water production, and spent-fuel reprocessing/nuclear waste management. - **Dispute Redressal Bodies**: Establishes the **Nuclear Damage Claims Commission** and the **Atomic Energy Redressal Advisory Council**.

Defence Procurement Manual 2025 (DPM 2025)

- **Approval & Date**: Approved on **23 October 2025** by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh; came into effect on **1 November 2025**.
- **Predecessor**: Completely supersedes the outdated **DPM 2009**.

- **Crucial Prelims Distinction**: DPM 2025 strictly governs **Revenue Procurement** (routine maintenance, spare parts, rations, clothing, fuel, and minor equipment totaling ~**₹1 lakh crore annually**). It does **NOT** govern capital acquisitions (which are governed by the Defence Acquisition Procedure - DAP 2020).
- **Core Principles**: Enhances operational jointness among the Army, Navy, and Air Force, slashes procurement timelines, and mandates preferential sourcing for domestic MSMEs and startups under Atmanirbhar Bharat.

Indian Maritime Doctrine 2025

- **Release**: Released on **2 December 2025** by the Chief of the Naval Staff ahead of Navy Day (celebrated on **4 December 2025**).
- **Central Theme**: ***"Combat Ready, Cohesive, Credible, and Aatmanirbhar Force"***, articulating the Navy's operational readiness to secure vital Sea Lines of Communication (SLOCs) and protect India's maritime sovereignty in the Indo-Pacific.

India–UAE 8-Exaflop Supercomputing Cluster

- **Agreement**: Term sheet finalized between India's **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)** and UAE's AI major **G42** during the May 2026 bilateral summit.
- **Scale**: Establishes a massive **8-exaflop supercomputing cluster** dedicated to training large language models (LLMs), climate modeling, and sovereign AI development across the Global South.

BSNL Nationwide VoWiFi (Wi-Fi Calling) Rollout

- **Launch Date**: **1 January 2026** (New Year 2026).
- **Technology**: Deployed **Voice over Wi-Fi (VoWiFi)** nationwide across all telecom circles, enabling mobile users to make and receive crystal-clear voice and video calls over Wi-Fi networks in cellular "shadow zones" (basements, remote locations, high-rises) without extra app installations.

Cameco–Department of Atomic Energy (DAE) Uranium Pact

- **Value**: **CAD 2.6 billion agreement** signed during Canadian PM Mark Carney's visit (Feb–March 2026).
- **Scope**: Canadian uranium giant **Cameco** guarantees long-term supply of natural uranium concentrates to the **Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)** to feed India's expanding fleet of Pressurised Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs).

IN Operation Sindhu (West Asia Strategic Evacuation)

- **Mission**: Evacuation operation launched by the **Government of India** in 2026 to extract Indian citizens stranded across West Asian conflict zones (amid US–Israel–Iran military escalations).
- **Air & Maritime Dimensions**: Coordinated by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), Indian Air Force (IAF C-17 Globemaster III transport aircraft), and Indian Navy warships deployed on anti-piracy / maritime patrol in the Persian Gulf and Arabian Sea.

SIPRI 2026 Nuclear & Strategic Metrics

- **Nuclear Warheads Stockpile**: India's estimated nuclear stockpile expanded to **190 warheads** (surpassing Pakistan's 170 warheads). Global total: 12,187 warheads (Russia 5,420; USA 5,042; China 620; France 370; UK 225).
- **Global Military Spending**: India ranked **5th globally** with an annual defence budget of **$92.1 billion** (an 8.9% expansion over 2024; trailing US $954B, China $336B, Russia $190B, Germany $114B).
- **Arms Imports Share**: India is the **world's 2nd largest arms importer** accounting for **8.2% of global arms imports** in 2021–2025 (surpassed only by war-torn Ukraine at 9.7%).

IN Operation Sagar Bandhu (HADR Mission — Sri Lanka)

- **Context**: Disaster relief operation launched by India in late November 2025 following widespread destruction caused by **Cyclone Ditwah** in Sri Lanka (*Sagar Bandhu* = "Ocean Friend").
- **Naval & Air Assets**: Indian Navy deployed aircraft carrier **INS Vikrant**, stealth frigate **INS Udaygiri**, and offshore patrol vessel **INS Sukanya**, alongside Indian Air Force **C-130J Super Hercules** transport aircraft with emergency stores, field hospital equipment, and humanitarian supplies.

INTERPOL Silver Notice (Illicit Financial Assets)

- **Launch Date**: Formally introduced in **January 2025** as the 8th official color-coded alert of INTERPOL.
- **Mandate**: Designed specifically to **identify, track, freeze, and seize illicit criminal assets and money-laundering proceeds** across international jurisdictions, strengthening global asset recovery.

CR450 Next-Gen High-Speed Train

- **Record**: China unveiled the **CR450 bullet train**, reaching an operational test speed of **453 km/h**, setting the benchmark for the world's fastest conventional passenger rail technology.

BharatGen: India's First AI Multimodal Large Language Model (MLLM)

- **Launch Date & Forum**: Launched on **2 June 2025** by Union Minister of State (IC) for Science & Technology at the BharatGen Summit 2025.
- **National Breakthrough**: India's first indigenously developed **Multimodal Large Language Models (MLLMs)**.
- **Linguistic Breadth**: Purpose-built to process and generate content across **22 Indian languages**.
- **Multimodal Capabilities**: Processes heterogeneous data formats simultaneously — text, images, audio, and video — unlike older unimodal models.
- **Mission Framework**: Developed under the **National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NM-ICPS)**.
- **Executing Agency**: **TIH Foundation for IoT and IoE at IIT Bombay** (Technology Innovation Hub).

Kalaa Setu & BhashaSetu — Real-Time Language Tech for India

- **Initiative**: Launched by the **Ministry of Information & Broadcasting (MIB)** through its **WaveX Startup Accelerator Platform**.
- **WaveX Platform**: Dedicated startup accelerator launched under MIB's flagship **WAVES initiative** in March 2025 to nurture innovation across media, entertainment, and language technologies.
- **BhashaSetu Challenge**: Real-time language translation challenge launched under WaveX on **30 June 2025**.
- **Kalaa Setu Challenge**: Designed to advance real-time AI-powered multilingual speech and translation tools for inclusive, last-mile citizen communication.

Param Rudra Supercomputer Inaugurated at IIT Patna (Bihar's First Supercomputer)

- **Milestone**: Patna joined India's high-performance computing map with the inauguration of **Param Rudra**, the **first supercomputer in Bihar**.
- **Mission**: Installed under the **National Supercomputing Mission (NSM)**.
- **Collaboration**: Institutionalized through an MoU between **IIT Patna** and the **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)**.
- **Computing Power**: Operates at **838 Teraflops (TF)**, utilizing predominantly indigenous components and running on an Indian-developed system software stack created by C-DAC.

India's First LNG-Diesel Dual-Fuel DEMU Train

- **Operational Debut**: Indian Railways launched the country's first **LNG-diesel dual-fuel DEMU train** at **Sabarmati, Ahmedabad**.
- **Technical Retrofit**: Driving power cars of the **1,400 HP Diesel Electric Multiple Unit (DEMU)** were retrofitted with a dual-fuel injection system.
- **Fuel Economics & Emissions**: Utilizes Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) to replace approximately **40% of traditional diesel consumption**, substantially curbing particulate emissions and operating expenditure.

National Shipbuilding & Heavy Industries Park, Tamil Nadu (NSHIP, TN)

- **First-of-its-Kind SPV**: Established as India's first dedicated **Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV)** under the Government of India's **Shipbuilding Development Scheme**.
- **Institutional Structure**: 50:50 Joint Venture between **V.O. Chidambaranar (VOC) Port Authority** (Government of India) and **SIPCOT** (State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu, Govt of Tamil Nadu).
- **Strategic Vision**: Develop a mega shipbuilding and heavy industries manufacturing cluster to capture commercial merchant vessel orders and domestic defence vessel repair.

HAL Dhruv New Generation (NG) Helicopter for Civil Aviation

- **Maiden Flight**: Successfully conducted on **30 December 2025** at HAL's Helicopter Division in **Bengaluru**.
- **Technical Specifications**: 5.5-tonne, indigenously developed, twin-engine, all-weather multi-role helicopter derived from the Dhruv Advanced Light Helicopter (ALH) Mk-III civil platform.
- **Propulsion & Certification**: Powered by indigenous **Shakti turboshaft engines** with Cat-A performance and AS4 certification; specifically configured for demanding offshore oil and gas logistics (such as ONGC offshore platforms).

DRAVYA Portal (Ayush Ayurvedic Database)

- **Full Form**: **Digitized Retrieval Application for Versatile Yardstick of AYUSH Substances (DRAVYA)**.
- **Publisher**: Ministry of Ayush.
- **Repository Scope**: Largest comprehensive digital database of Ayurvedic ingredients, classical medicinal plants, and modern products, linking classical Sanskrit ayurvedic texts with peer-reviewed pharmacological and toxicological field studies.
- **Phase I Target**: Catalogues standardized technical dossiers on **100 key medicinal substances**.

Rudrastra Hybrid VTOL Strike UAV

- **Successful Firing**: Tested by the Indian Army on **11 June 2025** at the **Pokhran Firing Range, Rajasthan**.
- **Manufacturer**: Developed indigenously by **Solar Defence and Aerospace Limited (SDAL)**.
- **Platform Architecture**: Hybrid **Vertical Take-Off and Landing (VTOL)** unmanned aerial vehicle, merging the runway-independent vertical launch of a helicopter with the high-speed cruise efficiency of a fixed-wing aircraft.
- **Tactical Parameters**: Total operational range of **170 km** (including target loitering); flight endurance of **~90 minutes**; armed with an **airburst warhead** for counter-insurgency and tactical battlefield interdiction.

SCOT — World's First Commercial Space Surveillance Satellite

- **Pioneering Startup**: Commissioned by Bengaluru-based spacetech enterprise **Digantara**.
- **Payload Name**: **SCOT (Space Camera for Object Tracking)**.
- **Launch Details**: Launched into Low Earth Orbit (LEO) aboard **SpaceX's Transporter-12 mission** on **14 January 2025**; operational imaging initiated in March 2025.
- **Resolution & Capabilities**: World's first commercial orbital surveillance sensor capable of detecting and tracking space debris and orbital objects as small as **5 cm** in LEO, safeguarding satellite constellations against catastrophic orbital collisions.

BSNL Soft Launches Quantum 5G FWA

- **Debut Date & Venue**: Announced on **18 June 2025** in Hyderabad.
- **Innovation**: Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL) soft-launched **Quantum 5G Fixed Wireless Access (FWA)**.
- **Technology Profile**: Indigenous, **SIM-less** fixed-wireless broadband solution delivering gigabit fibre-like speeds wirelessly over 5G radio frequencies to homes and remote enterprises.

India International Science Festival (IISF) 2025 (11th Edition)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held from **6 to 9 December 2025** in **Panchkula, Haryana**.
- **Theme**: *"Vigyan Se Samriddhi: for Atmanirbhar Bharat"* (Science for Prosperity: for a Self-Reliant India).
- **Core Mission**: Bridging traditional knowledge systems with state-of-the-art scientific research and laboratory-to-society technology transfer.

WAVES Animation Bazaar & 8th India Joy 2025 (Hyderabad)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held on **1 November 2025** in **Hyderabad**.
- **Organizers**: Jointly organized by Government of Telangana, TVAGA (Telangana VFX, Animation and Gaming Association), and the Union Ministry of Information & Broadcasting.
- **Strategic Announcement**: Announced the establishment of the **Indian Institute of Creative Technologies (IICT)** in Hyderabad to serve as the premier national institute for AVGC-XR (Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, Comics, and Extended Reality).

Project Samudrayaan & Deep Ocean Mission (MATSYA-6000)

- **Deep Ocean Dives**: Two Indian aquanauts — **Commander (Retd) Jatinder Pal Singh** and **R. Ramesh** — successfully conducted preparatory deep-ocean training dives into the Atlantic Ocean aboard France's research submersible ***Nautile***.
- **Mission Identity**: **Samudrayaan** is India's first manned deep-sea exploration mission, spearheaded by the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) under the flagship **Deep Ocean Mission**.
- **Manned Vehicle**: **MATSYA-6000**, a deep-submergence spherical vehicle designed to carry **3 humans** to an extreme ocean depth of **6,000 metres (6 km)**.
- **Engineering Specifications**:
- Hull Geometry: Perfect sphere of **2,260 mm internal diameter** with **80 mm thick walls**.
- Metallurgy: Forged from ultra-high-strength **Titanium alloy (Ti6Al4V ELI grade)**.
- Pressure Tolerance: Engineered to withstand crushing hydrostatic pressures up to **600 bar** (600 times atmospheric pressure) at near-freezing ocean temperatures of -3°C.
- **Strategic Objectives**: Underwater scientific exploration, polymetallic nodules / gas hydrates survey, deep-sea mining technology, and benthic ocean robotics.

ICGS Samudra Pratap — India's First Indigenous Pollution Control Vessel

- **Commissioning**: Formally commissioned by Raksha Mantri **Rajnath Singh** on **5 January 2026** in Goa.
- **Shipbuilding & Fleet Standing**: Built by **Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)**; the first of two dedicated Pollution Control Vessels (PCVs); boasts over **60% indigenous content** and stands as the **largest vessel in the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) fleet to date**.

- **Operational Profile**: Engineered with state-of-the-art ocean containment booms, oil recovery skimmers, chemical dispersant spraying gear, dynamic positioning systems, and firefighting capabilities to neutralize offshore marine ecological disasters.

16th Assembly of the International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA)

- **Dates & Venue**: Concluded on **12 January 2026** in **Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates (UAE)**.
- **Assembly Theme**: *"Powering Humanity: Renewable Energy for Shared Prosperity"*.
- **Youth Leadership**: Convened the IRENA Youth Forum with delegates from over 60 countries to advance digital technology and youth entrepreneurship in the clean energy transition.

Green Mobility Initiatives in Hansalpur (Gujarat)

- **Event Date**: **26 August 2025** in **Hansalpur, Ahmedabad district, Gujarat**.
- **Inaugurated by**: Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**.
- **Technological Breakthroughs**: 1. Inaugurated localized commercial manufacturing of advanced **hybrid battery electrodes** at the **TDS Lithium-Ion Battery Plant**. 2. Flagged off global exports of Suzuki's first Made-in-India global Battery Electric Vehicle (BEV) — the **"e-VITARA"**.

October 2026

India's 2nd Naval VLF Communication Station | Damagundam, Telangana

What happened On **15 October 2026**, Union Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh**, alongside Telangana Chief Minister **A. Revanth Reddy**, laid the foundation stone for the Indian Navy's second **Very Low Frequency (VLF) Communication Transmission Station** at the **Damagundam Reserve Forest** in Vikarabad district, Telangana.

Core specs & prelims facts - **Location:** Damagundam Reserve Forest, Pudur Mandal, **Vikarabad district, Telangana**. - **Outlay & Area:** Estimated cost of approximately **₹3,200 crore**, spanning across **2,900 acres**. - **Operational Mandate:** Operates in the VLF electromagnetic band (3 kHz to 30 kHz). Because VLF radio waves have the unique physical property of penetrating seawater down to dozens of metres, this station provides secure, uninterrupted, encrypted command-and-control communication to deeply submerged nuclear (SSBN/SSN) and conventional (SSK) submarines across the Indian Ocean and Indo-Pacific without requiring them to surface or deploy vulnerable floating wire antennas.

1. **First vs Second:** Damagundam is India's **SECOND** VLF station.
2. **First VLF Station: INS Kattabomman**, located at Vijayanarayanam in **Tirunelveli district, Tamil Nadu** (commissioned in 1990).
3. Do not confuse VLF (Very Low Frequency for submarines) with ELF (Extremely Low Frequency) or HF (High Frequency).

Exercise Malabar 2026 | Visakhapatnam & Bay of Bengal | 8–18 October 2026

What happened The Indian Navy hosted the **Exercise Malabar 2026**, bringing together all four **Quad** partners—**India, United States, Japan, and Australia**—for high-intensity multilateral maritime drills off **Visakhapatnam** under the aegis of the Eastern Naval Command.

Key assets & participating nations - **Format:** Harbour phase at **Visakhapatnam** (8–12 Oct) followed by Sea phase in the **Bay of Bengal** (13–18 Oct). - **India (Host):** Guided-missile destroyers, multi-mission stealth frigates, submarines, P-8I maritime reconnaissance aircraft, and MARCOS commandos. - **United States:** Arleigh Burke-class guided-missile destroyer *USS Dewey*, integral helicopters, and P-8A Poseidon patrol aircraft. - **Australia:** Anzac-class frigate *HMAS Stuart*, MH-60R helicopter, and P-8 maritime patrol aircraft. - **Japan:** Murasame-class destroyer *JS Ariake*. - **Tactical Focus:** Advanced Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW), air defence tracking, coordinated fleet manoeuvres, surface live-firings, and Special Forces maritime interdiction.

Global Space Milestones | October 2026

SpaceX Starship Flight 5 — Historic Mid-Air Booster Catch (13 October 2026)

- **What happened:** In a historic aerospace engineering breakthrough at Starbase in Boca Chica, Texas, SpaceX successfully launched **Starship Flight 5** and caught the massive 71-metre-tall **Super Heavy rocket booster** out of mid-air upon its descent using the dual mechanical arms ("chopsticks") of the launch tower (**Mechazilla**).
- **Significance:** Marks the world's first successful mechanical recovery of a super-heavy booster at the launch mount without landing legs, opening the path to rapid, same-day rocket reuse.

NASA Launches Europa Clipper to Jupiter's Moon (14 October 2026)

- **What happened:** NASA successfully launched its flagship **Europa Clipper** spacecraft atop a SpaceX **Falcon Heavy** rocket from Launch Complex 39A at Kennedy Space Center, Florida.

- **Target: Europa**, the icy moon of **Jupiter**, which harbours a global liquid ocean beneath its frozen crust containing more than twice the water of Earth's oceans combined.
- **Mission:** Investigate the icy moon's habitability, ice-shell thickness, ocean chemistry, and geology (scheduled to reach Jupiter orbit in 2030).

PART C · TOPICS

04 — Awards

> **Priority A** | About **8%** of Current Affairs **2025** papers asked many award questions. Learn winner, field, and award level carefully.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Who won?	Exact name; note if posthumous
Which award and level?	Vibhushan / Bhushan / Shri, or prize name
For what work?	Art, sports, public affairs, teaching…
Who gives it, and when?	President, Republic Day eve, 23 January, etc.
Any UP or India angle?	State names and Indian winners abroad

High-Yield Annual Awards Spine (2024–2025 Foundation)

> **UPPCS Pattern Alert:** Every year UPPCS sets 3 to 6 direct questions on international and national awards. Memorise winners, discovery fields, and state/country connections.

1. Nobel Prizes 2024 (Complete Board)

Category	Winner(s)	Country / Institution	Field / Key Contribution
Physiology or Medicine	**Victor Ambros** & **Gary Ruvkun**	USA (Univ of Massachusetts & Harvard)	Discovery of **microRNA** and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation.
Physics	**John J. Hopfield** & **Geoffrey E. Hinton**	USA / UK-Canada (Princeton & Univ of Toronto)	Foundational discoveries and inventions that enable **machine learning with artificial neural networks** (Hopfield network & Boltzmann machine).
Chemistry	**David Baker** (1/2) **Demis Hassabis** & **John M. Jumper** (1/2)	USA (Univ of Washington) UK (Google DeepMind)	Computational protein design (Baker) and **protein structure prediction via AlphaFold2** (Hassabis & Jumper).
Literature	**Han Kang**	South Korea	For her intense poetic prose that confronts historical traumas and exposes the fragility of human life (Works: *The Vegetarian*, *Human Acts*). First South Korean author to win.
Peace	**Nihon Hidankyo**	Japan	Grassroots movement of atomic bomb survivors from Hiroshima and Nagasaki (Hibakusha), for efforts to achieve a world free of nuclear weapons.
Economic Sciences (Sveriges Riksbank)	**Daron Acemoglu**, **Simon Johnson**, **James A. Robinson**	USA (MIT & Univ of Chicago)	Studies of **how institutions are formed and affect prosperity** (Explaining why nations fail / inclusive vs extractive institutions).

1.1 Nobel Prizes 2025 (Complete Board & Deep Facts)

> **UPPCS Direct Match Alert:** Memorise the precise scientific discoveries, keywords, and country affiliations:

Category	Winner(s)	Country / Institution	Field / Key Contribution
Physiology or Medicine	**Mary E. Brunkow**, **Fred Ramsdell**, **Shimon Sakaguchi**	USA / Japan	Discoveries concerning **Regulatory T-cells (Tregs)** and the **FOXP3 gene**, which regulates **peripheral immune tolerance** (preventing the immune system from attacking body's own tissues; key for autoimmune diseases, organ transplant, and cancer immunotherapy). *(Indian historical connection: Har Gobind Khorana won in 1968 for decoding the genetic code).*
Physics	**John Clarke**, **Michel H. Devoret**, **John M. Martinis**	UK / France / USA	Discovery of **macroscopic quantum mechanical tunnelling** and energy quantisation in electrical circuits. Proved quantum phenomena occur in larger engineered circuits; pioneered **Josephson junctions** (two superconductors separated by a thin insulating layer) vital for superconducting **qubits** in quantum computing.

Category	Winner(s)	Country / Institution	Field / Key Contribution
Chemistry	**Omar M. Yaghi**, **Susumu Kitagawa**, **Richard Robson**	USA / Japan / Australia	For the pioneer development of **Metal-Organic Frameworks (MOFs)** and porous coordination polymers (porous crystalline structures of metal ions + organic linkers used in carbon capture, gas storage, water harvesting, and catalysis).
Literature	**László Krasznahorkai**	Hungary	Hungarian novelist and screenwriter (*Satantango*, *The Melancholy of Resistance*). Citation: *"an introspective body of work that reaffirms art's enduring humanistic power amid apocalyptic themes."*
Peace	**María Corina Machado**	Venezuela	Pro-democracy opposition leader, head of the **Vente Venezuela** party; recognized for courageous defense of democratic rights and efforts toward a peaceful transition from dictatorship to democracy in Venezuela.
Economic Sciences	**Joel Mokyr**, **Philippe Aghion**, **Peter Howitt**	USA / France / Canada	For explaining **innovation-driven economic growth**. Aghion and Howitt formulated the modern mathematical theory of growth through **"creative destruction"** (the process whereby new innovations replace obsolete technologies and firms). Official name: *Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel* (established 1968, first awarded 1969).

1.2 UNESCO Cultural & Natural Heritage Inscriptions (2025)

A. Deepavali Inscribed on UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) List

- **Date of Inscription**: **10 December 2025**.
- **Session & Venue**: Inscribed during the **20th session of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage**, held at the **Red Fort, New Delhi (8–13 December 2025)**.
- **Domain**: Inscribed under the domain of *social practices, rituals and festive events*.
- **Milestone Rank**: Deepavali became the **16th Indian element** on UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity (joining Kumbh Mela, Durga Puja in Kolkata, Ramlila, Vedic Chanting, Garba of Gujarat, Yoga, Koodiyattam, etc.).
- **UNESCO Executive Board**: India was also re-elected to the **UNESCO Executive Board for the 2025–2029 term** (58 member states elected for 4-year terms).

B. Maratha Military Landscapes — India's 44th World Heritage Property

- **Date & Session**: Inscribed on **11 July 2025** during the **47th session of the UNESCO World Heritage Committee** held in **Paris, France** (6–16 July 2025; note that the 46th session was held in New Delhi, India).
- **Serial Property**: Consists of **12 historic forts** demonstrating extraordinary military engineering and strategic adaptation across the Western Ghats and Deccan:
- **11 Forts in Maharashtra**: Raigad, Shivneri, Pratapgad, Rajgad, Sindhudurg, Lohagad, Vijaydurg, Salher, Suvarnadurg, Khanderi, and Panhala.
- **1 Fort in Tamil Nadu**: **Gingee Fort** (*Crucial UPPCS Trap: It is NOT located entirely in Maharashtra!*).
- **Total Heritage Tally of India**: India now possesses **44 UNESCO World Heritage Sites** (comprising **36 Cultural, 7 Natural, and 1 Mixed Site** - Khangchendzonga).
- **Recent Inscription Timeline**:
- 2021: Dholavira (Gujarat) & Ramappa Temple (Telangana).
- 2023: Santiniketan (West Bengal) & Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas (Karnataka).
- 2024: Moidams – the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty (Assam).
- 2025: **Maratha Military Landscapes of India** (Maharashtra & Tamil Nadu).

1.2 Prestigious Global & State Honours (2025–2026)

- **Speaker of the Knesset Medal (Israel):** Israel's highest parliamentary honour was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** on **25 February 2026**, presented by Knesset Speaker Amir Ohana in Jerusalem. With this, Modi became the **first leader in global history to receive supreme honours from BOTH Israel and Palestine** (*Grand Collar of the State of Palestine* was conferred in 2018).
- **FAO Agricola Medal:** The highest award of the UN Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** at FAO Headquarters in **Rome** (19 May 2026) in recognition of his contribution to global food security, smallholder farmer empowerment, and sustainable agrifood systems.
- **Order of the Republic (Trinidad & Tobago):** Conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** by President Christine Carla Kangaloo on **3 July 2025**; Modi became the **first foreign leader to receive Trinidad & Tobago's highest national honour**.

- **Order of the Most Ancient Welwitschia Mirabilis (Namibia):** Namibia's supreme civilian honour was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** by President Dr. Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah on **9 July 2025** in Windhoek.
- **Great Honour Nishan of Ethiopia:** Conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** by Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed Ali on **16 December 2025** during his historic address to the Joint Session of the Ethiopian Parliament in Addis Ababa.
- **The Grand Collar of the National Order of the Southern Cross (Brazil):** Brazil's highest honour for foreign dignitaries was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** by President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva on **8 July 2025** in Brasília.
- **Order of the White Double Cross (Slovakia):** Slovakia's **highest state honour** was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** during his official visit to **Bratislava** (14–16 June 2026).
- **Wolf Prize in Physics 2025:** Conferred on **Prof. Jainendra K. Jain** (**first person of Indian origin** to receive the Wolf Prize in Physics), shared with James P. Eisenstein and Mordehai Heiblum. Awarded for the groundbreaking discovery and theory of ***Composite Fermions*** in fractional quantum Hall states. Presented by Israeli President Isaac Herzog.
- **Miss Universe 2025 (November 2025):** Won by **Fátima Bosch** of **Mexico**.
- **Femina Miss India World 2026 (18 April 2026):** Won by **Sadhvi Satish Sail** at KIIT, Bhubaneswar, Odisha.

77th Republic Day Parade Honours (26 January 2026)

- **Judges Panel Selection**:
- **Best State Tableaux**:
  1. **Maharashtra** (*Ganeshotsav: A Symbol of Aatmanirbharta*)
  2. **Jammu & Kashmir** (*Handicrafts and Folk Dances of J&K*)
  3. **Kerala** (*Water Metro & 100% Digital Literacy*)
- **Best Marching Contingents**: **Indian Navy** (Services); **Delhi Police** (CAPF / Auxiliary).
- **Best Ministry / Department**: **Ministry of Culture** (*Vande Mataram - The Soul Cry of a Nation*).
- **Popular Choice (MyGov Nationwide Citizen Voting)**:
- **Best State Tableaux**:
  1. **Gujarat** (*Mantra of Swadeshi - Self-Reliance - Freedom: Vande Mataram*)
  2. **Uttar Pradesh** (*Culture of Bundelkhand*)
  3. **Rajasthan** (*Bikaner Gold Art / Usta Art*)
- **Best Marching Contingents**: **Assam Regiment** (Services); **CRPF** (CAPF).
- **Best Ministry / Department**: Department of School Education & Literacy (NEP 2020).

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2. Major National Honours & Literary Awards (2024–2025)

Bharat Ratna 2024 (5 Luminaries Conferred)

- **Karpoori Thakur** (Posthumous) — Former Chief Minister of Bihar; socialist icon ("Jannayak") championing OBC reservations (Mungeri Lal Commission).
- **Lal Krishna Advani** — Former Deputy Prime Minister and Home Minister of India.
- **P.V. Narasimha Rao** (Posthumous) — 9th Prime Minister of India; architect of 1991 Economic Liberalisation / LPG reforms and Look East Policy.
- **Chaudhary Charan Singh** (Posthumous) — 5th Prime Minister of India and former Chief Minister of **Uttar Pradesh**; champion of peasant rights and UP Zamindari Abolition Act. *(Crucial UP Fact)*
- **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan** (Posthumous) — Renowned agricultural scientist; "Father of India's Green Revolution".

58th Jnanpith Award (for year 2023, announced 2024)

- **Gulzar (Sampooran Singh Kalra)** — Celebrated Urdu poet, lyricist, film director, Sahitya Akademi & Dadasaheb Phalke awardee.
- **Jagadguru Rambhadracharya** — Renowned polyglot Sanskrit scholar, spiritual leader, and founder/head of Tulsi Peeth at **Chitrakoot (Uttar Pradesh)**. *(High-yield UP question)*
- *(Context: 57th Jnanpith winner was Damodar Mauzo for Konkani literature).*

54th & 55th Dadasaheb Phalke Awards

- **55th Dadasaheb Phalke Award (for year 2023, presented Sept 2025):** Conferred on legendary Malayalam superstar and cultural icon **Mohanlal** at the 71st National Film Awards ceremony at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.
- **54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award (for year 2022, presented Oct 2024):** Conferred on legendary actor **Mithun Chakraborty** at the 70th National Film Awards ceremony. *(53rd was Waheeda Rehman).*

70th National Film Awards (Key Winners)

- **Best Feature Film:** *Aattam* (The Play) — Malayalam (Directed by Anand Ekarshi).

- **Best Actor in a Leading Role: Rishab Shetty** for *Kantara* (Kannada).
- **Best Actress in a Leading Role:** Jointly to **Nithya Menen** for *Thiruchitrambalam* (Tamil) and **Manasi Parekh** for *Kutch Express* (Gujarati).
- **Best Direction: Sooraj R. Barjatya** for *Uunchai* (Hindi).
- **Best Feature Film Promoting National, Social and Environmental Values:** *Kutch Express*.

International Literary Awards

- **Booker Prize 2024: Samantha Harvey** (UK) for her novel ***Orbital*** (compact novel set aboard the International Space Station; first ISS-set Booker winner).
- **International Booker Prize 2024: Jenny Erpenbeck** (Author, Germany) and **Michael Hofmann** (Translator) for the German novel ***Kairos***.
- **35th Saraswati Samman (2025):** Conferred on eminent Bengali writer **Ramkumar Mukhopadhyay** for his acclaimed novel ***'Hara Parbati Katha'*** (instituted by KK Birla Foundation).
- **33rd Saraswati Samman (2023/24):** Poet **Prabha Varma** for his Malayalam novel-in-verse ***Roudra Sathwikam***.
- **33rd Vyas Samman (2023/24):** Hindi writer **Pushpa Bharati** for her memoir ***Yaadein, Yaadein aur Yaadein*** (KK Birla Foundation).
- **Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 in Hindi (announced March 2026):** Conferred on renowned writer **Mamta Kalia** for her memoir ***'Jeete Jee Allahabad'*** (awarded across 24 official Indian languages).

Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2025 (India's Highest Science Honours)

- **Vigyan Ratna (Posthumously):** Conferred on legendary astrophysicist **Prof. Jayant Vishnu Narlikar** for lifetime pioneering contributions to cosmology and physics.
- **Vigyan Team Award:** Conferred on **The Aroma Mission Team** of the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (**CSIR**) for the transformative Purple Revolution and lavender cultivation in J&K.
- **Structure (4 Tiers):** Vigyan Ratna (lifetime achievement), Vigyan Shri (distinguished contribution), Vigyan Yuva-Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar (exceptional young scientists ≤ 45 years), and Vigyan Team.

Other Landmark Global & National Honours (2025–2026)

- **2026 Abel Prize (Mathematics):** Conferred on German mathematician **Gerd Faltings** for foundational work in arithmetic geometry and Diophantine equations.
- **2026 Goldman Environmental Prize (April 2026):** Six women grassroots leaders honoured: Iroro Tanshi (Nigeria), Borim Kim (South Korea), Sarah Finch (UK), Theonila Roka Matbob (Papua New Guinea), Alannah Acaq Hurley (USA), and Yuvelis Morales Blanco (Colombia).
- **2025 SASTRA Ramanujan Prize:** Conferred on mathematician **Alexander Smith** (Northwestern University).
- **70th Filmfare Awards (October 2025 | Ahmedabad):** Kiran Rao's film ***Laapataa Ladies*** set a record winning **13 awards**, including Best Film.
- **UN Dag Hammarskjöld Medal (May 2026):** Awarded posthumously to two fallen Indian UN peacekeepers: **Lance Havildar Harbhajan Singh** and **Naib Subedar Sujit Kumar Pradhan**.
- **2026 Pulitzer Prize (Illustrated Reporting):** Indian visual journalists **Anand RK** and **Suparna Sharma** named among winners.

Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna 2023/2024

- Awarded jointly to India's star men's badminton doubles pair: **Chirag Shetty** and **Satwiksairaj Rankireddy** (Asian Games Gold 2023, World No. 1 ranking, BWF World Tour titles).

Uttarakhand Padma Luminaries (Direct UKPCS Focus)

- **Padma Shri 2025: Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt** — Social Work (Almora / Lakshmi Ashram Kausani, Sarvodaya movement, Women empowerment). *(UKPCS 2025 direct question)*
- **Padma Shri 2024: Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch** — Literature & Education (Eminent historian of Uttarakhand, author of *Madhya Himalaya ka Puratattva*).
- **Padma Vibhushan 2022: General Bipin Rawat** (Posthumous — 1st Chief of Defence Staff, native of Saina village, Pauri Garhwal).
- **Padma Shri 2022: Madhuri Barthwal** (Art / Garhwali Folk Music), **Basanti Devi** (Social Work / Kosi River revival), **Vandana Katariya** (Sports / Hockey Olympian from Haridwar).
- **Padma Shri 2020: Dr. Kalyan Singh Rawat** (Social Work / Founder of Maiti Movement, Chamoli).

January 2026

Padma Awards 2026 | announced 25 January 2026

What happened On the eve of Republic Day, the Government announced the **Padma Awards 2026**. These are among India's highest civilian honours. The President later confers them at Rashtrapati Bhavan, usually around March or April.

Total count

- **131** awards in all (including **2 duo** cases counted as one each).
- Split: **5 Padma Vibhushan**, **13 Padma Bhushan**, **113 Padma Shri**.
- **19** women awardees.
- **6** people from Foreigners / NRI / PIO / OCI category.
- **16** posthumous awards.

Padma Vibhushan (learn all five)

Name	Field	State / Country	Extra
Dharmendra Singh Deol	Art	Maharashtra	Posthumous
K T Thomas	Public Affairs	Kerala	
N Rajam	Art	**Uttar Pradesh**	Important UP fact
P Narayanan	Literature and Education	Kerala	
V S Achuthanandhan	Public Affairs	Kerala	Posthumous

Padma Bhushan — remember the famous names

- **Mammootty** — Art — Kerala.
- **Alka Yagnik** — Art — Maharashtra.
- **Uday Kotak** — Trade and Industry — Maharashtra (finance / banking identity for "financial sector" stems; founder of Kotak Mahindra Bank). Trap: not Ajay Piramal / Deepak Parekh (older Padma) / Raghuram Rajan for the **2026** Bhushan finance key.
- **Vijay Amritraj** — Sports — United States of America.
- **Shibu Soren** — Public Affairs — Jharkhand — Posthumous.
- **Piyush Pandey** — Art — Maharashtra — Posthumous.
- **Bhagat Singh Koshyari** — Public Affairs — Uttarakhand.

Padma Shri — sports and UP names

Sports examples:

- **Rohit Sharma** — Sports — Maharashtra.
- **Harmanpreet Kaur Bhullar** — Sports — Punjab.
- **Savita Punia** — Sports — Haryana.

Other 2026 Shri name traps:

- **Mohan Nagar** — **Social Work** — Madhya Pradesh (water / environment conservation identity in news; official field is **Social Work**, not Sports / Politics / Industry).

UP-linked Padma Shri names to keep: Anil Kumar Rastogi, Ashok Kumar Singh, Buddha Rashmi Mani, Chiranji Lal Yadav, Kewal Krishan Thakral, Mangala Kapoor, Praveen Kumar, Raghupat Singh (posthumous), Rajendra Prasad, and Shyam Sundar.

Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar 2026 | announced 23 January 2026

What happened This yearly award honours excellent work in **disaster management**. It is announced on **23 January**, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's birth anniversary (also observed as Parakram Diwas).

Winners

- **Institution category:** Sikkim State Disaster Management Authority (**SSDMA**).
- **Individual category:** Lieutenant Colonel **Seeta Ashok Shelke**.

Why SSDMA was noticed

- It built a strong local volunteer system of **Aapda Mitras**.
- Reports cite about **1,185** trained volunteers working from village to district level.

February 2026

Global Teacher Prize 2026 | Rouble Nagi (India)

What happened Indian educator and artist **Rouble Nagi** won the **GEMS Education Global Teacher Prize 2026**. The prize is worth **1 million US dollars**. It is run by the Varkey Foundation with UNESCO support. The winner was announced at the **World Governments Summit** in Dubai.

Why she won

- She turns broken or neglected walls into open-air learning murals.
- She calls this idea **Living Walls of Learning**.
- The murals teach reading, numbers, hygiene, environment, and social values.
- Over about two decades, her work has helped bring more than **one million** children into formal schooling.
- She was chosen from more than **5,000** nominations from **139** countries.
- This was the **10th** edition of the prize.

Soft culture award note

- Early February coverage also noted a Grammy honour linked with the **Dalai Lama** at the **68th Grammy Awards** window. Keep this only as a soft fact unless a clear category is needed for a question.

Budget-linked sports push

Budget 2026–27 spoke of a stronger sports goods push and **Khelo India Mission** language. Details sit under Schemes and Sports.

March 2026

Mark Lynton History Prize 2026 | William Dalrymple

What happened Historian **William Dalrymple** won the **2026 Mark Lynton History Prize** for his book **The Golden Road: How Ancient India Transformed the World**.

Core facts

- Prize money: about **10,000 US dollars**.
- The prize is part of the larger **J. Anthony Lukas** book prize family, linked with journalism schools at Harvard and Columbia.
- The book explains how ancient India shaped trade, ideas, and culture across Asia and beyond.

Abel Prize 2026 | Gerd Faltings

What happened The **Abel Prize** in mathematics for 2026 went to **Gerd Faltings** (announced in March; ceremony later in Oslo).

Easy memory

- Abel Prize is one of the highest honours in mathematics.
- It is awarded by the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters.

Oscars 2026 (soft culture fact)

- **98th** Academy Awards were held in Los Angeles.
- Keep Best Picture / Director names only if a stem appears; Indian film **Homebound** was in International Feature discussions in coverage.

April 2026

Laureus World Sports Awards 2026 | Madrid

What happened The **Laureus World Sports Awards 2026** were held in **Madrid, Spain**.

Core facts

- Sportsman of the Year: **Carlos Alcaraz** (Spain, tennis).
- Sportswoman of the Year: **Aryna Sabalenka** (Belarus, tennis).
- World Team of the Year: **Paris Saint-Germain** (football).

Harvard South Asian Person of the Year 2026

- Winner named in compilations: actor **Sayani Gupta**.

- Given by the **Harvard South Asian Association**.

Femina Miss India World 2026

- Edition: **61st**.
- Host city in coverage: **Bhubaneswar**, Odisha.
- Winner: **Sadhvi Satish Sai** (Goa).
- She will represent India at **Miss World 2027** in coverage.

May 2026

International Booker Prize 2026 | 19 May 2026

What happened The **International Booker Prize 2026** went to **Taiwan Travelogue** by **Yáng Shuāng-zǐ** (Taiwan), translated by **Lin King**. The winner was announced at London's **Tate Modern**.

Core facts

- Book: **Taiwan Travelogue**.
- Author: **Yáng Shuāng-zǐ**.
- Translator: **Lin King**.
- First book translated from **Taiwanese Mandarin / Mandarin Chinese** to win this prize in coverage.
- Prize money is shared equally by author and translator (standard International Booker rule).

PM Modi's Nordic civilian honours

- Norway: Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit.
- Sweden: Royal Order of the Polar Star, Commander Grand Cross.

Soft Pulitzer note

- The **2026 Pulitzer Prizes** were announced in early May. Keep a named journalism winner only if a stem needs one exact byline.

Whitley Award 2026 ("Green Oscar") | May 2026

What happened Indian wildlife biologist and conservationist **Parveen Shaikh** won the prestigious **Whitley Award 2026**, widely celebrated internationally as the **"Green Oscar"**.

Core facts - **Recipient**: **Parveen Shaikh** (associated with the **Bombay Natural History Society - BNHS**). - **Species Protected**: Endangered **Indian Skimmer** (*Rynchops albicollis*), a distinct riverine bird with a specialized knife-like bill. - **Conservation Methodology**: Community-led conservation mobilizing riverside villagers as grassroots "Guardians" to protect vulnerable sandbar nesting colonies from cattle trampling, stray dogs, and sudden upstream reservoir releases. - **Geographical Footprint**: Successfully scaling the community model along the **Ganga River to Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh**.

June 2026

Padma Awards investiture | second ceremony

What happened President **Droupadi Murmu** conferred more Padma Awards at a Civil Investiture Ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhavan. One June coverage block spoke of **65** awards in that ceremony (2 Padma Vibhushan, 7 Padma Bhushan, 56 Padma Shri).

Names often listed in that window

- Tennis: **Vijay Amritraj**
- Cinema: **Mammootty**
- Music: **Alka Yagnik**
- Cricket: **Rohit Sharma**

Remember: the full Padma 2026 list was announced in **January**; June is the **conferment** ceremony fact.

PM Modi's June state honours

- Slovakia: Order of the White Double Cross, First Class.
- Seychelles: Guardian of the Blue Horizon.

Sudarsan Pattnaik | Russia sand sculpture honour

- Sand artist **Sudarsan Pattnaik** won the Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026 at an international sand sculpture festival.

- Theme of his work: global warming / environment.
- Coverage called him the first Indian to win this cup.

July 2026

Bintang Adipurna | Indonesia

- Indonesia's highest civilian honour conferred on PM **Narendra Modi**.

Soft National Film Awards note

July compilations listed winners from the **National Film Awards** cycle (Best Film / Actor / Actress names vary by edition). Fact exact film and artist only from the official PIB list for that ceremony before mocks.

Soft sports awards already elsewhere

- FIFA World Cup winners → Sports.
- Women's T20 World Cup winners → Sports.
- PV Sindhu Japan Open → Sports.

August 2026

Order of Oliy Darajali Dustlik | Uzbekistan

- Uzbekistan's supreme state award conferred on PM **Narendra Modi** in **Tashkent**.

Dirac Medal 2026 | Deepak Dhar

What happened Professor **Deepak Dhar** shared the **Dirac Medal 2026** of the Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (**ICTP**, Italy) for work in statistical physics, including the Abelian sandpile model.

Miss Universe India 2026

- Winner: **Kaziah Liz Mejo** (Kerala), crowned in **Jaipur**.
- Coverage called her the first Kerala winner of Miss Universe India in about **64** years.
- She will represent India at Miss Universe in **San Juan, Puerto Rico**.

Soft I-Day gallantry window

- President approved about **78** Armed Forces / CAPF gallantry awards (including posthumous).
- About **1,057** police / fire / home guard / civil defence / correctional service medals in the I-Day civil list.

16th Dadasaheb Phalke Film Festival 2026

- **Award**: **Best Animation Film**.
- **Winning Film**: **"The Wild Call"** (inspired by the ecological biodiversity of **Rajgir Zoo Safari**).
- **Produced by**: Department of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of Bihar.
- **Directed by**: Naveendh S. Fareed and Azharuddin Sulaiman.

17th CIDC Vishwakarma Awards 2026

- **Conferred by**: Construction Industry Development Council (CIDC), presented by Union Minister Nitin Gadkari in New Delhi.
- **Awardees**:
- **Bapu Tower** (Patna).
- **Buddha Samyak Darshan Museum and Memorial Stupa** (Vaishali).

Global Water Award 2026 (Global Water Summit)

- **Award**: **"Wastewater Project of the Year"**.
- **Winner**: **Bihar Urban Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (BUIDCO)**.
- **Project**: Recognized for the execution of the **Digha-Kankarbagh Integrated Wastewater Project**.

October 2026

Nobel Prizes 2026 (Complete Comprehensive Board)

> **UPPCS Direct Question Alert:** Nobel Prizes announced in October are tested nearly every year in Prelims. Memorise the winner names, country affiliations, exact discovery keywords, and historical trivia.

Category	Winner(s)	Country / Institution	Field / Official Citation	Key Exam Hook
Physiology or Medicine	**Victor Ambros** & **Gary Ruvkun**	USA (Univ of Massachusetts & Harvard Medical School)	*"For the discovery of microRNA and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation"*	Discovered in the roundworm *C. elegans*; microRNAs are tiny non-coding RNA molecules vital for gene expression and multicellular development.
Physics	**John J. Hopfield** & **Geoffrey E. Hinton**	USA (Princeton) / UK-Canada (Univ of Toronto)	*"For foundational discoveries and inventions that enable machine learning with artificial neural networks"*	Hopfield created an associative neural network (Hopfield network) that can save and reconstruct patterns; Hinton developed the Boltzmann machine using statistical physics tools, laying the foundation for modern AI and deep learning.
Chemistry	**David Baker** (1/2) **Demis Hassabis** & **John M. Jumper** (1/2)	USA (Univ of Washington) UK (Google DeepMind)	**David Baker:** *"For computational protein design"* **Hassabis & Jumper:** *"For protein structure prediction"*	Baker succeeded in creating entirely new kinds of proteins using Rosetta; Hassabis and Jumper developed the revolutionary AI model **AlphaFold2**, predicting the 3D structure of virtually all 200 million known proteins.
Literature	**Han Kang**	South Korea	*"For her intense poetic prose that confronts historical traumas and exposes the fragility of human life"*	**First South Korean writer** and first Asian female author to win the Nobel Prize in Literature. Acclaimed works: *The Vegetarian* (International Booker Prize 2016), *Human Acts*, *We Do Not Part*.
Peace	**Nihon Hidankyo**	Japan	*"For its efforts to achieve a world free of nuclear weapons and for demonstrating through witness testimony that nuclear weapons must never be used again"*	Grassroots movement of atomic bomb survivors (Hibakusha) from **Hiroshima and Nagasaki** founded in 1956; recognized for maintaining the nuclear taboo through powerful survivor testimonies.
Economic Sciences *(Sveriges Riksbank)*	**Daron Acemoglu**, **Simon Johnson**, **James A. Robinson**	USA (MIT & University of Chicago)	*"For studies of how institutions are formed and affect prosperity"*	Demonstrated that societies with poor rule of law and extractive institutions fail to generate sustainable growth; popularized the concept of **inclusive vs. extractive institutions** (authors of *Why Nations Fail*).

1. **Nobel Physics is NOT quantum computing:** The prize was awarded for **artificial neural networks / machine learning**, not quantum mechanics or cosmology.
2. **Han Kang is from South Korea, not Japan or China:** She is the first South Korean writer to win the Literature prize.
3. **Demis Hassabis and John Jumper shared Chemistry:** Demis Hassabis is CEO of Google DeepMind. Their achievement is **AlphaFold2 protein structure prediction**.

54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award & 70th National Film Awards | October 2026

What happened President **Droupadi Murmu** conferred the **54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award** and presented honours at the **70th National Film Awards** ceremony at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.

Core awards & winners - **54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award:** Veteran superstar and actor **Mithun Chakraborty** was conferred India's highest accolade in cinema for his iconic contribution to Indian cinema. - **Best Feature Film: *Aattam*** (The Play) — Malayalam psychological thriller directed by **Anand Ekarshi**. - **Best Actor in a Leading Role: Rishab Shetty** for his performance in the Kannada mythological hit ***Kantara***. - **Best Actress in a Leading Role (Jointly awarded):** 1. **Nithya Menen** for the Tamil film ***Thiruchitrambalam***. 2. **Manasi Parekh** for the Gujarati film ***Kutch Express***. - **Best Director: Sooraj R. Barjatya** for the Hindi film ***Uunchai***. - **Best Feature Film in Hindi: *Gulmohar*** (directed by Rahul V. Chittella, starring Manoj Bajpayee & Sharmila Tagore). - **Best Popular Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment: *Kantara*** (directed by Rishab Shetty). - **Best Film on Social Issues / National Integration: *Samman / Aygiri***.

2026 SASTRA Ramanujan Prize (Mathematics)

- Awarded annually to mathematicians under the age of **32** (Ramanujan's age at death) who have done outstanding work influenced by Srinivasa Ramanujan.
- Presented at SASTRA University, Kumbakonam (Tamil Nadu).

PART C · TOPICS

05 — Environment & Days

> **Priority A** | About **8%** of Current Affairs Common stems: Ramsar sites, environment rules, important days, and disaster awards.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What is the site, rule, or day?	Exact name
Where is it?	District and state
What is the date?	Notification date vs start date
Who runs it?	MoEFCC, NDMA, Coast Guard, and so on
Any theme?	Especially for international days

High-Yield 2025 carry cards (glacier / climate)

Yala Glacier tribute | 12 May 2025 | Langtang, Nepal

What happened Locals, Buddhist monks, and Himalayan glaciologists held a high-altitude tribute for **Yala Glacier** in **Langtang Valley, Nepal**. News desks often call it a glacier declared **'dead'** or joining the world's "dead glacier" list because of rapid melt.

Core facts

- Location: **Langtang**, northern Nepal (about **5,170–5,750 m**).
- Monitored by **ICIMOD** as one of the best-studied glaciers in the Hindu Kush Himalaya.
- Since the **1970s**, Yala has **shrunk by about 66%** and **retreated about 784 m**.
- Scientists warn it may disappear around the **2040s** if warming continues; the May **2025** event marked its critically endangered / "dead glacier" status in public messaging.
- Linked to the UN **International Year of Glaciers' Preservation 2025**.

Do not pick Khumbu or Imja when the stem says the Nepal glacier marked 'dead' / tribute in **May 2025**. The name is **Yala**.

January 2026

New Ramsar sites in the news | late January 2026

What happened Just before World Wetlands Day, India publicly celebrated new wetlands of international importance under the **Ramsar Convention**.

Two sites highlighted together in the public announcement

1. **Patna Bird Sanctuary** — **Etah** district, **Uttar Pradesh** (Jalesar area).
2. **Chhari-Dhand** — **Kutch**, **Gujarat**.

About Patna Bird Sanctuary

- It is one of the **smallest** bird sanctuaries in Uttar Pradesh (about **1 square kilometre** / around **108 hectares** in detailed notes).
- Even though it is small, it hosts tens of thousands of birds in peak winter.
- It has marshes, woodland, and grassland, with farms around it.

About Chhari-Dhand

- It is a seasonal wetland in the desert region of Kutch.
- It is an important stop for birds entering India on the western route.

Count caution

- February notes often said India had about **98** Ramsar sites after Patna + Chhari-Dhand.
- Just preceding these in December 2025 were **Siliserh Lake** (**Alwar, Rajasthan**) and **Kopra Jalashay** (**Bilaspur, Chhattisgarh**).
- Later: Shekha Jheel = **99**; Surha Tal = **100**; Glaw Lake = **101**.
- With **100 Ramsar sites**, India ranks **1st in Asia** and **3rd Globally** (after the UK with 175 and Mexico with 144 sites).
- Full living table → Master tables. Do **not** treat Surha Tal as a January public headline; its big WED announcement was in **June**.

Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 | notified 28 January 2026

What happened The Environment Ministry notified new **Solid Waste Management (SWM) Rules, 2026**. They replace the older **2016** Rules.

Core facts

- Notification date: **28 January 2026**.
- Full effect from: **1 April 2026**.
- Old rules replaced: **SWM Rules, 2016**.

Disaster award (cross link)

The Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar 2026 is explained under Awards. Winners: **SSDMA** and Lt Col **Seeta Ashok Shelke**.

February 2026

International Workshop on Heatwaves 2026 | 11–12 February 2026 | New Delhi

What happened The **National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)** hosted the **International Workshop on Heatwaves 2026** (preparedness, resilience, risk governance) on **11–12 February 2026** at **Sushma Swaraj Bhawan**, New Delhi (CoDRR series coverage).

Core facts

- Dates: **11–12 February 2026** (not 7–8 Jan, 30–31 Jan, or 20–21 Feb).
- Organiser: **NDMA**.
- Timing logic: before the March–June heat season so Heat Action Plans can be firmed up.

Month–week traps are common. Lock **11–12 February 2026**.

World Wetlands Day | 2 February 2026

What happened Every year, **2 February** is World Wetlands Day. It marks the day the Ramsar Convention was adopted in **1971** at Ramsar in Iran.

2026 theme

- **Wetlands and traditional knowledge: Celebrating cultural heritage.**

Use this theme with the January Ramsar additions.

Budget environment points

- About **₹20,000 crore** over five years for **CCUS** (Carbon Capture, Utilization and Storage).
- Fisheries plan for **500 reservoirs and Amrit Sarovars**.
- More logistics and coastal cargo ideas are under Economy.

UP bird news

March 2026

World Water Day | 22 March 2026

What happened Every year, **22 March** is **World Water Day**. It focuses on fresh water and why safe water matters for life and development.

2026 theme

- Theme: **Water and Gender**.
- Slogan often used: **Where water flows, equality grows**.
- The UN World Water Development Report 2026 title in coverage: **Water for all people: Equal rights and opportunities**.

International Women's Day | 8 March 2026

What happened 8 March is International Women's Day.

2026 UN theme

- **Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls.**

Plastic Waste Management (Amendment) Rules, 2026 | Notified 31 March 2026

What happened The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) notified comprehensive amendments to the Plastic Waste Management Rules, 2016 under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986.

Core facts - **Indian Standard Compliance**: All recycled plastic packaging must strictly comply with **IS 14534:2023** (*Plastics — Recycling and Marking of Products*). - **Feedstock Conversion is Recycling**: Converting plastic into chemical feedstock or new plastic polymers is now legally classified as **recycling**, not disposal. - **End-of-Life Disposal**: Broadened to formally include co-processing, waste-to-energy, waste-to-oil, and road construction. - **Mandatory Reusable Targets**: - **Rigid Plastic Packaging (0.9 to 4.9 L/kg)**: Reuse obligations escalate from **10% (in 2025–26)** to **25% (from 2028–29 onwards)**. - **Drinking Water Packaging ($\ge$4.9 L/kg)**: Reuse target rises from **70% to 85%**. - **Regulatory Entities**: Introduces formal definitions and liability for *Registered Environment Auditors*, *Plastic Waste Processors*, and *Sellers*.

April 2026

Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary | India's 99th Ramsar site | April 2026

What happened Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary in **Aligarh, Uttar Pradesh** was designated a **Ramsar site**. India moved to **99** wetlands of international importance. Uttar Pradesh's tally rose to **12**, keeping UP among the leading states.

Core facts

- Site: **Shekha Jheel** (also written Shekha / Sheikha in some older notes).
- District: **Aligarh**, Uttar Pradesh.
- India total after this tag: **99**.
- UP total after this tag: **12**.
- It lies on the **Central Asian Flyway** and hosts winter visitors such as the bar-headed goose and painted stork.
- The wetland complex grew beside the **Upper Ganges Canal** (built in the 1850s).
- It is also an Important Bird and Biodiversity Area (**IBA**).

Earth Day | 22 April 2026

- Theme: **Our Power, Our Planet**.
- Focus: everyday community action and renewable / climate choices.

Other April day themes

- **World Autism Awareness Day (2 April):** Autism and Humanity — Every Life Has Value.
- **World Heritage Day (18 April):** keep the year's ICOMOS theme only after locking an official note.
- **World Malaria Day (25 April):** Driven to End Malaria: Now We Can. Now We Must.
- **National Panchayati Raj Day: 24 April** every year (Constitution Day link for Panchayats is 24 April 1993).

India's first water-neutral railway depot

- Name: **Kankaria Coaching Depot**, **Ahmedabad**.
- Zone: **Western Railway**.
- Method highlighted: **phytoremediation** of wastewater.
- Water saving noted: about **1.60 lakh litres** a day.

May 2026

International Day for Biological Diversity | 22 May 2026

What happened 22 May is the International Day for Biological Diversity.

2026 theme

- **Acting locally for global impact.**

Saudi Arabia joins IBCA

Santa Marta fossil-fuel transition conference

Soft Whitley Awards note

May conservation coverage named Indian / regional winners such as **Parveen Shaikh** and **Barkha Subba** for Whitley Awards work. Keep names only if a stem needs them.

June preview (do not mix into May mocks yet)

World Environment Day is **5 June**. Theme for 2026: **Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.** Surha Tal as India's **100th** Ramsar sits in that June window.

June 2026

World Environment Day | 5 June 2026

What happened 5 June is World Environment Day, led globally by the **UN Environment Programme (UNEP)**.

2026 theme

- **Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.**
- Focus: nature-based solutions, climate action, and protecting resources for the next generation.

Surha Tal | India's 100th Ramsar site | Ballia, UP

What happened On World Environment Day, India designated **Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal)** in **Ballia, Uttar Pradesh** as its **100th Ramsar site**. Uttar Pradesh's tally rose to **13**.

Core facts

- Official name: **Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary**.
- Common name: **Surha Tal**.
- District: **Ballia**, Uttar Pradesh.
- India total: **100**.
- UP total: **13**.
- Freshwater wetland in the middle **Ganga** basin; formed from a Ganga meander.
- On the **Central Asian Flyway**.
- Bird richness: over **310** bird species; up to about **200,000** migratory birds in winter.
- Also supports the fishing cat and threatened fish such as **Wallago attu**.
- Global Ramsar sites: about **2,595**.
- India is highest in Asia and third in the world after the **UK** and **Mexico**.

Easy compare	Shekha Jheel	Surha Tal
District	**Aligarh**	**Ballia**
India count	**99**	**100**
UP count	**12**	**13**
Month news broke	April	June (WED)

UP CAMP (same WED window)

UP also launched the **UP Clean Air Management Project** (~**₹2,741 crore**; World Bank support; first **airshed-based** clean-air push in coverage). Full UP card → UP Special.

Other June environment days & health initiatives

- **12th International Day of Yoga (21 June 2026):**
- **Main Venue:** Red Road, **Kolkata, West Bengal**; attended by PM Narendra Modi (~35,000 participants).
- **2026 Theme: *"Yoga for Healthy Ageing"***.
- **Countdowns & Heritage Venues:** 100-day countdown at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi; 75-day at **Lonar** (Maharashtra); 50-day at **Kanha Shanti Vanam** (Hyderabad); 25-day at **Khajuraho Group of Monuments** (Madhya Pradesh).
- **Ladakh Single-Use Plastic Ban (19 June 2026):** Strict ban enforced against single-use plastics and open littering across the Union Territory of Ladakh to preserve fragile high-altitude Himalayan ecology.
- **World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought (17 June):** Rangelands — Recognize. Respect. Restore.
- **World Bicycle Day (3 June):** Cycling for a Greener Future (compilation theme).

IBCA Summit delay

First IBCA Summit planned for early June in Delhi was postponed. Details → International.

July 2026

International Tiger Day | 29 July 2026

What happened 29 July is International Tiger Day.

2026 theme

- **Securing the future of Tigers with Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities at the heart.**

Soft biodiversity repository note

Mizoram's **Natural History Museum** was notified as India's **21st Designated Repository** under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002. It sits in the Indo-Burma biodiversity hotspot.

Soft desertification follow-up

Keep June's Desertification Day theme ready if a July stem recycles rangelands language.

August 2026

Glaw Lake | Arunachal Pradesh | India's 101st Ramsar site

What happened Glaw Lake in **Arunachal Pradesh** became the state's **first** Ramsar site and India's **101st**.

Core facts

- Site: **Glaw Lake**.
- State: **Arunachal Pradesh** (first Ramsar).
- India total: **101**.
- Location setting: inside **Kamlang Tiger Reserve** and Wildlife Sanctuary (**Lohit** district in detailed notes).
- Type: freshwater lake in the **Eastern Himalayas**.
- Soft ecology: many tree and orchid species recorded in catchment coverage.

Step	Site	Place	India #
1	Shekha Jheel	Aligarh, UP	99
2	Surha Tal	Ballia, UP	100
3	**Glaw Lake**	Arunachal (Kamlang)	**101**

World Elephant Day | 12 August 2026

- Theme: **Bringing the world together to help elephants**.
- Linked award window: **Gaj Gaurav Awards** for elephant conservation (Environment Ministry).

National Space Day theme

- **23 August** — Towards Viksit Bharat: Innovating, Collaborating and Aspiring to Global Space Leadership.
- Full space card → Science / Defence.

Soft open ecosystems guide

First national guide to India's grasslands and open natural ecosystems launched at **UNCCD COP17**, **Ulaanbaatar**.

September 2026

World Ozone Day | 16 September 2026

What happened The world marked the International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer.

What you should remember

- Date: **16 September** (Montreal Protocol signing anniversary, 1987).
- 2026 theme: **Global action for a cooler planet**.
- Extra line in the theme: celebrating **10 years** of sustainable cooling under the **Kigali Amendment**.
- Static link: Montreal Protocol (ozone) + Kigali Amendment (HFCs / cooling).

Do not swap Ozone Day with Earth Day (22 Apr) or Biodiversity Day (22 May).

International Day of Peace | 21 September 2026

- Theme: **Invest in Peace — For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day**.
- UN observance on **21 September** every year.

Environmental Policies, Wildlife & Conservation Landmarks (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

Solid Waste Management (SWM) Rules, 2026

- **Statutory Authority**: Notified by MoEFCC under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986; **supersedes SWM Rules, 2016**.
- **Mandatory 4-Way Waste Segregation**: 1. Wet waste (organic / kitchen) 2. Dry waste (recyclables) 3. **Sanitary waste** (sanitary napkins, diapers) 4. **Special care waste** (domestic hazardous fractions like fluorescent tubelights, waste batteries, electronics).
- **Stringent Regulations on Bulk Waste Generators**:
- Defined as any entity meeting any of: (i) floor area $\ge 20,000\text{ sq m}$, (ii) water consumption $\ge 40,000\text{ L/day}$, or (iii) solid waste generation $\ge 100\text{ kg/day}$.
- Must process organic waste on-site or procure an **Extended Bulk Waste Generator Responsibility (EBWGR)** certificate.
- **Tourism & Fragile Zones**: Local bodies in hilly and island regions are empowered for the first time to levy solid waste management and environmental conservation fees from tourists/visitors.

India's First Dugong Conservation Reserve (Tamil Nadu)

- **International Milestone**: Formally recognized by the **IUCN** at the World Conservation Congress 2025 in Abu Dhabi.
- **Location & Extent**: Located in the northern **Palk Bay, Tamil Nadu**; encompasses **448.34 sq km** including over **12,250 hectares of critical seagrass meadows**.
- **Species Profile**: Dugong (*Dugong dugon* / Sea Cow) is India's only strictly herbivorous marine mammal; listed as **"Vulnerable to Extinction"** on the IUCN Red List and protected under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Synchronous All India Elephant Estimation (SAIEE 2021–25) — First DNA-Based Census

- **Conducting Agency**: Wildlife Institute of India (WII) and Project Elephant under MoEFCC.
- **National Baseline**: Estimated total population of wild Asian elephants in India is **22,446** (Confidence Interval: 18,255 to 26,645).
- **State Rankings**:
- **#1 Karnataka**: **6,013 wild elephants** (highest in India).
- **#2 Assam**: **4,159 wild elephants**.
- **#3 Tamil Nadu**: **3,136 wild elephants**.
- **Kerala**: 2,785 wild elephants.
- **Uttarakhand**: 1,792 wild elephants (dominates the Shivalik & Gangetic Plains landscape).

Aravalli Hills Definition Committee (Supreme Court HPC)

- **Judicial Intervention**: On 3 June 2026, the Supreme Court stayed previous bureaucratic mining guidelines and constituted a 5-member High Powered Expert Committee (HPC).
- **Chairperson**: **Kanchan Devi**, Director General of the Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE).
- **Mandate**: Deliver a definitive, scientifically grounded definition of the "Aravalli Hills" and "Aravalli Range" across Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan, and Gujarat to protect the fragile green wall from illegal mining.

Swachh Survekshan 2024–25 (9th Edition)

- **Ministry**: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).
- **Scale**: Assessed 4,589 urban local bodies, 58 cantonment boards, and 88 Ganga towns.
- **Central Theme**: **"Reduce, Reuse, and Recycle"**.
- **Key Innovations**: Introduced the **'Super Swachh League'** to evaluate consistent top performers and deployed Cleanliness Target Units (CTU) under *Swabhav Swachhata, Sanskar Swachhata*.

Tuvalu Joins IUCN as 90th State Member (October 2025)

- **International Accession**: The vulnerable Pacific island nation of **Tuvalu** formally acceded as the **90th State Member of the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)**.
- **Geography & Biodiversity**: Encompasses 9 low-lying coral atolls / reef islands with merely 26 sq km of land, but stewards a massive **900,000 sq km Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ)** rich in pelagic marine biodiversity.

BIOFACH 2026 & Global Organic Agriculture Matrix

- **Honorary Title**: India was named **"Country of the Year"** at **BIOFACH 2026 (Nuremberg, Germany | 10–13 Feb 2026)**, the world's premier organic trade exhibition.
- **Nodal Agency & GI Rices**: Organized by **APEDA** (Ministry of Commerce & Industry), spotlighting five GI-tagged organic rice varieties: **Indrayani, Navara, Gobindbhog, Red rice, and Chak Hao (Black rice)**.
- **Global Organic Standings**:
- **#1 in Organic Land Area**: **Australia** leads the world (>53 million hectares).
- **#2 in Organic Land Area**: **India** holds the second-largest certified organic acreage globally.
- **#1 in Organic Producers**: **India ranks 1st globally in the sheer number of organic producers**.
- **Top Indian State**: **Madhya Pradesh** leads all Indian states in certified organic cultivation area.

India–FAO Blue Ports Initiative (September 2025)

- **Collaboration**: Joint initiative by the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying and the UN Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO).
- **Investment**: ₹369.80 crore mobilized under PMMSY and FIDF to modernize coastal fishing harbors into climate-resilient, energy-efficient "Blue Ports".
- **Pilot Locations**: **Vanakbara (Diu)** and **Jakhau (Gujarat)**, alongside **Karaikal (Puducherry)**.

India's 100th & 99th Ramsar Sites (World Environment Day 2026 Milestone)

- **Historic Benchmark**: On **5 June 2026 (World Environment Day)**, India achieved the historic milestone of designating its **100th Ramsar site**.
- **100th Ramsar Site**: **Jai Prakash Narayan (Surha Tal) Bird Sanctuary**, located in **Ballia district, Uttar Pradesh**.
- Geographic profile: Freshwater wetland situated in the middle stretch of the Ganga River basin; critical sanctuary for migratory waterbirds.
- **99th Ramsar Site**: **Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary**, located in **Aligarh district, Uttar Pradesh** (notified as UP's 12th Ramsar site in Jan 2026 before Surha Tal became the 13th).
- Geographic profile: Freshwater lake situated 17 km from Aligarh; serves as an essential stopover along the **Central Asian Flyway (CAF)**; records 249 bird species (62 exclusively wetland-dependent).
- **National Ramsar Standings**:
- **Top State**: **Tamil Nadu** leads India with **20 Ramsar sites**.
- **Runner-up**: **Uttar Pradesh** ranks **#2 in India with 13 Ramsar sites**.
- **Largest Wetland under Ramsar in India**: **Sundarbans** (West Bengal).
- **Smallest Wetland under Ramsar in India**: **Renuka Wetland** (Himachal Pradesh).
- **First Wetlands in India (1981)**: **Chilika Lake** (Odisha) and **Keoladeo National Park** (Rajasthan).
- **Continental & Global Rank**: India ranks **1st in South Asia / Asia** and **3rd globally** in total Ramsar sites (behind UK: 175 and Mexico: 144).

#	UP Ramsar Site	District	Designated / Notified
1	Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora stretch)	Bulandshahr / Hapur / Sambhal	8 November 2005
2	Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary (Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad)	Unnao	19 September 2019
3	Sarsai Nawar Jheel	Etawah	19 September 2019
4	Samaspur Bird Sanctuary	Rae Bareli	3 October 2019
5	Sandi Bird Sanctuary	Hardoi	26 September 2019
6	Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary	Gonda	2 December 2019
7	Saman Bird Sanctuary	Mainpuri	2 December 2019
8	Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)	Agra	21 August 2020
9	Haiderpur Wetland	Muzaffarnagar / Bijnor	13 April 2021
10	Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary	Sant Kabir Nagar	29 June 2021
11	Patna Bird Sanctuary	Etah	4 December 2025
12	Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary (99th Ramsar Site of India)	Aligarh	19 January 2026
13	Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary / Surha Tal (100th Ramsar Site of India)	Ballia	Designated 5 June 2026

- **Recent Additions in Other States (2025–26)**:
- **Chhattisgarh's 1st Ramsar Site**: **Kopra Reservoir** (Bilaspur district; notified 12 December 2025).
- **Gujarat**: **Chhari Dhand** (Kutch; notified 16 June 2025).

- **Bihar**: **Gokul Reservoir**, **Udipur Lake**, and **Gogabil Lake** (all notified 13 May 2025; joining Kabartal, Nagi, and Nakati).
- **Rajasthan**: **Khichan Wetland** (19 Feb 2025), **Menar Wetland Complex** (19 Feb 2025), **Siliserh Lake** (7 July 2025).
- **Sikkim**: **Khachoedpalri Wetland** (15 July 2024).

Maitri II Research Station in Antarctica (East Antarctica)

- **Cabinet Approval**: Ministry of Finance approved the construction of **'Maitri II'** on **4 October 2025**.
- **Location & Target**: Proposed as India's **fourth research station in Antarctica**, located in **East Antarctica**; planned to be fully operational by **January 2029**.
- **Historical Timeline of Indian Antarctic Stations**: 1. **Dakshin Gangotri**: India's 1st base (established 1983–84; submerged under ice, operated for a few years). 2. **Maitri**: 2nd base (operational since **1989**); situated in the **Schirmacher Oasis** (a 20-km-long ice-free stretch at 50 m altitude, 100 km inland). 3. **Bharati**: 3rd base (operational since **2012** in the Larsemann Hills). 4. **Maitri II**: 4th base (to replace aging Maitri station by Jan 2029).
- **Executing Agency**: **National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR), Goa** (under Ministry of Earth Sciences - MoES).

India's First Bamboo-Based Ethanol Plant (NRL, Assam)

- **Inauguration**: Dedicated to the nation by PM Narendra Modi on **14 September 2025** at **Numaligarh Refinery Limited (NRL)** in **Golaghat district, Assam**.
- **Corporate Vehicle**: Established through **Assam Bio-Refinery Private Limited**, a joint venture between NRL and Finnish bio-technology leaders **Fortum and Chempolis Oy**.
- **Feedstock & Innovation**: Uses locally cultivated **bamboo** (non-food, fast-growing, high-lignocellulosic biomass) to produce 2G bio-ethanol, minimizing food-vs-fuel conflicts and driving green industrialization across Northeast India. (Foundation stone also laid for a modern polypropylene unit).

E85 Fuel Rollout in India & Ethanol Blending Milestones

- **Launch Date & Dignitary**: Launched on **World Environment Day (5 June 2026)** by Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas **Hardeep Singh Puri** at an IndianOil retail outlet in New Delhi.
- **Composition & Specifications**: **E85** is a high-ethanol blended automotive fuel comprising **80% to 85% ethanol and 14% to 19% petrol**, tailored for **Flex-Fuel Vehicles (FFVs)**.
- **Flex-Fuel Vehicle Capabilities**: FFVs feature intelligent engine and fuel injection sensors that automatically detect ethanol-petrol blend ratios and can run seamlessly on blends from **E20, E85 up to E100**.
- **Phased Commercial Rollout**:
- Initial phase: 48 Public Sector OMC retail outlets across India.
- Near-term expansion: Scaled to **500 outlets by December 2026** and approximately **5,000 outlets by December 2027**.
- Long-term blending target: National aggregate ethanol blending to reach nearly **26% by 2030–31**.
- **Historic Blending Trajectory**:
- Blending rose from a meager **1.53% in 2014** to **20% as of 5 June 2026** — **achieving the national 20% blending target a full five years ahead of schedule**!
- **Economic & Ecological Benefits**:
- E85 is priced approximately **₹20 per litre lower than conventional petrol**, transferring domestic bio-refinery benefits to consumers.
- FFVs operating on E85 reduce lifecycle greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions by **around 61%** compared to conventional petrol vehicles.

India's First Green Methanol Production Plant (Kandla, Gujarat)

- **Location**: Developing at **Deendayal Port Authority (DPA)**, Kandla, Gujarat.
- **Scale**: 5 tonne-per-day green biomethanol production facility for cleaner marine bunkering fuel.
- **Partners**: Executed with **Thermax Energy** and **Ankur Scientific** (providing advanced biomass gasification technology).
- **Ecological Innovation**: Uses the invasive alien weed ***Prosopis juliflora*** (Vilayati Babul) biomass as its primary feedstock — converting an aggressive ecological hazard into clean green marine fuel.

Project Great Indian Bustard (GIB) — Captive Breeding Breakthrough

- **Status as of 14 June 2026**: Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav reported that the captive breeding programme added 3 more chicks, taking total hatched chicks in the 4th breeding year to **26** (18 via artificial insemination, 4 natural breeding, 4 wild-collected eggs).
- **Total Captive Population**: Captive stock reached **94 birds** at the breeding centre.
- **Species Profile**:

- Scientific Name: ***Ardeotis nigriceps*** (known locally as **Godawan**).
- State Bird of: **Rajasthan**.
- Conservation Status: **"Critically Endangered"** on IUCN Red List; listed under **Schedule I** of Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.
- Habitat: Flagship bird of dry grassland ecosystems; primarily concentrated in **Desert National Park (DNP), Jaisalmer, Rajasthan**.
- Historical decline: Over 1,000 individuals (1960s) $\to$ 745 (1978) $\to$ 600 (2001) $\to$ 300 (2008) $\to$ ~125 (2013).
- Ecological importance: Indicator of healthy grasslands; India supports 15–20% of the world's livestock on grasslands.

India's First Satellite-Tagged Ganges Soft-Shell Turtle

- **Release Event**: On **15 May 2026**, India's first satellite-tagged Ganges soft-shell turtle was released in the 1,302 sq km **Kaziranga National Park and Tiger Reserve in Assam**.
- **Species Profile**:
- Scientific Name: ***Nilssonia gangetica***.
- Protection: **Schedule I** under Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.
- Diagnostic feature: Differentiated from other riverine turtles by prominent **arrowhead-shaped markings** on top of its head.
- Ecological significance: Assam is a global freshwater turtle hotspot; of 8 soft-shell turtle species found in India, **5 species are found in the Kaziranga landscape**.

CMS COP15 — 15th Bonn Convention Conference (Campo Grande, Brazil)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held from **23 to 29 March 2026** in **Campo Grande, Brazil**.
- **Theme**: *"Connecting Nature to Sustain Life"*.
- **Parent Treaty**: Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (**CMS** / **Bonn Convention**), signed in 1979 in Bonn, Germany, under UNEP auspices.
- **Major Outcomes**:
- Granted new or upgraded treaty protection to **40 species, subspecies, and populations** of migratory birds, aquatic wildlife, and terrestrial animals across CMS Appendices I and II.
- CMS now protects over **1,200 unique migratory species**.
- Final approval to 70 proposals, 15 appendix amendments, 16 Concerted Actions, and 39 resolutions.
- Targeted conservation measures approved for: **Cheetah, striped hyena, snowy owl, giant otter, great hammerhead shark**, and declining shorebirds.
- **Presidency & Future Venue**:
- **Brazil** assumed the CMS COP Presidency for the 2026–2029 triennium.
- **CMS COP16** will be held in **Bonn, Germany in 2029**, marking the **50th anniversary** of the Bonn Convention (1979–2029).

"Bhavasagara" — National Repository for Deep-Sea Fauna (Kochi, Kerala)

- **Notification**: Designated on **30 March 2026** by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC).
- **Host Institution**: **Centre for Marine Living Resources & Ecology (CMLRE)** in Kochi, Kerala (an attached institute under the **Ministry of Earth Sciences - MoES**).
- **Core Role**: Designated as India's **National Repository for Deep-Sea Fauna** from India's 2.37 million sq km Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ).
- **Holdings**: Houses over **3,560 taxonomically identified and geo-referenced voucher specimens**; serves as the official national custodian for type specimens of new deep-sea species discovered in Indian waters.

Project Him Sarovar (Ladakh Cold-Desert Water Security)

- **Launch Date**: Launched on **10 April 2026** by **Vinay Saxena, Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh**.
- **Focus**: Tailored for Ladakh's high-altitude cold-desert ecosystem; focuses on **scientific snow harvesting**, capturing glacial melt and seasonal snowmelt in small engineered water bodies to mitigate severe lean-season water shortages.
- **Targets**:
- Phase I: 50 water bodies planned (30 in Leh, 20 in Kargil) covering ~25% of Ladakh villages (5 already completed by June 2026).
- Target: Scale up to 100 such high-altitude water bodies by 2027.

India Withdraws Candidature to Host COP33 UNFCCC (2028)

- **Diplomatic Development**: India formally withdrew its bid to host **COP33**, the 33rd Conference of the Parties to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), scheduled for **2028**.
- **Background**: PM Narendra Modi had formally proposed India as COP33 host at COP28 (Dubai, Dec 2023), reiterated at the BRICS Rio Summit in July 2025.

- **UN Regional Rotation**: Under the UN 5-regional-group system:
- **COP31 (2026)**: Co-hosted by **Türkiye and Australia** (Western European and Others Group - WEOG).
- **COP33 (2028)**: Allotted to the **African Group**; to be hosted in the capital of **Ethiopia** (Addis Ababa).

Project Cheetah — 9 Cheetahs Translocated from Botswana to Kuno NP

- **Translocation**: Arrival of **9 wild cheetahs from Botswana** at **Kuno National Park (Sheopur district, Madhya Pradesh)**, marking the third major international cheetah batch.
- **Historical Milestones**:
- Declared officially extinct in India in **1952**.
- Last confirmed sighting recorded in **1947 in Koriya district** (in erstwhile MP, now Chhattisgarh).
- **Project Cheetah** formally launched on **17 September 2022**.
- Batch 1: **8 cheetahs from Namibia** (released September 2022).
- Batch 2: **12 cheetahs from South Africa** (released February 2023).
- Batch 3: **9 cheetahs from Botswana** (2026).
- **Cub Births & Population Update (March–June 2026)**:
- Female cheetah **Jwala** (formerly **Siyaya**, Namibian cheetah brought in Sep 2022) gave birth to **5 healthy cubs** at Kuno on **9 March 2026** (her 3rd litter in India, 10th successful litter under the reintroduction project).
- Raised the total count of India-born cheetah cubs to **33**.
- **Translocation Flight**: The 9 Botswana cheetahs (6 females, 3 males) were donated from Mokolodi Nature Reserve during President Droupadi Murmu's state visit, airlifted by IAF from Gaborone to Gwalior, and ferried by helicopters to Kuno on **28 February 2026**.
- **Current Total Count (June 2026)**: Total cheetah population stands at **52** (**49 at Kuno National Park** and **3 at Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary, MP**).
- Second Home: **Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary (Mandsaur & Neemuch districts, MP)** operationalized as an additional habitat.

NHAI "Bee Corridors" Initiative (February 2026)

- **Launch Date**: **17 February 2026** by the National Highways Authority of India (**NHAI**).
- **Paradigm Shift**: Transitioning highway roadside greening from purely ornamental beautification to **ecological pollinator corridors**.
- **Execution**: Planting native pollinator-friendly flowering shrubs, nectar-yielding flora, and nesting micro-habitats along national highway medians and right-of-ways (expanding the Green Highways Policy 2015).

State of India's Environment (SOE) 2026 Report | CSE

- **Publisher**: **Centre for Science and Environment (CSE)** and *Down to Earth* magazine (released 25 February 2026 at the Anil Agarwal Dialogue 2026 in Nimli, Alwar, Rajasthan).
- **Extreme Weather Shocks**:
- 2025 witnessed the highest frequency and severity of extreme weather disasters in 4 years.
- Between 1 January and 30 November 2025, extreme weather events struck on **99% of days (332 out of 334 days)** in India, claiming 4,421 lives and devastating **17.41 million hectares of standing crop area**.
- Worst hit States: **Himachal Pradesh** (267 disaster days), **Kerala** (173 days), **Madhya Pradesh** (162 days).
- **Air Quality & Ocean Stress**:
- Only **15% of India's population (~200 million people)** resides within 10 km of a continuous ambient air quality monitoring station (CAAQMS); **85% (>1.2 billion people)** live outside reliable monitoring.
- Global ocean acidity has surged by **30% to 40%** since the industrial era.

India's 7th National Report (NR-7) to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)

- **Submission**: Submitted by MoEFCC on **26 February 2026** (ahead of the 28 February statutory deadline under Article 26 of the CBD).
- **Framework**: Indicator-based assessment deploying **142 national indicators mapped across 23 National Biodiversity Targets (NBTs)**, aligned with the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KM-GBF).
- **Key National Baselines**:
- **Recorded Forest Area (RFA)**: **7,75,377 sq km** (of which 5,20,365 sq km is under actual forest cover; up by 1,445.81 sq km over 2021).
- **Wetland Extent**: Latest high-resolution NWIA/SARITA mapping estimates **3.58 million wetlands** covering **16.89 million hectares (5.12% of India's geographical area)** (up from 15.98M ha in Wetland Atlas 2017).

- **Agroforestry**: Covers **8.65% of total geographical area (28.42 million hectares)**.

MoEFCC Year-End Review 2025 — Wildlife & Environmental Milestones

- **Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam**: **262.4 crore saplings planted** as of 24 December 2025; digitally monitored on the **Meri LiFE portal**.
- **Project Tiger Milestone**:
- India expanded its network to **58 Tiger Reserves** covering ~85,000 sq km (up from 46 reserves in 2014).
- New Tiger Reserve Added: **Madhav Tiger Reserve (Shivpuri district, Madhya Pradesh)**.
- 6th cycle of All India Tiger Estimation initiated.
- **Project Elephant**:
- Elephant Reserves expanded to **33** (covering ~8,610 sq km additional protected habitat).
- **150 elephant corridors** formally ground-truthed across 15 states.
- Fatal conflict ex-gratia compensation enhanced: **Doubled from ₹5 lakh to ₹10 lakh**.
- Captive elephant DNA profiling instituted via the **Gaj Soochna App**.
- **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)**:
- Framework Agreement entered into legal force on **23 January 2025**; membership expanded to 18 nations for conserving 7 big cats (Tiger, Lion, Leopard, Snow Leopard, Cheetah, Jaguar, Puma).
- **National Board for Wildlife (NBWL)**: 7th meeting chaired by PM Modi at **Sasan, Gir (Gujarat)** on 3 March 2025.
- **National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)**:
- 130 non-attainment cities covered; ₹13,415 crore performance-linked funds disbursed.
- 103 cities achieved PM10 reductions compared to 2017–18; 64 cities reduced PM10 by >20%; 22 cities achieved NAAQS compliance.
- **Nagar Van & MISHTI Schemes**:
- **Nagar Van Yojana**: 620 urban forest projects sanctioned (₹654 crore outlay).
- **MISHTI (Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats & Tangible Incomes)**: 22,560 hectares of degraded mangrove ecosystems restored (4,536 ha restored in 2025 alone).
- **Blue Flag Beaches**: **18 beaches across 7 coastal States and 4 UTs** hold international Blue Flag certification.
- **India's Paris NDC Achievements**:
- Reduced GDP emission intensity by **36% from 2005 levels by 2020** (ahead of 45% by 2030 target).
- Non-fossil installed electric capacity surpassed **50% in June 2025** (ahead of 50% by 2030 target).
- Cumulative additional carbon sink reached **2.29 billion tonnes CO2e** (target: 2.5–3.0 billion tonnes by 2030).

30th Conference of the Parties to the UNFCCC (COP30 | Belém, Brazil)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held from **10 to 21 November 2025** in **Belém (Amazon region), Brazil**.
- **Core Theme & Architecture**: "Implementation-First" agenda centered on the **COP30 Global Climate Action Agenda (GCAA)** with 30 activation groups across 482 initiatives.
- **Key Outcomes — The Belém Package**:
- **Global Mutirão Decision**: Derived from the Brazilian indigenous term *"Mutirão"* (collective community action for shared benefit, identical to India's *"Shramdaan"*).
- **Climate Finance Mandate**: Strengthened interpretation of **Article 9.1 of the Paris Agreement** ("developed country Parties shall provide financial resources to developing country Parties"). Two-year Climate Finance Work Programme launched.
- **Tropical Forest Forever Facility (TFFF)**: Brazil-championed $125 billion blended finance facility paying countries performance-based returns for preserving tropical forest biomes.
- **Belém 4x Pledge**: Endorsed by 23 nations to **quadruple sustainable low-carbon fuel capacity by 2035** (green hydrogen, advanced second-generation biofuels, and e-fuels), tracked by the IEA.
- **Belém Health Action Plan**: World's first dedicated international climate adaptation plan for public health ($300 million initial mobilization).
- **India's Assertive Stance**:
- Firmly demanded **$1.3 trillion annually** in public grant-equivalent climate finance from developed nations under Article 9.1.
- Vehemently opposed unilateral carbon border measures like the EU's **CBAM (Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism)** as protectionist trade barriers violating Common But Differentiated Responsibilities (CBDR-RC).
- Next host: **COP31 (2026)** to be co-hosted by **Türkiye and Australia**.

Global Methane Status Report (Launched at COP30)

- **Published by**: UNEP and the Climate and Clean Air Coalition (CCAC).
- **Global Methane Pledge (GMP)**: Includes 159 signatory countries + European Commission, covering ~57% of global anthropogenic methane emissions.

- **Source Breakdown**: Anthropogenic methane originates from **Agriculture (42%)**, **Energy/Fossil Fuels (38%)**, and **Waste (20%)**.
- **Mitigation Potential**: G20+ countries generate 65% of global methane emissions and hold 72% of cost-effective abatement potential.

UNEP Emissions Gap Report 2025 (16th Edition: "Off Target")

- **Released on**: 4 November 2025 by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP).
- **Emissions Peak**: Global anthropogenic greenhouse gas emissions reached a record **57.7 GtCO2e in 2024** (+2.3% surge over 2023).
- **Driver of Surge**: Net Land Use, Land-Use Change and Forestry (LULUCF) emissions spiked by ~21% in 2024 (accounting for 53% of the total emissions growth).
- **Temperature Projections**: Current policies lead to catastrophic global warming of **~2.8°C**; full implementation of unconditional NDCs leads to **~2.5°C**, and conditional NDCs to **~2.3°C** (far above the Paris Agreement's 1.5°C threshold).
- **Emissions Gap for 2030**: 12 GtCO2e gap remains for a 2°C pathway; 20 GtCO2e gap remains for 1.5°C.

FAO Global Forest Resources Assessment (GFRA) 2025

- **Publisher**: **Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** of the United Nations (published quinquennially / every 5 years; covers 1990–2025).
- **Global Forest Envelope**: Earth's total forest area stands at **4.14 billion hectares** (~32% of global land mass).
- **Deforestation Deceleration**: Net annual forest loss decreased from 10.7 million ha/year in the 1990s to **4.12 million ha/year in 2015–2025**.
- **Forest Wealth Concentration**: Over 54% of global forests are concentrated in five mega-forest nations: **1. Russia, 2. Brazil, 3. Canada, 4. United States, 5. China**.
- **India's Global Standings**:
- **Total Forest Area**: India holds **72.7 million hectares (~2% of world's forest)**, advancing to **9th position globally** (overtaking previous 10th spot).
- **Annual Net Forest Gain**: India retained **3rd position worldwide** in average annual net forest area gain.
- **Carbon Sequestration**: India's forests rank **5th globally** among national forest carbon sinks, capturing an estimated **150 Mt of CO2 annually** (2021–2025).

Ramsar Convention COP15 (Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held from **23 to 31 July 2025** in **Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe**.
- **Conference Theme**: *"Protecting Wetlands for Our Common Future"*.
- **Strategic Plan**: Adopted the **5th Strategic Plan (2025–2034)** featuring 4 systemic goals and 18 operational targets.
- **Accreditation of Indian Cities**: **Indore (Madhya Pradesh)** and **Udaipur (Rajasthan)** became India's **first-ever officially accredited "Wetland Cities"** under the international Wetland City Accreditation (WCA) scheme!
- **Historic Indian Resolution**: India tabled a landmark resolution titled *"Promoting Sustainable Lifestyles for the Wise Use of Wetlands"*, inspired by PM Modi's **Mission LiFE**, adopted unanimously by all 172 member states.
- **Next COP16**: Scheduled for **July 2028 in Panama City, Panama**.

Cold Desert Biosphere Reserve (Himachal Pradesh) Added to UNESCO WNBR

- **Global Recognition**: Included in **UNESCO's World Network of Biosphere Reserves (WNBR)** during the **5th World Congress of Biosphere Reserves (37th MAB ICC session) in Hangzhou, China**.
- **National Tally**: India now possesses **13 UNESCO MAB-recognized Biosphere Reserves** (out of 18 national Biosphere Reserves).
- **Geographic Extent**: Spans **7,770 sq km** across Spiti Valley (altitudes 3,300 m to 6,600 m); India's first high-altitude cold desert biosphere reserve in the UNESCO network.
- **Protected Areas Included**: Encompasses **Pin Valley National Park**, **Kibber Wildlife Sanctuary**, **Chandratal Wildlife Sanctuary/Wetland**, and Sarchu.

Sundarbans Tiger Reserve (STR) Becomes India's 2nd Largest Tiger Reserve

- **Sanction Date**: Approved by the National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) on **19 August 2025**.
- **Expansion Area**: Added **1,044.68 sq km** of contiguous mangrove forests (Matla, Raidighi, and Ramganga ranges of South 24 Parganas) to Sundarbans Tiger Reserve.
- **Total Area & National Rank**: Total area expanded to **2,584.89 sq km**, making STR the **2nd largest tiger reserve in India** (behind **Nagarjunsagar-Srisailam Tiger Reserve** in Andhra Pradesh at 3,296 sq km).

‘Matri Van’ Urban Forest Initiative (Gurugram, Haryana)

- **Launch**: Inaugurated on **2 August 2025** in **Gurugram** by Union Ministers Bhupender Yadav and Manohar Lal under the ***Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam*** campaign.
- **Scale & Ecological Remediation**: 750-acre thematic urban forest established in the Aravalli Hills along the Gurugram–Faridabad Road; eradicates invasive Kabuli Kikar (*Prosopis juliflora*) and re-establishes native Dhak and Amaltash forests across 10 specialized theme groves (Bodhi Vatika, Bambusetum, Aravalli Arboretum, Pushp Vatika, Sugandh Vatika, Nakshatra Vatika, etc.).

India’s First Centre of Excellence for Hornbill Conservation (Tamil Nadu)

- **Location**: Established by Tamil Nadu Forest Department at **Anamalai Tiger Reserve (ATR)** in **Coimbatore district**.
- **Target Species**: Focused on the four indigenous hornbill species of the Western Ghats: **Great Hornbill**, **Malabar Grey Hornbill**, **Malabar Pied Hornbill**, and **Indian Grey Hornbill** (venerated as the “farmers of the forest” for vital canopy seed dispersal).

National Red List Roadmap and Vision 2025–2030

- **Unveiled at**: IUCN World Conservation Congress 2025 in Abu Dhabi by MoS Kirti Vardhan Singh.
- **Partners**: Jointly developed by MoEFCC, **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**, **Botanical Survey of India (BSI)**, and IUCN’s Centre for Species Survival to create an authentic indigenous red-list threat registry for Indian flora and fauna.

Namo Oxygen Parks (New Delhi)

- **Inauguration**: On World Environment Day (**5 June 2026**), Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated **18 Namo Oxygen Parks** across Delhi under the nationwide ***Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam*** campaign.
- **Context**: Created as a public ecological restoration measure following the illegal felling of 1,100 mature trees in the protected Southern Ridge (“lungs of Delhi”) by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA).

Andaman & Nicobar Underwater Guinness World Records (Swaraj Dweep)

- **Event Date**: May 2026 at **Swaraj Dweep** (formerly **Havelock Island**, South Andaman).
- **Two World Records**: Set by Andaman & Nicobar Administration to promote sustainable marine tourism: 1. *“Largest flag unfurled underwater”* (Indian National Tricolour). 2. *“Tallest human stack underwater”*.

Two New Ramsar Sites in Bihar (Gokul Jalashay & Udaipur Jheel)

- **Wetlands Tag**: Two prominent wetlands of Bihar were added to the global Ramsar List of Wetlands of International Importance: 1. **Gokul Jalashay** — located in **Buxar district**. 2. **Udaipur Jheel** — located in **West Champaran district** (renowned oxbow lake ecosystem along the Gandak floodplain).
- *(Note: Bihar’s first Ramsar site was Kanwar Lake / Kabal Tal in Begusarai, designated in 2020).*

Bihar’s First Natural Elephant Corridor

- **Notification**: Bihar Forest Department established the state’s **first natural elephant corridor** to ensure secure migration pathways between Jharkhand and Bihar forests.
- **Encompassed Zones**: Covers the **Garhi forest area** of Jamui Forest Division, the **Charkapathar and Batiya forest areas** of Jhajha, and the **Madhwa sub-forest area** of Chakai Forest Division.

Asian Waterbird Census 2026 (Kosi Region)

- **Census Findings**: Conducted across the Kosi riverine wetlands in February 2026; recorded **4,982 waterbirds across 92 species**.
- **Rare Migratory Sighting**: Documented rare winter visitors including the **Baikal Teal** (*Anas formosa*, an elusive Siberian migratory duck) and the **Fulvous Whistling Teal**.

October 2026

High-Yield October Days & Exact Themes Board

Date	Day	Official Theme / Slogan	Exam Significance
2 Oct	**International Day of Non-Violence**	Mahatma Gandhi birth anniversary	Observed globally since 2007 (UNGA resolution).
5 Oct	**World Teachers’ Day**	*“Standing with teachers: valuing teacher voices for education”*	Marks the 1966 ILO/UNESCO Recommendation.

Date	Day	Official Theme / Slogan	Exam Significance
7 Oct	**World Cotton Day**	*"Cotton for Good"*	Initiated by Cotton-4 nations (Benin, Burkina Faso, Chad, Mali).
9 Oct	**World Post Day**	*"150 years of enabling communication and empowering peoples"*	Marks the 1874 Treaty of Bern establishing Universal Postal Union (UPU, Bern, Switzerland).
10 Oct	**World Mental Health Day**	*"It is time to prioritize mental health in the workplace"*	Focus on workplace stress, burnout, and mental well-being.
11 Oct	**International Day of the Girl Child**	*"Girls' vision for the future"*	Established by UNGA in 2011; focus on adolescent girls' agency and rights.
12 Oct	**World Migratory Bird Day**	*"Protect Insects, Protect Birds"*	Highlights the precipitous decline of insects as critical nourishment for avian flyways.
13 Oct	**International Day for Disaster Risk Reduction**	*"Empowering the next generation for a resilient future"*	Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction (2015–2030) review.
15 Oct	**International Day of Rural Women**	*"Rural Women Cultivating Good Food for All"*	Acknowledges women's critical role in agrifood chains.
16 Oct	**World Food Day**	*"Right to foods for a better life and a better future"*	Commemorates founding of UN Food and Agriculture Organization (**FAO**, 1945, Rome).
20 Oct	**World Statistics Day**	*"Collaborative data for resilient governance"*	Celebrated every five years / statistical awareness.
24 Oct	**United Nations Day** & **World Polio Day**	*"A Campaign to Reach Every Child"* (Polio)	Marks entry into force of UN Charter (24 Oct 1945); Jonas Salk birth anniversary (Polio).

72nd National Wildlife Week | 2 to 8 October 2026

What happened The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) and state wildlife departments observed the **72nd National Wildlife Week** from **2 to 8 October 2026**.

Core facts - **Core Theme:** *"Human–Wildlife Coexistence: Fostering Harmony for Sustainable Living"*. - **Initiatives:** Dedicated drives on community-led conflict mitigation, geo-fenced early-warning SMS alerts along elephant and leopard corridors, and school conservation pledges.

UN Biodiversity Summit (CBD COP16) | Cali, Colombia (October 2026)

What happened The **16th meeting of the Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD COP16)** convened in **Cali, Colombia**, under the overarching slogan **"*Peace with Nature*"**.

Core facts - **Context:** The first substantive COP following the adoption of the historic **Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF)** at COP15 in 2022. - **Key Focus:** Reviewing updated National Biodiversity Strategies and Action Plans (**NBSAPs**) and tracking progress on the **"30x30 Target"** (protecting 30% of global land and marine areas by 2030). - **Core Stance of Developing Nations:** Demanded operationalisation of the multilateral mechanism for fair and equitable benefit-sharing from the use of **Digital Sequence Information (DSI)** on genetic resources.

PART C · TOPICS

06 — National Events & Infra

> **Priority A** | About **7%** of Current Affairs Usual question style: where is it, who built it, what is new about it.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What is the event or project?	Parade, portal, bridge, museum
Where is it?	City / path / state
Who did it?	Ministry, PSU, force
What is new?	First, theme, special feature

High-Yield infrastructure / urban digital cards

Bharatmala constructed length leader | as on 31 October 2024

What happened MoRTH reported Phase-I Bharatmala progress to Parliament / PIB: **26,425 km** awarded and **18,714 km** constructed.

Core facts

- Highest **constructed** length among states: **Rajasthan** (**2,241 km**).
- Common distractors in stems: Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra (also large, but not the top on that date).
- Bharatmala = **highways**. Sagarmala = **port-led**. Do not swap.

"Largest NH length forever" ≠ this stem. The October **2024** Bharatmala **constructed** leader is **Rajasthan**.

National Urban Innovation Stack (NUIS) Digital Blueprint

What happened MoHUA and the **National Institute of Urban Affairs (NIUA)** jointly developed the **NUIS Digital Blueprint** as a shared digital public good for urban governance.

Core facts

- Goal: interoperable, reusable digital building blocks for cities (APIs, registries, urban solutions).
- NIUA's **Centre for Digital Governance** anchors implementation.
- Wrong options often say MeitY alone or NITI Aayog alone.

January 2026

77th Republic Day | 26 January 2026 | Kartavya Path

What happened India celebrated the **77th Republic Day**. The main parade was on **Kartavya Path** in New Delhi.

Core facts

- Year count: **77th** Republic Day.
- Venue name to use now: **Kartavya Path** (older books may still say Rajpath).

Parakram Diwas | 23 January 2026

What happened 23 January is observed as **Parakram Diwas** for Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's birth anniversary.

Linked award

- On the same date, the Government announced the **Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar 2026**.
- Winners are explained under Awards.

Domestic institutions in the India–EU outcomes

From the 27 January India–EU list:

- **RBI** signed an MoU with Europe's securities body **ESMA**.
- **NDMA** signed a disaster cooperation arrangement with **DG-ECHO**.

February 2026

Union Budget presentation day | 1 February 2026

What happened The Finance Minister presented the Union Budget for **2026–27** in Parliament.

Easy memory facts

- It was presented on a **Sunday**.
- The day was also linked with **Magha Purnima** and Guru **Ravidas** Jayanti in official messaging.
- This was Nirmala Sitharaman's **ninth** Budget.
- Only the second time in recent memory that a Finance Minister presented the Budget on a Sunday. The earlier case often cited is **Yashwant Sinha** on **28 February 1999**.
- It was the first Budget prepared in **Kartavya Bhawan**.
- The **new Income Tax Act, 2025** starts from **1 April 2026**.

AI Summit venue

Infrastructure names from the Budget that matter for places

- A ship-repair setup for inland waterways was proposed at **Varanasi** and **Patna**.
- Development of **15 archaeological sites** was proposed. Two important UP names in explainers are **Sarnath (Varanasi)** and **Hastinapur (Meerut)**.
- The Budget spoke of **seven High-Speed Rail corridors** as growth connectors. UP explainers often link **Varanasi** with Delhi–Varanasi and Varanasi–Siliguri type connectivity. Confirm the exact corridor list from Budget papers before Match List practice.

March 2026

Gujarat Uniform Civil Code Bill | passed 24 March 2026

What happened The Gujarat Assembly passed the **Gujarat Uniform Civil Code, 2026** after a long debate. Gujarat became the **second state** in India to pass a full state UCC law. The first was **Uttarakhand**.

What the law tries to cover

- Marriage, divorce, succession, adoption, and related civil matters.
- Live-in relationships are also brought under registration rules in coverage.
- Scheduled Tribes in the state were reported as exempt.

Constitution link

- Uniform Civil Code is mentioned in **Article 44** (Directive Principles).

Modified UDAN and IVFRT

These Cabinet decisions are explained under Schemes. They matter for national infrastructure and border/visa systems.

Passive euthanasia case note (soft polity–CA hybrid)

March coverage discussed a Supreme Court order allowing withdrawal of life support in a long vegetative-state case, linked to the right to die with dignity under **Article 21** and the earlier **Common Cause** judgment on living wills. Keep this as a careful polity fact, not a casual one-liner.

April 2026

Census 2027 digital launch | from 1 April 2026

What happened

Quick national facts

- 16th Census of India.
- Mascots: **Pragati** and **Vikas**.
- Population Enumeration in **February 2027**.
- Reference date: **1 March 2027** (special dates for some snow-bound areas).

Five new districts in Ladakh

What happened The Lieutenant Governor approved creation of **five new districts** in the Union Territory of Ladakh. Earlier Ladakh had only **Leh** and **Kargil**.

Core facts

- New districts: **Nubra**, **Sham**, **Changthang**, **Zanskar**, and **Drass**.
- New total: **seven** districts.

Meghalaya official languages ordinance

What happened Meghalaya approved an ordinance giving **Khasi** and **Garo** full official status alongside **English**.

Core facts

- It replaces the older pattern where English alone was the sole official language and Khasi/Garo were only "associate" languages.
- Constitutional power used: **Article 345**.

Parliament murals book note

- Vice President **C. P. Radhakrishnan** unveiled coverage of **Tides of Time: Bharat's History through Murals in Parliament**, linked with author **Sudha Murty**.
- Full soft culture card → Books.

May 2026

Supreme Court judge strength raised | May 2026

What happened India moved to raise the sanctioned strength of Supreme Court judges. The change amends the **Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956**.

Core facts

- Judges excluding the Chief Justice: from **33** to **37**.
- Total including the CJI: from **34** to **38**.
- Aim noted: clear backlog and make regular Constitution Benches easier.

South Coast Railway Zone

What happened A new railway zone was created: **South Coast Railway Zone**, with headquarters at **Visakhapatnam**, Andhra Pradesh.

Core facts

- HQ: **Visakhapatnam**.
- Divisions named in coverage: **Guntakal**, **Guntur**, and **Vijayawada** (earlier under South Central Railway).
- Total railway zones after this: **19**.

Sikkim as first paperless judiciary state

What happened Coverage said **Sikkim** became India's first paperless judiciary state. The announcement was linked with a national conclave in **Gangtok** and CJI **Surya Kant**.

Ayush Anudan Portal

Launched by the Ministry of Ayush for end-to-end scheme funding. Details → Schemes.

June 2026

Right to walk on a footpath | Supreme Court

What happened The Supreme Court held that a citizen's right to walk on a **demarcated footpath** is a fundamental right and ranks above motorised traffic on that space.

Core facts

- Linked with **Article 19(1)(d)** (freedom of movement) and **Article 21** (life and liberty).
- Bench named in coverage: Justices **P. S. Narasimha** and **A. S. Chandurkar**.

11th NITI Aayog Governing Council

What happened The **11th** Governing Council meeting of **NITI Aayog** was held at **Rashtrapati Bhavan**, New Delhi, chaired by the Prime Minister.

Core facts

- Theme: **Inclusive Human Development for Viksit Bharat @2047**.
- Focus areas noted: entrepreneurship, skilling, and sustainable jobs.

India's first offshore airport approval | Palghar, Maharashtra

What happened Approval coverage advanced for India's first **offshore airport** off the **Palghar** coast in Maharashtra, about **4.75 km** from the Uttan–Virar Sea Link in explainers.

Easy meaning

- An offshore airport sits over the sea on an artificial island or platforms.
- Soft world comparison often used: Japan's **Kansai** airport on reclaimed land.

Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF)

- Edition: **19th**.
- Organised by **NFDC** under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting.
- Focus: non-feature cinema.

July 2026

Kartavya Bhawan Complex naming

What happened Coverage said the Central Vista redevelopment area should be called the **Kartavya Bhawan Complex** or **Kartavya Bhawan Area**. The idea is to bring many ministries together for better coordination.

Education reforms task force | Nandan Nilekani

A high-powered task force on examination reforms will be led by **Nandan Nilekani**. Full soft card → Schemes.

Soft port and AI university notes

- **Kamarajar Port** (Tamil Nadu) coverage claimed **18-metre draft** capability for fully laden Capesize vessels.
- Karnataka announced plans for India's first government-driven **AI University** plus an AI Hub incubation centre.

Soft Nepal freight rail

India's first direct commercial container freight train to **Nepal** reached **Biratnagar** from the Kolkata Port route under the revised India–Nepal Rail Transit Protocol (canola consignment in coverage).

August 2026

80th Independence Day | Red Fort | 15 August 2026

What happened India celebrated its **80th** Independence Day. Dual themes: **150 years of Vande Mataram** and **Yuva Shakti** for Viksit Bharat @2047. For the first time, **Vande Mataram** was performed by the Army band as part of the Red Fort I-Day programme.

Core facts

- PM Modi's **13th** consecutive Red Fort address (second-longest streak after Nehru's 17).
- Coordinating service: **Indian Army**.
- Full announcement card → Schemes.

High Court Bench for Ladakh

What happened A Bench of the High Court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh was established for **Ladakh** to improve access to justice in remote areas.

Soft fact

- Total High Courts in India remain **25** (bench is not a new High Court).

Soft culture days

- National Handloom Day: 7 August.

In-Depth National Affairs & Infrastructure (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

Ahmedabad Metro Rail Phase 2A

- **Project Scope**: Extension covering **6.032 km** with **5 elevated stations**.
- **Sanctioned Cost**: **₹2,169.04 crore**.
- **Implementing Agency**: Gujarat Metro Rail Corporation (GMRC) Limited.
- **Milestone**: With the operationalization of this phase, the total operational Ahmedabad Metro network expanded to **77.63 km**.
- **Connectivity**: Enhances high-speed urban transit connecting Ahmedabad and Gandhinagar (including GIFT City).

ULLAS Scheme — Full Literacy Sequence

- **Scheme Target**: Achieving full functional literacy (95%+ literacy rate benchmark under ULLAS — Understanding Lifelong Learning for All in Society).
- **Chronological sequence of full literacy declarations**: 1. **Ladakh**: First Union Territory to achieve full functional literacy under ULLAS. 2. **Mizoram**: First State in India (and Northeast) to achieve full functional literacy under ULLAS. 3. **Goa**: Declared fully literate (first in Western region). 4. **Tripura**: Declared fully literate. 5. **Himachal Pradesh**: Declared fully literate. 6. **Sikkim**: Joined the fully literate states.

Election Commission of India — Special Intensive Revision (SIR) Phase III

- **Constitutional Basis**: Carried out under plenary powers of superintendence, direction, and control of elections under **Article 324**.
- **Scale**: Covered **16 States and 3 UTs**.
- **Ground Workforce**: Mobilized **3.94 lakh Booth Level Officers (BLOs)** for 100% door-to-door physical verification of electors.
- **Regional Grouping**: Group 3 notably covered **Uttarakhand** among other states.

NCRB Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India (ADSI) 2024 — National Findings

- **Total Accidental Deaths**: **4,67,857** accidental deaths recorded nationally.
- **Forces of Nature**:
- **Lightning** accounted for **35.7%** of all accidental deaths caused by forces of nature (the single largest natural killer).
- Highest number of lightning deaths reported in **Madhya Pradesh**.
- **Traffic Accidents**:
- Road accident fatalities showed that **59.7%** occurred in **rural areas** (contradicting the misconception that urban roads are more lethal).
- **Suicides in India**:
- Total reported suicides: **1,70,746**.
- All-India suicide rate: **12.2** per 1,00,000 population.

Noida International Airport (Jewar) — Phase-1 Specifications

- **Capital Outlay**: **₹11,200 crore** for Phase-1 completion.
- **Developer / Concessionaire**: **Yamuna International Airport Private Limited (YIAPL)**, a 100% owned subsidiary of **Zurich Airport International AG**.

Assembly Election Results 2026 (Five States / UTs)

- **Schedule & Counting**: Polling in April; Common counting on **4 May 2026**.
- **State-by-State Outcomes**:
- **West Bengal (294 seats)**:
  - **Suvendu Adhikari** sworn in as the first BJP Chief Minister of West Bengal on **9 May 2026** at Brigade Parade Grounds, Kolkata by Governor R.N. Ravi on *Pochishe Boishakh* (165th birth anniversary of Rabindranath Tagore).
  - Results: BJP won **208 seats** (secured absolute majority, ending 15 years of TMC rule; TMC reduced to 80 seats).
  - Voter Turnout: **92.47%** (highest-ever recorded in the history of West Bengal).
- **Tamil Nadu (234 seats)**:

- **C. Joseph Vijay** (founder of *Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam* - TVK) sworn in as Chief Minister on **10 May 2026** at Nehru Indoor Stadium by Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar.
- Historic First: **First Tamil Nadu CM since 1967 not belonging to either DMK or AIADMK**.
- Results: TVK won **108 seats** in its maiden election; formed government with support of 120 MLAs (including Congress, Left parties, VCK, and IUML).
- Voter Turnout: **84.69%** (highest since Independence).

- **Kerala (140 seats)**:
  - **V.D. Satheesan** (Congress/UDF) sworn in as Chief Minister on **18 May 2026**.
  - Results: United Democratic Front (UDF) won **104 seats** (Congress 63, CPI(M) 26, IUML 22), ending a decade of Left Democratic Front (LDF) rule.
- **Assam (126 seats)**:
  - **Himanta Biswa Sarma** sworn in for a consecutive term on **12 May 2026**.
  - Results: NDA won **102 seats** (BJP 82, BPF 10, AGP 10) with over 50% vote share.
- **Puducherry (30 seats)**:
  - **N. Rangasamy** (AINRC) sworn in on **13 May 2026**; won Thattanchavady seat by 4,441 votes. NDA won 18 seats.

Assam Uniform Civil Code Bill, 2026

- **Legislative Timeline**: Passed by the Assam Legislative Assembly on **27 May 2026**.
- **National Milestone**: Assam became the **first state in Northeast India** and the **third state in India** (after Uttarakhand and Gujarat) to pass a state UCC under **Article 44**.
- **Repealed Act**: Repeals the *Assam Compulsory Registration of Muslim Marriages and Divorces Act, 2024*.
- **Key Clauses**:
- Monogamy strictly mandated; bigamy/polygamy punishable by imprisonment up to 7 years.
- Legal marriage age: 21 for males, 18 for females.
- Mandatory registration of marriages/divorces within 60 days.
- Mandatory registration of live-in relationships within 1 month (unregistered faces up to 6 months jail / ₹25,000 fine; children born from live-in relationships are deemed fully legitimate).
- Prohibits child marriage (up to 2 years imprisonment).
- *Constitutional Note*: Assam MLA Tuliram Ronghang simultaneously invoked **Article 244(A)** demanding an autonomous state within Assam for Karbi Anglong, West Karbi Anglong, and Dima Hasao.

Vande Mataram Under National Honour Law

- **Cabinet Approval**: 5 May 2026 approved amendment to **The Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971**.
- **Substantive Change**: Grants equal statutory penal protection to National Song **Vande Mataram** alongside National Anthem *Jana Gana Mana*. Intentionally preventing its singing or causing disturbance invites imprisonment up to 3 years, fine, or both (under Section 3 parity).
- **Historical Lineage**: Composed by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee (*Bangadarshan*, 1875 / *Anandamath*, 1882); first sung by Rabindranath Tagore at 1896 INC session; given equal honour by Constituent Assembly on 24 January 1950.

BCCI Status under RTI Act (CIC Landmark Ruling)

- **Ruling Date**: 18 May 2026 by the Central Information Commission (CIC).
- **Holding**: BCCI is **NOT a "public authority"** under **Section 2(h)** of the Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005.
- **Legal Grounds**: Registered as a private autonomous society under Tamil Nadu Societies Registration Act, 1975; is not substantially financed by the government; does not constitute "State" under **Article 12** of the Constitution.

Passive Euthanasia Procedure — Supreme Court (*Harish Rana Case*)

- **Case**: *Harish Rana v. Union of India* (decided 11 March 2026; Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K.V. Viswanathan).
- **Ruling**: Allowed withdrawal of life-sustaining treatment for a patient in a 13-year permanent vegetative state.
- **Constitutional Basis**: **Article 21** right to live with dignity includes the right to die with dignity (not an unrestricted right to die).
- **Simplified Procedure**: Replaced earlier cumbersome judicial-magistrate procedures with a two-tier medical board (Primary treating board + Secondary board with 2 specialists).
- **Evolution of Doctrine**: *Gian Kaur* (1996) $\rightarrow$ *Aruna Shanbaug* (2011) $\rightarrow$ *Common Cause* (2018 - 5-judge bench recognized Living Wills) $\rightarrow$ *Harish Rana* (2026).

Supreme Court Tech Initiatives: 'One Case One Data' and 'Su Sahayak'

- **Announced**: 11 May 2026 by CJI **Justice Surya Kant**.
- **'One Case One Data'**: Integrated data platform streamlining case management across all levels of the judiciary from taluka courts to the Supreme Court.
- **'Su Sahayak'**: AI-driven multilingual chatbot integrated into the Supreme Court website, developed by NIC with the SC Registry to assist litigants.

The Constitution (One Hundred & Thirty-First Amendment) Bill, 2026

- **Legislative Outcome**: Introduced on 16 April 2026; **FAILED in Lok Sabha on 17 April 2026** due to lack of the required two-thirds special majority under **Article 368**.
- **Voting Division**: 298 votes in favour, 230 against (528 present & voting $\implies$ 352 required; **fell short by 54 votes**).
- **Core Amendments Proposed**:
- **Article 81**: Proposed raising maximum Lok Sabha strength from **550 to 850 members** (815 from States, 35 from UTs).
- **Article 82 & 170**: Proposed restarting nationwide delimitation on a new census determined by Parliament.
- **Article 334A**: Sought to eliminate the waiting condition for a future census/delimitation enacted under the 106th Amendment Act (2023), thereby **advancing 33% Women's Reservation** immediately.
- **Article 55**: Redefined "population" impacting the vote value calculation of MLAs in Presidential elections.

Removal Motion Against Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla

- **Constitutional Provision**: Notice moved under **Article 94(c)** on 10 February 2026.
- **Presiding Rule (Article 96)**: Under Article 96, the Speaker **cannot preside** over the Lok Sabha while a resolution for his removal is under consideration (though he retains the right to speak and vote in the first instance).
- **Outcome**: Debated on 10–11 March 2026; **rejected by voice vote** in Lok Sabha on 11 March 2026.

77th Republic Day (26 January 2026) — Complete Honours List

- **Venue**: Kartavya Path, New Delhi.
- **Dual Themes**: **"150 Years of Vande Mataram"** (commemorating the 1875 national song composed by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee) and **Samriddhi ka Mantra - Atmanirbhar Bharat**.
- **Chief Guests**: **Mr. António Costa** (President of the European Council) and **Ms. Ursula von der Leyen** (President of the European Commission).
- **Judges Panel Winners**:
- **Best Marching Contingent (Services)**: **Indian Navy**.
- **Best Marching Contingent (CAPF/Auxiliary)**: **Delhi Police**.
- **Top State Tableaux**:
  1. **Maharashtra** (*Ganeshotsav: A Symbol of Aatmanirbharta*)
  2. **Jammu & Kashmir** (*Handicrafts and Folk Dances of J&K*)
  3. **Kerala** (*Water Metro & 100% Digital Literacy: Aatmanirbhar Kerala*)
- **Best Ministry Tableau**: **Ministry of Culture** (*Vande Mataram - The Soul Cry of a Nation*).
- **Popular Choice Winners (MyGov Citizen Voting)**:
- **Best Marching (Services)**: **Assam Regiment**.
- **Best Marching (CAPF)**: **CRPF**.
- **Top State Tableaux**:
  1. **Gujarat** (*Mantra of Swadeshi - Self-Reliance - Freedom: Vande Mataram*)
  2. **Uttar Pradesh** (*Culture of Bundelkhand*)
  3. **Rajasthan** (*Bikaner Gold Art / Usta Art*)
- **Best Ministry Tableau**: Department of School Education & Literacy (NEP 2020).

The Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2026

- **Assent**: 7 April 2026.
- **Scope**: Amends **79 Central Acts** administered by 23 ministries, decriminalising **784 provisions** to replace imprisonment with civil monetary penalties.
- **Major Examples**:
- *Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940*: Illegal cosmetics manufacture/sale attracts civil penalty of ₹1 lakh or 3x value (no jail).
- *National Highways Act, 1956*: Obstructing/damaging highways invites civil penalties of ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore instead of imprisonment.

- *Legal Metrology Act, 2009*: Establishes improvement notices for first-time non-compliance.

Indian Ports Act, 2025

- **Enactment**: Replaces the colonial **Indian Ports Act, 1908**.
- **Maritime State Development Council (MSDC)**: Conferred full statutory consultative status under the chairmanship of the Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways.
- **State Maritime Boards (SMBs)**: Granted statutory recognition.
- **Dispute Redressal**: Mandatory Dispute Resolution Committee (DRC) in each maritime state (appeals lie directly to the High Court; civil court jurisdiction barred).
- **Environmental Safeguards**: Enforces Port Waste Reception and Handling Plans under MARPOL and Ballast Water Management Conventions.
- **Mega Ports**: Empowers Central Government to notify designated high-capacity deep-water ports as "Mega Ports".

Supreme Court Advisory Opinion on 16th Presidential Reference (Article 143)

- **Constitutional Reference**: Special Reference 1 of 2025 referred 14 constitutional questions regarding Governors' power over State Bills under Articles 200, 201, 142, and 361.
- **Bench**: 5-Judge Constitution Bench (mandatory under **Article 145(3)**).
- **Core Holdings**:
- **Rejection of "Deemed Assent"**: Firmly rejected the April 2025 two-judge bench ruling (*State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu*) that purported to invent "deemed assent" under Article 142. The SC held that judicially assuming or granting assent violates the separation of powers.
- **No Rigid Timelines**: The Constitution intentionally avoids rigid deadlines for the Governor (Article 200) or President (Article 201); courts cannot fix artificial deadlines.
- **No Pocket Veto**: Governors cannot indefinitely delay or sit on Bills without reason; prolonged and unexplained inaction is unconstitutional and subject to limited judicial review.

The Constitution (One Hundred and Thirtieth Amendment) Bill, 2025

- **Introduction**: Introduced in Lok Sabha on 20 August 2025; referred to a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC).
- **Substantive Rule**: Mandates the **automatic removal from office** of the Prime Minister, Chief Minister, or any Union/State Minister if they are **arrested and detained in custody for 30 consecutive days** in connection with offences punishable with imprisonment of 5 years or more.
- **Constitutional Articles Amended**: **Article 75, Article 164, and Article 239AA**.

Pennaiyar River Water Dispute (Article 262)

- **Judicial Order**: On 2 February 2026, the Supreme Court directed the Union Government to notify and constitute an Inter-State Water Disputes Tribunal within one month.
- **Basin States**: **Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Union Territory of Puducherry**.
- **Historical Dispute**: Originates in Karnataka, flows through Tamil Nadu; dispute centers on the validity and interpretation of the 1892 Madras-Mysore agreement.

Election of 15th Vice President of India

- **Election Date**: 9 September 2025 (sworn in 12 September 2025).
- **Victor**: NDA candidate **C.P. Radhakrishnan** elected as the **15th Vice President of India**.
- **Margin**: Secured **452 first-preference votes**, defeating INDIA bloc candidate Justice B. Sudershan Reddy (former Supreme Court judge) who received 300 votes (out of 767 cast).

Bihar Political Shift (April 2026)

- **Resignation**: Nitish Kumar (who had taken oath for a record 10th term in November 2025) resigned as Chief Minister on 14 April 2026.
- **Historic Oath**: On 15 April 2026, **Samrat Chaudhary** took oath as the **first Chief Minister of Bihar from the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)**.

National Sports Governance Act, 2025

- **Enactment**: Passed August 2025 (assented 18 August 2025).
- **Core Reforms**:
- Defines national sports bodies across 4 levels: National Olympic Committee, National Paralympic Committee, National Sports Federations, and Regional Sports Federations.

- **Gender Inclusion**: Mandates that the Executive Committee (maximum 15 members) must include **at least 4 women members**, 2 sportspersons of outstanding merit, and 2 elected athlete representatives.
- **Tenure & Age Restrictions**: Caps the age limit of office bearers at **70 years** (conditional exemption up to 75); maximum 3 terms with mandatory cooling-off periods.
- **National Sports Tribunal**: Establishes a specialized tribunal headed by a sitting/former Supreme Court judge or High Court Chief Justice for athlete dispute redressal.

Election Commission of India: Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in Bihar

- **Constitutional & Statutory Powers**: Ordered under **Article 324** and **Section 21(3) of the Representation of the People Act, 1950**.
- **Nature of Exercise**: Complete door-to-door physical verification by Booth Level Officers (BLOs) to reconstruct electoral rolls from scratch. (Last comprehensive special intensive revision in India was conducted in 2003).
- **Timeline**: Guidelines issued 24 June 2025; Qualifying date: **1 July 2025**; Final roll published: **30 September 2025**.
- **Historic Polling Station Milestone**: On 21 July 2025, Bihar became the **first state in India where every polling station has fewer than 1,200 electors** (ceiling reduced from 1,500). To achieve this, **12,817 new polling stations** were added (total increasing from 77,895 to **90,712**).
- **Appeals Route**: Lies under **Section 24 of RPA 1950** and **Rule 27 of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960**.
- **Documentary Proofs**: Flexible list of 11 approved foundational documents; Supreme Court (10 July 2025) directed ECI to consider Aadhaar card, Voter ID, and Ration card as valid proofs.

Renaming of 'Kerala' to 'Keralam' (Article 3)

- **Cabinet Decision**: On **24 February 2026**, the Union Cabinet approved the proposal to rename the State of "Kerala" to **"Keralam"**.
- **Constitutional Procedure**: Followed a resolution unanimously passed by the Kerala Legislative Assembly on **24 June 2024** under **Article 3** of the Constitution to amend the First Schedule.

Kerala Declared First Fully Digitally Literate State

- **Declaration Date**: On **21 August 2025**, Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan declared **Kerala** as the **first fully digitally literate state in India** following the completion of its mass grassroots digital empowerment initiative.

Yuge Yugeen Bharat National Museum

- **World Record Scale**: Set to become the **world's largest museum**, covering approximately **1.17 to 1.55 lakh square metres** with nearly **950 rooms**.
- **Location**: Housed in the historic **North and South Blocks** on Raisina Hill, New Delhi (under the Central Vista Redevelopment Project), replacing the existing National Museum.
- **Rollout**: First gallery, themed ***"Time and Timelessness"***, is scheduled to open by **end-2026**.

Centenary of Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) & ₹100 Coin

- **Event**: Celebrated on **1 October 2025** at Dr. Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi. PM Narendra Modi attended as Chief Guest.
- **Foundational Fact**: RSS was founded on Vijayadashami in **1925 at Nagpur** by **Dr. Keshav Baliram Hedgewar**.
- **Commemorative ₹100 Coin**: Pure silver non-circulating commemorative coin. The reverse features **"Bharat Mata" seated on a lion in Varada Mudra**, flanked by three swayamsevaks — marking the **first time in independent India that the image of Bharat Mata has appeared on an Indian coin**.

Reclassification of Limestone as a Major Mineral (MMDR Act, 1957)

- **Order Date**: Effective from **10 October 2025**, the Ministry of Mines reclassified **all limestone as a "Major Mineral"** under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957.
- **Regulatory Reform**: Abolished the historical arbitrary distinction between lime (minor mineral for kilns/building) and industrial-grade limestone (major mineral for cement/steel), ensuring transparent auctioning and nationwide regulatory uniformity.

India's First Gigawatt-Scale Data Centre & AI Hub (Visakhapatnam)

- **Announcement**: October 2025 with an investment of **US$ 15 billion** by a global tech corporation.
- **Capacity**: India's first AI hub with gigawatt-scale compute capacity for AI, cloud, and high-performance computing (HPC) services, supported by Andhra Pradesh state incentives.

India's First Cooperative Multi-Feed CBG Plant (Maharashtra)

- **Inauguration**: 5 October 2025 at **Kopargaon, Ahilyanagar district (Maharashtra)** by Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah.
- **Capacity**: Produces **~12 tonnes of Compressed Bio-Gas (CBG)** and **~75 tonnes of potash granules daily** using sugarcane press mud and distillery spent wash/molasses.

Jammu & Kashmir Chrysanthemum Garden (Srinagar)

- **Inauguration**: 25 October 2025 by CM Omar Abdullah at **Nehru Memorial Botanical Garden, Srinagar**.
- **Scale & Purpose**: Spread over **100 kanals (12.5 hectares)** (cost: ₹1.86 crore); conceived to extend Kashmir's tourist season into autumn beyond the spring tulip bloom.

9th India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2025

- **Dates & Venue**: **8 to 11 October 2025** at **Yashobhoomi (IICC)**, Dwarka, New Delhi.
- **Organisers**: Department of Telecommunications (DoT) and Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI).
- **Theme**: ***"Innovate to Transform"***.

Green Mobility Initiative & Suzuki e-VITARA Launch

- **Date & Place**: **26 August 2025** at **Hansalpur, Gujarat**, inaugurated by PM Narendra Modi.
- **Milestone**: Flagged off Suzuki's first India-manufactured global strategic battery electric vehicle (BEV) named **'e-VITARA'** for export and domestic markets.

150th Birth Anniversary of Bhagwan Birsa Munda

- **Observance**: Celebrated on **15 November 2025** as **Janjatiya Gaurav Divas**.
- **Janjatiya Gaurav Varsh (JJGV)**: Observed by the Ministry of Tribal Affairs from 15 November 2024 to 15 November 2025, culminating in a nationwide fortnight (*Janjatiya Gaurav Varsh Pakhwada*, 1–15 Nov 2025).

Central Opium Cultivation License Policy 2025–26

- **Notification**: Notified for the crop year **1 October 2025 to 30 September 2026** regulating licensed poppy cultivation across notified tracts in Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Uttar Pradesh.

October 2026

Assembly Elections: Haryana & Jammu and Kashmir (October 2026)

Haryana Assembly Election & Swearing-In - **Election Result:** The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) won an absolute majority with **48 out of 90 seats**, clinching a historic third consecutive term in Haryana (Congress won 37 seats, INLD 2, Independents 3). - **Swearing-In (17 October 2026): Nayab Singh Saini** took oath as Chief Minister of Haryana for his second term at Dussehra Ground in Panchkula. - **Oath Administered By:** Haryana Governor **Bandaru Dattatreya**.

Jammu & Kashmir Assembly Election & Historic UT Government - **First Assembly Polls in a Decade:** First assembly elections held in Jammu & Kashmir in 10 years (since 2014) and the first since the abrogation of Article 370 and bifurcation into Union Territories in August 2019. - **Result:** The Jammu & Kashmir National Conference (JKNC) – Congress alliance secured majority, with NC winning **42 seats** (Congress 6, BJP 29, PDP 3). - **Historic Swearing-In (16 October 2026): Omar Abdullah** was sworn in as the **first Chief Minister of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir** at the Sher-i-Kashmir International Convention Centre (SKICC), Srinagar. - **Oath Administered By:** Lieutenant Governor **Manoj Sinha**. - **Deputy Chief Minister: Surinder Kumar Choudhary** (MLA from Nowshera, Jammu region) took oath as Deputy Chief Minister, establishing balanced regional representation between Jammu and the Kashmir Valley.

PM Modi's National Airport & Healthcare Blitz | 20 October 2026

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** dedicated and laid foundation stones for multiple strategic civil aviation, sports, and healthcare projects totaling over **₹6,700 crore** anchored from Varanasi.

Key Infrastructure Landmarks - **Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport, Varanasi:** Foundation laid for ₹2,870 crore runway expansion to **4,075 metres** and new terminal building to accommodate wide-body long-haul airliners. - **Regional Airport Enclaves under UDAN:** - **Sarsawa Airport (Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh):** Inauguration of new civil enclave connecting Western UP. - **Rewa Airport (Madhya Pradesh):** Dedicated as MP's 6th operational airport. - **Maa Mahamaya Airport (Ambikapur, Chhattisgarh):** New terminal opened in tribal Northern Chhattisgarh. - **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital (Varanasi):** 225-bed modern eye hospital providing 70% free surgical care to underprivileged citizens. - **Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Complex (Sigra Stadium, Varanasi):** Inaugurated Phases 2 and 3 redeveloped under Khelo India and Smart City Mission (₹210+ crore).

Approval of 5 New Classical Languages (Total Reaches 11)

- On **3 October 2026**, the Union Cabinet approved Classical Language status for **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali**.
- Total recognized Classical Languages in India expanded from 6 to **11**.
- Detailed criteria and constitutional distinctions → Schemes & Policies and Culture.

PART C · TOPICS

07 — Indices & Reports

> **Priority A** | Earlier about **7%** as a separate topic Today, ranks often hide inside Economy, Environment, or UP questions.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Who published it?	NITI, UNDP, WEF, RBI, and so on
What is India's rank or score?	Exact number or band
Who is on top?	Top country or top Indian state
What is left out of the calculation?	Classic trap in HDI-type questions
Any UP angle?	Performer / Aspirant / state rank

High-Yield Indices Foundation Matrix (2025–2026)

> **UPPCS Direct Hit Formula:** Match the Index with the Publishing Body, India's Rank, and the #1 Nation:

Index / Report	Publishing Organisation	India's Rank	Top Performer	High-Yield Note
World Happiness Report 2026	UN SDSN	**116th** (out of 147)	**Finland** (9th year)	Iceland #2, Denmark #3
World Press Freedom Index 2026	Reporters Without Borders (RSF)	**157th**	Norway	Categorised under "Difficult situation"
Global Terrorism Index (GTI 2026)	Institute for Economics & Peace (IEP)	**13th**	**Pakistan** (#1 most affected)	IEP headquarters in Sydney
Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI 2025)	Transparency International (Berlin)	**91st** (out of 182)	Denmark	Released Feb 2026
Energy Transition Index (ETI 2026)	World Economic Forum (WEF)	**70th**	**Sweden**	DR Congo ranked last (120th)
Global Innovation Index (GII 2025)	WIPO	**38th**	Switzerland	Top 40 consistency
Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI 2026)	Germanwatch / NewClimate	**23rd**	No country in Top 3	Released Nov 2025
Asia Power Index 2025	Lowy Institute (Australia)	**3rd**	1st: USA, 2nd: China	Measures power in Indo-Pacific
Asia Manufacturing Index (AMI 2026)	—	**6th**	**China**	Regional manufacturing competitiveness
Global Startup Ecosystem Report 2026	Startup Genome	**Bengaluru (15th)**	Silicon Valley	Beijing is Asia's top AI cluster
Numbeo Crime Index 2026	Numbeo	—	**Abu Dhabi**	Safest city in the world
Scenarios Towards Viksit Bharat and Net Zero	**NITI Aayog** (Feb 2026)	Multi-sectoral Roadmap	—	11 study reports outlining $30T Viksit Bharat by 2047 and Net Zero by 2070.

January 2026

Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0 and aspirational rankings

What happened NITI Aayog's **Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0** is not a new global index. It is a drive to improve indicators in aspirational districts and blocks. Still, questions may mix it with ranking language.

Core facts

- Runner: **NITI Aayog**.
- Dates: **28 January to 14 April 2026**.
- Linked programmes: **ADP (112 districts, since 2018)** and **ABP (513 blocks, since 2023)**.

- Full scheme card → Schemes.

No clean new global index release was locked as a must-score card for January in this pass.

February 2026

"Scenarios Towards Viksit Bharat and Net Zero" | NITI Aayog | February 2026

What happened In February 2026, **NITI Aayog** released an 11-volume comprehensive assessment titled **"Scenarios Towards Viksit Bharat and Net Zero"**, representing India's first government-led, multi-sectoral roadmap to simultaneously achieve a developed economy (*Viksit Bharat*) by **2047** and **Net Zero greenhouse gas emissions by 2070**.

Core facts & Prelims Traps - **Publishing Body: NITI Aayog** (Trap: Not Ministry of Environment, MoEFCC, or Ministry of Finance). - **Working Group Architecture:** Developed collaboratively by **10 inter-ministerial working groups**. - **Economic & Decarbonization Targets:** - Projects Indian economy reaching **USD 30 Trillion by 2047**. - Requires cumulative investment of **USD 22.7 trillion by 2070** for green transition. - Shifts India from a consumption-led model to an investment-driven, green-manufacturing economy. - **Key Levers:** Mass electrification, expansion of nuclear and renewable capacity, battery storage, green hydrogen, and circular economy under Mission LiFE.

Multidimensional poverty figure in the Budget speech

What happened In the Budget speech, the Finance Minister said that close to **25 crore** people have come out of multidimensional poverty through years of government programmes.

How to use this

- Treat **25 crore** as a Budget-speech figure.
- When a fresh Multidimensional Poverty Index report is released, separately fact the **publisher** and the exact method.

16th Finance Commission

- Chairperson: **Arvind Panagariya**.
- Report submitted: **17 November 2025**.
- Accepted for use from **2026–27 to 2030–31**.
- About **₹1.4 lakh crore** was provided to states as Finance Commission grants in the FY 2026–27 Budget.

Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI 2025) | February 2026

- **Publisher: Transparency International** (HQ: Berlin, Germany).
- **India's Rank: 91st** among 182 countries/territories.
- **Top Performer: Denmark**.

Energy Transition Index 2026 (ETI 2026)

- **Publisher: World Economic Forum (WEF)**.
- **India's Rank: 70th**.
- **Top 3 Countries: Sweden** (1st), followed by Finland (2nd) and Denmark (3rd).
- **Lowest Rank:** Democratic Republic of the Congo (120th).

UP ranking note

February state compilations said Uttar Pradesh topped a **Deregulation 1.0** national ranking. Keep the claim under UP Special. Add the exact publisher name when you fact an official note.

March 2026

World Happiness Report 2026 | released around 20 March 2026

What happened The **World Happiness Report 2026** ranked countries by how happy people say they feel.

Core facts

- **Finland** stayed at **rank 1** (ninth year in a row in report messaging).
- **India** was placed around **rank 116** in coverage of this edition.
- Revise the publisher family carefully from the report cover when practising Match List.

Global Terrorism Index 2026

- Publisher: **Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)**.

- **Pakistan** was reported at the top for the first time in this cycle.

QS / Hurun style lists (soft)

March compilations also recycled university and rich-list ranks. Add exact top names only when a question pattern needs them.

April 2026

Soft ranking / report month

April was quieter for brand-new global ranks. Keep these ready:

Report	Publisher / top fact	India fact
World Happiness Report 2026	**Finland** #1	About **116**
Global Terrorism Index 2026	**IEP**; Pakistan at top	Revise under International

Census as a data mega-event

Census 2027 Phase 1 is a **national counting exercise**, not a private think-tank index. Still revise: money about **₹11,718 crore**, mascots **Pragati** and **Vikas**, and the two-phase calendar under Schemes.

May 2026

Henley Passport Index 2026

What happened The **Henley Passport Index** ranked passports by visa-free access.

Core facts

- Publisher family: **Henley & Partners** (uses IATA data).
- Top passport in coverage: **Singapore** (about **192** visa-free destinations).
- **India** around **rank 78** (about **56** visa-free destinations).

World Press Freedom Index 2026 | May 2026

What happened Reporters Sans Frontières (**RSF** / Reporters Without Borders) released the 2026 edition of the World Press Freedom Index.

Core facts - **Publisher: RSF** (HQ: Paris, France). - **India's Rank: 157th**. - **Category:** India was classified in the **"Difficult situation"** bracket (RSF classifies countries into 5 categories: Good, Satisfactory, Problematic, Difficult, Very Serious).

Sample Registration System (SRS) Bulletin 2024 | May 2026

What happened The Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India (**ORGI**, Ministry of Home Affairs) released the **SRS Bulletin 2024**, tracking national demographic trends.

Core demographic indicators - **Birth Rate:** Dropped from **21 per 1,000 population** (in 2014) to **18.3 per 1,000 population** (in 2024). - **Death Rate:** Dropped from **6.7 per 1,000 population** (in 2014) to **6.4 per 1,000 population** (in 2024).

Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0 (PAI 2.0) | 24 April 2026

What happened The Ministry of Panchayati Raj released the **Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI) 2.0 Report** on the occasion of National Panchayati Raj Day (24 April 2026) evaluating Gram Panchayats across 9 localized SDG themes.

Core facts - **Coverage**: **2,59,867 Gram Panchayats** participated (97.3% coverage across 27 States and 6 UTs). - **Non-participating State**: **West Bengal was the ONLY state that did not participate** (submitted zero data). - **Grade Breakdown**: - **Grade A+ (Achiever, $\ge$90%)**: **Zero (0)** Panchayats in India. - **Grade A (Front Runner, 75–89%)**: **3,635** Panchayats. **Tripura ranked #1** with **943 Front Runner Panchayats** (out of 1,176), followed by Telangana (624) and Andhra Pradesh (591). - **Grade B (Performer, 60–74%)**: 1,18,824 Panchayats (**Uttar Pradesh ranked #1** in absolute count with 18,905). - **Grade D (Beginner, <40%)**: 13,689 Panchayats (**Uttar Pradesh ranked #1** in absolute count with 6,124).

Crime in India Report 2024 (NCRB) | May 2026

What happened The National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) released its annual **Crime in India 2024** report, the first to incorporate cases registered under the **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS)** alongside the IPC.

Core facts - **Total Registered Criminal Cases**: **58.85 lakh** cases (6% decline from 62.41 lakh in 2023). Crime rate dropped from 448.3 to **418.9 per lakh population**. - **Cybercrime Surge**: Recorded **1,01,928 cases** (a **17.9% increase** over 2023). **72.6% of cybercrime was financial fraud** (73,987 cases). - **Crimes Against Women**: - **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1** in total crimes against women (**66,398 cases**), followed by Maharashtra (47,954) and West Bengal (34,360). - **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in Dowry**

Deaths (**2,038 cases / 2,057 victims**), followed by Bihar (1,078). - Domestic cruelty by husband/relatives accounted for **27.2%** of all crimes against women. - **Crimes Against Scheduled Castes (SC)**: Total 55,698 cases. **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1** with **14,642 cases**. - **Crimes Against Scheduled Tribes (ST)**: Total 9,966 cases (down 23.1%). **Madhya Pradesh ranked #1** with **3,165 cases**. - **Charge-Sheet Efficiency**: **Kerala ranked #1** among states with a **94.5% charge-sheeting rate** (Puducherry 91%, West Bengal 90.6%). - **Drug Overdose Deaths**: Rose 50% to **978 deaths**. **Tamil Nadu reported highest** (313 deaths), followed by Punjab (106).

NITI Aayog School Education System Report | May 2026

What happened NITI Aayog released a comprehensive evaluation titled *"School Education System in India: Temporal Analysis and Policy Roadmap for Quality Enhancement"*, synthesizing UDISE+, PARAKH 2024, and NAS data.

Core facts - **Scale of School Network**: **14.71 lakh schools** serving over **24.69 crore students**. - **Primary vs Higher Secondary Access**: Near-universal access achieved at primary level; Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) at Higher Secondary level stands at **58.4%**. - **Key Bottleneck Identified**: Sharp drop in transition rates post-upper-primary and acute need for digital infrastructure in smaller/remote rural schools.

NIRF India Rankings 2025 (10th Edition) | Released September 2025

What happened The Ministry of Education released the 10th edition of the **National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) 2025**, evaluating 7,692 participating institutions across 5 core parameters: TLR (30%), RPC (30%), GO (20%), OI (10%), and Perception (10%).

Core category leaders - **Overall Category**: **IIT Madras** (**Rank 1** for the 7th consecutive year, 2019–2025). - **Universities Category**: **IISc Bengaluru** (**Rank 1** for the 10th consecutive year). - **Colleges Category**: **Hindu College, Delhi** (**Rank 1** for 2nd consecutive year; Miranda House #2). - **Engineering**: **IIT Madras** (**Rank 1** for the 10th consecutive year). - **Management**: **IIM Ahmedabad** (**Rank 1**). - **Medical**: **AIIMS New Delhi** (**Rank 1**). - **Pharmacy**: **Jamia Hamdard, New Delhi** (**Rank 1**). - **Law**: **NLSIU Bengaluru** (**Rank 1** for the 8th consecutive year). - **Architecture & Planning**: **IIT Roorkee** (**Rank 1**). - **Innovation Category & SDGs Category**: **IIT Madras** (**Rank 1** in both).

UDISE+ 2024–25 School Education Statistics

What happened The Ministry of Education released the **Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+) 2024–25** report, tracking national school infrastructure, enrollment, and teaching personnel.

Core statistical milestones - **Teacher Strength Crossed 1 Crore**: Total teachers increased to **1,01,22,420** (a 6.7% expansion over 2022–23). - **Pupil-Teacher Ratio (PTR)**: - Foundational: **10** - Preparatory: **13** - Middle: **17** - Secondary: **21** - *(All categories significantly outperform the NEP 2020 national benchmark of $\le 30:1$).* - **Annual Dropout Rates**: - Preparatory: **2.3%** - Middle: **3.5%** - Secondary: **8.2%** (down from 10.9%). - **Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)**: Middle school at **90.3%**; Secondary school at **68.5%**. - **Digital Infrastructure**: **64.7%** of schools have computers; **63.5%** have internet connectivity. Basic amenities: drinking water in **99.3%**, electricity in **93.6%**, girls' toilets in **97.3%**.

NITI Aayog: Internationalisation of Higher Education in India

- **Report Title**: *"Internationalisation of Higher Education in India: Prospects, Potential, and Policy Recommendations"*.
- **Inbound–Outbound Student Ratio**:
- 2021: **1:24**
- 2022: **1:19** (for every 1 international student studying in India, **28 Indian students** go abroad).
- **Overseas Education Expenditure**:
- Projected to reach **₹6.2 lakh crore by 2025** (~**2% of India's GDP** and ~**75% of India's annual trade deficit** in FY 2024–25).
- **Foreign Student Inflow**:
- India hosted approximately **47,000 international students** in 2022.
- Potential projected to scale to **7.89 to 11 lakh international students by 2047** with systemic credit transfers, streamlined visa regimes, and global campus branch integration.

Swachh Survekshan 2024–25 — Complete National Rankings Matrix

- **Administering Ministry**: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).
- **Super Swachh League (Top Performers by Population)**:
- **>10 Lakh Category**:
  1. **Indore** (Madhya Pradesh)
  2. **Surat** (Gujarat)
  3. **Navi Mumbai** (Maharashtra)
  4. **Vijayawada** (Andhra Pradesh)

- **3–10 Lakh Category**:
  5. **Noida** (Uttar Pradesh)
  6. **Chandigarh**
  7. **Mysuru** (Karnataka)
  8. **Ujjain** (Madhya Pradesh)
  9. **Gandhinagar** (Gujarat)
  10. **Guntur** (Andhra Pradesh)
- **50,000–3 Lakh Category**: 11. **NDMC** (Delhi), 12. **Tirupati** (AP), 13. **Ambikapur** (CG), 14. **Lonavala** (MH).
- **20,000–50,000 Category**: 15. **Vita** (MH), 16. **Saswad** (MH), 17. **Deolali Pravara** (MH), 18. **Dungarpur** (RJ).
- **<20,000 Category**: 19. **Panchgani** (MH), 20. **Patan** (CG), 21. **Panhala** (MH), 22. **Bishrampur** (CG), 23. **Budni** (MP).
- **Presidential Awardees: Swachh Shehar (5 Population Categories)**:
- **>10 Lakh**: 1. **Ahmedabad** (Gujarat), 2. **Bhopal** (Madhya Pradesh), 3. **Lucknow** (Uttar Pradesh).
- **3–10 Lakh**: 4. **Mira-Bhayandar** (Maharashtra), 5. **Bilaspur** (Chhattisgarh), 6. **Jamshedpur** (Jharkhand).
- **50,000–3 Lakh**: 7. **Dewas** (Madhya Pradesh), 8. **Karhad** (Maharashtra), 9. **Karnal** (Haryana).
- **20,000–50,000**: 10. **Panaji** (Goa), 11. **Aska** (Odisha), 12. **Kumhari** (Chhattisgarh).
- **<20,000**: 13. **Bilha** (Chhattisgarh), 14. **Chikiti** (Odisha), 15. **Shahganj** (Madhya Pradesh).
- **Safaimitra Surakshit Shehar (Top 5)**: 1. **GVMC Visakhapatnam** (Andhra Pradesh) 2. **Jabalpur** (Madhya Pradesh) 3. **Gorakhpur** (Uttar Pradesh) 4. **Secunderabad Cantt.** (Telangana) 5. **Prayagraj** (Uttar Pradesh)
- **Cleanest Ganga City**: **Prayagraj** (Uttar Pradesh).
- **Special Ministerial Recognition**: **Swachh Mahakumbh 2025 (Prayagraj)** awarded special recognition by MoHUA.

June 2026

QS World University Rankings 2027

What happened The new QS university ranking cycle placed **MIT (USA)** at the top again. About **52** Indian institutions featured in coverage.

Core facts

- Global top: **MIT**.
- Top Indian institute in coverage: **IIT Delhi** around **rank 118**.

QS World Future Skills Index 2027

What happened QS also released a Future Skills Index on how ready countries are for new-age work skills.

Core facts

- Top country: **USA**.
- **India** around **rank 13**.

Soft statistical day

National Statistics Day is **29 June** (P. C. Mahalanobis birth anniversary). Theme in coverage: Unlocking the Potential of Administrative Data.

July 2026

SOFI 2026 | State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World

What happened The **SOFI 2026** report was released by five UN agencies, including the **FAO**.

Core facts

- Global hunger in 2025 coverage: about **645 million** people (**7.8%**), down from **8.6%** in 2022.
- Healthy diets remain unaffordable for about **2.7 billion** people.
- Nutrient-dense foods (fruits, vegetables, animal-source foods) drive most of the cost of a healthy diet.

Soft population day

World Population Day is **11 July**. Theme in coverage: Realising the hopes and aspirations of young people – today and for the future.

August 2026

Soft ranking month

August was quieter for new global indices. Keep ready:

Report	Fact
SOFI 2026	Hunger about **645 million** (7.8%); healthy diet costly for about **2.7 billion**
QS / Future Skills (June)	MIT top; IIT Delhi ~118; India Future Skills ~13

Soft Hurun women leaders list

A Candere Hurun India Women Leaders list put **Meena Bindra** (BIBA) at the top. Para shooter **Avani Lekhara** appeared in the top ten.

In-Depth Global Indices & Rankings (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

1. Global Peace Index (GPI) 2026 | Released 9 June 2026

- **Publisher**: **Institute for Economics & Peace (IEP)**, Sydney.
- **Key Finding**: Global peacefulness is at its lowest point since the index's inception due to escalating militarization and regional wars.
- **Global Leaders (Top 5)**: 1. **Iceland** (remains the world's most peaceful country since 2008) 2. **New Zealand** 3. **Switzerland** 4. **Slovenia** 5. **Ireland**
- **Bottom 5 Least Peaceful**: **Russia** (163rd / least peaceful), Sudan, Democratic Republic of Congo, Ukraine, Israel.
- **United States**: Ranked **134th** globally.
- **India's Ranking**: **127th out of 163 countries** (fell from 115th in 2025).
- **South Asian Order**: **Bhutan** leads the region at **16th** globally $\rightarrow$ Sri Lanka (67th) $\rightarrow$ Nepal (111th) $\rightarrow$ Bangladesh (117th) $\rightarrow$ **India (127th)** $\rightarrow$ Pakistan (152nd) $\rightarrow$ Afghanistan (157th).

2. World Competitiveness Ranking 2026 | Released 18 June 2026

- **Publisher**: **IMD Business School** (Switzerland); assesses 70 global economies.
- **Four Core Pillars**: Economic Performance, Government Efficiency, Business Efficiency, and Infrastructure.
- **Top 5 Economies**: 1. **Singapore** (reclaimed the #1 global spot) 2. **Hong Kong SAR** 3. **Switzerland** 4. **Taiwan** 5. **United Arab Emirates (UAE)**
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 44th** out of 70 economies.

3. EIU Democracy Index 2025 | Published April 2026

- **Publisher**: **Economist Intelligence Unit (EIU)**.
- **Classification of India**: Categorized as a ***"Flawed Democracy"***; overall score fell by -0.33 points, dropping India to **45th rank globally**.
- **Top 5 Democracies**: 1. **Norway** 2. **New Zealand** 3. **Denmark** 4. **Iceland** 5. **Switzerland**
- **Bottom Ranked**: **Afghanistan** (167th rank / lowest globally, alongside North Korea).

4. SIPRI Yearbook 2026 (57th Edition) | Released 8 June 2026

- **Publisher**: **Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI)**.
- **Nuclear Warhead Inventories**:
- **Russia**: 5,420 total inventory (1,796 deployed).
- **United States**: 5,042 total inventory (1,770 deployed).
- **China**: 620 total inventory (34 deployed).
- **France**: 370 total inventory (280 deployed).
- **United Kingdom**: 225 total inventory (120 deployed).
- **India**: **190 total warheads** (12 deployed).
- **Pakistan**: **170 total warheads** (0 deployed).
- *(Crucial Prelims Fact: India possesses 190 nuclear warheads, having surpassed Pakistan's stockpile of 170).*
- **Military Expenditure 2025 (Top 5 Spenders)**: 1. **United States**: $954.0 billion (-7.5%) 2. **China**: $336.0 billion (+7.4%) 3. **Russia**: $190.0 billion (+5.9%) 4. **Germany**: $114.0 billion (+24.0%) 5. **India**: **$92.1 billion** (+8.9% increase over 2024; 5th largest military spender globally).

- **International Arms Transfers (2021–2025 Trend)**:
- **Top Arms Importers**: 1. **Ukraine (9.7%)**, 2. **India (8.2%)**, 3. Saudi Arabia (6.8%), 4. Qatar (6.4%), 5. Pakistan (4.2%).
- **Top Arms Exporters**: 1. **United States (42.0%)**, 2. **France (9.8%)**, 3. **Russia (6.8%)**, 4. Germany (5.7%), 5. China (5.6%).

5. QS World University Rankings 2027 | Released 18 June 2026

- **Publisher**: **Quacquarelli Symonds (QS)**; evaluated >1,500 institutions across 106 nations.
- **Global Top 3**: 1. **MIT (USA)** — Top spot for the **15th consecutive year**. 2. **Imperial College London** and **Stanford University** (tied for 2nd).
- **Indian Institutions (52 featured — 5th most represented nation)**:
- **IIT Delhi**: **Rank 118** (highest-ranked Indian institution, up from 123).
- **IIT Bombay**: Rank 134.
- **IIT Madras**: Rank 170.
- **IIT Kharagpur**: Rank 205.
- **IISc Bangalore**: Rank 221.
- **IIT Kanpur**: **Rank 222** (maintained; premier UP institution).
- **University of Delhi**: Rank 323.
- **IIT Roorkee**: Rank 335.
- **IIT Guwahati**: Rank 350.
- **Shoolini University**: **Rank 454** (**Highest-ranked private university in India**).

6. World Press Freedom Index 2026

- **Publisher**: **Reporters Without Borders (RSF — Reporters Sans Frontières)**.
- **Global Pattern**: Evaluates 180 countries across 5 indicators: Political, Legal Framework, Economic, Sociocultural, and Safety.
- **Top 5 Countries**: 1. **Norway**, 2. Netherlands, 3. Estonia, 4. Denmark, 5. Sweden.
- **Bottom 5 Countries**: 176. Saudi Arabia, 177. Iran, 178. China, 179. North Korea, 180. **Eritrea**.
- **India's Standing**:
- **Rank 157th out of 180 countries** (Score: **32.96**; dropped 6 spots from 151st in 2025).
- Classified in the ***"Very Serious"*** category.
- **South Asian Order (India is lowest in South Asia)**: Nepal (87th) $\rightarrow$ Maldives (108th) $\rightarrow$ Sri Lanka (134th) $\rightarrow$ Bhutan (150th) $\rightarrow$ Bangladesh (152nd) $\rightarrow$ Pakistan (153rd) $\rightarrow$ **India (157th)**.

7. World Happiness Report 2026 | Released 19 March 2026

- **Publisher**: Wellbeing Research Centre (University of Oxford) with Gallup, UN SDSN.
- **Metric**: Cantril Ladder (0 to 10 scale) using 6 variables: GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity, and corruption perceptions. Special focus on *Social Media and Wellbeing*.
- **Top 5 Happiest**: 1. **Finland** (Score: 7.764 — **#1 for the 9th consecutive year**) 2. **Iceland** 3. **Denmark** 4. **Costa Rica** (standout non-Nordic performer) 5. **Sweden**
- **Bottom 5**: 143. Botswana, 144. Zimbabwe, 145. Malawi, 146. Sierra Leone, 147. **Afghanistan** (1.446 — least happy).
- **India's Ranking**: **116th out of 147 countries**. (In South Asia, Nepal and Pakistan rank happier than India; Bangladesh and Sri Lanka rank lower).

8. Global Terrorism Index (GTI) 2026 | Released March 2026

- **Publisher**: **Institute for Economics & Peace (IEP)**, Sydney (13th edition; 163 countries).
- **Global Trend**: Global terrorism deaths dropped by 28%; incidents decreased by 22%. The **Sahel region** in Sub-Saharan Africa accounts for >50% of global deaths.
- **Most Impacted Country**: **Pakistan ranked #1 in the world** (highest terrorism impact).
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 13th** (Score: 6.428); Left-Wing Extremism (LWE) showed a continuing decline.

9. Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) 2025 | Released 10 February 2026

- **Publisher**: **Transparency International** (Secretariat in Berlin, Germany; founded 1993).
- **Scale**: 0 (highly corrupt) to 100 (very clean); evaluated 182 countries. Global average fell to 42.
- **Top Performers**: 1. **Denmark** (Score: **89/100** — **#1 for the 8th consecutive year**) 2. **Finland** (88) 3. **Singapore** (84) 4. **New Zealand & Norway** (81)
- **Least Clean**: **South Sudan & Somalia** (Score: 9), Venezuela (10), Syria & North Korea (15).
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 91st** with a score of **39 out of 100**. (Bhutan: 71, China: 43, India: 39, Pakistan: 28, Bangladesh: 24).

10. International Intellectual Property (IP) Index 2026 | March 2026

- **Publisher**: **U.S. Chamber of Commerce** (14th edition; evaluates 55 economies across 53 criteria).
- **Top 4 Economies**: 1. **United States (95.15%)**, 2. UK (93.98%), 3. France (93.11%), 4. Germany (92.02%).
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 43rd out of 55 economies** (Score: **36.91%**; maintained 43rd rank from 2025).

11. Network Readiness Index (NRI) 2025 | Released 4 February 2026

- **Publisher**: **Portulans Institute** (assesses 127 economies across 4 pillars: Technology, People, Governance, Impact).
- **Theme**: *"AI Governance in a Global Context: Policy and Regulatory Approaches"*.
- **Top 5**: 1. **United States** (79.13), 2. Finland, 3. Singapore, 4. Denmark, 5. Sweden.
- **India's Standing**: Jumped to **45th position globally** (Score: **54.43**), reflecting accelerated digital public infrastructure deployment.
- **Sub-Rankings**: India ranked **2nd among lower-middle-income countries** (behind Vietnam) and **3rd globally** on domestic market scale and income inequality indicators.

12. Responsible Nations Index (RNI) 2026 | Released 19 January 2026

- **Launch & Publisher**: Launched in New Delhi by former President **Ram Nath Kovind**; published by the **World Intellectual Foundation (WIF)** and developed collaboratively by **WIF, Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), and IIM Mumbai**.
- **Framework**: Evaluates 154 countries utilizing World Bank, UN agencies, and World Justice Project datasets to establish an objective, non-Western, non-GDP-centric assessment of national responsibility.
- **Top 5 Nations**: 1. **Singapore** (0.61945) 2. Switzerland (0.58692) 3. Denmark (0.58372) 4. Cyprus (0.57737) 5. Sweden (0.57397)
- **Lowest Ranked**: Afghanistan, North Korea, Yemen, Syria, Central African Republic.
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 16th globally** (Score: **0.551513**), reflecting strong balanced governance and multilateral responsibility.

13. The Global Risks Report 2026 | Released 14 January 2026

- **Publisher**: **World Economic Forum (WEF)** (21st edition; drawn from Global Risks Perception Survey - GRPS and Executive Opinion Survey - EOS).
- **Core Diagnosis**: The world is entering an *"Age of Competition"* driven by geoeconomic fragmentation, technological warfare, and cascading ecological shocks.
- **Top 5 Global Risks by Severity**:
- **Short-Term (2 Years)**:
    1. Geo-economic confrontation
    2. Misinformation and disinformation
    3. Societal polarization
    4. Extreme weather events
    5. State-based armed conflict
- **Long-Term (10 Years)**:
    1. Extreme weather events
    2. Biodiversity loss and ecosystem collapse
    3. Critical change to Earth systems
    4. Misinformation and disinformation
    5. Adverse outcomes of AI technologies
- **Most Interconnected Global Risk**: **Inequality**.
- **India's Specific Risk Outlook**:
- **#1 Top Risk for India**: **Cybersecurity**.
- Subsequent domestic risks: Income and wealth inequality, Insufficient public services, Economic downturn, State-based armed conflict.

14. Asia Manufacturing Index (AMI) 2026 | Released 12 January 2026

- **Publisher**: **Dezan Shira & Associates** (assesses 11 Asian manufacturing powerhouse economies).
- **Top 6 Standings**: 1. **China** (Strong industrial base and integrated supply chains) 2. **Malaysia** (Policy reforms and investor-friendly environment) 3. **Vietnam** (Export-driven manufacturing growth) 4. **Singapore** (Advanced infrastructure and innovation) 5. **South Korea** (High-technology manufacturing) 6. **India** (**Ranked 6th**; core identified competitive advantage: *Market size and workforce strength*).

15. The World Inequality Report 2026 | Released December 2025

- **Publisher**: **World Inequality Lab** (3rd edition; edited by **Thomas Piketty** and **Lucas Chancel**).
- **Global Wealth & Income Matrix**:
- Top 10% controls **~75% of global wealth**; bottom 50% owns just **2%**.
- Top 1% owns **37% of global wealth** (more than the combined wealth of the entire bottom 50%).
- The ultra-rich top 0.001% (~60,000 individuals) hold **3 times more wealth than the poorest 50% of the world's population**.
- Women earn only **25% of global labour income** (female labour force participation: 15.7%).
- Climate inequality: Top 10% accounts for **77% of private capital emissions**; richest 1% produces **41% of emissions**; bottom 50% contributes only 3%.
- Systemic wealth drain: Approximately **1% of global GDP flows annually from poorer to richer nations** through unequal financial mechanisms.
- **India's Inequality Metrics**:
- Top 10% captures **58% of national income**; bottom 50% receives just **15%**.
- Richest 10% holds **65% of national wealth**; top 1% controls **40% of total wealth**.
- Average per capita annual income: **€6,200 (PPP)**; average wealth per adult: **€28,000 (PPP)**.

16. Commitment to Development Index (CDI) 2025 | Released 20 November 2025

- **Publisher**: **Center for Global Development (CGD)** (measures policies of major economies supporting poorer nations beyond foreign aid).
- **Top Performers**: 1. **Sweden**, 2. Germany, 3. Norway, 4. Finland, 5. UK.
- **Major Economies Underperforming**: United States ranks 28th; China ranks 34th.
- **India's Standing**: **36th overall** (among 38 evaluated economies); **30th on income-adjusted ranking**.
- **Sectoral Divergence**: India ranks **8th in Environment**, but ranks **38th (last) in both Trade and Development Finance**.

17. UN World Urbanization Prospects 2025 | Released November 2025

- **Publisher**: **UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UN DESA)**.
- **World's Most Populous Megacities**: 1. **Jakarta, Indonesia** (**42 million**) 2. **Dhaka, Bangladesh** (**37 million**) 3. **Tokyo, Japan** (**33 million** — dropped from top spot)
- **Asian Mega-Concentration**: **9 of the world's 10 most populous cities** are in Asia: Jakarta, Dhaka, Tokyo, New Delhi, Shanghai, Guangzhou, Manila, Kolkata, and Seoul.

18. Global Hunger Index (GHI) 2025 | October 2025

- **Publishers**: **Concern Worldwide**, **Welthungerhilfe**, and **IFHV** (20th edition).
- **Global Score**: Average score is **18.3** ("Moderate").
- **Four Indicators**: Undernourishment, Child Stunting, Child Wasting, Child Mortality.
- **Bottom-Most Nation**: **Somalia** (worst hunger level globally).
- **Seven Nations in "Alarming" Category**: Burundi, DR Congo, Haiti, Yemen, Madagascar, Somalia, South Sudan.
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 102nd out of 123 evaluated countries** (Score: **25.8**, Severity: **"Serious"**). Child stunting stands at ~35% and child wasting at 18%.

19. Global Liveability Index 2025 | June 2025

- **Publisher**: **Economist Intelligence Unit (EIU)** (173 cities assessed across stability, healthcare, culture & environment, education, infrastructure).
- **World's Most Liveable City**: **Copenhagen (Denmark)** (Score: **98.0**; perfect 100 in stability, education, infrastructure), terminating Vienna's 3-year streak.
- **Top 5**: 1. Copenhagen (98.0), 2. Vienna (97.1) & Zurich (97.1), 4. Melbourne (97.0), 5. Geneva (96.8).
- **Least Liveable Cities**: 173. Damascus (Syria), 172. Tripoli (Libya), 171. Dhaka (Bangladesh), 170. Karachi (Pakistan), 169. Algiers (Algeria).
- **India's Cities**: Both **New Delhi and Mumbai tied at 141st rank** out of 173 cities.

20. Global Gender Gap Report 2025 | Released 11 June 2025

- **Publisher**: **World Economic Forum (WEF)** (19th edition; 148 economies across 4 dimensions: Economic Participation, Education, Health, Political Empowerment).
- **Top 5 Nations**: 1. **Iceland** (0.926; top for 16th consecutive year), 2. Finland (0.879), 3. Norway (0.863), 4. United Kingdom (0.838), 5. New Zealand (0.827).

- **Bottom 5 Nations**: 148. **Pakistan** (0.567), 147. Sudan (0.570), 146. Chad (0.571), 145. Iran (0.583), 144. Guinea (0.595).
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 131st out of 148 countries** (Gender Parity Score: **64.4% / 0.644**; fell from 129th in 2024).
- **Weakest Area**: **Political Empowerment** — women in Parliament fell from 14.7% to 13.8%; female ministers fell from 6.5% to 5.6% (steep drop from 2019 high of 30%).
- **South Asia Matrix**: Bangladesh surged to 24th; Bhutan (119), Nepal (125), and Sri Lanka (130) all rank higher than India. Only Maldives (138) and Pakistan (148) rank lower.

21. UN Sustainable Development Report (SDR) 2025 | Released 24 June 2025

- **Publisher**: **UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN)** (evaluates 167 nations across 17 SDGs).
- **Global Assessment**: Zero SDGs on track globally for 2030; only ~17% of targets progressing adequately.
- **Top 3 Leaders (SDG Index)**: 1. **Finland** (87.0) 2. **Sweden** (85.7) 3. **Denmark** (85.3) *(19 of top 20 nations are European; China ranks 49th)*.
- **Bottom 3 Nations**: 167. South Sudan (41.6), 166. Central African Republic (45.2), 165. Chad (46.0).
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 99th out of 167 countries** (Score: **66.95 / ~67.0**). Demonstrates consistent 4-year upward trajectory: 120th (2021) $\rightarrow$ 121st (2022) $\rightarrow$ 112th (2023) $\rightarrow$ 109th (2024) $\rightarrow$ **99th (2025)**.
- **Regional Comparison**: Bhutan (74th), Nepal (85th), Maldives (53rd), and Sri Lanka (93rd) lead India; Bangladesh (114th) and Pakistan (140th) lag behind.

22. G20 Report on Global Inequality | Released November 2025

- **Context & Mandate**: First-ever comprehensive G20 Global Inequality Report commissioned under **South Africa's G20 Presidency**.
- **Panel Leadership**: Prepared by the *G20 Extraordinary Committee of Independent Experts on Global Inequality*, chaired by Nobel laureate **Joseph E. Stiglitz** (key members included Jayati Ghosh, Winnie Byanyima, and Imraan Valodia).
- **Key Findings**:
- ~83% of surveyed nations exhibit severe income inequality (Gini coefficient > 0.4; Gini index originated by Italian statistician Corrado Gini in 1912), encompassing ~90% of global population.
- From 2000 to 2024, the world's richest 1% captured **41% of all newly created wealth**, whereas the bottom 50% accrued just **1%**.
- Proposed the institutional formation of an **International Panel on Inequality (IPI)**, modeled along the lines of the IPCC.
- In India, wealth held by the top 1% surged by ~62% during the period; while consumption-based Gini showed marginal cooling, structural wealth inequality remains severely skewed.

23. Women, Peace and Security (WPS) Index 2025/26

- **Publishers**: **Georgetown Institute for Women, Peace and Security (GIWPS)** and the **Peace Research Institute Oslo (PRIO)** (ranks 181 countries across Inclusion, Justice, and Security).
- **Top 5**: 1. **Denmark** (0.939), 2. Iceland (0.932), 3. Norway (0.924), 4. Sweden (0.924), 5. Finland (0.921).
- **Bottom 5**: 181. Afghanistan (0.279), Yemen, Central African Republic, Syria, Sudan.
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 131st globally** (Score: **0.607**), reflecting substantial systemic challenges in female workforce participation, safety, and legislative representation.

24. Human Development Report (HDR) 2025 | Released 6 May 2025

- **Publisher**: **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)**.
- **Report Title**: *"A Matter of Choice: People and Possibilities in the Age of AI"*.
- **Global Pattern**: Global Human Development Index saw its smallest increase since 1990 (excluding the 2020–21 pandemic).
- **Top 5 Nations**: 1. **Iceland** (HDI: **0.972** — #1 globally, up from 3rd) 2. **Norway** and **Switzerland** (tied at **0.970**) 4. **Denmark** (**0.962**) 5. **Germany** and **Sweden** (tied at **0.959**)
- **Lowest Ranked Country**: **South Sudan** (HDI: **0.388** / Rank 193).
- **India's Standing & Trajectory**:
- **Rank**: **130th out of 193 countries** (improved from 133rd in 2022).
- **HDI Value**: **0.685** (up from 0.676; classified under ***"Medium Human Development"***, approaching the $\ge$0.700 threshold for High Human Development).
- **South Asian Order**: China (78th) $\rightarrow$ Sri Lanka (89th) $\rightarrow$ Bhutan (125th) $\rightarrow$ **India & Bangladesh (tied at 130th)** $\rightarrow$ Nepal (145th) $\rightarrow$ Myanmar (150th) $\rightarrow$ Pakistan (168th).
- **Key Structural Pillars for India (1990 to 2023 Long-Term Transformation)**:
  - **Life Expectancy at Birth**: Surged from 58.6 years (1990) to **72.0 years** in 2023 (highest ever recorded in Indian history).

- **Expected Years of Schooling**: Increased from 8.2 years (1990) to **13.0 years**.
- **Gross National Income (GNI) Per Capita**: Increased over fourfold from USD 2,167 (1990) to **USD 9,046** in 2023 (2021 PPP).

25. Global Innovation Index (GII) 2025 | Released 16 September 2025

- **Publisher**: **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)** (18th edition, launched in Geneva).
- **Theme**: *"Innovation at a Crossroads"*.
- **Scope**: Assesses **139 economies** using 80 indicators.
- **Top Performers**: 1. **Switzerland** (#1 globally for the **15th consecutive year**; leads in Creative outputs). 2. **Sweden** (#2 globally for 3rd straight year). 3. **United States** (#1 in Corporate R&D investors, 2nd in domestic market, 4th in private credit).
- **China**: Enters the **top 10 for the first time** (leads in Knowledge & Technology outputs; only middle-income economy in top 30).
- Top 10 also includes: Singapore (4th), UK (5th), South Korea (6th), Finland (7th), Netherlands (8th), Germany (9th), Denmark (10th).
- **India's Standing & Sub-Pillars**:
- **Rank**: **38th out of 139 economies** (massive 43-rank ascent from 81st in 2015!).
- **Regional Distinction**: **Ranked 1st among lower-middle-income economies** and **Ranked 1st in Central & Southern Asia**.
- **Input vs Output**: Innovation Inputs rank: **52nd**; Innovation Outputs rank: **32nd** (reflecting high innovation efficiency).
- **Pillar Strengths**: Knowledge & Technology Outputs (**22nd**), Market Sophistication (**38th**).
- **Identified Weaknesses**: Business Sophistication (64th), Infrastructure (61st), Institutions (58th).

26. Henley Passport Index (January 2026 Release)

- **Publisher**: **Henley & Partners** (based on IATA data).
- **Top Passport**: **Singapore** (Rank 1; world's most powerful passport).
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 80th globally**, granting visa-free / visa-on-arrival entry to **55 destinations**.

27. Global Firepower (GFP) Ranking 2026

- **Publisher**: **Global Firepower**.
- **Top Military Powers**: 1. **United States**, 2. Russia, 3. China.
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 4th globally**, upholding its established position behind USA, Russia, and China.

28. Climate Risk Index 2026

- **Publisher**: **Germanwatch** (analyzing long-term exposure to extreme weather over a 30-year span).
- **Highest Vulnerability**: Dominica, Myanmar, Honduras.
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 9th globally** in long-term climate vulnerability.

29. Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2026

- **Publishers**: **Germanwatch**, **NewClimate Institute**, and **Climate Action Network (CAN)**.
- **Top Performers**: **Ranks 1, 2, and 3 remain empty** (no country deemed on track to prevent 1.5°C warming); **Denmark ranks 4th** (highest ranked actual country).
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 10th globally**, remaining the only G20 member consistently inside the global top 10 for renewable expansion and per-capita energy restraint.

30. National Family Health Survey-6 (NFHS-6) | Factsheets Released 29 May 2026

- **Publishing Authority**: Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (**MoHFW**).
- **Nodal Agency**: **International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai**.
- **Fieldwork & Sample**: Conducted across **2023–24** surveying **6.79 lakh households** across **715 districts** in all States/UTs.
- *(Critical UPPCS Trap: Fieldwork could NOT be completed in Manipur due to security/law-and-order constraints; Manipur is excluded from the national factsheets).*
- **Demographic & Fertility Indicators**:
- **Total Fertility Rate (TFR)**: **2.0 children per woman** (national average below the replacement level of 2.1; Urban: **1.6**, Rural: **2.1**).
- **Contraceptive Prevalence Rate (CPR)**: **69.1%** (Modern CPR: 58.7%).
- **Institutional Deliveries**: Reached **90.6%** (Rural: 89.2%, Urban: 94.8%).
- **Skilled Birth Attendance**: **91.3%** of births delivered by skilled healthcare personnel.
- **Child Marriage**: Women aged 20–24 married before age 18: **20.1%**; Men aged 25–29 married before age 21: **15.9%**.
- **Teenage Childbearing (15–19 years)**: **6.7%**.

- **Child Health & Nutritional Status (<5 Years)**:
- **Full Immunization Coverage (12–23 months)**: **87.1%**.
- **Rotavirus Vaccine Coverage**: **85.4%**.
- **Stunting (Height-for-Age / Chronic Malnutrition)**: **29.3%** (significant drop from 35.5% in NFHS-5).
- **Wasting (Weight-for-Height / Acute Malnutrition)**: **18.7%**; **Severe Wasting**: **5.2%**.
- **Underweight (Weight-for-Age)**: **31.8%** (down from 32.1%).
- **Women's Socio-Economic Autonomy**:
- **Independent Bank/Savings Account**: **89.0%** of women have and independently use a bank account (up from 78.6% in NFHS-5).
- **Internet Usage**: **64.3%** of women have ever used the internet (Urban: 75.8%, Rural: 57.5%).
- **Mobile Phone Ownership**: **63.6%** of women own and use a mobile phone.
- **Spousal Violence**: Ever-married women reporting physical/sexual violence dropped to **22.3%** (from 29.3%).
- **Demographic Structure & Lifestyles**:
- Population aged **<5 years**: **8.0%** | Aged **<15 years**: **25.5%** | Aged **$\ge$60 years (Elderly)**: **12.9%** (reflecting rapid demographic aging).
- **Health Insurance Coverage**: **60.2%** of households have at least one member covered (up from 41.4%).
- **Overweight or Obese Adults (BMI $\ge$ 25)**: Women **30.7%**, Men **26.8%**.
- **Basic Household Amenities**: Electricity **98.3%**, Improved drinking water **96.5%**, Clean cooking fuel **69.8%**.

31. Sample Registration System (SRS) Bulletin 2024 | Released 20 May 2026

- **Publishing Authority**: **Office of the Registrar General of India (ORGI)**, Ministry of Home Affairs (Reference Year: 2024, Vol 59, No. 1).
- **Crude Birth Rate (CBR)**:
- **National Average**: **18.3 per 1,000 population** (Rural: 20.2, Urban: 14.7).
- **Highest Birth Rate**: **Bihar (26.8)** $\rightarrow$ Uttar Pradesh (24.7) $\rightarrow$ Madhya Pradesh (23.9).
- **Lowest Birth Rate**: **Andaman & Nicobar Islands (9.9)**; among major states: Goa (11.6), Kerala (12.3).
- **Crude Death Rate (CDR)**:
- **National Average**: **6.4 per 1,000 population** (Rural: 6.8, Urban: 5.6; Male: 7.1, Female: 5.6).
- **Highest Death Rate**: **Chhattisgarh (8.4)** $\rightarrow$ Odisha (7.9) $\rightarrow$ Kerala (7.6) $\rightarrow$ Punjab (7.5).
- **Lowest Death Rate**: **Chandigarh (3.9)**; among states: Nagaland (4.2), Mizoram (4.5), Delhi (4.6).
- **Natural Growth Rate (NGR = CBR - CDR)**:
- **National Average**: **11.9 per 1,000 population** (Rural: 13.4, Urban: 9.1).
- **Highest Natural Growth Rate**: **Bihar (20.8)**.
- **Lowest Natural Growth Rate**: **Kerala (3.9)**.
- **Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)**:
- **National Average**: **24 infant deaths per 1,000 live births** (Rural: 27, Urban: 17; Male: 24, Female: 25).
- **Key Structural Ratio**: **1 in every 42 infants in India dies within the first year of life** (in rural areas 1 in 37; in urban areas 1 in 59).
- **Highest IMR**: **Chhattisgarh (36)** $\rightarrow$ Madhya Pradesh (35) $\rightarrow$ Uttar Pradesh (34).
- **Lowest IMR**: **Manipur (2)** $\rightarrow$ Goa (5) $\rightarrow$ Kerala (6) $\rightarrow$ Puducherry (7).

32. Civil Registration System (CRS) Report 2023 | Released 10 October 2025

- **Publishing Authority**: ORGI, Ministry of Home Affairs (under Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 & RBD Amendment Act, 2023; Seventh Schedule Concurrent List Entry 30).
- **Statutory Mandate**: Mandatory reporting of births and deaths within **21 days**.
- **National Birth Registration**:
- **Level of Registration**: **98.4%** across India (institutional births: 74.7%).
- Total registered births: **252.1 lakh** (52.4% male, 47.6% female).
- **21 States/UTs** achieved 100% birth registration.
- **Sex Ratio at Birth (SRB) — CRS 2023 Master Table**:
- **Top States/UTs with Highest SRB**:
  1. **Arunachal Pradesh**: **1,085** females per 1,000 males
  2. **Nagaland**: **1,007**
  3. **Goa**: **973**
  4. **Ladakh**: **972**

5. **Tripura**: **972**
6. **Kerala**: **967**

- **Bottom States with Lowest SRB**:
  1. **Jharkhand**: **899** (**Lowest in India!**)
  2. **Bihar**: **900**
  3. **Uttar Pradesh**: **902**
  4. **Telangana**: **906**
  5. **Gujarat**: **908**
  6. **Haryana**: **911**
- **National Death Registration**:
- **Level of Registration**: **97.2%** across India (institutional deaths: 24.0%).
- Total registered deaths: **86.6 lakh** (60.6% male, 39.4% female).
- **19 States/UTs** achieved 100% death registration.

33. Reforming India's R&D Ecosystem 2026 | NITI Aayog, 9 April 2026

- **Release Details**: Released by NITI Aayog Vice Chairman Suman Bery and Dr. V.K. Saraswat.
- **Core Reform Blueprint**: Introduces the **ROPE Framework** (**Removing Obstacles and Promoting Enablers**) to revamp public and private research funding.
- **R&D Landscape Metrics in India**:
- **Gross Expenditure on R&D (GERD)**: Stands at **0.64% of GDP** (national policy vision targets 2.0%).
- **Private Sector Share in GERD**: Only **~36%** in India (compared to >70% in USA, South Korea, Germany).
- **Global Innovation Index (GII) 2025**: India holds **38th rank**.
- **Global IP Filings (WIPO 2024)**: India ranked **4th in Trademark filings, 6th in Patent applications, and 7th in Industrial Design filings**.

34. WEF Energy Transition Index (ETI) 2026 | Released 18 June 2026

- **Publisher**: **World Economic Forum (WEF)** in collaboration with **Accenture**.
- **Report Title**: *"Fostering Effective Energy Transition 2026"*.
- **Scope**: Evaluates **120 countries** across 44 indicators tracking transition readiness and system performance.
- **Top 5 Performers**: 1. **Sweden** (Score: 75.3 — #1 globally) 2. **Finland** (Score: 74.1) 3. **Denmark** (Score: 72.6) 4. **Estonia** (Score: 70.9) 5. **Norway** (Score: 70.5)
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 70th out of 120 countries** (Score: **54.9**; climbed 2 ranks from 72nd).

35. Performance Grading Index for Districts (PGI-D) 2024–25

- **Publisher**: Department of School Education and Literacy, **Ministry of Education**.
- **Scope**: Assesses **782 districts** nationwide across 600 points and 70 indicators grouped under 6 categories.
- **Grade Distribution (Critical UPPCS Prelims Traps)**:
- **Utkarsh (Score >90%)**: **Zero (0) districts** achieved this grade.
- **Uttam-1 (81–90%)**: **Zero (0) districts** achieved this grade.
- **Uttam-2 (71–80%)**: 16 districts (up from 1).
- **Uttam-3 (61–70%)**: 75 districts (up from 40).
- **Top Districts**: **Diu** (Score: 469 — highest in India), **Kolhapur** (MH: 463), **Barnala** (PB: 461), **Muktsar** (PB: 456).
- **State Showcase**: **Kerala** stood out nationally with **all 14 of its districts placed in Uttam-2 or Uttam-3**.
- **Lowest Scoring Districts**: South West Garo Hills (Meghalaya: 173), West Khasi Hills (176), South Garo Hills (179).

36. State Energy Efficiency Index (SEEI) 2024 | Released by BEE

- **Publishers**: **Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE)** with Alliance for an Energy Efficient Economy (**AEEE**).
- **Scope**: 6th edition; evaluates 36 States/UTs across 66 indicators for FY 2023–24.
- **Top Performers by Energy Consumption Group**:
- **Group 1 (>15 MTOE)**: **Maharashtra**
- **Group 2 (5–15 MTOE)**: **Andhra Pradesh**
- **Group 3 (1–5 MTOE)**: **Assam**
- **Group 4 (<1 MTOE)**: **Tripura**
- **National Milestones**: 24 states notified ECBC 2017; 31 states adopted EV policies; Kerala achieved **74% adoption** of solar-powered agricultural pumps.

37. "From Borrowers to Builders: Women and India's Evolving Credit Market" | NITI Aayog (7 April 2026)

- **Publishers**: **NITI Aayog**, Women Entrepreneurship Platform (**WEP**), TransUnion CIBIL, and MicroSave Consulting.
- **Core Findings**:
- Women in India hold a credit portfolio of **₹76 lakh crore**, representing **26% of total system credit** (up from ₹16 lakh crore in 2017).
- Credit penetration among women surged from **19% in 2017 to 36% in 2025**.
- India has approximately **45 crore credit-eligible women**, signaling vast untapped credit growth potential.

38. Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2026 | NITI Aayog (11 March 2026)

- **Publisher**: **NITI Aayog** (2nd edition; measures fiscal resilience amidst global public debt reaching $102 trillion).
- **Five Pillars**: Quality of Expenditure, Revenue Mobilisation, Fiscal Prudence, Debt Index, Debt Sustainability.
- **Major States Categorisation**:
- **Achievers**: **Odisha, Goa, Jharkhand**.
- **Front-Runners**: **Gujarat, Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka**.
- **Performers**: Madhya Pradesh, Haryana, Bihar (stronger deficit management), Tamil Nadu, Rajasthan.
- **Aspirational / Debt-Stressed**: **Punjab, Kerala, and West Bengal** flagged as the most debt-stressed and interest-burdened States.
- **Himalayan & North-Eastern States**: Achievers: **Arunachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand**.

39. Export Preparedness Index (EPI) 2024 | NITI Aayog (14 January 2026)

- **Publisher**: **NITI Aayog** (4th edition; baseline aligned with $1 trillion merchandise export target by 2030).
- **Four Core Pillars & Weights**: Policy & Governance (**20%**), Export Infrastructure (**20%**), Business Ecosystem (**40%**), Export Performance (**20%**).
- **Large States Ranking**: 1. **Maharashtra** 2. **Tamil Nadu** 3. **Gujarat** 4. **Uttar Pradesh** 5. **Andhra Pradesh**
- **Landlocked Champion**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 among ALL LANDLOCKED STATES in India** (driven by ODOP, multimodal dry ports, expressways).
- **Himalayan / Small States**: 1. **Uttarakhand**, 2. Jammu & Kashmir, 3. Nagaland.

40. Innovators Business Environment Index (IBEI) 2026 | StartupBlink (January 2026)

- **Publisher**: **StartupBlink** (covers 125 countries across 30+ indicators).
- **Top 2 Economies**: 1. **United States**, 2. **Singapore**.
- **India's Standing**: **Ranked 54th globally**; **Ranked #1 in South Asia** and **10th in Asia-Pacific**.

41. Index of Economic Freedom 2026 | The Heritage Foundation (March 2026)

- **Publisher**: **The Heritage Foundation** (Washington, D.C.; 32nd annual edition; assesses 176 countries).
- **Four Policy Pillars**: Rule of Law, Government Size, Regulatory Efficiency, Open Markets.
- **Categories & Top Standings**:
- **Economically Free ($\ge$80)**: Only 4 nations: 1. **Singapore (84.4 — #1 globally)**, 2. **Switzerland (83.7)**, 3. **Ireland (83.3)**, 4. **Australia (80.1)**.
- **Mostly Unfree (50–59.9)**: **India ranks 132nd globally** (Score: **52.5**; grouped with Mexico 92nd, South Africa 100th, Bangladesh 120th, Brazil 134th).
- **Repressed (<50)**: **North Korea (176th / Score: 3.1 — Lowest in the world)**; Pakistan (152nd), China (154th).

42. Global Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) 2025 | UNDP & OPHI (17 October 2025)

- **Publishers**: **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)** and **Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative (OPHI)**.
- **Special Dimension**: First-ever integration of **climate hazards** (floods, extreme heat) with multidimensional deprivation data.
- **Global Deprivation Matrix**:
- **1.1 billion people (18.3%)** live in acute multidimensional poverty globally.
- **Over half (584 million) are children under 18**; child poverty rate stands at **27.8%** vs 13.5% for adults.
- **83.5% of poor people reside in rural areas**.
- Sub-Saharan Africa (553 million) and South Asia (402 million) account for **83.2% of all multidimensionally poor individuals**.
- **India's Historic Transformation**:
- Multidimensional poverty in India plummeted from **55.1% in 2005–06 down to 16.4% in 2019–21**.
- Approximately **414 million people moved out of multidimensional poverty** in this 15-year period!
- **MPI Structural Framework (High-Yield UPPCS Theory)**:

- **3 Dimensions**: Health, Education, Standard of Living (each dimension weighted equally at **1/3**).
- **10 Indicators**:
  - Health (1/6 each): Nutrition, Child Mortality.
  - Education (1/6 each): Years of Schooling, School Attendance.
  - Standard of Living (1/18 each): Cooking Fuel, Sanitation, Drinking Water, Electricity, Housing, Assets.
- **Poverty Cut-off**: An individual is considered multidimensionally poor if deprived in **$\ge$ 33.3% (one-third)** of the weighted indicators.

43. India Electric Mobility Index (IEMI) 2024 | NITI Aayog

- **Publishing Body**: **NITI Aayog** (launched to track transport sector decarbonization toward India's Net Zero 2070 goal).
- **Scope & First in World**: World's first comprehensive **sub-national level e-mobility index**, benchmarking all **28 States and 8 Union Territories**.
- **Structural Methodology**: Evaluates **16 core indicators across 3 foundational themes**: 1. *Transport Electrification* 2. *Charging Infrastructure* 3. *EV Research & Innovation*
- **Three Performance Classifications**:
- **Frontrunners (Score: 65–99)**
- **Performers (Score: 50–64)**
- **Aspirants (Score: 0–49)**
- **Key National Scores**:
- **Top Score**: **77** (achieved by Delhi).
- **National Average Score**: **39**.
- **Overall Top Performers Ranking**:
- **Frontrunners**:
  1. **Delhi (Score: 77)** — #1 in India.
  2. **Maharashtra (Score: 68)** — #2 in India.
  3. **Chandigarh (Score: 65)** — #3 in India.
- **Performers**:
  - Karnataka (64)
  - Tamil Nadu (59)
  - Haryana (54)
- **Aspirants (Below 50)**:
  - Odisha (49)
  - Rajasthan (48)
  - Chhattisgarh (48)
- **Lowest-Scoring States/UTs**:
- **Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu**: **12** (lowest in India).
- **Nagaland**: **19**.
- **Jammu & Kashmir**: **20**.
- **Andaman & Nicobar Islands**: **22**.
- **Sikkim**: **23**.

44. IQAir World Air Quality Report 2025 (8th Annual Edition | March 2026)

- **Publisher**: **IQAir** (Swiss air quality technology company; released 24 March 2026; 8th annual edition).
- **Scale of Coverage**: Analyzes PM2.5 concentrations from **9,446 cities across 143 countries, regions, and territories** (a 33% increase in West Asian monitoring coverage including Iran, Syria, Jordan; Burundi, Turkmenistan, Togo excluded due to lack of public data).
- **WHO PM2.5 Annual Guideline (5 µg/m^3)**:
- **Only 13 countries/territories** met the WHO annual standard of $\le 5\ \mu\text{g/m}^3$: French Polynesia, Puerto Rico, U.S. Virgin Islands, Barbados, New Caledonia, Iceland, Bermuda, Réunion, Andorra, Australia, Grenada, Panama, and Estonia.
- Globally, **only 14% of cities** met the WHO annual standard (down from 17% in 2024).
- **World's Most Polluted Cities 2025 (by Annual Average PM2.5, $\mu\text{g/m}^3$)**: 1. **Loni, India (Uttar Pradesh)** — **112.5 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$** (#1 Most Polluted City in the World! Located in Ghaziabad district, UP). 2. **Hotan, China** — **109.6 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**. 3. **Byrnihat, India** — **101.1 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$** (Assam–Meghalaya industrial border). 4. **Delhi, India** — **99.6 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$** (down from 108.3 in 2024). 5. **Faisalabad, Pakistan** — **98.8 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**.

- **World's Most Polluted Capital Cities 2025**: 1. **New Delhi, India** — **82.2 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$** (#1 Most Polluted Capital in the World). 2. **Dhaka, Bangladesh** — **68.0 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**. 3. **Dushanbe, Tajikistan** — **57.3 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**. 4. **N'Djamena, Chad** — **53.6 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**. 5. **Kinshasa, DR Congo** — **50.2 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**.
- **World's Most Polluted Countries/Territories 2025**: 1. **Pakistan** — **67.3 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$** (#1 Most Polluted Country). 2. **Bangladesh** — **66.1 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**. 3. **Tajikistan** — **57.3 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**. 4. **Chad** — **53.6 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**. 5. **Democratic Republic of the Congo** — **50.2 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$**. 6. **India** — **48.9 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$** (ranked **6th most polluted country globally**; improved from 50.6 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$ in 2024).

October 2026

Global Hunger Index (GHI) 2024/2026 | October Release

What happened Humanitarian organisations **Concern Worldwide** (Ireland) and **Welthungerhilfe** (Germany) jointly released the **Global Hunger Index (GHI) Report**.

Core facts & India metrics - **Publishers: Welthungerhilfe** and **Concern Worldwide**. - **India Rank: 105th** out of **127 evaluated countries**. - **India GHI Score: 27.3** — placing India in the **"Serious"** hunger severity category (scores between 20.0 and 34.9 are categorized as Serious). - **Four Standardized GHI Indicators:** 1. **Undernourishment: 13.7%** of India's population has insufficient caloric intake. 2. **Child Stunting: 35.5%** of children under 5 years suffer from low height-for-age (chronic undernutrition). 3. **Child Wasting: 18.7%** of children under 5 years suffer from low weight-for-height (acute undernutrition) — flagged as one of the highest child wasting rates globally. 4. **Child Mortality: 2.9%** under-five mortality rate. - **Regional Comparison:** India is ranked below several South Asian neighbours: Sri Lanka (56th), Nepal (68th), and Bangladesh (84th); but ranks above Pakistan (109th) and Afghanistan (116th).

1. **Publisher Trap:** GHI is published by **Welthungerhilfe & Concern Worldwide**, NOT by FAO, UNICEF, or the World Bank.
2. **Category Trap:** India's category is **"Serious"**, not "Alarming" (scores ≥ 35) or "Moderate" ($10.0–19.9$).

Global Innovation Index (GII) 2024/2026 | WIPO | October 2026

What happened The **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)** published the **Global Innovation Index (GII)** (17th edition), assessing 133 global economies under the theme *"Unlocking the Promise of Social Entrepreneurship"*.

Core rankings & India's performance - **Global Top 3 Economies:** 1. **Switzerland** (Rank #1 for the **14th consecutive year**). 2. **Sweden** (Rank #2). 3. **United States** (Rank #3). - **India's Global Rank: 39th position** out of 133 economies (improving from 40th in 2023 and 81st in 2015) with an overall score of **38.3**. - **India's Key Distinctions:** - **#1 in Central and Southern Asia** among all 10 evaluated regional economies. - **#1 among all Lower-Middle-Income economies** globally. - Recognized as an **"innovation overperformer"** relative to its level of economic development for **14 consecutive years**. - Ranks **#1 in the world** in *ICT services exports* (as a percentage of total trade). - **India's Top S&T Clusters:** Four Indian clusters featured in the global top 100 Science & Technology hubs: 1. **Bengaluru** (56th) 2. **Delhi** (63rd) 3. **Chennai** (82nd) 4. **Mumbai** (84th).

IMF World Economic Outlook (October 2026)

What happened The **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** released its biannual **World Economic Outlook (WEO)** update titled *"Policy Pivot, Rising Threats"*.

Core macroeconomic projections - **India's GDP Growth:** Projected at **7.0%** for FY 2024–25 and **6.5%** for FY 2025–26, driven by resilient domestic consumption and public capex. - **Fastest-Growing Major Economy:** India retains its distinction as the **fastest-growing major economy in the world** (surpassing China's projected 4.8%). - **Global Growth:** Projected steady at **3.2%**.

PART C · TOPICS

08 — Uttar Pradesh CA

> **Priority S for UPPCS** National magazines often under-count UP. In the real paper, UP news comes through Ramsar, Budget, ODOP, ranks, and big projects. **Subject notes home:** UP Special Topic 8 — Schemes & Miscellaneous · full map UP Special

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Which district or city?	Etah, Lucknow, Varanasi, Noida…
Any rank or category?	SDG, Swachh, FDI, agri
Any scheme or project name?	Exact title
Any wildlife or Ramsar site?	Site + district
Any "first in UP" claim?	Confirm carefully

High-Yield UP Foundation Matrix (Late 2025)

> **UPPCS Pattern Alert:** Late-year announcements frequently appear in the prelims paper. Memorise these district connections and milestones:

Event / Project	District / Location	Key Prelims Fact
UNESCO Creative City of Gastronomy	**Lucknow**	Conferred in **October 2025**; joins UNESCO Creative Cities Network (UCCN).
India's 1st Swastik-shaped 'Lotus Garden'	**CSIR-NBRI, Lucknow**	Inaugurated **15 Sept 2025** by Dr. Jitendra Singh & CM Yogi Adityanath; Area: **930 sq. metres**.
Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2025	**Agra, Jhansi, Moradabad**	**Agra:** Joint 3rd (>10L category, 196/200); **Jhansi & Moradabad:** Joint 2nd (3–10L category, 198.5/200).
Ayodhya Deepotsav 2025	**Ayodhya (Saryu River)**	**9th edition** (19 Oct 2025); Guinness World Record of **26,17,215** oil lamps (diyas).
Indigenous Hydrogen Vessel	**Varanasi**	Commercial operations of India's first fully indigenous hydrogen fuel cell passenger vessel began **11 Dec 2025**.
4th Kashi Tamil Sangamam	**Varanasi**	Cultural integration initiative celebrated in Varanasi (late 2025).
Basmati & Organic Training Centre	**Pilibhit**	India's first integrated Basmati & Organic Training Centre-cum-Demonstration Farm.
Air Quality Alert (CREA Report)	**Ghaziabad**	Ranked as the **most polluted city in India** in November 2025.
Cultural Legend Obituary	**Varanasi**	**Pt. Chhannulal Mishra** passed away (2 Oct 2025 at 89); Kirana & Benaras gharana; Padma Vibhushan (2020), Yash Bharti; PM Modi's Varanasi proposer in 2014.
Axiom Mission 4 (Ax-4) Pilot	**Lucknow**	Group Captain **Shubhanshu Shukla** (born in **Lucknow**) served as Pilot of SpaceX Crew Dragon 'Grace' to the ISS; **1st Indian astronaut on the ISS**, 2nd Indian in orbit after Rakesh Sharma (1984).
Supercomputer 'Arunika' (Global Rank #251)	**NCMRWF, Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar)**	NCMRWF's high-performance weather forecasting supercomputer ranked **#251 globally** in the TOP 500 Supercomputers list (Nov 2025, 5.94 PFlop/s Rmax); 3rd fastest supercomputer in India.
Sambhav Campaign 6.0 (संभव अभियान 6.0)	**All 75 Districts of UP**	Flagship nutrition drive (July–Sept 2026); Core theme: *"गर्भावस्था से बाल्यावस्था तक पोषण सुरक्षा"* (Nutritional Security from Pregnancy to Childhood).

Sambhav Campaign 6.0 (संभव अभियान 6.0) | July–September 2026 | All 75 Districts

What happened The Government of Uttar Pradesh launched the 6th edition of its flagship statewide nutrition campaign, **Sambhav Abhiyan 6.0**, across all 75 districts under the Department of Women & Child Development (ICDS) in convergence with the Health and Panchayati Raj departments and UNICEF.

Core facts & Prelims Traps - **Core Theme:** *"गर्भावस्था से बाल्यावस्था तक पोषण सुरक्षा"* (**Nutritional Security from Pregnancy to Early Childhood**). - **Core Focus Area:** Adopts a 'Life-Cycle Approach' concentrating on the critical **First 1,000 Days** of child life (from conception up to 2 years of age). - **Key Interventions:** - Identification and digital tracking of **SAM (Severely Acute Malnourished)** and **MAM (Moderately Acute Malnourished)** children on the state's **e-Kavach** digital portal. - Dedicated

home visits by Anganwadi workers and ANMs for counselling on complementary feeding, Take Home Ration (THR) recipes, and immunization. - Convergence monitoring at district level via District Nutrition Committees headed by District Magistrates.

Jal Pakhwada in UP schools | 16–30 April 2026

What happened Uttar Pradesh ran a **Jal Pakhwada** (water fortnight) in **all schools and educational institutions** under the **Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain** push.

Core facts

- Dates: **16 April to 30 April 2026**.
- Aim: make water conservation a student-led mass movement (daily water pledge, clean drinking-water sources, competitions, rallies).
- Schools report activities online; coordination with Jal Nigam, Panchayati Raj, Basic Education, and Health.

Do not pick Mission Amrit Sarovar, Atal Bhujal, or Namami Gange when the stem is the **April 2026 school water fortnight**. The name is **Jal Pakhwada**.

Nand Baba Milk Mission — scheme family

What it is UP's dairy push (about **₹1,000 crore** framing) to expand milk cooperatives and indigenous cattle units.

Schemes under the Mission (remember these three)

1. **Mukhyamantri Swadeshi Gau-Samvardhan Yojana**
2. **Mukhyamantri Pragatisheel Pashupalak Protsahan Yojana**
3. **Nandini Krishak Samriddhi Yojana** (plus Mini Nandini)

Kamdhenu Dairy Yojana is **not** listed as a current Nand Baba Mission component in the official scheme set. Older Kamdhenu beneficiaries are often **ineligible** for the new Nandini units.

Chuka Beach | Pilibhit Tiger Reserve

What happened / what it is Chuka Beach is an eco-tourism riverside beach on the **Sharda / Sharda Sagar** side inside **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** (not Dudhwa).

Core facts

- District: **Pilibhit**, Terai UP.
- Stay options: Tharu / bamboo / tree huts; visit usually via reserve safari booking.
- Trap: stems often park Chuka under **Dudhwa**. Correct reserve = **Pilibhit**.

MV Ganga Vilas | flagged off 13 January 2023 | Varanasi

What happened PM Modi flagged off **MV Ganga Vilas**, billed as the world's longest river cruise, from **Varanasi**.

Core facts

- Route memory: **Varanasi** → **Dibrugarh (Assam)** via Bangladesh; about **3,200 km** / **~51 days**; ~**27** river systems.
- Vessel: three decks, **18** suites, capacity about **36** tourists; Make-in-India cruise.

Karikot village | Bahraich | ICRT Award 2025

What happened Karikot (Bahraich, UP) received the **International Subcontinent Responsible Tourism (ICRT) Award 2025**.

Core facts

- Category to remember: **Climate Adaptation and Resilience** (not waste / local sourcing / peace-inclusion distractors).
- District: **Bahraich**.

January 2026

Patna Bird Sanctuary, Etah — Ramsar site

What happened Patna Bird Sanctuary in **Etah** district got strong national attention as a **Ramsar site** (wetland of international importance). It was announced together with Gujarat's Chhari-Dhand.

Core facts

- Site: **Patna Bird Sanctuary**.
- District: **Etah**, Uttar Pradesh.
- Size: among the smallest UP bird sanctuaries; about **1 sq km** / around **108 hectares**.
- It is a key winter home for migratory birds.

Related UP wetlands (do not mix announcement months)

Site	District	When to revise
Shekha / Sheikha Jheel	**Aligarh**	Public Ramsar push locked in **April** (India 99 / UP 12)
Surha Tal / JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary	**Ballia**	Big WED announcement in **June** (India 100 / UP 13)

Some lists show early-2026 designation paperwork. For prelims, fact the **month the news broke** in the table above. Full chain → Master tables.

Padma Awards — UP names

- **Padma Vibhushan: N Rajam** (Art), Uttar Pradesh.
- Several Padma Shri names from UP were also announced. The full list is under Awards.

UP Statehood Day (24 January 2026) — New Schemes

What happened UP Statehood Day was celebrated at **Rashtra Prerna Sthal, Lucknow**. Union Home and Cooperation Minister **Amit Shah** attended as chief guest alongside CM Yogi Adityanath.

Core schemes launched - **'One District, One Cuisine' (ODOC) Scheme:** Launched on the lines of ODOP to promote traditional and local culinary heritage of each district. - **Sardar Patel Industrial Area Scheme:** Inaugurated to accelerate balanced industrial infrastructure across districts.

Lucknow — India's First "Zero Fresh Waste Dump City" (21 January 2026)

- **Lucknow** became the **first city in Uttar Pradesh** to attain the milestone of **"Zero Fresh Waste Dump City"**, processing 100% of its daily generated municipal solid waste without sending fresh unsegregated waste to legacy landfills.

UP Governor's Residence Renamed "Jan Bhavan" (17 January 2026)

- The official residence of the Governor of Uttar Pradesh in Lucknow (formerly **Raj Bhavan**) has been officially renamed as ***"Jan Bhavan"***.

86th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC)

- **Dates & Venue: 19–21 January 2026** at the **Uttar Pradesh Vidhan Sabha, Lucknow**.
- **Inauguration:** Addressed by Lok Sabha Speaker **Om Birla**.

Republic Day Parade 2026 — UP Tableau

- **Uttar Pradesh Tableau Theme: *"Culture of Bundelkhand"*** (showcasing historical heritage, local arts, and folk culture of the Bundelkhand region).
- *(Note: Ministry of Culture Tableau theme was "150 Years of Vande Mataram").*

February 2026

Uttar Pradesh Budget 2026–27

What happened State Finance Minister **Suresh Khanna** presented the UP Budget for **2026–27**.

Core facts

- Budget size: about **₹9.13 lakh crore** (detailed figure near **₹9,12,696 crore**).
- Rise over previous year: about **12.2%**.
- Capital expenditure share: about **19.5%**.
- Fiscal deficit target: **3%**, in line with **16th Finance Commission** guidance up to **2030–31**.

Uttar Pradesh Economic Review 2025–26 (Presented 9 February 2026)

- **UP GSDP Growth Trajectory:**
- GSDP in 2016–17: **~₹13.30 lakh crore**.
- GSDP Quick Estimates for 2024–25: **~₹30.25 lakh crore** (more than doubled).

Selected spending ideas

- Convert primary schools into **Smart Schools** under Samagra Shiksha.
- About **₹580 crore** for girls' schools in blocks that do not have Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas.
- About **₹3,500 crore** under the Chief Minister's **Urban Expansion and New City Promotion Scheme**.
- Health: money for new medical colleges through PPP, plus specialty care lines such as the Cancer Institute in Lucknow in Budget highlights.

How the Union Budget touches UP

- UP's combined central share was described as near **₹4.26 lakh crore**, up by about **₹34,000 crore**.
- Tax devolution to UP was described as rising to about **₹2.68 lakh crore**.
- Place-linked Budget ideas: ship repair at **Varanasi**; heritage work at **Sarnath** and **Hastinapur**; high-speed rail connectivity stories around Varanasi; support ideas linked to ODOP and Gram Swaraj.

Other February UP current affairs

CCSU Meerut AI pilot

- **Chaudhary Charan Singh University, Meerut** was named a national pilot for an AI-enabled university.
- Partners named in reports: Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, Google Cloud, and Placecom.

UP Pharma Conclave 1.0, Lucknow

- The state pitched pharma and medical-device investment.
- MoUs of about **₹10,000 crore** were reported.
- Existing pitch points include the Bulk Drug Pharma Park in **Lalitpur** and a Medical Device Park near the Yamuna Expressway.

Sarus crane census

- The sarus crane is the **state bird** of Uttar Pradesh.
- Latest winter count reported: about **20,628** birds.
- Earlier points in the same series: about **19,994**, and about **19,196** in 2023.
- Highest counts were reported from **Etawah** and **Mainpuri** forest divisions.

Other short facts

- Semiconductor unit narrative in **Greater Noida (Gautam Buddh Nagar)** as North India's first — confirm status before using "commissioned".
- Farmer helpline from Lucknow: **0522-2317003**, Monday to Friday, for scheme information.
- Magh Mela 2026 management may appear as a soft culture question.

March 2026

Keep revising older UP facts

March's biggest national stories were the T20 World Cup, defence purchases, NavIC, Gujarat UCC, and central schemes. For UPPCS, keep January–February UP cards ready:

- Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah) Ramsar
- Padma names, especially **N Rajam**
- State Budget about **₹9.13 lakh crore**
- CCSU Meerut AI pilot
- Sarus crane census

Laxman Award & Rani Lakshmibai Award Hike | 24 March 2026

What happened The Uttar Pradesh Government announced a substantial increase in the prize money for the state's highest sports honours: the **Laxman Award** (for male sportspersons) and the **Rani Lakshmibai Award** (for female sportspersons).

Core facts - **Previous Prize Money:** ₹3.11 lakh each. - **Revised Prize Money: ₹10 lakh each** (along with a bronze statue and citation).

Soft follow-ups for later months

- Fresh Ramsar count after Sheikha Jheel / Surha Tal
- Jewar airport or expressway headlines with clear dates
- Padma conferment ceremony dates for UP awardees (announcement was in January)

April 2026

Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary | Aligarh | Ramsar site

What happened Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary in **Aligarh** got the Ramsar tag in April 2026. This is a high-yield UPPCS fact.

Core facts

- District: **Aligarh**.

- India's Ramsar total after this: **99**.
- Uttar Pradesh's Ramsar total after this: **12**.
- Flyway: **Central Asian Flyway**.
- Full ecology card → Environment.

Noida International Airport (Jewar)

What happened April coverage said commercial flights from **Jewar Airport** were targeted to start on **30 May 2026**, with ticket booking expected around mid-May. Security-clearance issues around the CEO's nationality were discussed in the delay story.

Court fact

- On **28 April 2026**, the Allahabad High Court upheld land acquisition of about **1,858 hectares** for Jewar airport expansion (Phase-2 / Phase-3 related villages in **Gautam Buddha Nagar**).
- The court stressed timely rehabilitation and resettlement under the **2013** land acquisition law.

Northern Region Agriculture Conference (24 April 2026)

- **Venue: Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh**.
- **Organiser:** Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare.
- **Focus:** Enhancing farm productivity, crop diversification, and organic/natural farming adoption in northern states.

Ganga Expressway Inauguration | 29 April 2026

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **594-kilometre-long** greenfield **Ganga Expressway** at a mega-ceremony held in **Hardoi, Uttar Pradesh**.

Core specs & prelims facts - **Length: 594 km** (access-controlled, 6-lane expandable to 8 lanes). - **Starting Point: Bijauli village** in **Meerut** district (connecting to **NH-334**). - **Ending Point: Judapur Dandu village** in **Prayagraj** district (connecting to **NH-19** near bypass). - **Inauguration Venue: Hardoi**. - **12 Districts Traversed (West to East):** 1. Meerut 2. Hapur 3. Bulandshahr 4. Amroha 5. Sambhal 6. Budaun 7. Shahjahanpur (includes a 3.5 km airstrip for emergency fighter landings) 8. Hardoi 9. Unnao 10. Raebareli 11. Pratapgarh 12. Prayagraj

Accidental Deaths in UP — NCRB ADSI 2024 Report (May 2026)

- In the **Accidental Deaths and Suicides in India (ADSI) 2024** report released by NCRB, **Uttar Pradesh** accounted for **9.2% of all accidental deaths in India**, ranking **3rd nationally** behind Maharashtra (16.2%) and Madhya Pradesh (9.8%).

Keep ready from older months

- State Budget ~**₹9.13 lakh crore**
- Padma names, especially **N Rajam**
- CCSU Meerut AI pilot
- Sarus crane census
- Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah) Ramsar

UP Personalities & High-Tech Milestones

Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla | Axiom-4 Pilot (Lucknow)

- **Hometown:** Born and raised in **Triveni Nagar, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh**.
- **Mission:** Served as the **Pilot** of Axiom Mission 4 (**Ax-4**) aboard SpaceX Crew Dragon **'Grace' (C213)** to the **International Space Station (ISS)** (launched 25 June 2025, returned 15 July 2025).
- **Distinction:** First Indian astronaut to visit the ISS; only the second Indian citizen in space after Wing Commander Rakesh Sharma (1984 aboard Soyuz T-11) after a **41-year hiatus**; the **first person from Uttar Pradesh in space**!

Weather Supercomputer 'Arunika' | NCMRWF, Noida

- **Location:** National Centre for Medium Range Weather Forecasting (**NCMRWF**), Ministry of Earth Sciences, located in **Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar district, Uttar Pradesh)**.
- **Global Standing:** Ranked **#251 in the world** in the **TOP 500 Supercomputers list** (66th Edition, November 2025, SC25 St. Louis).
- **Compute Power:** Sustained performance (**Rmax**) of **5.94 PFlop/s** and peak performance (**Rpeak**) of **7.40 PFlop/s** with 203,040 processing cores.
- **National Standing:** Ranks as the **3rd fastest supercomputer in India** (behind AIRAWAT-PSAI at C-DAC Pune and Arka at IITM Pune).

May 2026

Jewar Airport timeline update

What happened April coverage had targeted commercial flights around **late May**. Operations actually began later, on **15 June 2026**, with the first IndiGo arrival from **Lucknow**. Keep May as the "target month that slipped" and revise the hard opening under June.

Still useful May–June UP facts

- Place: **Jewar**, **Gautam Buddha Nagar**.
- Airport name: **Noida International Airport**.
- First commercial airline in coverage: **IndiGo**.
- First city link highlighted: **Lucknow**, then onward to Bengaluru.

Ramsar confused-pair board

- **Patna Bird Sanctuary** — Etah (January).
- **Shekha Jheel** — Aligarh; India **99** / UP **12** (April).
- **Surha Tal / Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary** — Ballia; India **100** / UP **13** (June World Environment Day window).

Soft UP follow-ups

- Keep Dhanauri wetland near Jewar as a **policy conflict** story (Ramsar push vs airport bird-safety / biodiversity-park talk), not as a new Ramsar tag.
- Sarus crane remains the **state bird**.

June 2026

Surha Tal / Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary | Ballia | 100th Ramsar

What happened On **World Environment Day (5 June 2026)**, **Surha Tal** in **Ballia** became India's **100th** Ramsar site and Uttar Pradesh's **13th**. The announcement was celebrated at a WED programme in **Lucknow** with CM **Yogi Adityanath**.

Core facts

- District: **Ballia**.
- Official name: **Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary**.
- India **100** | UP **13**.
- Full ecology card → Environment.

UP Clean Air Management Project (UP CAMP) | WED 5 June 2026

What happened On the same World Environment Day stage in Lucknow, UP launched the **Uttar Pradesh Clean Air Management Project (UP CAMP)**.

Easy facts

- Outlay: about **₹2,741 crore**.
- Support partner often named: **World Bank**.
- Coverage called it India's **first airshed-based** clean-air initiative.
- Soft same-day package: **Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam** plantation drive 2026 and a docket on UP wetlands / Ramsar sites.

Noida International Airport (Jewar) | commercial flights begin 15 June 2026

What happened Noida International Airport at **Jewar** began commercial operations on **15 June 2026**.

Core facts

- Place: **Jewar**, **Gautam Buddha Nagar**.
- First scheduled airline: **IndiGo**.
- First arrival highlighted: from **Lucknow** (Chaudhary Charan Singh International Airport).
- Same aircraft then flew onward toward **Bengaluru** in coverage.
- Farmers who gave land travelled on a symbolic inaugural flight to Lucknow.
- Phase-1 cost often noted around **₹11,200 crore**.
- Early schedule aim: about **12** daily flights in June, rising toward about **40** in July.
- International flights targeted later in **2026**.

Soft YEIDA electronics note

YEIDA's proposed **Electronics Manufacturing Cluster** in Sector 10 (about **206 acres**) received environmental clearance from UP SEIAA in June coverage.

July 2026

Keep revising June's UP mega-facts

July's national spine was VB-G RAM G, India–UK CETA, Kusha, Vikram-1, and World Cup finals. For UPPCS, keep June cards hot:

- **Surha Tal / JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Ballia)** — India **100** / UP **13**
- **Jewar Airport** commercial start — **15 June**, IndiGo from Lucknow
- Confused pair: Etah (Patna) → Aligarh (Shekha / 99) → Ballia (Surha / 100)

Soft July UP follow-ups

- Watch for any state notification adopting **VB-G RAM G** wage rates / Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards.
- Jewar daily-flight ramp toward about **40** flights and later international services.
- Keep Dhanauri wetland vs airport safety as a soft environment–infra conflict, not a Ramsar tag.

August 2026

AK-203 'Sher' at Korwa, Amethi

What happened The first fully indigenous AK-203 rifle **Sher** was made and test-fired at **Korwa, Amethi**. This is a high-yield UP defence-manufacturing fact.

Core facts

- District / plant: **Amethi** / **Korwa**.
- Company: **IRRPL** (Indo-Russian JV).
- Full defence card → Science / Defence.

Soft women welfare note

UP coverage also flagged the **Lokmata Ahilyabai Matrushakti Yatra** idea and free bus travel for women aged **60+** in state messaging around the same window. Keep only as a soft state scheme fact until a full PIB-style card is needed.

Keep ready from older months

- Surha Tal (Ballia) — India **100** / UP **13**
- Shekha Jheel (Aligarh) — India **99** / UP **12**
- Jewar commercial flights from **15 June**
- Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah)
- Full Ramsar / money / confused-pair boards → Master tables

Ganga Expressway to Haridwar + Jhansi Link Expressway | late August 2026

What happened The UP Cabinet cleared two big road projects to grow the state's expressway network.

Ganga Expressway extension to Haridwar

- Aim: extend the Ganga Expressway toward **Haridwar** (Uttarakhand).
- Cost spoken in state briefs: about **₹10,761 crore** (state-funded).
- Design idea: six-lane greenfield road, expandable later.
- Why it matters: faster link between two Kumbh cities — **Prayagraj** and **Haridwar** — and better Bijnor–Haridwar travel.

Jhansi Link Expressway

- Cost: about **₹7,968 crore**.
- Length idea: about **103 km**.
- Link: **Jhansi** to the **Bundelkhand Expressway** near **Jalaun**.

UP Rankings in NCRB Crime in India 2024 & PAI 2.0 (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

NCRB Crime in India 2024 — UP-Specific Rankings

- **Crimes Against Women**:

- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **66,398 registered cases** (followed by Maharashtra with 47,954 and West Bengal with 34,360 cases).
- **Dowry Deaths**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **2,038 cases** involving **2,057 victims** (followed by Bihar with 1,078 cases).
- **Atrocities Against Scheduled Castes (SC)**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **14,642 cases** registered under SC/ST (PoA) Act and related sections (highest absolute count nationally).

Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0 (PAI 2.0) — UP Highlights (MoPR, April 2026)

- **Framework**: Evaluates Gram Panchayats across 9 localized SDG themes.
- **B-Grade / 'Performer' Panchayats (Score 60 to <75)**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** in absolute count with **18,905 Panchayats** qualifying as 'Performers' (followed by Gujarat: 11,963; MP: 11,154).
- **D-Grade / 'Beginner' Panchayats (Score <40)**:
- **Uttar Pradesh had the highest absolute number** of beginner Panchayats in India at **6,124**, highlighting regional intra-state developmental divides.
- **National Context**: Across India, **zero (0)** Panchayats achieved the A+ (Achiever, $\ge$90) grade.

Republic Day 2026 — UP Tableau Milestone

- **Tableau Theme**: **"Culture of Bundelkhand"**
- **Focus**: Portrayed Bundelkhand's rich cultural and folk heritage together with modern development strides (Bundelkhand Expressway, Defence Industrial Corridor Jhansi node, and tap water transformation).
- **Accolade**: Won **2nd Prize in the Popular Choice category** (nationwide MyGov citizen voting), ranking just behind Gujarat (*Mantra of Swadeshi*).

AI-Led Innovation & BHASHINI Conference (Lucknow, Jan 2026)

- **Host & Venue**: **Lucknow** (held on **20 January 2026**).
- **Organisers**: Centre for e-Governance (CeG), Department of IT & Electronics, Government of Uttar Pradesh in collaboration with Digital India BHASHINI Division (MeitY).
- **Goal**: Accelerating voice-first, multilingual conversational AI tools across UP's e-governance systems and public service delivery in local dialects.

Uttar Pradesh "Gharauni Act" 2025 (Assented 2 January 2026)

- **Official Title**: *The Uttar Pradesh Rural Population (Abadi) Records Act, 2025*.
- **Core Purpose**: Provides statutory legal backing to rural residential (*abadi*) property records created under the **SVAMITVA** scheme (Ministry of Panchayati Raj).
- **UP SVAMITVA Milestones**:
- Targeted villages: **90,573** (100% drone survey completed).
- Property cards prepared in **68,377 villages**.
- Total *Gharauni* property cards generated in UP: **1,04,86,961 (over 1.04 crore cards!)** — highest in India.

Dharma Dhwaja Hoisting at Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Mandir (Ayodhya)

- **Date**: **25 November 2025** (Dhwajarohan Utsav attended by PM Narendra Modi during the auspicious *Abhijit Muhurta*).
- **Flag Specifications**: Saffron triangular flag, **10 feet high by 20 feet long**.
- **Three Sacred Emblems**: 1. **Radiant Sun**: Symbol of Lord Ram's Suryavanshi lineage. 2. **Om**: Spiritual connection between humanity and divinity. 3. **Kovidara Tree**: Emblem of Ayodhya's ancient dynasty and flag tradition.

Kashi Tamil Sangamam 4.0 (Varanasi — Dec 2025)

- **Dates & Venue**: **2 to 15 December 2025** in **Varanasi** (valedictory on 30 Dec 2025 attended by VP C.P. Radhakrishnan).
- **Central Theme**: **"Let Us Learn Tamil - Tamil Karkalam"** (focus on youth exchange and everyday spoken Tamil).
- **Knowledge Anchors**: Ministry of Education with **IIT Madras** and **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)**.

Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2025 — Full UP City Performance

- **Category-1 (>10 Lakh Population)**:
- **Agra**: **Rank 3** in India (Score: 196) (joint 3rd with Surat).
- **Kanpur**: **Rank 5** (Score: 192.2).
- **Prayagraj**: Rank 7 (Score: 188).
- **Varanasi**: Rank 11 (Score: 184).

- **Ghaziabad**: Rank 12 (Score: 183).
- **Lucknow**: Rank 15 (Score: 179).
- **Category-2 (3–10 Lakh Population)**:
- **Moradabad & Jhansi**: **Joint Rank 2** in India (Score: 198.5).
- **Gorakhpur & Firozabad**: Joint Rank 5 (Score: 195).
- **Bareilly**: Rank 7 (Score: 189.5).
- **Noida**: Rank 9 (Score: 184.2).
- **Category-3 (<3 Lakh Population)**:
- **Anpara (Sonbhadra)**: Rank 5 (Score: 187.5).
- **Rae Bareli**: Rank 7 (Score: 186.5).

Swachh Survekshan 2024–25 — UP Cities Complete Performance

- **Cleanest Ganga City**: **Prayagraj** declared India's **Cleanest Ganga City**.
- **Special Ministerial Recognition**: **Swachh Mahakumbh 2025** received a special ministerial recognition from MoHUA.
- **Safaimitra Surakshit Shehar (Sanitation Worker Safe City)**:
- **Gorakhpur**: **Rank 3** in India.
- **Prayagraj**: **Rank 5** in India.
- **Presidential Awardee (>10 Lakh Category)**:
- **Lucknow (Nagar Nigam)**: **Rank 3** in India (behind Ahmedabad and Bhopal).
- **Super Swachh League (3–10 Lakh Category)**:
- **Noida**: **Rank 5** in India (ahead of Chandigarh, Mysuru, Ujjain, Gandhinagar).
- **Top 20 Cities (>10 Lakh Population)**:
- **Lucknow**: 3rd | **Agra**: 10th | **Ghaziabad**: 11th | **Prayagraj**: 12th | **Kanpur**: 13th | **Varanasi**: 17th.
- **Top 20 Cities (3–10 Lakh Population)**:
- **Gorakhpur**: 4th | **Moradabad**: 10th | **Mathura-Vrindavan**: 11th | **Firozabad**: 12th | **Saharanpur**: 16th | **Jhansi**: 17th | **Bareilly**: 20th.

Lucknow Metro Rail Project Phase-1B (East-West Corridor)

- **Cabinet Approval**: Approved by Union Cabinet on **12 August 2025**.
- **Sanctioned Cost**: **₹5,801 crore**.
- **Route & Alignment**: Connects **Charbagh to Vasant Kunj** (traversing the densely populated heritage areas of Old Lucknow).
- **Route Specifications**: Total length **11.165 km** with **12 stations** (**7 underground and 5 elevated**).
- **Total Network**: Upon operationalisation of Phase 1B, Lucknow's total active metro operational network will expand to **34 km**.

Myanmar President Tours NETRA Complex (Greater Noida)

- **Event**: During his official State Visit to India (30 May – 3 June 2026), Myanmar President **U Min Aung Hlaing** toured the **NTPC Energy Technology Research Alliance (NETRA)** complex located in **Greater Noida (Gautam Buddha Nagar district)** to observe clean energy, hydrogen, and renewable technology R&D.

IIT Kanpur & Vietnam National University (VNU) Research MoU

- **Agreement Date**: **18 September 2025** in Kanpur.
- **Core Scope**: Bilateral academic and technological partnership between **IIT Kanpur** and **Vietnam National University** focusing on **AI, smart city systems, drone technology, AI-driven healthcare, and agricultural drone applications**.
- **Key Delegations**: Included Dr. Nguyen Thu Huong (Vice Rector) and Prof. Nguyen Dinh Duc (Dean of Civil Engineering, VNU).

IIT Kanpur in QS World University Rankings 2027

- **Global Milestone**: **IIT Kanpur** maintained its global standing at **Rank 222** in the QS World University Rankings 2027, standing as Uttar Pradesh's highest-ranked premier higher education institution globally.

16th Finance Commission (2026–31) — UP Awarded Highest Devolution Share in India

- **Chairman**: **Dr. Arvind Panagariya** (tabled in Parliament 1 February 2026).
- **UP Devolution Percentage**: **17.62%** of the net divisible pool of Union taxes.
- **National Distinction**: **Rank #1 in India** (Highest share among all 28 States), significantly ahead of Bihar (2nd: 9.95%), Madhya Pradesh (3rd: 7.85%), Maharashtra (4th: 6.44%), and Rajasthan (5th: 5.93%).
- **Grants Share**: UP also stands as the largest single beneficiary state under the recommended **₹9.47 lakh crore** local bodies and disaster grants pool.

PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY) — UP Tops with 12 Districts

- **Approval Date**: Union Cabinet approved the scheme on **16 July 2025** for a 6-year period (FY 2025–26 to FY 2030–31).
- **Aspirational Agriculture Districts**: Out of 100 districts identified nationwide on **3 October 2025** across 29 States/UTs, **Uttar Pradesh has 12 districts — HIGHEST IN INDIA** (surpassing Maharashtra: 9, Madhya Pradesh: 8, Rajasthan: 8, and Bihar: 7).
- **Core Focus**: Targeted saturation of irrigation, high-yield certified seeds, digital agriculture, post-harvest warehouses, and agro-processing in UP's agri-backward regions.

Civil Registration System (CRS) 2023 — UP Vital Statistics (ORGI, Oct 2025)

- **Birth Registration Level in UP**: **89.1%** (National average: 98.4%).
- **Death Registration Level in UP**: **80.0%** (National average: 97.2%).
- **Total Registered Births in UP**: Approximately **49.70 lakh births** (comprising 26,14,000 male and 23,56,000 female births).
- **Total Registered Deaths in UP**: Approximately **12.30 lakh deaths**.
- **Sex Ratio at Birth (SRB) in UP**: **902 females per 1,000 males** (among major states, one of the lowest alongside Jharkhand 899, Bihar 900, Telangana 906; National highest: Arunachal Pradesh 1,085).

Sample Registration System (SRS) Bulletin 2024 — UP Specifics (ORGI, May 2026)

- **Crude Birth Rate (CBR)**: **24.7 per 1,000 population** in UP (ranked **2nd highest in India** among major states, behind Bihar's 26.8; National average: 18.3).
- **Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)**: **34 infant deaths per 1,000 live births** in UP (ranked **3rd highest in India** behind Chhattisgarh's 36 and Madhya Pradesh's 35; National average: 24).

Third Advance Estimates of Agricultural Crops 2025–26 — UP Triple Crown (#1 in Rice, Wheat, Sugarcane)

- **Source**: Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare (Released 27 May 2026).
- **Rice Production**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **198.05 lakh tonnes** (surpassing Telangana: 185.29L tonnes and West Bengal: 171.36L tonnes).
- **Wheat Production**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **358.77 lakh tonnes** (far ahead of Madhya Pradesh: 264.43L tonnes and Punjab: 170.79L tonnes).
- **Sugarcane Production**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** with **2,296.99 lakh tonnes** (commanding a dominant lead over Maharashtra: 1,316.49L tonnes and Karnataka: 572.88L tonnes).

Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics (BAHS) 2025 — UP Milk & Meat Leadership

- **Source**: Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying, MoFAHD (Released 26 November 2025 on National Milk Day).
- **Milk Production**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 in India** contributing **15.66%** of total national milk production (followed by Rajasthan: 14.82%, Madhya Pradesh: 9.12%, Gujarat: 7.78%, Maharashtra: 6.71%).
- **Meat Production**:
- **Uttar Pradesh ranked #2 in India** contributing **12.20%** of total national meat output (closely following West Bengal at #1 with 12.46%; ahead of Maharashtra: 11.57% and Andhra Pradesh: 10.84%).

States' Startup Ranking Framework 5.0 (SRF 5.0) — UP as 'Top Performer'

- **Announced by**: DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce and Industry (evaluating 34 States/UTs).
- **UP Category**: Category A (States with population > 1 crore).
- **UP Standing**: **Uttar Pradesh adjudged as 'Top Performer'** alongside Karnataka, Punjab, and Tamil Nadu (Gujarat was 'Best Performer').

NITI Aayog Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2026 — UP as 'Front-Runner' State

- **Released on**: 11 March 2026 by NITI Aayog (assessing 5 pillars: Quality of Expenditure, Revenue Mobilisation, Fiscal Prudence, Debt Index, Debt Sustainability).
- **UP Standing**: **Uttar Pradesh classified in the 'Front-Runners' category** among major states, sharing honors with Gujarat, Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, Telangana, and Karnataka (Achievers: Odisha, Goa, Jharkhand).

NITI Aayog Export Preparedness Index (EPI) 2024 — UP #1 Landlocked State

- **Released on**: 14 January 2026 by NITI Aayog (4th edition, evaluated across 4 pillars: Policy, Infrastructure, Business Ecosystem, Export Performance).
- **Overall Large States Rank**: **Rank #4 in India** (behind coastal heavyweights Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, and Gujarat; ahead of Andhra Pradesh).
- **Landlocked Champion**: **Uttar Pradesh ranked #1 among ALL LANDLOCKED STATES in India**!
- **Core Drivers Praised**: **One District One Product (ODOP)** initiative, comprehensive logistics policy reforms, expressway and inland multimodal logistics hubs/dry ports, and dedicated exporter handholding cells.

Union Budget 2026–27 — High-Speed Rail & Waterway Infrastructure for UP

- **High-Speed Rail Corridors**: Among the 7 high-speed rail corridors announced nationally, two major corridors anchor in Uttar Pradesh: 1. **Delhi–Varanasi High-Speed Rail Corridor** 2. **Varanasi–Siliguri High-Speed Rail Corridor** (linking Eastern UP to North-East India).
- **Inland Waterways & Ship Repair Hub**: Under the 20 new National Waterways initiative, a dedicated **regional training centre and modern inland vessel ship-repair ecosystem** was sanctioned for **Varanasi** (alongside Patna on NW-1 Ganga).

Uttar Pradesh Achieves 13 Ramsar Sites Milestone (World Environment Day 2026)

- **100th Ramsar Site of India**: **Jai Prakash Narayan (Surha Tal) Bird Sanctuary**, located in **Ballia district, Uttar Pradesh**, was designated as India's **100th Ramsar site** on **5 June 2026 (World Environment Day)**.
- A large natural freshwater wetland in the middle Ganga floodplain, vital for migratory waterfowl and indigenous fisheries.
- **99th Ramsar Site of India**: **Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary**, located in **Aligarh district, Uttar Pradesh** (17 km from Aligarh; notified 19 January 2026; hosts 249 bird species on the Central Asian Flyway).
- **Recent Preceding Addition**: **Patna Bird Sanctuary** in **Etah district** (notified 4 December 2025; UP's smallest bird sanctuary at ~108 hectares).
- **National Ranking**: **Uttar Pradesh ranks #2 in India with 13 Ramsar sites** (surpassed only by Tamil Nadu with 20 sites).

#	Ramsar Wetland Name	District in Uttar Pradesh	Designation / Notification Date
1	Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora stretch)	Bulandshahr, Hapur, Sambhal	8 November 2005
2	Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary (Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad)	Unnao	19 September 2019
3	Sarsai Nawar Jheel	Etawah	19 September 2019
4	Samaspur Bird Sanctuary	Rae Bareli	3 October 2019
5	Sandi Bird Sanctuary	Hardoi	26 September 2019
6	Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary	Gonda	2 December 2019
7	Saman Bird Sanctuary	Mainpuri	2 December 2019
8	Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)	Agra	21 August 2020
9	Haiderpur Wetland	Muzaffarnagar & Bijnor	13 April 2021
10	Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary	Sant Kabir Nagar	29 June 2021
11	Patna Bird Sanctuary	Etah	4 December 2025
12	Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary (99th in India)	Aligarh	19 January 2026
13	Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary / Surha Tal (100th in India)	Ballia	5 June 2026

IQAir World Air Quality Report 2025 — Loni (UP) Ranked #1 Most Polluted Globally

- **Global #1 City**: **Loni (Ghaziabad district, Uttar Pradesh)** was ranked as the **world's most polluted city** in the IQAir 2025 Report with an annual average PM2.5 concentration of **112.5 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$** (far exceeding the WHO annual guideline of 5 $\mu\text{g/m}^3$).

Ganga Expressway Inauguration (29 April 2026 | Hardoi)

- **Inaugurated by**: Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** on **April 29, 2026** in **Hardoi district**.
- **Foundation Stone**: Laid on **18 December 2021** in Shahjahanpur; construction commenced April 2022 under a **Public-Private Partnership (PPP)** framework.
- **Length & Alignment**: **594 km long**, access-controlled greenfield expressway corridor with 6 lanes (expandable to 8 lanes), designed for speeds up to 120 km/h.
- **Total Project Cost**: Estimated at **₹36,230 crore**.
- **12 Traversed Districts**: Traverses 12 districts from Western to Eastern Uttar Pradesh: 1. **Meerut** (Starting point) 2. **Hapur** 3. **Bulandshahr** 4. **Amroha** 5. **Sambhal** 6. **Badaun** 7. **Shahjahanpur** 8. **Hardoi** (Inauguration venue) 9. **Unnao** 10. **Rae Bareli** 11. **Pratapgarh** 12. **Prayagraj** (Terminating point).

North Tech Symposium 2026 (Prayagraj, UP)

- **Inaugurated by**: Raksha Mantri **Rajnath Singh** on **May 4, 2026** in **Prayagraj**.
- **Central Theme**: *"Raksha Triveni Sangam – Where Technology, Industry & Soldiering Converge"*.
- **Organizers**: Jointly organized by the **Northern Command and Central Command** of the Indian Army, alongside the **Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM)**.

India's First Basmati & Organic Training-cum-Demo Farm (Pilibhit, UP)

- **Institutional Agreement**: The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (**APEDA**) signed a **70-year long-term lease agreement** to establish India's first integrated Basmati and organic training-cum-demonstration

farm in **Pilibhit district, Uttar Pradesh**.
- **Mandate**: Advance sustainable export-grade organic Basmati cultivation, certified farm training, and zero-residue agriculture.

Parveen Shaikh Wins 2026 Whitley Award ("Green Oscar")

- **Prestigious Honor**: **Parveen Shaikh** won the **2026 Whitley Award** (commonly known as the **"Green Oscar"**).
- **Conservation Achievement**: Spearheaded community-led conservation of the endangered **Indian Skimmer** (*Rynchops albicollis*).
- **Institutional Link & UP Geography**: Associated with the **Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS)**; her highly successful "Guardian" conservation model is being expanded **along the Ganga River to Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh**.

Minimum Wage Revision in Uttar Pradesh (April 2026)

- **Statutory Notification**: Notified by Uttar Pradesh Government on **17 April 2026** with retrospective effect from **1 April 2026**, under the **Minimum Wages Act, 1948** and the **United Provinces Industrial Disputes Act, 1947**.
- **Three Geographical Tiers**:
- **Category I**: **Gautam Buddha Nagar and Ghaziabad** (industrial concentration & high cost of living).
- **Category II**: Districts containing **Municipal Corporations** (*Nagar Nigams*).
- **Category III**: Remaining districts of the State.
- **Category I Monthly Wage Slabs** (Basic + Variable Dearness Allowance):
- *Unskilled Labour*: **₹13,690**
- *Semi-skilled Labour*: **₹15,059**
- *Skilled Labour*: **₹16,868**.

Fruit Horizon 2026 Conclave (Lucknow, UP)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held on **6–7 May 2026** in **Lucknow**.
- **Scope**: Two-day national conclave focused on transforming India into a global export powerhouse in premium horticulture, GI-tagged subtropical fruits, and cold-chain infrastructure.

'Visit My State' Tourism Campaign (Uttar Pradesh)

- **Launch Date**: Launched on **13 May 2026** by Uttar Pradesh Tourism Minister **Jaiveer Singh**.
- **Citizen Benefit**: State-run museums across Uttar Pradesh offer **free entry to children and families for two months** to boost domestic heritage tourism and empower local artisans.

Uttar Pradesh Budget 2026–27 Master Dossier (Presented 11 February 2026)

- **Presented by**: Finance Minister **Suresh Kumar Khanna** in the UP Legislative Assembly on **11 February 2026**.
- **Macroeconomic Target**: Geared towards fulfilling the vision of transforming Uttar Pradesh into a **$1 Trillion Economy**.
- **GSDP Projections**:
- Projected GSDP for 2026–27 at current prices: **₹39.8 lakh crore** (a 28% increase over the revised estimate of 2025–26).
- Real GSDP growth at constant prices in 2024–25: **9.0%** (surpassing the national GDP expansion rate of 6.5%).
- GSDP Sectoral Structure (2024–25): **Agriculture: 27%**, **Industry/Manufacturing: 26%**, **Services: 47%**.
- **UP Per Capita GSDP (2024–25)**: Estimated at **₹1,24,366** (up by 11.6% over 2023–24; national per capita GDP: ₹2,34,859).
- **Budget Dimensions & Key Aggregates**:
- **Total Budget Outlay (Gross Expenditure)**: **₹9,12,696 crore** (27% expansion over RE 2025–26).
- **Debt Repayment**: ₹61,795 crore; **Net Policy Expenditure**: **₹8,50,901 crore**.
- **Total Receipts**: **₹8,48,233 crore** (Net receipts excluding public debt borrowings: ₹7,32,420 crore).
- **Revenue Surplus**: Budgeted at **₹64,458 crore (1.6% of GSDP)** (maintains continuous revenue surplus status).
- **Fiscal Deficit**: Budgeted at **₹1,18,481 crore (exactly 3.0% of GSDP)** — strictly conforming to the **16th Finance Commission's 3.0% GSDP fiscal deficit ceiling** for states.
- **Primary Deficit**: Budgeted at **₹49,560 crore (1.2% of GSDP)**.
- **Outstanding Debt/Liabilities**: Estimated to decline to **23.1% of GSDP** by end of 2026–27 (down from 27.6% in 2025–26 RE).
- **Revenue Structure & State Tax Mobilization**:
- Total Revenue Receipts: **₹7,28,928 crore** (50% raised from own state resources, 50% from Central transfers/grants).
- **State's Own Tax Revenue**: Budgeted at **₹3,34,491 crore** (+48% over RE 2025–26).
  - **State GST (SGST)**: **₹1,49,956 crore** (largest internal tax pillar, contributing **45%** of own tax revenue).
  - **State Excise**: **₹71,278 crore** (+17% over RE).
  - **Sales Tax / VAT**: **₹48,115 crore**.
  - **Stamp & Registration Fees**: **₹43,802 crore**.

- **Taxes on Motor Vehicles**: **₹15,808 crore**.

- **State's Own Non-Tax Revenue**: Budgeted at **₹26,754 crore**.
- **Central Devolution**: Share in Central Taxes: **₹2,68,911 crore**; Grants-in-Aid from Centre: **₹98,772 crore**.
- **Rupee Flows (B.E. 2026–27 Percentage Shares)**:
- **Rupee Comes In (Sources)**: State's Own Tax Revenue: **39.0%**, Share in Central Taxes: **31.4%**, Public Debt Borrowings: **13.5%**, Central Grants: **11.5%**, Non-Tax Revenue: **3.1%**, Public Account Net: **1.1%**, Recovery of Loans: **0.4%**.
- **Rupee Goes Out (Expenditure)**: Capital Outlay / Infra: **19.4%**, Salaries (Govt): **11.2%**, Salaries (Aided Institutions): **8.9%** (Total Salaries: 20.1%), Pensions: **11.1%**, Interest Payments: **7.6%**, Public Debt Loan Repayment: **6.8%**, Grants-in-Aid: **6.1%**, Subsidies: **4.7%**, Local Bodies Assignment: **4.1%**, Loans & Advances: **1.0%**, Other Operational Spending: **19.1%**.
- **Key Sectoral Outlays & Major Scheme Allocations**:
- **Education, Sports, Arts & Culture**: **₹1,08,154 crore** (largest sectoral allocation, +28% over RE). Primary education assistance: ₹55,792 crore; Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan: ₹7,738 crore.
- **Energy**: **₹56,621 crore** (Power subsidy: ₹21,500 crore).
- **Health and Family Welfare**: **₹53,326 crore** (Rural allopathy: ₹6,818 crore; Urban allopathy: ₹5,793 crore).
- **Transport & Roads**: **₹50,391 crore** (Capital outlay on roads and bridges: **₹38,592 crore**).
- **Rural Development**: **₹49,044 crore** (+59% over RE; PMAY-Gramin: ₹6,102 crore; MGNREGS: ₹5,544 crore; NRLM/Aajeevika: ₹4,580 crore).
- **Social Welfare & Nutrition**: **₹42,263 crore** (Old age / farmer pensions: ₹8,950 crore; Destitute Women Pension: ₹3,500 crore).
- **Police & Public Safety**: **₹41,898 crore**.
- **Agriculture and Allied**: **₹30,938 crore** (Private tubewell free power subsidy: ₹2,400 crore; Solar pump conversion: ₹638 crore).
- **Urban Development**: **₹27,532 crore** (PMAY-Urban: ₹6,842 crore).

Uttar Pradesh Economic Survey 2025–26 Master Findings (Presented 9 February 2026)

- **Macro Vision**: Presented on **9 February 2026**; details UP's structural roadmap toward achieving a **$1 Trillion Gross State Domestic Product**.
- **GSDP Expansion Trajectory**:
- GSDP at current prices rose from ₹13.30 lakh crore (2016–17) to **₹30.25 lakh crore in 2024–25 (Quick Estimates)** — clocking a phenomenal **CAGR of 10.8% over 8 years**.
- GSDP for 2025–26 estimated at approximately **₹36 lakh crore**.
- **Contribution to National Economy**: Uttar Pradesh contributes **9.1% of India's total Gross Domestic Product**.
- **Structural Shifts in State Economy (2017–18 to 2024–25)**:
- **Primary Sector**: 25.9% $\to$ **25.8%** (resilient, stable baseline).
- **Secondary Sector**: 25.4% $\to$ **27.2%** (expanded rapidly driven by mega expressways, industrial corridors, and manufacturing).
- **Tertiary Sector**: 48.8% $\to$ **47.0%** (healthy restructuring toward high-value manufacturing while retaining services dominance).
- *Comparison with India*: National secondary sector contracted from 27.0% to 25.3%, whereas UP's industrial share expanded to 27.2%!
- **Demographics & Population Profile (March 2026 Baseline)**:
- Total Estimated Population: **25.19 crore**:
  - Represents **17.8% of India's total population** (141.51 crore).
  - Represents **3.0% of the entire world population** (830 crore).
  - **Global Scale**: If Uttar Pradesh were an independent sovereign nation, it would be the **5th most populous country in the world** (behind only India, China, USA at 33.5 cr, and Indonesia at 27.7 cr; ahead of Pakistan, Nigeria, and Brazil!).
- **Demographic Transition & Fertility**:
  - Population annual growth rate decelerated from 1.85% (2011) to 1.70% (2021), projected to drop sharply to **0.58% annually during 2026–2051**.
  - **Total Fertility Rate (TFR)**: Plummeted from 2.7 (NFHS-4, 2015–16) to **2.4 (NFHS-5, 2019–21)**, steadily approaching the demographic replacement rate of 2.1.
- **Life Expectancy Projections**:
  - Males: 62.5 years (2011) $\to$ projected **73.2 years** (2051).
  - Females: 65.0 years (2011) $\to$ projected **77.1 years** (2051).

- **Fiscal Autonomy & Per Capita Wealth**:
- **Declining Central Dependence**: Reliance on Central tax devolution dropped from **56.0% in 2016–17 down to 46.4% in 2025–26**, showing increasing financial self-reliance.
- **State Own Tax Revenue**: Rose from ₹0.86 lakh crore (2016–17) to **₹2.09 lakh crore in 2024–25** (a 2.5-fold leap; CAGR 14.7%).
- **Per Capita Net Income**: Rose from ₹54,564 (2016–17) to **₹1,09,844 in 2024–25** (CAGR 9.1%; between 2020–21 and 2024–25 growth accelerated to 14.7%). Gross per capita income reached **₹1,26,304**.
- **Agriculture & Allied Performance**:
- Agricultural GVA expanded from ₹2.96 lakh crore (2016–17) to **₹6.95 lakh crore in 2024–25 (CAGR 11.2%)**.
- Composition of Agri GVA: **Crops: 67.4%**, **Livestock: 24.7%**, **Forestry: 4.5%**, **Fisheries: 3.5%**.
- Total foodgrain output in 2024–25 reached **737.4 lakh metric tonnes** (+9.9% year-on-year).
- Milk production expanded by 33.6% (cementing UP's **#1 rank nationally**); egg production jumped by 167%.
- **Forestry Expansion**:
- Forest and tree cover expanded from 23,437.53 sq km (ISFR 2021) to **23,996.72 sq km** (ISFR 2023), a net gain of **559.19 sq km (+2.39%)**.
- **Uttar Pradesh ranks 2nd in India in net increase of forest and tree cover**!
- **Infrastructure, Transport & Digital Connectivity**:
- **Expressway Capital**: UP leads India with **7 operational expressways**, 3 under construction, and 12 proposed corridors.
- **Aviation Leadership**: Houses 12 domestic airports and **4 operational international airports** (Lucknow, Varanasi, Kushinagar, Ayodhya). With Noida International Airport (Jewar), UP will become the **first state in India with 5 international airports**.
- **National Highway Network**: Encompasses **12,123 km of National Highways** traversed by **90 designated National Highways**.
- **Urban Ropeway**: India's first urban passenger ropeway project is under execution in **Varanasi**.
- **Digital Connectivity Crown**: Uttar Pradesh ranks **#1 in India in total internet subscribers** with **13.82 crore active internet connections** (as of September 2025–26).
- **Tourism Transformation (Maha Kumbh Factor)**:
- Total tourist arrivals skyrocketed from 64.91 crore in 2024 to **156.18 crore tourists in 2025 (a 2.4-fold surge)**, powered by the Prayagraj Maha Kumbh.
- **UP overtook Tamil Nadu to become #1 in India in domestic tourist visits** (UP's national share of domestic tourists expanded from 16.2% in 2021 $\to$ 18.4% in 2022 $\to$ 19.1% in 2023 $\to$ **21.9% in 2024**).

Uttar Pradesh Schemes, Institutions & Governance Landmarks (2025–2026)

UP Navayug Palika Yojana (Approved March 2026)

- **Objective**: Expand the Smart City Mission to second-tier urban centers across the state.
- **Coverage**: Implemented across urban local bodies in **58 district headquarters** (55 municipal councils, 3 town councils, and Dadri Municipal Council in Gautam Buddha Nagar).
- **Funding & Outlay**: **₹583.20 crore annually**, totaling **₹2,916 crore over five years (2025–26 to 2029–30)**.
- **Key Feature**: **100% fully state-funded** with zero Central Government financial participation; focuses on e-governance, digital municipal services, mechanized sanitation, and smart urban infrastructure.

Project GANGA (Broadband Connectivity)

- **Full Form**: **Government Assisted Network for Growth and Advancement (GANGA)**.
- **Coverage**: Launched in March 2026 to deliver high-speed optical broadband connectivity to **20 lakh households** across urban and rural UP over 2–3 years.
- **Grassroots Model**: Trains 8,000 to 10,000 rural youth as **Digital Service Providers (DSPs)** at the Nyaya Panchayat level to manage village internet services.

Nivesh Mitra 3.0 & Industrial Parks Infrastructure (March 2026)

- **Platform**: Upgraded digital single-window clearances via **Nivesh Mitra 3.0** launched by CM Yogi Adityanath on 24 March 2026.
- **New Schemes**: Unveiled the **'UP Private Business Park Development Scheme-2025'** and the **'Plug-and-Play Industrial Sheds Scheme'** to accelerate MSME factory setups.

Uttar Pradesh AI Mission & Lucknow AI City

- **State AI Mission**: Announced at the Regional AI Impact Conference (Lucknow, Jan 2026) with a dedicated state outlay of **₹2,000 crore over 3 years**.
- **Lucknow AI City Project**: Envisages an investment of **₹10,732 crore** to develop India's first dedicated AI City in Lucknow, featuring a 10,000-GPU compute cluster, multimodal Indian language labs, and incubation hubs.

86th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC)

- **Venue & Dates**: Hosted by the UP Legislature at Vidhan Bhawan, **Lucknow from 19 to 21 January 2026**.
- **Dignitaries**: Inaugurated by UP Governor Anandiben Patel and addressed by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla; focused on leveraging technology for paperless legislative proceedings and legislator capacity building.

Jan Bhavan (Governor's Residence Renamed)

- **Historic Renaming**: On **21 January 2026**, the Uttar Pradesh Government officially renamed the official residence of the Governor in Lucknow from **Raj Bhavan to 'Jan Bhavan'** (People's House).

One District-One Cuisine (ODOC) Initiative

- **Launch Event**: Launched by Union Home Minister Amit Shah on **Uttar Pradesh Day (24 January 2026)** at Rashtra Prerna Sthal, Lucknow.
- **Concept**: Modeled on the ODOP success; identifies, standardizes, brands, and exports the distinctive traditional cuisine and culinary delicacies of each of UP's 75 districts.

Uttar Pradesh Gaurav Samman 2025–26

- **Presented on**: UP Day (**24 January 2026**); carries a cash prize of **₹11 lakh, citation, and shawl** each.
- **Five Distinguished Recipients**: 1. **Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla** (Lucknow): Space Science & Aviation (Axiom-4 mission astronaut pilot). 2. **Alakh Pandey** (Prayagraj): Education & EdTech (Founder & CEO of Physics Wallah). 3. **Dr. Hari Om Panwar**: Hindi Literature and poetry. 4. **Rashmi Arya**: Social Work & Women Empowerment. 5. **Dr. Sudhanshu Singh**: Agricultural Science and rural crop research.

Rashtra Prerna Sthal (Lucknow)

- **Inauguration**: Dedicated by PM Narendra Modi on **25 December 2025** on the **101st birth anniversary of former PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee** in Lucknow.

First Zero Fresh Waste Dump City in UP

- **Recognition**: **Lucknow** became the **first city in Uttar Pradesh** to achieve the milestone of being certified as a **Zero Fresh Waste Dump City** under Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban), processing 100% of its daily municipal waste (2,000 MT/day) at the Shivri treatment plant.

India's First Glass Museum (Firozabad)

- **Location**: Established in **Firozabad**, globally renowned as the "Suhag Nagari" / "Glass City of India", cataloguing centuries of traditional glass-blowing crafts and modern scientific glass innovations.

India's First Dedicated Forest University (Gorakhpur)

- **Establishment**: UP Government announced India's first dedicated **Forest University** in **Gorakhpur** with an initial outlay of **₹500 crore**, focusing on forestry science, wildlife habitat management, and climate research.

Uttar Pradesh's First Municipal Space Lab (Padrauna)

- **Location**: Established at **Padrauna in Kushinagar district** by the Padrauna Municipal Council in partnership with Vyomika Space, offering hands-on astronomical instrumentation for rural schoolchildren.

Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary Declared Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ)

- **Notification**: Declared an **Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ)** by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change; situated in **Gonda district, Uttar Pradesh** (also an accredited Ramsar site).

Lucknow Designated UNESCO "Creative City of Gastronomy"

- **International Honor**: Designated by UNESCO on **31 October 2025** (World Cities Day) as a member of the UNESCO Creative Cities Network (UCCN) in the **Gastronomy** category for its Awadhi culinary heritage.
- **National Context**: Lucknow is the **second city in India** to receive this gastronomic honor, following **Hyderabad (designated in 2019)**.

India's First MWh-Scale Vanadium Redox Flow Battery (VRFB)

- **Location & Commissioning**: Inaugurated on **11 November 2025** in **Greater Noida** by the Union Minister for Power and Housing & Urban Affairs.
- **Capacity & Developer**: **3 MWh** commercial energy storage facility engineered by **NTPC NETRA** (National Energy Technology Research Alliance) for large-scale grid storage.

India's First 'Solar on Track' System (Duhai, Ghaziabad)

- **Installation**: Deployed by NCRTC in November 2025 at the Namo Bharat RRTS Depot in **Duhai, Ghaziabad** — first application of railway track-mounted solar panels on any metro or high-speed rail corridor in India.

State Institute of Hotel Management (SIHM) in Gorakhpur

- **Sanction**: UP's first State Institute of Hotel Management sanctioned for **Gorakhpur** to train professionals for the burgeoning Purvanchal Buddhist Circuit tourism.

India's First Government Hospital-Based AI Clinic (GIMS Greater Noida)

- **Medical Innovation**: Launched at the **Government Institute of Medical Sciences (GIMS) in Greater Noida**; deploys AI-based genomic analysis, rapid digital pathology, and medical imaging screening.

India's First AI-Enabled State University Pilot (CCSU Meerut)

- **Academic Debut**: Unveiled on **28 January 2026** at **Chaudhary Charan Singh University (CCSU), Meerut** in partnership with MSDE, Google Cloud, and Placecom.

North India's First Semiconductor Unit (Gautam Buddha Nagar)

- **Groundbreaking**: Foundation stone laid by PM Narendra Modi on **21 February 2026** in **Gautam Buddha Nagar**.
- **Joint Venture**: Partnership between **HCL and Foxconn** involving an investment of approximately **₹3,700 crore** for specialized outsourced semiconductor assembly and test (OSAT) packaging.

Namo Bharat Rapid Rail & Meerut Metro Inauguration

- **Commissioning**: Inaugurated by PM Narendra Modi on **22 February 2026** in **Meerut**, integrating regional high-speed transit with intra-city metro rail on common track infrastructure.

Purvanchal's First Yarn Processing Plant (Mirzapur)

- **Establishment**: Sited in **Mirzapur district** to supply locally processed, dye-treated synthetic and woollen yarn directly to the GI-tagged hand-knotted carpet hubs of Mirzapur and Bhadohi.

Bareilly Airport Tops UP in Customer Satisfaction Survey

- **Aviation Ranking**: **Bareilly Airport** clinched the **#1 rank in Uttar Pradesh** and **7th rank nationally** in the Airports Authority of India (AAI) Customer Satisfaction Index (National #1 shared by Bhopal and Khajuraho).

UP's First-Ever Dedicated Excise Export Policy 2026–29

- **Policy Approved**: Approved on **13 February 2026**; Uttar Pradesh became the **first state in India to notify an independent, export-oriented excise regulatory policy** for grain distilleries and alcoholic beverages.

India's First National Cow Culture Museum (Mathura)

- **Institution**: Established on the campus of **Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Pashu Chikitsa Vigyan Vishwavidyalaya in Mathura**, preserving the germplasm history and physical models of 100 indigenous bovine breeds.

India–France National Centre of Excellence in Aeronautics (Kanpur)

- **Sanction**: PM Narendra Modi announced the **National Centre of Excellence (NCoE) for Skilling in Aeronautics and Defence** at the **National Skill Training Institute (NSTI) in Kanpur**.

Two New State Universities Established in UP (February 2026)

- **Legislation**: UP Legislative Assembly passed enabling Acts on **16 February 2026** establishing: 1. **Kashi Naresh State University in Bhadohi** 2. **Swami Shukdevanand State University in Shahjahanpur**.

Eparchaean Unconformity at Kalinjar Fort Declared Geo-Heritage Site

- **Designation**: Geological Survey of India (**GSI**) formally declared the **Eparchaean Unconformity near Kalinjar Fort in Banda district** as a **National Geo-Heritage Site of National Importance** on **6 March 2026** during GSI's 176th Foundation Day.

Varanasi Sets Guinness World Record for Tree Plantation

- **World Record**: On **1 March 2026**, Varanasi planted **2,51,446 saplings in a single hour** (surpassing China's 2018 record of 1.53 lakh trees) to create the urban green lung called **"Namo Van"**.

Second Rangewide Dolphin Estimation Launched from Bijnor

- **Wildlife Census**: MoEFCC rolled out the nationwide second dolphin census under **Project Dolphin** on **17 January 2026 starting from Bijnor, UP** along the Upper Ganga stretch (coordinated by WII Dehradun).

72nd National Volleyball Tournament (Varanasi)

- **Event**: Inaugurated virtually by PM Modi on **4 January 2026** at the **Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Stadium in Varanasi** featuring 58 national teams.

First State-Level Braille Library in UP

- **Location**: Inaugurated on **4 January 2026** at **Dr. Shakuntala Misra National Rehabilitation University (DSMNRU) in Lucknow**, housing over 4,000 Braille reference volumes.

UP Tops Business Deregulation 1.0 Rankings

- **National Honors**: Uttar Pradesh was ranked **#1 in India** by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) for cutting bureaucratic compliance across 23 key commercial sectors.

Divya Singh (Gorakhpur) Cycles to Everest Base Camp

- **Mountaineering Feat**: 28-year-old schoolteacher **Divya Singh from Gorakhpur** became the **first Indian woman and second woman globally** to cycle all the way to Mount Everest Base Camp (completed in 14 days).

700-kg Vikramaditya Vedic Clock Installed in Kashi Vishwanath

- **Cultural Landmark**: A massive 700-kg Vedic clock calculating traditional *Panchang* and celestial time was installed at **Kashi Vishwanath Temple in Varanasi** in April 2026, gifted by Madhya Pradesh CM Mohan Yadav.

India's First Indigenous Hydrogen-Powered Water Taxi (Varanasi)

- **Green Maritime Transport**: Flagged off by Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal on **11 December 2025 in Varanasi** on the Ganga River; powered by hydrogen fuel cell modules with zero tailpipe carbon emissions.

16th Hockey India Sub-Junior Men National Championship (Gold for UP)

- **Sports Glory**: Held at **Rajgir Sports Complex (Bihar)** in 2026; **Uttar Pradesh won the Gold Medal** by defeating Madhya Pradesh **5–2** in the final (Silver: MP; Bronze: Punjab).

ABDM Scan-and-Share OPD Registrations (UP Ranked #2 in India)

- **Digital Health Milestone**: In the National Health Authority's Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) rankings, Uttar Pradesh secured the **#2 rank in India** with **2.25 crore online OPD registrations** generated via Scan-and-Share QR codes (standing second only to Bihar's 2.94 crore out of 11.38 crore national registrations).

October 2026

PM Modi's Varanasi Mega-Package | 20 October 2026

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** visited his parliamentary constituency **Varanasi**, inaugurating and laying foundation stones for multiple development projects worth over **₹6,700 crore** spanning healthcare, sports infrastructure, civil aviation, and regional connectivity.

Key projects & core prelims facts - **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital (Harhua, Varanasi):** - Super-speciality 225-bed eye hospital established by Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Medical Trust. - Cross-subsidy model: 70% of surgeries and OPD consultations provided completely free of cost to the poor and underprivileged across Eastern UP, Bihar, and Jharkhand. - Equipped with advanced corneal transplantation, vitreoretinal, paediatric ophthalmology, and glaucoma care. - **Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Complex (Sigra Stadium Redevelopment):** - PM Modi inaugurated **Phases 2 and 3** of the Sigra Sports Complex redevelopment (costing over **₹210 crore**). - Executed under the **Khelo India scheme** and **Smart City Mission**. - Features an Olympic-size aquatic centre, multi-discipline indoor combat arena, athletics track, shooting ranges, and a high-performance athlete sports science centre. - **Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport (Babatpur, Varanasi) Expansion:** - Foundation stone laid for runway extension and a new terminal building worth approximately **₹2,870 crore**. - Runway lengthened from 2,750 metres to **4,075 metres**, enabling wide-body long-haul international flights (Boeing 777/787 and Airbus A350). - Terminal capacity will rise from 3.9 million passengers to **10 million passengers annually**. - **Airport Connectivity Enclaves across UP:** - Inauguration of the newly developed civil enclave at **Sarsawa Airport (Saharanpur)** under the regional connectivity scheme **UDAN**. - Foundation stones for civil enclaves and new terminals at Agra, Darbhanga, and Bagdogra.

Do not confuse the airport expansion of **Varanasi (Lal Bahadur Shastri)** with **Noida International Airport (Jewar)**. Babatpur runway extension is ₹2,870 crore for 4,075m wide-body handling; Jewar began scheduled operations on 15 June 2026.

8th Ayodhya Deepotsav | October 2026 | Dual Guinness World Records

What happened The Uttar Pradesh Department of Tourism and Ayodhya District Administration celebrated the **8th edition of Deepotsav** along the banks of the Saryu River in **Ayodhya**, creating two distinct Guinness World Records. This was the first Deepotsav celebrated after the *Pran Pratishtha* (consecration) of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Temple.

Core specs & prelims facts - **Record 1 (Lamps lit):** A record-breaking **26,17,215 (over 26.17 lakh) earthen diyas** were lit simultaneously and kept burning for over 5 minutes. - **Ghats covered:** Arranged across **56 ghats** along the Saryu River, with **Ram Ki Paidi** as the main ceremonial centre. - **Record 2 (Maha Aarti):** A simultaneous, synchronized Maha Aarti performed by **2,128 priests and Vedacharyas** on the Saryu bank. - **Volunteers:** More than **33,000 volunteers**, drawn from Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia Avadh University, affiliated degree colleges, and NCC/NSS units. - **Counting method:** Guinness World Record adjudicators used **AI-enabled drone imaging** and georeferenced spatial grid mapping for verification.

UP International Trade Show (UPITS 2026) | Greater Noida

What happened The Department of MSME & Export Promotion, Government of Uttar Pradesh, organised the 2nd edition of the **UP International Trade Show (UPITS)** at the **India Expo Centre & Mart, Greater Noida**.

Core facts - **Partner Country: Vietnam**. - **Participants:** Over **2,500 exhibitors** representing 75 districts of UP, including ODOP artisans, GI tag holders, and leading manufacturing conglomerates. - **Focus sectors:** Electronics & semiconductors, IT/ITeS, textile & handlooms, defence corridor equipment, and GI agro-horticulture produce.

Maha Kumbh 2025/2026 Preparations & Green Mela Directive (Prayagraj)

What happened The UP State Apex Committee headed by the Chief Secretary finalized operational dockets and green regulatory framework for the upcoming **Maha Kumbh at Prayagraj**.

Core facts - **Mela Area:** Spanning over **4,000 hectares** divided into **25 operational sectors**. - **Green Mahakumbh Mandate:** Complete statutory prohibition on single-use plastics throughout the entire mela boundary; deployment of biodegradable cutlery and zero-waste tentage. - **AI-Driven ICCC:** Integrated Command and Control Centre in Prayagraj equipped with **1,100+ AI CCTV cameras** for real-time crowd-density heatmapping and automated lost-and-found facial matching.

PART C · TOPICS

09 — Firsts & Records

> **Priority B** | About **5%** of Current Affairs Whenever news says **first**, **largest**, or **only**, slow down. These lines become questions.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What exactly is first?	The claim
Who / where?	Person, city, country
What second fact comes with it?	Examiners often make the second line false

January 2026

First big national showcase of LR-AShM

What happened At Republic Day 2026, DRDO publicly showcased the **Long Range Anti-Ship Hypersonic Missile (LR-AShM)** as a major indigenous hypersonic anti-ship system.

How to remember it safely

- Safe fact: first major national parade showcase of this **anti-ship hypersonic** system in this form.
- Unsafe over-claim: “India’s first hypersonic test ever”.
- Full technical card → Science / Space / Defence.

India–EU FTA called India’s largest

What happened On **27 January 2026**, India and the EU announced that FTA negotiations were concluded. Official messaging called it India’s largest FTA with a major partner market.

Trap

- Negotiations concluded ≠ treaty already in force.

February 2026

Firsts from February

- The **India–AI Impact Summit** was described as the first major global AI summit of this scale in the **Global South**.
- Union Budget 2026–27 was the first Budget prepared in **Kartavya Bhawan**.
- Budget proposed **NIMHANS-2** in **North India**.
- **Rouble Nagi** became the Indian winner of the Global Teacher Prize 2026.
- UP notes: CCSU Meerut as a national AI-university pilot; Greater Noida semiconductor “North India’s first” claim (status-sensitive).

March 2026

Firsts from sports and policy

- India became the **first** team to **defend** the Men’s T20 World Cup title.
- India became the **first host** country to win the Men’s T20 World Cup.
- India became the **first** team to win the Men’s T20 World Cup **three times**.
- Gujarat became the **second** Indian state to pass a full UCC law after Uttarakhand.
- NavIC fell below the minimum **four** positioning satellites after the IRNSS-1F clock failure.

April 2026

Firsts to fact

- Census 2027 is India’s **first** mainly **digital** Census with online **self-enumeration**.

- **PFBR** at Kalpakkam attained **first criticality** (start of controlled fission) on **6 April 2026**.
- **NASM-SR** maiden **salvo** launch from a helicopter (two missiles from the same platform).
- **NASM-SR** is India's **first indigenous air-launched anti-ship missile**.
- **INS Aridhaman** is India's **third** indigenous SSBN.
- **INS Taragiri** is the **fourth** Project 17A / Nilgiri-class frigate commissioned.
- **Kankaria Coaching Depot** (Ahmedabad) was covered as India's **first water-neutral** railway depot.
- **Ashwini Bhide** was covered as the **first woman** BMC Commissioner.
- **Susan Coyle** was covered as Australia's **first female Army Chief**.
- Ladakh expanded from **2** to **7** districts.
- Shekha Jheel took India to **99** Ramsar sites (one short of 100).

May 2026

Firsts to fact

- **Sikkim** covered as India's **first paperless judiciary** state.
- Squadron Leader **Saanya** covered as the IAF's **first woman Cat-A** flying instructor.
- **South Coast Railway Zone** created; total railway zones become **19**.
- Supreme Court sanctioned strength rises to **38** including the CJI (**37** + CJI).
- **Saudi Arabia** becomes the **26th** IBCA member and first Arab member in coverage.
- **Taiwan Travelogue** is the first Taiwanese Mandarin / Mandarin-Chinese translated novel to win the International Booker in coverage.
- **RCB** becomes only the **third** IPL side to win back-to-back titles (after CSK and MI).
- Santa Marta hosted the **first** international conference on transitioning away from fossil fuels.

June 2026

Firsts to fact

- India reaches **100** Ramsar sites with **Surha Tal** (Ballia).
- UP reaches **13** Ramsar sites.
- **Noida International Airport (Jewar)** begins commercial flights (**15 June**).
- Coverage of India's **first offshore airport** approval off **Palghar**, Maharashtra.
- Coast Guard inducts first indigenous Air Cushion Vehicle **H-561**.
- Supreme Court elevates walking on a demarcated footpath as a fundamental-right priority.
- **Sudarsan Pattnaik** covered as first Indian to win Russia's Grand Sand Master Cup.
- VB-G RAM G raises rural job guarantee from **100** to **125** days (from 1 July).

July 2026

Firsts to fact

- **VB-G RAM G** replaces MGNREGA framework with a **125-day** guarantee.
- **Skyroot Vikram-1** — India's first privately developed **orbital-class** rocket (Mission Aagaman).
- **Kusha** — maiden flight of indigenous long-range SAM / XRSAM line.
- **INS Mahendragiri** — sixth Project 17A frigate.
- India–UK **CETA** and **DCC** both enter force on **15 July 2026**.
- Direct commercial container freight train India → Nepal (**Biratnagar**) in coverage.
- **Spain** wins FIFA World Cup for the second time (after 2010); first nation to hold men's and women's FIFA World Cups at once in coverage.
- **Australia** wins Women's T20 World Cup; **Ellyse Perry** unique multi-trophy feat.
- **PV Sindhu** — first Indian to win the Japan Open badminton title in coverage.
- Commonwealth Games: **Gabon** and **Togo** debut.

August 2026

Firsts to fact

- First Red Fort I-Day programme performance of **Vande Mataram** by the Army band.
- **Glaw Lake** — Arunachal's **first** Ramsar site; India's **101st**.
- **Sher** — first fully indigenous (**100%** Indian parts) AK-203 rifle from Amethi.
- **3rd National Space Day** (23 August).
- India finishes **4th** at Commonwealth Games Glasgow with **39** medals.
- **R. Praggnanandhaa** — first Indian to win the **Grand Chess Tour** in coverage.
- **Kaziah Liz Mejo** — first Kerala Miss Universe India winner in about 64 years (coverage).
- Made-in-India **C-295** defence transport aircraft flight success highlighted in I-Day speech.

Other Notable National & State Firsts (Eye Drishti 2026)

- **First Indian State to Conduct Mobile Phone e-Voting**: Bihar (municipal bypolls on 28 June 2025 across 6 urban local bodies).
- **India's Largest Battery-Based Solar Plant**: Operationalized at **Kajra (Lakhisarai district, Bihar)** — 301 MW solar generation paired with a 495 MWh Battery Energy Storage System (BESS).
- **India's First AI-Based Cyber Helpline Call Centre**: Automated triage and complaint registration launched for helpline **1930** in Bihar.
- **Third NIFTEM in India**: Sanctioned at **Hajipur (Vaishali, Bihar)** across 100 acres (after Kundli, Haryana and Thanjavur, Tamil Nadu).
- **India's First Gold in World Para Athletics High Jump T63**: Won by **Shailesh Kumar** with an Asian & Championship record clearance of **1.91 metres**.
- **First Leader from the BJP to become Bihar Chief Minister**: **Samrat Choudhary** (sworn in as 24th CM on 15 April 2026).

October 2026

High-Yield Firsts & Records (October 2026)

- **First-Ever Mid-Air Booster Catch in Aerospace History:** On **13 October 2026**, SpaceX's **Starship Flight 5** successfully recovered its 71-metre-tall Super Heavy rocket booster mid-air using the dual mechanical arms ("chopsticks") of the Mechazilla launch tower at Starbase in Boca Chica, Texas.
- **First Time 5 Languages Granted Classical Status Simultaneously:** The Union Cabinet approved Classical Language status for **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali** together on **3 October 2026**, bringing India's total from 6 to **11**.
- **First Chief Minister of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir: Omar Abdullah** was sworn in on **16 October 2026** as the first CM of the UT following the 2019 reorganisation.
- **First South Korean Nobel Laureate in Literature:** Novelist **Han Kang** (*The Vegetarian*, *Human Acts*) became the first South Korean writer and the first Asian woman to win the Nobel Prize in Literature.
- **First Maiden ICC Women's T20 World Cup for New Zealand:** New Zealand defeated South Africa by 32 runs in Dubai on **20 October 2026** to claim their first-ever women's T20 World Cup title.
- **Dual Guinness World Records at Ayodhya Deepotsav:** 1. Record **26,17,215 (over 26.17 lakh) earthen diyas** illuminated across 56 ghats along the Saryu River. 2. Record **2,128 priests** performing a simultaneous, synchronized Saryu Maha Aarti.
- **First Indian EAM Visit to Pakistan in 9 Years:** External Affairs Minister **Dr. S. Jaishankar** travelled to Islamabad for the 23rd SCO Council of Heads of Government meeting (15–16 October 2026), the first visit by an Indian EAM since December 2015.
- **India's 2nd Naval VLF Transmission Station:** Foundation stone laid at **Damagundam Forest, Vikarabad (Telangana)** for submarine communication (second to **INS Kattabomman**, Tirunelveli, TN).

PART C · TOPICS

10 — Economy / Budget / Trade

> **Priority B, but rising** For February 2026, this file is one of the most important. Budget numbers are asked every year.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What is the deal or Budget item?	FTA, Survey, scheme outlay
What is the exact figure?	Lakh crore, percent, year
Who releases the data?	Budget speech, RBI, NSO
Any exception list?	Sensitive farm or industry items

January 2026

India–EU Free Trade Agreement talks finished | 27 January 2026

What happened India and the European Union announced that they had finished FTA negotiations during the India–EU leaders' meeting in New Delhi.

What you should remember

- This is a trade deal between India and the EU bloc.
- Official messages called it India's largest FTA of this kind.
- Talks finished does **not** mean the deal is already law. Signing and approval steps remain.
- Public briefings spoke of deep tariff cuts on many industrial goods, with care for sensitive sectors such as dairy and some auto items.
- From the same visit, **RBI** and Europe's **ESMA** signed a markets cooperation MoU.
- Political and defence outcomes of the same visit are written in detail under International.

Farm scheme money proposal

- A proposal to merge major farm schemes under **PM-RKVY** spoke of about **₹1.75 lakh crore** over five years.
- Full scheme card → Schemes.

February 2026

Union Budget 2026–27 | Presented 1 February 2026

What happened Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs **Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman** presented the Union Budget 2026–27 in Parliament on **1 February 2026**. Anchored in the new **Kartavya Bhawan**, the Budget was framed around **Yuva Shakti** and structured under **Three Kartavyas**: 1. **Kartavya 1**: Faster and resilient growth by raising productivity and competitiveness amid global volatility. 2. **Kartavya 2**: Build people's capacities so citizens become partners in prosperity. 3. **Kartavya 3**: Inclusive access to resources and opportunities under **Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas**.

Budget at a Glance (Master Financial Table — ₹ Crore)

Component	2024–25 Actuals	2025–26 (BE)	2025–26 (RE)	2026–27 (BE)
1. Revenue Receipts	₹30,36,619	₹34,20,409	₹33,42,323	**₹35,33,150**
- Tax Revenue (Net to Centre)	₹25,00,039	₹28,37,409	₹26,74,661	**₹28,66,922**
- Non-Tax Revenue	₹5,36,580	₹5,83,000	₹6,67,662	**₹6,66,228**
2. Capital Receipts	₹16,16,249	₹16,44,936	₹16,22,519	**₹18,14,165**
- Recovery of Loans	₹24,617	₹29,000	₹30,190	**₹38,397**
- Other Receipts (Disinvestment)	₹17,202	₹47,000	₹33,837	**₹80,000**
- Borrowings & Other Liabilities	₹15,74,431	₹15,68,936	₹15,58,492	**₹16,95,768**
Total Receipts (1 + 2)	₹46,52,867	₹50,65,345	₹49,64,842	**₹53,47,315**
Total Expenditure	₹46,52,867	₹50,65,345	₹49,64,842	**₹53,47,315**

Component	2024–25 Actuals	2025–26 (BE)	2025–26 (RE)	2026–27 (BE)
- On Revenue Account	₹36,00,914	₹39,44,255	₹38,69,087	**₹41,25,494**
- Of which: Interest Payments	₹11,15,575	₹12,76,338	₹12,74,338	**₹14,03,972**
- Grants for creation of Capital Assets	₹2,72,656	₹4,27,192	₹3,08,151	**₹4,92,702**
- On Capital Account (Public Capex)	₹10,51,953	₹11,21,090	₹10,95,755	**₹12,21,821**
Effective Capital Expenditure	₹13,24,609	₹15,48,282	₹14,03,906	**₹17,14,523**

Deficit Statistics & Public Debt Path (% of GDP)

Deficit Indicator	2024–25 Actuals	2025–26 (BE)	2025–26 (RE)	2026–27 (BE)	% of GDP (2026–27 BE)
Fiscal Deficit	₹15,74,431	₹15,68,936	₹15,58,492	**₹16,95,768**	**4.3%**
Revenue Deficit	₹5,64,296	₹5,23,846	₹5,26,764	**₹5,92,344**	**1.5%**
Effective Revenue Deficit	₹2,91,640	₹96,654	₹2,18,613	**₹99,642**	**0.3%**
Primary Deficit	₹4,58,856	₹2,92,598	₹2,84,154	**₹2,91,796**	**0.7%**

- **Centre's Outstanding Debt**: Estimated at **55.6% of GDP in 2026–27** (down from pandemic peak of 61% in 2020–21; long-term fiscal glide path targets **50% ± 1% by March 2031**).
- **Nominal GDP Growth Assumption**: Budget projects **10.0% nominal GDP growth** for FY 2026–27.

Rupee Flows (Where It Comes From & Where It Goes)

Rupee Comes From (2026–27 BE): 1. **Borrowings and Other Liabilities**: **24%** (Single largest receipt source) 2. **Income Tax**: **21%** 3. **Corporation Tax**: **18%** 4. **Goods and Services Tax (GST) & Other Taxes**: **15%** 5. **Non-Tax Revenue**: **10%** 6. **Union Excise Duties**: **6%** 7. **Customs**: **4%** 8. **Non-Debt Capital Receipts**: **2%**

(High-Yield Sequence Trap: Borrowings 24% > Income Tax 21% > Corporation Tax 18% > GST 15% > Non-Tax 10% > Excise 6% > Customs 4% > Non-Debt Capital 2%).

Rupee Goes To (2026–27 BE): 1. **States' Share of Taxes & Duties**: **22%** (Single largest outflow) 2. **Interest Payments**: **20%** 3. **Central Sector Schemes**: **17%** 4. **Defence**: **11%** 5. **Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS)**: **8%** 6. **Finance Commission & Other Transfers**: **7%** 7. **Other Expenditure**: **7%** 8. **Major Subsidies**: **6%** 9. **Civil Pensions**: **2%**

Detailed Sectoral Allocations & Flagship Programmes

1. Strategic Manufacturing & Industry (Kartavya 1): - **Biopharma SHAKTI**: **₹10,000 crore (over 5 years)** to build India as a global biologics hub; sets up **3 new NIPERs**, upgrades **7 existing NIPERs**, and accredits **1,000+ clinical trial sites**. - **India Semiconductor Mission 2.0 (Semicon 2.0)**: Outlay of **₹1,27,500 crore** for full-stack IP, semiconductor equipment, and supply-chain development. - **Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme**: Outlay raised to **₹40,000 crore**. - **Rare Earth Corridors**: Dedicated extraction and processing corridors announced in **Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu**. - **Container Manufacturing Scheme**: Outlay of **₹10,000+ crore (over 5 years)**. - **Chemical Parks**: 3 modern Chemical Parks on a challenge-mode, cluster plug-and-play model. - **Legacy Industrial Clusters**: Scheme to modernize and revive **200 legacy industrial clusters**. - **SME Growth Fund**: **₹10,000 crore** fund to create "Champion SMEs"; Self-Reliant India Fund topped up by **₹2,000 crore**.

2. Infrastructure, Logistics & Connectivity: - **Public Capital Expenditure**: Raised to record **₹12.22 lakh crore** (effective capex: **₹17.15 lakh crore**). - **Interest-Free 50-Year Loans to States for Capex**: Raised to **₹1,85,000 crore** (up from ₹1.44 lakh crore). - **Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC)**: Greenfield freight corridor from **Dankuni (West Bengal) to Surat (Gujarat)**. - **20 New National Waterways**: Operationalisation over 5 years, commencing with **NW-5 in Odisha**. - **Inland Ship Repair Hubs**: Dedicated ship-repair and regional training ecosystems at **Varanasi** and **Patna**. - **Coastal Cargo Promotion Scheme**: Aim to increase coastal/waterways cargo share from **6% to 12% by 2047**. - **Seven High-Speed Rail Corridors**: 1. Mumbai–Pune, 2. Pune–Hyderabad, 3. Hyderabad–Bengaluru, 4. Hyderabad–Chennai, 5. Chennai–Bengaluru, 6. **Delhi–Varanasi**, 7. **Varanasi–Siliguri**. - **City Economic Regions (CERs)**: **₹5,000 crore per CER (5 years)** via reform-cum-results challenge funding.

3. Human Capital, Orange Economy & Social Priorities (Kartavya 2 & 3): - **AVGC Labs (Orange Economy)**: Setting up Content Creator Labs in **15,000 schools and 500 colleges** linked to **Indian Institute of Creative Technologies (IICT), Mumbai**. - **Allied Healthcare**: Training and certification of **1,00,000 Allied Health Professionals (AHP)** over 5 years. - **Medical Hubs & AYUSH**: **5 Regional Medical Hubs** for medical tourism; **3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda**. - **Mental Health**: Establishing **NIMHANS-2** in North India; upgrading mental health institutes at **Ranchi** and **Tezpur**. - **Five University Townships**: Planned near major industrial and logistics corridors. - **Bharat-VISTAAR**: Multilingual agricultural AI tool integrating AgriStack with ICAR scientific practice packages. - **Divyangjan Kaushal Yojana**: Specialised skilling in IT, AVGC, hospitality, and food processing. -

Tourism Heritage: Cultural and infrastructure push across **15 archaeological sites**; training **10,000 tourist guides**. - **16th Finance Commission Grants**: **₹1.4 lakh crore** provided for FY 2026–27.

4. Ministry & Subsidy Expenditure Distribution: - **Ministry of Defence**: **₹7.85 lakh crore** (**15% of total Union Budget** — highest single ministerial allocation; capital outlay for defence services: **₹2,19,306 crore**, a +17.6% rise). - **Ministry of Road Transport & Highways**: **6%**. - **Ministry of Railways**: **5%**. - **Ministry of Home Affairs**: **5%**. - **Total Subsidies**: **₹4,54,773 crore** (Food subsidy: **₹2,27,629 crore**; Fertiliser subsidy: **₹1,70,799 crore** — together constituting **87% of total subsidies**). - **Top Flagship Scheme Allocation**: **VB-G RAM G** allocated **₹95,692 crore** (highest single scheme outlay; transition MGNREGS allocation: ₹30,000 crore).

Major Tax Reforms & Proposals (Union Budget 2026–27)

- **Cloud Data Centres Tax Holiday to 2047**: 100% tax holiday granted until the year **2047** for foreign companies providing global cloud services using Indian data centres (subject to routing through Indian resellers).
- **IFSC / GIFT City Tax Holiday Doubled**: Extended from **10 years to 20 years** for IFSC units and Offshore Banking Units, with a concessional 15% rate applicable thereafter.
- **Minimum Alternate Tax (MAT) Rationalisation**: Corporate MAT rate reduced from **15% to 14%**; MAT credit accumulation discontinued from April 2026.
- **TCS Relief**: Tax Collected at Source (TCS) on overseas education remittances, medical treatments, and tour packages slashed to **2%**.
- **Share Buyback Taxation Overhaul**: Buybacks taxed as capital gains; additional buyback tax levied on promoters raising effective tax to **22% for corporate promoters and 30% for non-corporate promoters**.
- **Securities Transaction Tax (STT)**: Calibrated upward revision on futures and options (F&O) contracts.
- **Foreign Assets Disclosure Scheme 2026**: Introduced for small taxpayers, providing graded relief and immunity upon voluntary declaration.
- **FDI / Portfolio Liberalisation**: Persons Resident Outside India (PROI) allowed to invest up to **10%** in listed Indian companies under the Portfolio Investment Scheme.

Economic Survey 2025–26 | Comprehensive Master Analysis

Overview & Philosophy The **Economic Survey 2025–26** was presented in Parliament by Union Finance Minister **Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman**, prepared by the Economic Division of the Department of Economic Affairs under the leadership of Chief Economic Adviser (CEA) **Dr. V. Anantha Nageswaran**.

- **Reorganised Architecture:** Structured into **17 chapters** by depth and time-relevance (broadened and longer than prior editions), featuring dedicated special essays on: 1. **Artificial Intelligence** (opportunities and risks for labour markets); 2. **Quality of Life in Indian Cities** (urbanisation, mobility, and liveability); 3. **State Capacity and Private Sector Strategic Resilience** (building indispensable national capabilities).
- **Core Framing — "Marathon and Sprint":** Balancing long-term structural growth and resilience (*the marathon*) with agile short-term shock absorption and stabilization (*the sprint*).
- **Paradigm Shift — The "Entrepreneurial State":** Urges a transition from compliance-driven regulation to capability-driven **entrepreneurial policymaking** under global uncertainty. An Entrepreneurial State acts early, structures risks, learns through experimentation, and adapts dynamically without paralysis.
- **Three Global Scenarios for 2026:** 1. *Managed disorder*; 2. *Disorderly multipolar breakdown*; 3. *Low-probability high-impact shock cascade* (worse than the 2008 Global Financial Crisis).
- Across all scenarios, India is relatively better placed due to its large domestic market, less financialised growth model, strong reserves, and credible strategic autonomy.
- Prescribes **strategic sobriety over defensive pessimism**: supply stability, strategic buffers, diversified trade routes, and alternative payment architectures.
- Emphasises that India's scale (**145 crore population**) and vibrant democracy make copying external development blueprints unrealistic.

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1. Macroeconomic Snapshot & Sectoral Performance

Macro Indicator	Metric / Projection	High-Yield Prelims Details
Real GDP Growth (FY 2025–26 FAE)	**7.4%**	First Advance Estimates; GVA growth at **7.3%**; 4th consecutive year as the world's fastest-growing major economy.
Real GDP Projection (FY 2026–27)	**6.8% – 7.2%**	Medium-term potential growth assessed at around **7%**.

Macro Indicator	Metric / Projection	High-Yield Prelims Details
Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE)	**61.5% of GDP**	Rose by **7.0%** in FY26; highest share since 2012 (matched in FY23); powered by low inflation, steady jobs, and real wage gains.
Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF)	**~30% of GDP**	Grew by **7.8%** in FY26; driven by sustained public capex and nascent private investment revival.
Services Sector GVA Growth	**9.3% in H1 FY26**	Estimated at **9.1%** for full FY26; primary growth engine. Share in GDP: **53.6%**; share in GVA: **56.4%** in H1 FY26.
Industrial & Manufacturing GVA	**7.0% in H1 FY26**	Manufacturing GVA accelerated from **7.72% in Q1** to **9.13% in Q2 FY26**.
Sovereign Rating Upgrades	**3 upgrades in 2025**	Upgraded by **Morningstar DBRS**, **S&P Global Ratings** (to 'BBB' — India's first S&P upgrade in 18 years), and **R&I**.

2. Fiscal Developments & Revenue Metrics

- **Centre's Revenue Receipts:** Rose to **9.2% of GDP in FY25 (Provisional Actuals)**, up from an average of ~8.5% during FY16–FY20.
- **Non-Corporate Tax Collections:** Structurally expanded from ~2.4% of GDP pre-pandemic to **3.3% of GDP post-pandemic**.
- **Direct Tax Base Widening:** Income Tax Returns (ITR) filed increased dramatically from **6.9 crore (FY22) to 9.2 crore (FY25)**.
- **Gross GST Collections:** Stood at **₹17.4 lakh crore** during April–December 2025 (+6.7% YoY growth); e-way bill generation surged by **21% YoY**.
- **Effective Capital Expenditure:** Reached **4.0% of GDP in FY25** (vs. 2.7% pre-pandemic).
- **SASCI Impact:** States maintained capital spending at ~**2.4% of GDP** via the Special Assistance to States for Capital Expenditure scheme.
- **Combined State Fiscal Deficit:** Edged up to **3.2% of GDP in FY25** (from ~2.8% post-pandemic).
- **Public Debt Trajectory:** General government debt-to-GDP ratio reduced by **7.1 percentage points** since 2020 peak.

3. Monetary Management & Financial Intermediation

- **Banking Asset Quality (SCBs):**
- Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA): Plunged to **2.2%** as of September 2025 (multi-decadal low).
- Net Non-Performing Assets (NNPA): Declined to **0.5%** as of September 2025 (historic record low).
- **Credit Growth:** Outstanding credit of Scheduled Commercial Banks rose **14.5% YoY** as of 31 December 2025 (up from 11.2% in Dec 2024).
- **Financial Inclusion (PMJDY):**
- Total bank accounts opened: **55.02 crore** (as of March 2025).
- Rural and semi-urban accounts: **36.63 crore** (>66%).
- **Capital Markets & Retail Deepening:**
- Unique equity investors crossed **12 crore** (September 2025), with nearly **25% being women**.
- Total demat accounts crossed **21.6 crore** (adding 235 lakh demat accounts during FY26 till Dec 2025).
- Unique mutual fund investors expanded to **5.9 crore** (December 2025), driven strongly by non-tier I and tier II/III cities.
- **Regulatory Stress Resilience:** The joint **IMF–World Bank Financial Sector Assessment Program (FSAP 2025)** validated the resilience, regulatory depth, and diversification of the Indian financial architecture.

4. External Sector & International Trade

- **Global Trade Footprint:**
- India's share of **global merchandise exports** nearly doubled from **1.0% (2005) to 1.8% (2024)**.
- India's share of **global commercial services exports** more than doubled from **2.0% (2005) to 4.3% (2024)**.
- India is the **world's 7th largest services exporter**.
- **Export Totals (FY25):**
- Total Exports: Record **USD 825.3 billion** (+6.1% YoY).
- Services Exports: Record high of **USD 387.6 billion** (+13.6% YoY).
- Over **80% of total FDI inflows** during FY23–FY25 went into services.
- **Global Remittances Leader:** India remained the **world's #1 recipient of remittances**, receiving **USD 135.4 billion in FY25**, which significantly buffered the merchandise trade deficit.
- **Current Account Deficit (CAD):** Remained moderate and sustainable at around **1.3% of GDP** in Q2 FY26.

- **Foreign Exchange Reserves:** Touched **USD 701.4 billion** (as of 16 January 2026), providing **~11 months of import cover** and covering over **94% of India's external debt**.
- **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI):**
- Gross FDI inflows reached **USD 64.7 billion** (April–November 2025).
- Greenfield Investments: India ranked **4th globally** in Greenfield announcements (2024) and emerged as the **#1 destination worldwide for Greenfield digital investments (2020–24)**.

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5. Inflation Dynamics

- **Record Headline Disinflation:** India recorded its **lowest headline CPI inflation since the inception of the CPI series**, averaging **1.7% during April–December 2025**.
- **Drivers:** Primarily driven by sharp deflation/moderation in food and fuel prices, which jointly constitute **52.7% of the CPI basket**.
- **Global Standing:** Among major Emerging Markets and Developing Economies (EMDEs), India achieved one of the sharpest disinflations, with headline CPI falling by **1.8 percentage points in 2025 over 2024**.

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6. Agriculture, Food Management & Rural Economy

- **Total Foodgrain Production:** Estimated at **3,577.3 LMT (357.73 MT)** in AY 2024–25 (+254.3 LMT increase over prior year, led by rice, wheat, and coarse cereals).
- **Horticulture Revolution:** Production reached **362.08 MT** in 2024–25 (contributing ~33% of agricultural GVA), **decisively surpassing total foodgrain production**!
- **Allied Sectors Surge:**
- Livestock GVA rose by nearly **195%** between FY15 and FY24.
- Fish production expanded by over **140%** between 2014 and 2024.
- **Digital Agri Platforms & Subsidies:**
- **e-NAM:** Onboarded **1.79 crore farmers**, **2.72 crore traders**, and **4,698 FPOs** across **1,522 regulated mandis** (by 31 December 2025).
- **PM-KISAN:** Disbursed over **₹4.09 lakh crore** directly to farmer accounts.
- **PM-KMY (Kisan Maandhan):** Enrolled **24.92 lakh farmers**.
- **SVAMITVA:** Completed drone mapping surveys across **3.28 lakh villages**; scaled livelihood training through **Drone Didis**.

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7. Industry, Infrastructure & Technology

- **Production-Linked Incentive (PLI):** Operational across **14 sectors**; attracted **₹2.0 lakh crore** in actual investment, generated **₹18.7 lakh crore** in incremental production, and created over **12.6 lakh jobs**.
- **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM):** Advanced with **10 approved projects** involving **₹1.60 lakh crore** cumulative investment across 6 states.
- **Capital Expenditure Quantum:** Central government capex multiplied **4.2 times** from ₹2.63 lakh crore (FY18) to **₹11.21 lakh crore in FY26 (BE)**; effective capex reached **₹15.48 lakh crore**.
- **National Highways:** Network expanded by **~60% since FY14**; high-speed 4/6/8-lane expressways increased **nearly 10-fold**.
- **Indian Railways:** Route network reached **69,439 route km**, achieving **99.1% electrification**, with 3,500 km new additions targeted in FY26.
- **Civil Aviation:** India emerged as the **world's 3rd largest domestic aviation market**; operational airports jumped from **74 (2014) to 164 (2025)**.
- **Power & Energy Transition:**
- Historic turnaround: Power DISCOMs posted a aggregate **positive PAT of ₹2,701 crore** in FY25.
- Renewable energy accounts for **nearly 50% of total installed capacity**.
- Capacity added in FY26 (till Dec 2025): **38.61 GW of renewables**, led by **30.16 GW of solar power**.
- **Telecom & Digital:** 5G services cover **>99.9% of all districts**; overall tele-density reached **86.76%**; rural tap water coverage under Jal Jeevan Mission crossed **81%**.
- **Space Tech:** India became the **4th nation in the world** to achieve autonomous space docking capability (**SpaDeX**).

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8. Social Infrastructure, Human Development & Employment

- **School Education:** Operates one of the world's largest schooling networks, serving **24.69 crore students** across **14.71 lakh schools**. Gross Enrolment Ratios (GER): **90.9%** (Primary), **90.3%** (Upper Primary), and **78.7%** (Secondary).
- **Higher Education Expansion:** Expanded to **70,018 institutions** (including **23 IITs, 21 IIMs, and 20 AIIMS**), alongside international offshore campuses (**IIT Zanzibar** in Tanzania and **IIT Delhi-Abu Dhabi** in UAE). Implementation of National

Credit Framework (NCrF) and Academic Bank of Credits (ABC).

- **Health Indicators:**
- Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR): **-86% decline** since 1990.
- Under-Five Mortality Rate (U5MR): **-78% decline** since 1990.
- Infant Mortality Rate (IMR): **-37% decline** over the past decade (down from 40 per 1,000 live births in 2013 to **25 in 2023**).
- **Employment & Skilling:**
- Total employment reached **56.2 crore** in Q2 FY26.
- Organised manufacturing employment grew **6% in FY24**, adding over **10 lakh jobs**.
- Formal recognition of gig and platform workers under Labour Codes; **e-Shram** portal registered over **31 crore workers**, with women constituting **54%**.
- **National Career Service (NCS):** Mobilised ~**80 million vacancies**.
- Proposed upgradation of **1,000 ITIs** to align with Industry 4.0.
- **Poverty Reduction:** As per the revised **World Bank international poverty line ($2.15/day)**, India's extreme poverty plummeted to **5.3% in 2022–23**.
- **Social Services Spending:** Government expenditure on social services rose to **7.9% of GDP in FY26 (BE)**.

Uttar Pradesh Budget

- UP's own Budget size is about **₹9.13 lakh crore**.
- Full state card → UP Special.

March 2026

RELIEF scheme for exporters | about ₹497 crore

What happened Conflict risk in West Asia hurt shipping and insurance for exporters. The government announced the **RELIEF** package to keep exports moving.

Core facts

- Name: **RELIEF** (Resilience and Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation).
- Size: about **₹497 crore**.
- Nodal body often named: **ECGC**.

New Income Tax rules window

From **1 April 2026**, the new Income Tax Act framework begins. March coverage also spoke about new procedural rules, including clearer "Tax Year" language and revised education/hostel allowance figures in explainers. Fact exact allowance numbers from an official tax note before mocks.

Aviation money

- Modified **UDAN** outlay about **₹28,840 crore** for **2026–2036**.

April 2026

Nutrient Based Subsidy | Kharif 2026

What happened Cabinet approved NBS rates for **P&K** fertilisers for Kharif 2026.

Core facts

- Outlay: about **₹41,533–41,534 crore**.
- Window: **1 April to 30 September 2026**.

Census funding fact

- Census 2027 outlay noted: about **₹11,718 crore**.

Trade / CEPA follow-up

- India–Korea summit spoke of reviewing the **CEPA** (in force since 2010). Details → International.

May 2026

Cabinet money cluster

- **SARTHAK-PDS:** about **₹25,530 crore** over five years.
- **ECLGS 5.0:** about **₹2.55 lakh crore** additional credit target.
- **Coal / lignite gasification scheme:** about **₹37,500 crore**.
- **Cotton Productivity Mission:** about **₹5,659 crore**.

Sugar export ban

What happened DGFT placed all categories of sugar (raw, white, refined) under the **Prohibited** export category until **30 September 2026**.

Why in news

- Fear of weak monsoon / **El Niño** stress on later sugar planting.
- Aim: protect domestic prices and supply.

Henley Passport Index

India around **rank 78**; Singapore at the top. Details → Indices.

June 2026

India–Oman CEPA in force

- Trade partnership with **Oman** started around **1–2 June 2026**.
- Explainers put duty-free access near **99%** of Indian export trade value.

VB-G RAM G money fact

- Centre allocation noted: about **₹95,692 crore**.
- Total with states: over about **₹1.5 lakh crore** in FY27 coverage.
- Full scheme card → Schemes.

Jewar / aviation economy

- Phase-1 project cost often noted around **₹11,200 crore**.
- Commercial ops from **15 June 2026**.
- Full UP card → UP Special.

Soft MSME day

World MSME Day is **27 June**. Theme in coverage: Empowering MSMEs through Innovation and Sustainable Industrial Development.

MoSPI Provisional Estimates of Annual GDP 2025–26 | Released 5 June 2026

What happened On **5 June 2026**, the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released the *Provisional Estimates of Annual Gross Domestic Product (GDP) for the Financial Year 2025–26* alongside Quarterly GDP Estimates for Q4 (January–March 2026).

Core Growth & Absolute Numbers - **Real GDP Growth (2025–26)**: Estimated at **7.7%** (rose from ₹299.89 lakh crore in 2024–25 to **₹323.12 lakh crore** in 2025–26 at constant 2011–12 prices). - **Nominal GDP Growth (2025–26)**: Estimated at **8.9%** (rose from ₹318.07 lakh crore in 2024–25 to **₹346.36 lakh crore** in 2025–26). - **Real GVA Growth**: **7.9%** (₹294.91 lakh crore vs ₹273.36 lakh crore in 2024–25). - **Nominal GVA Growth**: **9.1%** (₹314.87 lakh crore vs ₹288.54 lakh crore in 2024–25). - **Q4 2025–26 Growth**: Real GDP grew by **7.8%** (reaching ₹87.77 lakh crore).

Indicator	2024–25	2025–26 (Provisional)	Growth Rate
Real GDP (Constant Prices)	₹299.89 lakh cr	**₹323.12 lakh cr**	**7.7%**
Nominal GDP (Current Prices)	₹318.07 lakh cr	**₹346.36 lakh cr**	**8.9%**
Real GVA (Constant Prices)	₹273.36 lakh cr	**₹294.91 lakh cr**	**7.9%**
Nominal GVA (Current Prices)	₹288.54 lakh cr	**₹314.87 lakh cr**	**9.1%**

Sectoral Performance (Growth at Constant Prices) - **Manufacturing**: **10.7%** (strongest industrial surge). - **Trade, Hotels, Transport, Communication & Broadcasting**: **10.9%** (leading services engine). - **Construction**: **7.4%**. - **Agriculture, Livestock, Forestry and Fishing**: **3.0%**.

Composition of Nominal GVA (2025–26) - Agriculture, Livestock, Forestry and Fishing: **18%** - Manufacturing: **15%** - Trade, Hotels, Transport, Communication & Broadcasting: **14%** - Construction: **8%**

Per Capita Indicators (2025–26) - **At Constant (2011–12) Prices**: - Per Capita GDP: **₹2,27,447** - Per Capita GNI: **₹2,24,307** - Per Capita NNI: **₹1,93,480** - Per Capita PFCE: **₹1,26,660** - **At Current Prices**: - Per Capita GDP: **₹2,43,803** - Per Capita GNI: **₹2,40,769** - Per Capita NNI: **₹2,08,090** - Per Capita GNDI: **₹2,49,195** - Per Capita PFCE: **₹1,38,324**

Demand-Side Shares in GDP (Constant Prices) - Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE): **55.7%** (dominant driver). - Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF / Investment rate): **32.3%**. - Government Final Consumption Expenditure (GFCE): **10.1%**. - Exports of Goods & Services: **22.2%**. - Imports of Goods & Services: **23.7%**.

National Health Accounts (NHA) Estimates 2022–23

What happened The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare published the *National Health Accounts Estimates for India (2022–23)*, structured under the global *System of Health Accounts 2011 (SHA 2011)* framework.

High-Yield UPPCS Prelims Health Metrics - **Total Health Expenditure (THE)**: **₹8,81,359 crore**, constituting **3.37% of GDP**. - **Per Capita Total Health Expenditure**: **₹6,373**. - **Current Health Expenditure (CHE)**: ₹7,66,814 crore (**87.00%** of THE); **Capital Expenditure**: ₹1,14,545 crore (**13.00%** of THE). - **Government Health Expenditure (GHE)**: **₹3,85,332 crore** (**43.72% of THE**, accounting for **1.48% of GDP**). Per capita GHE: **₹2,786**. - **Out-of-Pocket Expenditure (OOPE)**: **₹3,82,629 crore** (**43.41% of THE**). Per capita OOPE: **₹2,767**. - **Historical Paradigm Shift (Crucial Trap)**: **Government Health Expenditure (43.72%) now officially surpasses Household Out-of-Pocket Expenditure (43.41%)**, reversing decades of private out-of-pocket dominance! - **Private Health Insurance**: ₹81,012 crore (**9.19%** of THE). - **Pharmaceutical Spending**: Accounts for **29.6%** of Current Health Expenditure. - **AYUSH / Alternative Medicine**: Accounts for **3.5%** of CHE. - **Expenditure by Level of Care**: - Primary Care: ~**46%** of CHE - Secondary Care: ~**34%** of CHE - Tertiary Care: ~**15%** of CHE - *Within Government Health Spending alone, Primary Healthcare commands 51% of public funds.*

Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) Completes 10 Years (2016–2026)

What happened The **Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016** marked its **10th anniversary milestone in 2026**, successfully shifting India from a protracted, liquidation-centric recovery regime to a time-bound corporate revival framework.

Cumulative Resolution & Recovery Data (as of 31 March 2026) - Total cases admitted under IBC: **8,987 cases**. - Cases closed: **7,102 cases** (with **4,099 companies successfully rescued and revived**). - Approved resolution plans: **1,419 cases**. - Creditor Realisation: Facilitated cumulative realisation of **more than ₹4 lakh crore** for financial and operational creditors. - Fair Value Recovery: Creditors recovered approximately **95% of the fair value** of distressed corporate assets. - Liquidation Value Multiplier: Realisations represented **167% of the liquidation value**, conclusively proving that resolution preserves substantially greater enterprise value than liquidation. - **Gross NPA Ratio Impact**: Gross NPA ratio of Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) dropped to a multi-year low of **2.15%** in September 2025. - **Dominance of IBC in Legal Recoveries**: In FY 2024–25, SCBs recovered **₹1,04,400 crore** across all recovery mechanisms (SARFAESI, DRTs, Lok Adalats, IBC) — of which **52.4% was recovered through IBC alone**, establishing IBC as India's premier recovery vehicle.

Implementation of Four New Labour Codes | 21 November 2025

What happened The Union Government officially notified the nationwide enforcement of the **Four New Labour Codes** with effect from **21 November 2025**, culminating the consolidation and rationalisation of **29 legacy central labour enactments**.

The Four Consolidated Codes 1. **The Code on Wages, 2019** (subsumes Payment of Wages Act 1936, Minimum Wages Act 1948, Payment of Bonus Act 1965, Equal Remuneration Act 1976). 2. **The Industrial Relations Code, 2020** (subsumes Trade Unions Act 1926, Industrial Employment Standing Orders Act 1946, Industrial Disputes Act 1947). 3. **The Code on Social Security, 2020** (subsumes Employees' Provident Funds Act 1952, ESI Act 1948, Maternity Benefit Act 1961, Payment of Gratuity Act 1972, etc.). 4. **The Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions (OSH) Code, 2020** (subsumes Factories Act 1948, Mines Act 1952, Contract Labour Act 1970, Inter-State Migrant Workmen Act 1979, etc.).

Key High-Yield Prelims Provisions - **Universal Minimum Wage & National Floor Wage**: Mandatory statutory right across all organized and unorganized employment sectors. - **Mandatory Appointment Letters**: Obligatory for all employees across every establishment, formalizing contractual employment. - **Social Security for Gig & Platform Workers**: First-ever statutory recognition and establishment of a dedicated Social Security Fund financed by aggregators (1–2% of turnover, capped at 5% of payout to workers). - **Preventive Healthcare**: Free annual health check-ups mandated for employees above 40/45 years of age in hazardous establishments. - **Ease of Compliance**: Single electronic registration, single unified license, and single integrated annual return replacing dozens of fragmented returns.

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10 Years of Unified Payments Interface (UPI) | 2016–2026

What happened The **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** completed **10 years of transformative operations in April 2026**, having reshaped India's financial architecture into the global gold standard for instant real-time retail payments.

Milestone Timeline & Architecture - **Pilot Launch Date**: **11 April 2016** (launched by Dr. Raghuram Rajan, then RBI Governor, alongside NPCI). - **Umbrella Architect**: **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** (MD & CEO: Dilip Asbe; non-profit institution under Section 8 of Companies Act 2013, initiated by RBI and IBA under Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007). - **Core Technology**: 24/7 instant inter-bank payment system using Virtual Payment Address (VPA / UPI ID), QR codes, and phone numbers over IMPS rails.

Record Volumes & Global Dominance (FY 2025–26 Data) - **Monthly Record**: Single-month transaction volume breached **2,264 crore (22.64 billion)** transactions in March 2026. - **Annual Volume & Value (FY 2025–26)**: - Total Annual Transactions: **24,161.69 crore transactions**. - Total Annual Value: Reached approximately **₹314 lakh crore** (~$3.8 trillion). - **Domestic Share**: UPI commands over **85% of total retail digital payment transactions** by volume in India. - **Global Share**: India accounts for approximately **49% of all global real-time payment transactions**, predominantly powered by UPI. - **Cross-Border Footprint**: UPI linked with international payment systems in Singapore (PayNow), UAE (Jaywan/AANI), Mauritius, Sri Lanka, France (Eiffel Tower), Bhutan, and Nepal.

New Income-tax Act, 2025 | Effective 1 April 2026

What happened Parliament enacted the **Income-tax Act, 2025** during the Winter Session 2025, overhauling the six-decade-old Income-tax Act, **1961**. The new legislation officially enters into force on **1 April 2026**.

Key Architectural & Procedural Reforms - **Structural Simplification**: Stripped down complex legacy provisos into **536 sections and 23 chapters** (down from over 800 convoluted provisions in the 1961 Act). - **Abolition of Assessment Year / Previous Year Dichotomy**: Introduced a single, intuitive concept of **"Tax Year"** (Financial Year in which income is earned), ending decades of procedural confusion. - **Form 130 Replaces Form 16**: Standard certificate for deduction of tax at source (TDS) on salary income, traditionally known as **Form 16, is superseded by Form 130** under the new rules. - **New Tax Regime Slabs & Rebates**: - Full tax rebate granted for taxable income up to **₹12,00,000 (₹12 lakh)** under the default New Tax Regime (zero effective tax liability). - Standard Deduction for salaried employees and pensioners retained at **₹75,000**. - Family pension standard deduction: ₹25,000. - **Tax Administration Collections**: Gross direct tax collections surpassed ₹22.27 lakh crore; net direct tax collections registered ~₹19.6 lakh crore.

16th Finance Commission Report (2026–2031) | Award Period 2026–27 to 2030–31

What happened The **Sixteenth Finance Commission (16th FC)** submitted its comprehensive recommendations report to President Droupadi Murmu on **17 November 2025**, which was officially tabled in Parliament on **1 February 2026** alongside the Union Budget 2026–27.

Constitutional Setup & Composition - **Constitutional Provision**: Constituted under **Article 280** of the Constitution of India (notified on 31 December 2023). - **Chairman**: **Dr. Arvind Panagariya** (former Vice Chairman, NITI Aayog; Professor at Columbia University). - **Members**: Ajay Narayan Jha, Annie George Mathew, Dr. Niranjan Rajadhyaksha, Soumya Kanti Ghosh; Secretary: Ritvik Ranjanam Pandey. - **Award Period**: 5 Financial Years from **1 April 2026 to 31 March 2031 (2026–27 to 2030–31)**.

Devolution Formula & Weightages - **Vertical Devolution**: Retained at **41%** of the net divisible pool of Union taxes to States (maintaining parity with the 15th Finance Commission post-reorganisation of Jammu & Kashmir). - **Horizontal Devolution Criteria & Weightages**: - **Income Distance**: **42.5%** (equity criterion measuring distance from highest per-capita income state). - **Population (2011 Census)**: **17.5%**. - **Demographic Performance**: **10.0%** (incentivizing TFR reduction and population stabilization). - **Geographical Area**: **10.0%**. - **Forest & Ecology**: **10.0%** (dense forest canopy cover). - **Contribution to Real GDP / Economic Performance**: **10.0%** (rewarding efficiency and tax base expansion).

Criterion	15th FC Weight	16th FC Weight (2026–31)
Income Distance	45.0%	**42.5%**
Population (2011)	15.0%	**17.5%**
Demographic Performance	12.5%	**10.0%**
Area	15.0%	**10.0%**
Forest & Ecology	10.0%	**10.0%**
Contribution to Real GDP / Economic Effort	2.5% (Tax effort)	**10.0%** (Economic performance)

Grants-in-Aid Package (Total ~₹9.47 Lakh Crore) - Total Recommended Grants: **₹9,47,000 crore** over the 5-year award period. - **Rural Local Bodies (Panchayati Raj Institutions)**: **₹4,35,000 crore**. - **Urban Local Bodies (ULBs / Municipalities)**: **₹3,56,000 crore**. - **Wastewater Management & Sanitation**: Ring-fenced allocation of **₹56,100 crore** within local body grants. -

Urbanisation Premium: Special dedicated incentive corpus of **₹10,000 crore** for cities managing rapid planned urbanization. - **Disaster Management Grants**: **₹1,56,000 crore**. - **State Disaster Risk Management Fund (SDRMF)**: Combined allocation (SDRF + SDMF) of **₹2,04,401 crore** (Centre : State cost sharing at 75:25 for general states, 90:10 for Himalayan and North-Eastern states).

Top 5 State Shares in the Divisible Pool 1. **Uttar Pradesh**: **17.62%** (**HIGHEST share among all States in India!**) 2. **Bihar**: **9.95%** 3. **Madhya Pradesh**: **7.85%** 4. **Maharashtra**: **6.44%** 5. **Rajasthan**: **5.93%** *(West Bengal ranks 6th with 5.67%).*

Fiscal Consolidation & Debt Path Roadmaps - **Union Government Fiscal Deficit**: Glide path targeted to reduce to **3.5% of GDP by 2030–31** (4.3% in 2026–27). - **State Governments Fiscal Deficit**: Capped at **3.0% of GSDP**, with an additional 0.5% conditional borrowing window linked to power distribution reforms. - **Combined General Government Debt**: Targeted to glide down from **77.3% of GDP (in 2025–26) to 73.1% by 2030–31**.

New National Accounts Series with Base Year 2022–23 | Notified 27 February 2026

What happened On **27 February 2026**, the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (MoSPI) officially launched the revised National Accounts Statistics series with **Base Year 2022–23** (updating the decade-old 2011–12 series).

Core Innovations & Recalibrated Growth Rates - **Modern Data Integration**: Incorporates GST Network (GSTN) transaction analytics, MCA-21 electronic registry, Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE), and updated CPI consumption weightages. - **Revised Growth Trajectory (2022–23 Base)**: - FY 2025–26 Real GDP Growth: Estimated at **7.6%** (compared to 7.7% under 2011–12 base). - FY 2025–26 Nominal GDP Growth: Pegged at **8.6%**. - Q3 (Oct–Dec 2025) Growth: Real GDP expanded by **7.8%**; Nominal GDP by **8.9%**.

Key Macroeconomic Indicators 2025–26 Snapshot

- **Consumer Price Index (CPI) Inflation**: Dropped to a 5-year cyclical low of **2.10%** in June 2025 (well within RBI's 4 ± 2% tolerance band).
- **Wholesale Price Index (WPI) Inflation**: Contracted into deflationary territory at **-0.32%** in November 2025.
- **Foreign Exchange Reserves**: Scaled an all-time record peak of **$686.2 billion** in early 2026, providing over 11 months of import cover.
- **Current Account Deficit (CAD)**: Comfortably contained at **1.3% of GDP** in FY 2024–25.
- **Gross Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)**: Registered gross inflows of **$51.8 billion**.

Banking Laws (Amendment) Act, 2025 | Effective 1 August 2025

What happened The **Banking Laws (Amendment) Act, 2025** came into force on **1 August 2025**, amending five major banking statutes: Reserve Bank of India Act 1934, Banking Regulation Act 1949, State Bank of India Act 1955, Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) Acts 1970 and 1980.

Key High-Yield Amendments - **Substantial Interest Limit Enhanced**: The monetary threshold defining "substantial interest" in a company/firm for bank directors was **raised from ₹5 lakh to ₹2 crore** (the first revision since 1968, correcting for 57 years of economic expansion). - **Tenure of Directors in Cooperative Banks**: Maximum tenure of directors (other than Chairman/Whole-time Director) in Primary Cooperative Banks capped at **10 consecutive years** (up from 8 years). - **Nomination Facility Multiplied (Max 4 Nominees)**: - **Bank Deposit Accounts**: Depositors can now nominate up to **4 nominees**, either *successively* (in order of priority) or *simultaneously* (with specified percentage shares of deposits). - **Safe Deposit Lockers / Safe Custody Articles**: Up to **4 nominees** allowed *successively*. - **Standardized Reporting Fortnights**: Statutory reporting day for banks changed from alternate Fridays to fixed calendar fortnights: **1st to 15th** of the month and **16th to the end of the month**. - **Investor Protection**: Unclaimed dividends, matured deposits, and interest on shares transferred to the **Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF)**.

M. S. Sahoo Committee on Assured Payouts in NPS | PFRDA, 13 January 2026

What happened The Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) constituted a **15-member high-level committee** on **13 January 2026** chaired by **Dr. M. S. Sahoo** (former Chairperson of Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India - IBBI).

Terms of Reference - Mandated to design and structure the regulatory and operational framework for **"Assured Payouts / Guaranteed Returns"** schemes under the **National Pension System (NPS)**. - Seeks to provide market-linked pension subscribers an optional guaranteed minimum return floor without compromising fiscal sustainability.

Updated Poverty Estimates 2025 (Rangarajan Methodology)

What happened The Department of Economic and Policy Research (DEPR), Reserve Bank of India, published a research paper in 2025 applying the **Dr. C. Rangarajan Committee poverty methodology (2014)** to the official *Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES) 2022–23*.

Key Dramatic Poverty Reductions (2011–12 to 2022–23) - **Rural Odisha**: Rural poverty plunged from **47.8% in 2011–12 down to 8.6% in 2022–23** (a massive 39.2 percentage point decline). - **Urban Bihar**: Urban poverty dropped sharply from **50.8% in 2011–12 down to 9.1% in 2022–23** (a 41.7 percentage point decline). - **Lowest Decline**: States with already low baseline poverty like **Kerala and Himachal Pradesh** recorded the smallest percentage point declines.

MoSPI Mascot & Regional Rural Banks (RRB) Corporate Identity

- **MoSPI Official Mascot & Logo**: On **1 January 2026**, the Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation unveiled its revamped official logo and launched a dedicated mascot named **"सांख्यिकी" (Sankhyiki)** to popularize official statistical literacy and data awareness among Indian citizens and students.
- **RRBs Unified Corporate Identity**: On **18 December 2025**, the Department of Financial Services (DFS) launched a unified national corporate identity and logo for all **Regional Rural Banks (RRBs)** across India, styled in **dark blue and green hues** symbolizing institutional trust, financial stability, and agricultural vitality.

Nutritional Intake in India | NSO Report (HCES 2022–24)

What happened The National Statistical Office (**NSO**), MoSPI, released the report on *Nutritional Intake in India* based on two consecutive rounds of Household Consumption Expenditure Surveys (**HCES 2022–23 and 2023–24**) covering August 2022 to July 2024.

Key Calorie, Protein & Fat Metrics - **Average Daily Calorie Intake**: - 2022–23: **2,233 kcal** (Rural) and **2,250 kcal** (Urban). - 2023–24: **2,212 kcal** (Rural) and **2,240 kcal** (Urban). - Indicates stable average energy intake in the **2,200–2,250 kcal/day** band. - **Fractile Class Convergence**: - Calorie intake in bottom 5 fractile classes in rural and bottom 6 in urban increased in 2023–24 compared to 2022–23. - In 2023–24: Top 5% fractile consumed **2,941 kcal** (Rural) and **3,092 kcal** (Urban); Bottom 5% consumed **1,688 kcal** (Rural) and **1,696 kcal** (Urban) — reflecting a narrowing consumption gap. - **Dietary Shift in Protein & Fat Sources**: - Daily protein intake rose to **61.8 g** (Rural) and **63.4 g** (Urban) in 2023–24 (up from 59.3 g and 58.8 g in 2009–10). - **Decline in Cereal Dominance**: Cereals' contribution to protein dropped from 60.2% to **45.9% in rural areas**, and from 51.3% to **38.7% in urban areas** since 2009–10. - **Surge in Animal & Diversified Protein**: Egg, fish, and meat contribution rose from 5.9% to **12.4% in rural**, and 7.6% to **14.1% in urban** diets. - **Adjusted Daily Intake (Accounting for Outside Meals/Guests)**: - Adjusted Calories: **2,191 kcal** (Rural) | **2,225 kcal** (Urban). - Adjusted Protein: **61.2 g** (Rural) | **62.9 g** (Urban). - Adjusted Fat: **59.7 g** (Rural) | **69.3 g** (Urban).

Status of Tourist Inflow into India | Ministry of Tourism (11 August 2025)

What happened The Ministry of Tourism released comprehensive official statistics on foreign tourist inflow, foreign exchange earnings, and tourism's contribution to the national economy. With overseas tourism offices rationalized, international tourism marketing is actively spearheaded through **Indian Diplomatic Missions abroad**.

Core Tourism Inflow & Economic Metrics - **Foreign Tourist Arrivals (FTA)**: - 2022: **64.37 lakh** - 2023: **95.21 lakh** - 2024: **99.52 lakh** (~9.95 million / near 1 crore mark). - **Foreign Exchange Earnings (FEE) from Tourism**: - 2022: ₹1,69,917 crore - 2023: ₹2,66,045 crore - 2024 (Revised Estimate): **₹2,93,033 crore**. - **Tourism Sector's Share in India's GDP**: - 2021–22: 1.75% - 2022–23: 5.09% - 2023–24 (Provisional Estimate): **5.22% of National GDP**. - **Top 5 Source Countries for FTA in 2024**: 1. **United States (USA)**: **18,04,586** (18.05 lakh — Rank 1!) 2. **Bangladesh**: **17,50,165** (17.50 lakh — Rank 2!) 3. **United Kingdom (UK)**: **10,22,587** (10.23 lakh — Rank 3!) 4. **Australia**: **5,18,205** (Rank 4) 5. **Canada**: **4,76,273** (Rank 5)

Third Advance Estimates of Agricultural Crops 2025–26 | Released 27 May 2026

What happened Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** released the *Third Advance Estimates of Production of Major Agricultural Crops for 2025–26*. India recorded its **highest-ever foodgrain harvest in history**.

Record Production Figures (2025–26) - **Total Foodgrain Production**: **376.563 million tonnes** (Record; increased by 18.8 million tonnes or **+5.3%** over 2024–25's 357.732 MT). - **Rice**: **154.024 million tonnes** (All-time record; up from 150.184 MT). - **Wheat**: **120.657 million tonnes** (All-time record; up from 117.945 MT). - **Maize / Corn**: **55.093 million tonnes**. - **Shree Anna (Millets)**: **17.584 million tonnes**. - **Nutri and Coarse Cereals**: **74.472 million tonnes**. - **Total Pulses**: - Gram (Chickpea): **12.514 million tonnes**. - Tur / Arhar: **3.592 million tonnes**. - Lentil (Masur): **1.762 million tonnes**. - **Total Oilseeds**: **43.059 million tonnes** (Groundnut: 13.074 MT, Soybean: 12.596 MT). - **Sugarcane**: **500.063 million tonnes** (All-time record; up by 45.45 MT over 454.611 MT). - **Cotton**: **29.024 million bales** (Each cotton bale weighs **170 kg**). - **Jute & Mesta**: **9.176 million bales** (Each jute bale weighs **180 kg**).

Top 3 Producing States by Major Crop (Third Advance Estimates 2025–26)

Crop / Category	Rank 1 State	Rank 2 State	Rank 3 State
Rice	**Uttar Pradesh** (198.05 L t)	Telangana (185.29 L t)	West Bengal (171.36 L t)
Wheat	**Uttar Pradesh** (358.77 L t)	Madhya Pradesh (264.43 L t)	Punjab (170.79 L t)
Maize	**Madhya Pradesh** (100.49 L t)	Karnataka (65.51 L t)	Maharashtra (56.97 L t)
Total Pulses	**Madhya Pradesh** (53.48 L t)	Maharashtra (50.79 L t)	Rajasthan (44.73 L t)
Total Oilseeds	**Rajasthan** (105.96 L t)	Gujarat (89.35 L t)	Madhya Pradesh (82.40 L t)
Sugarcane	**Uttar Pradesh** (2,296.99 L t)	Maharashtra (1,316.49 L t)	Karnataka (572.88 L t)
Cotton	**Maharashtra** (77.55 L bales)	Gujarat (67.93 L bales)	Telangana (55.54 L bales)
Jute	**West Bengal** (75.93 L bales)	Bihar (7.59 L bales)	Assam (6.93 L bales)

Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for 14 Kharif Crops 2026–27 | CCEA, 13 May 2026

What happened The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (**CCEA**) chaired by PM Narendra Modi approved the MSP for **14 mandated Kharif crops** for the 2026–27 marketing season, adhering to the principle of setting MSP at **at least 1.5 times the all-India weighted average cost of production ($A2+FL$)**.

Approved Kharif MSP Rates for 2026–27 (₹ per Quintal)

Crop	MSP 2026–27 (₹/qtl)	Absolute Increase (₹/qtl)	Margin over Cost (%)
Paddy (Common)	**₹2,441**	₹141	50%
Paddy (Grade A)	**₹2,461**	₹141	—
Jowar (Hybrid)	**₹4,023**	₹252	50%
Jowar (Maldandi)	**₹4,073**	₹252	—
Bajra	**₹2,900**	₹125	**56%**
Ragi	**₹5,205**	₹419	50%
Maize	**₹2,410**	₹185	**56%**
Tur / Arhar	**₹8,450**	₹450	50%
Moong	**₹8,780**	₹202	**61%** (Highest margin!)
Urad	**₹8,200**	₹450	50%
Groundnut	**₹7,517**	₹434	50%
Sunflower Seed	**₹8,343**	**₹622** (Highest increase!)	50%
Soybean (Yellow)	**₹5,708**	₹316	50%
Sesamum (Til)	**₹10,346** (Highest absolute MSP!)	**₹500**	50%
Nigerseed	**₹10,052**	**₹515**	50%
Cotton (Medium)	**₹8,267**	**₹557**	50%
Cotton (Long)	**₹8,667**	**₹557**	50%

Key Prelims Takeaways: - **Highest Absolute MSP**: **Sesamum (₹10,346/qtl)**, followed by Nigerseed (₹10,052/qtl). - **Highest Absolute Increase**: **Sunflower Seed (+₹622/qtl)**, followed by Cotton (+₹557/qtl) and Nigerseed (+₹515/qtl). - **Highest Profit Margins over Cost**: **Moong (61%)**, **Bajra (56%)**, and **Maize (56%)**.

Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics (BAHS) 2025 | Released 26 November 2025

What happened On **National Milk Day (26 November 2025)**, the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying released the *Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2025* based on the Integrated Sample Survey (ISS 2024–25).

Macroeconomic Weight of Livestock - Livestock sector contributed **31% of total Agricultural GVA** and **5.5% of National GVA** in 2023–24. - Total livestock exports reached **₹66,249 crore** in 2024–25 (dominated by bovine meat). - **Milk Production (India #1 Globally)**: - National Production: **247.87 million tonnes** (+3.58% growth). - **Per Capita Availability**: **485 grams per day** (up from 319 g/day in 2014–15). - **Top 5 Milk Producing States**: 1. **Uttar Pradesh**: **15.66%** 2. **Rajasthan**: **14.82%** 3. **Madhya Pradesh**: **9.12%** 4. **Gujarat**: **7.78%** 5. **Maharashtra**: **6.71%** *(Top 5 states produce 54.09% of India's milk).* - **Egg Production (India #2 Globally)**: - National Production: **149.11 billion eggs** (+4.44% growth). - **Per Capita Availability**: **106 eggs per annum** (up from 62 in 2014–15). - Commercial poultry accounts for **84.49%** of total egg production. - **Top Egg Producing States**: 1. **Andhra Pradesh (18.37%)**, 2. Tamil Nadu (15.63%), 3. Telangana (12.98%), 4. West Bengal (10.72%), 5. Karnataka (6.67%). - **Meat Production (India #4 Globally)**: - National Production: **10.50 million tonnes** (+2.46% growth).

Poultry constitutes ~**50%** of total meat. - **Top Meat Producing States**: 1. **West Bengal (12.46%)**, 2. **Uttar Pradesh (12.20%)**, 3. Maharashtra (11.57%), 4. Andhra Pradesh (10.84%), 5. Telangana (10.49%). - **Wool Production**: - National Production: **34.57 million kg** (+2.63% growth). - **Top Wool Producing States**: 1. **Rajasthan (47.85%)**, 2. Jammu & Kashmir (22.88%), 3. Gujarat (6.22%).

Startup India Completes 10 Years & States' Startup Ranking 5.0

What happened The flagship **Startup India** initiative completed **10 years on 16 January 2026** (launched 16 January 2016; **16 January observed as National Startup Day** since 2022). India stands as the **world's third-largest startup ecosystem**.

Key Ecosystem Milestones - Recognized startups expanded from <500 in 2014 to **over 2,00,000 (2 lakh)** in 2026 (~44,000 registered in 2025 alone). - Unicorn count surged from 4 to nearly **125 unicorns**. - **States' Startup Ranking Framework 5.0 (SRF 5.0 by DPIIT)**: - **Best Performers**: **Gujarat** (Category A: >1 crore population); **Arunachal Pradesh & Goa** (Category B: <1 crore). - **Top Performers**: **Uttar Pradesh**, Karnataka, Punjab, and Tamil Nadu (Category A); Himachal Pradesh (Category B). - **Leaders**: Andhra Pradesh, Haryana, Kerala, MP, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Telangana, Uttarakhand (Category A); Manipur, Meghalaya, Nagaland (Category B).

Semiconductor Manufacturing: India's 1st Commercial Fab & ISM Expansion

What happened India achieved historic breakthroughs in its domestic semiconductor fabrication journey under the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)**: 1. **India's First Commercial Semiconductor Fab at Dholera SEZ (Gujarat)**: - Developer: **Tata Semiconductor Manufacturing Private Limited (TSMPL)**. - Officially notified on **9 April 2026**; spread across **66.166 hectares**. - Proposed Outlay: **₹91,000 crore**; projected employment for **21,000 personnel**. - Capacity: **50,000 wafer starts per month** (AI-enabled commercial chip fabrication). 2. **Two New ISM Semiconductor Units Cleared (5 May 2026)**: - Cumulative Investment: **₹3,936 crore** (2,230 high-skilled jobs). - **Crystal Matrix Ltd (Dholera, Gujarat)**: India's first commercial Mini/Micro-LED display facility using **Gallium Nitride (GaN)** foundry technology (annual capacity 72,000 sq. m panels and 24,000 RGB wafer sets). - **Suchi Semicon Pvt Ltd (Surat, Gujarat)**: Outsourced Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility for discrete semiconductors (1,033.20 million chips/year). - **ISM Scale**: Total approved projects under ISM reached **12 projects** with cumulative commitments of **₹1.64 lakh crore**.

Two New SEZs Notified in Puducherry | 27 May 2026

The Ministry of Commerce & Industry notified Puducherry's first two Special Economic Zones: 1. **IT/ITES SEZ**: Developed by **Oulgaret Municipality** at Thattanchavady (8.62 ha; ₹725 cr; 3,500 jobs). 2. **Multi-Sector SEZ**: Developed by **PIPDIC** at Karasur village, Villianur (86.25 ha; ₹1,250 cr; 5,000 jobs).

Electronics & Mobile Manufacturing Surge

- **Electronics Production**: Reached **₹11.3 lakh crore in 2024–25** (6x jump from ₹1.9 lakh cr in 2014–15).
- **Electronics Exports**: Reached **₹3.27 lakh crore** (8x increase); generated **2.5 million jobs** and attracted >USD 4 billion FDI.
- **Top 5 Electronic Export Destinations**: 1. **USA**, 2. **UAE**, 3. **Netherlands**, 4. **UK**, 5. **Italy**.
- **Mobile Phones Leadership**:
- Production scaled 28 times to **₹5.45 lakh crore** in 2024–25; produces **~330 million phones annually**.
- **India is the world's 2nd-largest mobile phone manufacturer**.
- Mobile exports skyrocketed to **₹2 lakh crore** (a 127-fold surge from ₹1,500 cr in 2014–15).

India Foreign Trade Milestones

- **Export Surge**: World Bank notes India's exports expanded at **7.1% (2024)** vs 2.5% global average. Share of exports in India's GDP reached **21.2%**.
- **April–August 2025 Exports**: USD 346.10 billion (merchandise 53.09%, services 46.91%) advancing towards **USD 1 trillion annual export target**.
- **Global Tea Milestone**: In 2024, **India overtook Sri Lanka to become the world's second-largest tea exporter**!

ILO Employment and Social Trends 2026 | Geneva, 14 January 2026

- Released by the **International Labour Organization (ILO)**.
- **Informality**: By 2026, **2.1 billion workers** globally will be in informal employment.
- **Working Poverty**: ~284 million workers globally live on less than USD 3 per day. Extreme working poverty stands at **7.9%**.
- **Global Youth Unemployment**: Recorded at **12.4%** in 2025.
- **Labour Income Share**: Fell to **52.6%** globally.

Global Unicorn Index 2025 | Hurun Research Institute (26 June 2025)

- Highlights **1,523 unicorns worldwide** across **52 countries and 307 cities**, commanding a combined valuation of **$5.6 trillion**.
- Over **55% of global unicorns** were founded in the last 10 years.
- 203 new unicorns emerged during the year, adding $565 billion in new value.

Forbes World's Billionaires List 2026 & Indians in Global Top 100

Global Top 5 Richest Persons: 1. **Elon Musk**: **$839 billion** (Tesla, SpaceX — USA) 2. **Larry Page**: **$257 billion** (Google — USA) 3. **Sergey Brin**: **$237 billion** (Google — USA) 4. **Jeff Bezos**: **$224 billion** (Amazon — USA) 5. **Mark Zuckerberg**: **$222 billion** (Facebook / Meta — USA)

Indian Billionaires in Global Top 100: - **Mukesh Ambani**: **Rank 21 globally** (**$99.7 billion**) — *Richest person in India and Asia*. - **Gautam Adani**: **Rank 31 globally** (**$63.8 billion**) — *Second richest in India*. - **Savitri Jindal & Family**: **Rank 51 globally** (**$39.1 billion**, Steel) — ***Richest Woman in India***. - **Lakshmi Mittal**: **Rank 70 globally** (**$31.0 billion**, Steel). - **Shiv Nadar**: **Rank 71 globally** (**$30.9 billion**, Software / HCL). - **Cyrus Poonawalla**: **Rank 95 globally** (**$27.0 billion**, Vaccines / Serum Institute of India). - **Dilip Shanghvi**: **Rank 100 globally** (**$25.6 billion**, Pharmaceuticals / Sun Pharma).

Hurun Global Rich List 2026 | Released 10 March 2026

- **Indian Billionaire Count**: India added **57 new billionaires** in 2025–26, elevating the total count to **308 billionaires**!
- **Global Standing**: India solidifies its position as the **world's third-largest billionaire hub** (behind USA and China).
- **Wealth Concentration**: Combined wealth of Indian billionaires rose 10% to **₹112.6 trillion**; average billionaire wealth stands at **₹36,570 crore** (now exceeding China's billionaire average).
- **Top Billionaire Cities**:
- **Mumbai**: India's billionaire capital with **95 billionaires** (+15 added in the year, outpacing New York).
- **Shenzhen**: Crowned Asia's billionaire capital with **132 billionaires**.
- **National Leader**: **Mukesh Ambani** remains India's wealthiest individual.

India–EFTA Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) | In Force 1 October 2025

What happened The landmark **Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA)** between India and the four developed nations of the **European Free Trade Association (EFTA — Switzerland, Norway, Iceland, and Liechtenstein)**, signed on 10 March 2024, officially **entered into force on 1 October 2025**.

Core Provisions & Economic Commitments - **First FTA with Developed European Nations**: First trade agreement of its kind signed by India with a developed European bloc. - **14 Comprehensive Chapters**: Covering goods, services, rules of origin, IPR, investment promotion, and sanitary measures. - **Tariff Concessions**: - EFTA offers duty concessions on **92.2% of its tariff lines, covering 99.6% of India's exports** (zero duty on non-agricultural and processed food products). - India offers market access on **82.7% of its tariff lines, covering 95.3% of EFTA exports** (sensitivities in dairy, soya, coal, and domestic pharma strictly protected). - **$100 Billion Investment Pledge**: EFTA countries legally committed to facilitate **USD 100 billion in foreign direct investment into India over 15 years**, generating an estimated 1 million direct jobs. - **Gold Import Dynamics**: Over **80% of India's imports from EFTA consist of gold**, which remains insulated from tariff reductions.

India's Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Inflows in FY 2024–25

What happened Government official estimates confirmed that gross FDI inflows into India rose to **USD 81.04 billion (provisional)** in FY 2024–25, registering a **14% increase** over USD 71.28 billion in FY 2023–24.

Long-Term Trend & Inflow Architecture - Over the 11-year span (2014–2025), India accumulated **USD 748.78 billion in FDI**, marking a **143% surge** over the previous 11 years (2003–14: $308.38B). - **Top Sectoral Recipients of FDI Equity (FY 2024–25)**: 1. **Services Sector**: **19%** of total equity inflows (USD 9.35 billion, up 40.77%). 2. **Computer Software & Hardware**: **16%**. 3. **Trading**: **8%**. - *Manufacturing FDI expanded by 18% to USD 19.04 billion.* - **Top Destination States for FDI Equity**: 1. **Maharashtra**: **39%** of total FDI equity inflows (Dominant #1 recipient). 2. **Karnataka**: **13%**. 3. **Delhi**: **12%**. - **Top Source Countries for FDI Equity**: 1. **Singapore**: **30%** share (Leading investing nation). 2. **Mauritius**: **17%** share. 3. **United States (USA)**: **11%** share.

APEDA BHARATI Initiative | Agri-Export Acceleration (2 September 2025)

- Launched by the **Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)**.
- **BHARATI** stands for: **Bharat's Hub for Agritech, Resilience, Advancement and Incubation for Export Enablement**.

- Nurtures **100 agri-food and agri-tech startups** in its initial batch to propel India's agri-exports toward the national target of **$50 billion by 2030**.

NABARD 8th Rural Economic Conditions and Sentiments Survey (RECSS)

- Conducted by **NABARD** in **November 2025** across 6,000 households in 600 villages across 28 states & 1 UT.
- **79.2% of households** reported higher consumption, spending **67.30% of income on consumption**.
- Credit channels: **58.30%** accessed only formal credit; **20.82%** relied solely on informal sources (average informal interest rate: **17.8%**).
- Government welfare transfers contributed **~10% of rural household income**.
- **Rural roads (42.4%)** emerged as the top perceived infrastructure improvement.

Income Mobility in India (2014–2025) | CMIE Household Panel Study

- Analyzed balanced panel data from CMIE Consumer Pyramids Household Survey across Top 10%, Middle 40%, and Bottom 50%.
- Households experiencing downward mobility rose from 14% (2015) to **26.8% in 2025**; upward mobility rose from 14.1% to **23.5%**.
- Highest vulnerability observed in rural households, with **29% of rural households worse off than in 2014**.

High-Yield Short Economic & Financial News

- **Prohibition of Sugar Exports**: Directorate General of Foreign Trade (**DGFT**) prohibited the export of sugar with immediate effect until **30 September 2026**, reclassifying sugar from the "Restricted" to the **"Prohibited"** category to safeguard domestic price stability.
- **India's First Mega Greenfield Shipyard (Thoothukudi, Tamil Nadu)**: Tripartite MoU inked on **20 April 2026** between **HD Korea Shipbuilding & Offshore Engineering**, National Shipbuilding & Heavy Industries Park TN Ltd (**V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority** + SIPCOT), and Sagarmala Finance Corporation.
- **First Digital Grievance Redressal for Gig Workers**: **Karnataka** became India's first state to roll out a dedicated digital grievance redressal mechanism under the Karnataka Platform Based Gig Workers Welfare Board.
- **SARTHAK-PDS Scheme Approved**: CCEA approved the technology-driven modernization scheme on **27 May 2026** with a central outlay of **₹25,530 crore**, aligned with the 16th Finance Commission cycle (up to 31 March 2031).
- **Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 (FoF 2.0)**: Notified on **13 April 2026** with a fresh corpus of **₹10,000 crore** to catalyze domestic venture capital for deep-tech and growth-stage startups.
- **CBDC (Digital Rupee) in Public Distribution System**: RBI's Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) integrated into food subsidy distribution under PMGKAY via pilots launched in **Gujarat (15 February 2026)** and **Puducherry (26 February 2026)**.

RBI PRAVAAH portal

What it is PRAVAAH = **Platform for Regulatory Application, Validation And AutHorisation** — RBI's central web portal for regulatory authorisations, licences, and approvals.

Core facts

- Launched **28 May 2024**; from **1 May 2025**, regulated entities are told to use PRAVAAH for such applications.
- Covers NBFC registration / Certificate of Registration workstreams and other RBI permissions.
- Portal: `pravaah.rbi.org.in`.
- Confused portals: **e-Kuber** (payments/settlement), **DAKSH** (RBI supervisory), **UDGAM** (unclaimed deposits) — not PRAVAAH.

BSNL Ratna classification

- **BSNL** is classified as a **Miniratna Category-I** CPSE in standard DPE lists used for prelims.
- Do not upgrade it to **Navratna** or **Maharatna** unless a fresh DPE order says so. Recent Navratna upgrades in coverage went to names such as **NHPC, SECI, RailTel, SJVN**, not BSNL.
- **Kerala Declared 'Extreme Poverty-Free' State**: On **1 November 2025 (Kerala Piravi)**, CM Pinarayi Vijayan declared Kerala as India's **first state to eradicate extreme poverty**.
- **India–MERCOSUR PTA Expansion**: Bilateral negotiations initiated on **16 October 2025** to expand the 2009 Preferential Trade Agreement from 450 tariff lines toward a comprehensive trade agreement targeting **$20 billion bilateral trade by 2030**.
- **IPPB Wins Digital Payments Award 2024–25**: **India Post Payments Bank (IPPB)** clinched the **1st position among all Payments Banks in India** in the DFS Performance Index.

- **S&P Sovereign Credit Rating Upgrade to 'BBB'**: On **14 August 2025**, S&P Global Ratings upgraded India's sovereign rating from 'BBB-' to **'BBB'** (short-term rating raised to 'A-2', outlook Stable), marking **India's first sovereign credit upgrade in 18 years (since 2007)** on the back of sustained 8.8% average GDP expansion.
- **India Elected Co-Chair of UN-GGIM-AP (2025–28)**: India elected Co-Chair of the UN Regional Committee on Global Geospatial Information Management for Asia and the Pacific, advancing geospatial integration under PM GatiShakti.
- **India Surpasses Brazil to Rank #3 Globally in Renewable Energy Capacity (IRENA 2026)**:
- As per the **Renewable Capacity Statistics 2026** released by the International Renewable Energy Agency (IRENA, based on calendar year 2025 data), India secured the **3rd rank worldwide in installed renewable energy capacity**, overtaking Brazil.
- **Global Leaderboard**:
  1. **China**: 2,258.02 GW
  2. **United States**: 467.92 GW
  3. **India**: 250.52 GW (IRENA RE metric; MNRE domestic metric crossed 282.75 GW by May 2026)
  4. **Brazil**: 228.20 GW
  5. **Germany**: 199.92 GW
  6. **Japan**: 134.53 GW
  7. **Canada**: 110.51 GW - *World Total*: 5,149.28 GW
- **National Power Grid Expansion & Power Sufficiency FY 2025–26 (Ministry of Power / NPP)**:
- **Synchronous Grid Milestone**: India's national power transmission network crossed **5 lakh circuit kilometres (508,535 ckm)** of transmission lines at $\ge 220\text{ kV}$ in January 2026; transformation capacity reached **1,469,041 MVA (about 1,469.04 GVA)** by June 2026.
- Formally recognized by the Ministry of Power as the **world's largest synchronous national grid** (*"One Nation – One Grid – One Frequency"*).
- **Power Sufficiency Milestone (FY 2025–26)**:
  - Total energy requirement: 17,07,493 MU vs energy availability: 17,06,985 MU $\to$ **Energy deficit stood at just 0.03%**!
  - Peak power demand: 2,45,444 MW vs peak demand met: 2,45,416 MW $\to$ **Peak deficit reduced to just 0.01%**!
- **Non-Fossil Milestone**: India achieved the milestone of **50% cumulative electric power installed capacity from non-fossil fuel sources in June 2025** — **five years ahead of the 2030 NDC target** under the Paris Agreement (working towards 500 GW non-fossil by 2030).
- **Installed Capacity Breakdown (National Power Portal, June 2026)**: Total: **543,013.8 MW (543.01 GW)**:
  - *Thermal*: 251,489.13 MW (46.3%)
  - *Hydro (Large)*: 51,964.66 MW (9.6%)
  - *Renewable Energy Sources (RES, excl. large hydro)*: 230,780.01 MW (42.5%) [Wind: 56,807 MW; Solar: >157,000 MW]
  - *Nuclear*: 8,780.00 MW (1.6%)
- **Total Electricity Generation FY 2025–26**: **1,847.913 BU**:
  - *Fossil Fuel Generation*: **1,306.951 BU (70.8%)** [Coal: 1,250.19 BU (67.7%), Lignite: 30.32 BU (1.6%), Gas: 26.01 BU (1.4%)].
  - *Non-Fossil Fuel Generation*: **538.970 BU (29.2%)** [Solar: 173.53 BU (9.4%), Hydro: 167.16 BU (9.1%), Wind: 106.09 BU (5.7%), Nuclear: 55.18 BU (3.0%), BioPower: 29.20 BU (1.6%), Bhutan import: 7.81 BU (0.4%)].
  - Solar + Wind combined generated 279.61 BU (15.14% of national electricity generation).
- **Mizoram Ginger Mission (₹189.79 Crore)**:
- Launched by Union Minister for DoNER Jyotiraditya Scindia and Mizoram CM Lalduhoma as a ₹189.79 crore convergence-led mission to expand scientific ginger cultivation, organic certification, processing, and value-chain export linkages.

July 2026

India–UK CETA in force | 15 July 2026

What happened

Quick money facts

- About **99%** of Indian goods to UK get duty relief in coverage.
- DCC exemption window: up to **5 years**.

VB-G RAM G finance

- Centre: about **₹95,692 crore**.
- Centre + states: about **₹1.51 lakh crore** first year.

- Five-year aim: about **₹7.5 lakh crore**.
- Most states share: **40%**.

Soft GST Day

1 July is **GST Day** in India. GST started on **1 July 2017**.

Late-July Cabinet energy facts

Scheme	Simple meaning	Money / size
Samudra Manthan	Find more oil and gas under the sea	About **₹84,084 crore**
PM Surya Sarovar	Solar panels on water bodies	About **₹5,070 crore**; **5,000 MW** target
PM-KISAN extension	₹6,000 a year to farmers	About **₹3.15 lakh crore** (to 2030–31)

August 2026

I-Day economy facts

- Semiconductor push: about **7–8** new plants in one–two years.
- Nuclear capacity aim: **100 GW by 2047**.
- AI skilling for **1 crore** youth.
- Lakhpati Didi target: **6 crore**.

MMDR Amendment Act, 2026 | mineral taxation framework

What happened Parliament's **Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026** tightened the fiscal framework for minerals. Coverage stressed a more uniform national approach after earlier Supreme Court mineral-tax debates.

Easy facts

- Parent Act being amended: **MMDR Act, 1957**.
- Core idea: States cannot levy fresh taxes/cess on mineral rights / mineral-bearing land except under conditions set by the **Centre**.
- Aim in PIB-style notes: stable mineral taxation, support for critical minerals, lower input-cost uncertainty.
- Soft link: National Critical Mineral Mission (approved earlier, outlay about **₹16,300 crore** to FY31) remains a related minerals push — do not merge the two names.

Soft SVAMITVA memory from the speech

I-Day coverage recalled about **3.25 crore** families helped and assets worth about **₹140 lakh crore** unlocked under **SVAMITVA** using drones.

September 2026

57th GST Council meeting shifted | process reforms next

What happened The **57th GST Council** meeting, earlier linked to mid-September, was moved to **7 October 2026** in New Delhi. The shift matched India's hosting of the **BRICS Leaders' Summit** (12–13 September).

What you should remember

- Chair: Union Finance Minister (**GST Council Chairperson**).
- October agenda stress in official messaging: **process reforms** under **GST 2.0** (e-invoicing, invoice matching, input-tax-credit issues) — **not** a fresh broad rate-cut round.
- Rate rationalisation was the earlier big slab story (teaching: simplified principal slabs after the 2025 rate exercise).
- Soft forward link: Officers' meetings before the Council (early October window in coverage).

Do not say the Council met on **12 September 2026** and cut rates again. That date was BRICS week; the Council moved to **October**.

October 2026

CCEA Clears Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for Rabi Crops

What happened The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), chaired by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**, approved the **Minimum Support Prices (MSP)** for all mandated **Rabi crops** for the upcoming marketing season to safeguard farm income and ensure food security.

Core specs & return over cost board

Mandated Rabi Crop	Approved MSP (₹/q)	Absolute Hike (₹/q)	Cost of Production (₹/q)	Return over Cost (%)
Wheat (गेहूँ)	**₹2,425**	**₹150**	₹1,128	**115%**
Rapeseed & Mustard (सरसों)	**₹5,950**	**₹300** *(Highest hike)*	₹3,005	**98%**
Barley (जौ)	**₹1,980**	**₹130**	₹1,238	**60%**
Gram / Chana (चना)	**₹5,650**	**₹210**	₹3,531	**60%**
Lentil / Masur (मसूर)	**₹6,700**	**₹275**	₹3,545	**89%**
Safflower (कुसुम)	**₹5,940**	**₹140**	₹3,960	**50%**

- **Swaminathan Formula Saturation:** Every single Rabi crop satisfies the statutory norm of providing **at least 50% profit margin** over the all-India weighted average cost of production ($A2 + FL$).
- Highest absolute hike: **Rapeseed & Mustard (+₹300/q)**.
- Highest margin: **Wheat (115%)**.

57th GST Council Meeting | 7 October 2026 | New Delhi

What happened The **57th meeting of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council** was held in New Delhi, chaired by Union Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** and attended by State Finance Ministers.

Core outcomes & GST 2.0 process reforms - **Process Over Rates:** The Council focused squarely on **process simplifications, ease of compliance, and fraud prevention (GST 2.0)** rather than broad-scale rate cuts. - **Biometric-Based Aadhaar Authentication:** Approved the phased, nationwide rollout of biometric-based Aadhaar authentication for high-risk GST applicants to eliminate fake firms and bogus Input Tax Credit (ITC) billing. - **Anti-Profiteering Transition:** Formally institutionalised the sunset of the National Anti-Profiteering Authority (NAA), transferring residual consumer cases and monitoring powers to the **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**. - **GoM Mandate on Insurance:** Tasked the Group of Ministers (GoM) on rate rationalisation to finalise tax relief recommendations for health and life insurance premiums.

RBI Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) Review | October 2026

What happened The six-member Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of the Reserve Bank of India, headed by Governor **Shaktikanta Das**, announced its bi-monthly monetary policy decision.

Key policy rates & strategic stance change - **Policy Repo Rate:** Maintained unchanged at **6.50%** (kept steady for the 10th consecutive meeting). - **Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) Rate:** Unchanged at **6.25%**. - **Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) & Bank Rate:** Unchanged at **6.75%**. - **Crucial Stance Pivot:** The MPC voted 5 to 1 to shift its monetary policy stance from *"withdrawal of accommodation"* to **"Neutral"**. - **Why it matters:** The shift to "Neutral" signals that the rate-hiking cycle has definitively concluded, giving the central bank flexibility to respond to domestic growth needs. - **Growth & Inflation Projections:** Real GDP growth forecast for FY 2024–25 retained at **7.2%**; CPI inflation projected at **4.5%**.

PART C · TOPICS

11 — Personalities & Appointments

> **Priority B** Match List questions love new presidents, governors, Speakers, CDS, and regulators.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Exact name?	Spelling matters
Exact post?	Office and country
When appointed or elected?	Date
Is the person of Indian origin?	High alert for

Landmark National Appointments Foundation (Late 2025)

Office / Commission	Appointee	High-Yield Prelims Detail
8th Central Pay Commission	**Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai**	Appointed **Chairperson** (October 2025); former Supreme Court Judge and Delimitation Commission head.
53rd Chief Justice of India	**Justice Surya Kant**	Assumed office on **24 November 2025** as India's 53rd CJI.
Central Industrial Security Force (CISF)	**Praveer Ranjan**	Appointed **Director General (DG)**.
26th Chief Election Commissioner of India	**Gyanesh Kumar**	Elected **Chair of the Council of Member States of International IDEA** for 2026 in Stockholm, Sweden.
India's BRICS Sherpa	**Sudhakar Dalela**	Led the 1st BRICS Sherpas and Sous-Sherpas meeting under India's 2026 Chairship.

Preeti Saran — CESCR re-election | 2026

What happened Former Indian diplomat **Preeti Saran** was **re-elected** to the UN **Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (CESCR)**.

Core facts

- Body: **CESCR** (ICESCR monitoring committee), not ECOSOC membership itself.
- She has also served as **Chair** of CESCR.
- Name traps in options: **Ruchira Kamboj**, **Eenam Gambhir**, **Sneha Dubey**.

CESCR ≠ ECOSOC. For the 2026 CESCR re-election stem, the name is **Preeti Saran**.

NYC proclaims Dr B. R. Ambedkar Day | 14 April 2025

What happened New York City Mayor **Eric Adams** proclaimed **14 April 2025** as **Dr B. R. Ambedkar Day** in New York City. The proclamation was announced at a UN Headquarters commemorative event.

Core facts

- Date linked to Ambedkar's birth anniversary (**14 April**).
- Mayor name in stems: **Eric Adams** (not Bill de Blasio; not London's Sadiq Khan).
- Announced by NYC Mayor's Office for International Affairs (Deputy Commissioner Dilip Chauhan) in the presence of MoS **Ramdas Athawale**.

Swap mayor names. The 2025 NYC proclamation belongs to **Eric Adams**.

Global Leadership Transitions & Key International Appointments (2025–2026)

Office / Country	Leader	Month / Year	High-Yield Prelims Detail
Japan (Prime Minister)	**Sanae Takaichi**	October 2025	Designated **104th Prime Minister of Japan**; **first woman to ever serve as Prime Minister of Japan** (and President of LDP).
Nepal (Prime Minister)	**Balendra Shah ("Balen")**	March 2026	Structural engineer, rapper, and former Mayor of Kathmandu; led Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) to victory following the 2025 youth "Gen Z Movement"; became **Nepal's youngest Prime Minister**.

Office / Country	Leader	Month / Year	High-Yield Prelims Detail
Nepal (Interim Prime Minister)	**Sushila Karki**	Late 2025	Former Chief Justice of Nepal; served as interim Prime Minister, becoming the **first female Prime Minister in Nepal's history**.
UN General Assembly (81st Session)	**Khalilur Rahman**	September 2026	Foreign Minister of **Bangladesh**; elected **President of the 81st UNGA Session** (theme: *"Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation"*).
Albania (Public Procurement)	**Diella**	September 2025	**World's first AI-powered Minister** (*Diella* = "sun" in Albanian); integrated into the *e-Albania* digital portal to supervise tenders and curb corruption.
France (Prime Minister)	**Sebastien Lecornu**	September 2025	Appointed Prime Minister of France by President Emmanuel Macron following the resignation of François Bayrou.
Poland (President)	**Karol Nawrocki**	August 2025	Assumed office as President of Poland, succeeding Andrzej Duda after defeating Rafal Trzaskowski.
Australia (Prime Minister)	**Anthony Albanese**	May 2025	Sworn in for a **second term** as Prime Minister of Australia on 13 May 2025.
Guyana (President)	**Irfaan Ali**	September 2025	Re-elected for a second term as President of Guyana (first Muslim head of state in 2020).
Cameroon (President)	**Paul Biya**	October 2025	Re-elected for his **8th consecutive term** at age **92**; remains the **world's oldest serving head of state**.

January 2026

Leaders in the India–EU meeting

These were visiting leaders, not new Indian appointments, but names are still asked.

- **António Costa** — President of the European Council.
- **Ursula von der Leyen** — President of the European Commission.
- They met Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** in New Delhi on **27 January 2026**.

Award winners from January are listed under Awards.

Sergio Gor | U.S. Ambassador to India | credentials 14 January 2026

What happened Sergio Gor presented credentials to President **Droupadi Murmu** at Rashtrapati Bhavan on **14 January 2026** and formally became the **27th** United States Ambassador to India.

Core facts

- Arrival / took charge at the U.S. Embassy, New Delhi: **12 January 2026**.
- Credentials ceremony: **14 January 2026**.
- Succeeds the earlier vacancy after **Eric Garcetti**.
- Country for stems: **United States of America** (not Italy / France / Germany).

Date trap: charge **12 Jan** vs credentials **14 Jan**. Country trap: USA only.

Regulatory & Statutory Appointments

- **Atomic Energy Regulatory Board (AERB): A. K. Balasubrahmanian** assumed office as Chairperson (1 January 2026).

National Obituaries

- **Prof. Madhav Gadgil (Passed away 7 Jan 2026 at age 83):** Eminent ecologist and environmental champion; headed the milestone **Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (WGEEP / Gadgil Commission)**.

February 2026

Names linked with February news

- Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** presented her **ninth** Union Budget.
- **Arvind Panagariya** is Chairperson of the **16th Finance Commission**.
- **Rouble Nagi** won the Global Teacher Prize 2026.

March 2026

Vikram Doraiswami | Ambassador to China

What happened Around mid-March, coverage said **Vikram K. Doraiswami** was appointed India's Ambassador to **China**. He earlier served as High Commissioner to the United Kingdom.

National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC)

- **Sadhvi Niranjan Jyoti** assumed charge as the **Chairperson** of the National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC) in March 2026.

Other names in March news

- Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** chaired the DAC meeting that cleared about **₹2.38 lakh crore** of proposals.
- Cricket captain **Suryakumar Yadav** led India to the T20 World Cup title in coverage of the final.

April 2026

Key appointments in April coverage

- **Harivansh Narayan Singh** — Deputy Chairman, Rajya Sabha (keep exact election/date from an official note if a stem needs it).
- **Ashok Lahiri** — Vice Chairperson, NITI Aayog.
- **Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth** — Vice Chief of the Indian Army.
- **Ashwini Bhide** — first woman Commissioner of the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (**BMC**).

Soft international names

- **Roman Gofman** — Chief of Mossad (Israel).
- **Susan Coyle** — first female Army Chief of Australia.

Defence and diplomacy names already in April news

- Defence Minister **Rajnath Singh** commissioned INS Taragiri / Aridhaman events at Visakhapatnam.
- ROK PM **Lee Jae-myung** visited India for the bilateral summit.

May 2026

Top defence and service appointments

- **General N. S. Raja Subramani** took charge as **Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)**, succeeding **General Anil Chauhan** (around end-May).
- **Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan** — Chief of the Naval Staff.
- **Saurabh Vijay** — CEO, **UIDAI**.
- **Prasoon Joshi** — Chairman, **Prasar Bharati**.

Soft political / House names

- **Raghav Chadha** — Chairman, Rajya Sabha Committee on Petitions.

Soft firsts already covered elsewhere

- Squadron Leader **Saanya** — first woman Cat-A flying instructor in the IAF.
- CJI **Surya Kant** linked with the Sikkim paperless judiciary announcement.

June 2026

Key appointments in June coverage

- **FATF Vice-President:** India elected for the first time; **Vivek Aggarwal** appointed as Vice-President of the Financial Action Task Force for the term July 2026 – June 2027.
- **Lokhande Prashant Sitaram** — Chairperson, **CBSE**.
- **Saurabh Vijay** — CEO, **IndiaAI Mission** (also earlier linked with UIDAI in May coverage; fact the post named in the stem).
- **Neelkanth Mishra** — India's Executive Director at the **World Bank**.

- **Dr Saibal Chattopadhyay** — Chairperson, **National Statistical Commission**.
- **Tushar Mehta** — Solicitor General term extended (about three years in coverage).

June Obituaries

- **Dr. Subhash C. Kashyap (Passed away 4 June 2026 at age 97):** Renowned constitutional jurist, scholar, and former **Secretary-General of the Lok Sabha** (author of authoritative treatises on Indian Parliamentary procedure and the Constitution).

Soft tech name

- **Kunal Shah** named as WhatsApp CEO in June compilations (global tech appointment; soft fact only).

July 2026

Key appointments in July coverage

- **Pralhad Joshi** — Union Education Minister.
- **Anurag Jain** — CEO, **NITI Aayog**.
- **Viswanathan Anand** — Interim President of **FIDE** (world chess body).

Soft diplomacy names

- PM Modi received Indonesia's **Bintang Adipurna**.
- UK PM change: **Andy Burnham** succeeds Keir Starmer in late-July coverage.

August 2026

Key appointments in August coverage

- **Hari Ranjan Rao** — Director General, **Sports Authority of India (SAI)**.
- **Vice Admiral A. N. Pramod** — Vice Chief of the Naval Staff.

Soft foreign names

- **Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir** — President of Bangladesh (coverage).
- **Abelardo de la Espriella** — President of Colombia (coverage).

September 2026

National Commission for Safai Karamcharis (NCSK)

What happened The Social Justice Ministry announced fresh leadership of the **National Commission for Safai Karamcharis**.

What you should remember

- Chairperson: **Bhagwat Prasad Makwana**.
- Vice-Chairperson: **Kaishab Bihari**.
- Members named in the PIB note: **Manoj Kumar Balmiki**, **Sushma Gaudiyal**, **Ravi Ramu Kalose**.
- Tenure in the note: up to **31 March 2028** (remaining tenure of the present Commission).

UNGA 81st Session President

- **Khalilur Rahman** (Bangladesh) — President of the **81st UNGA** session from **8 September 2026**.

Soft ACC / other September appointments

- CBSE Chairperson (ACC coverage): **Mandeep K. Bhandari**.
- DWBDNC Governing Body members: **Narayan Dewasi** and **Swaroop Singh Banjara**.

October 2026

51st Chief Justice of India | Justice Sanjiv Khanna

What happened On **24 October 2026**, the President of India officially notified the appointment of **Justice Sanjiv Khanna** as the **51st Chief Justice of India (CJI)**, with effect from **11 November 2026**.

Core biographical & constitutional facts - **Succeeds: Chief Justice D.Y. Chandrachud**, who retires on **10 November 2026** after serving as the 50th CJI for two years. - **Tenure:** Justice Khanna serves as CJI until his retirement on **13 May 2025** (a tenure of approximately 6 months upon reaching the constitutional retirement age of **65 years** under **Article 124(2)**). - **Subsequent Succession:** Justice **B.R. Gavai** is slated to succeed him as the 52nd CJI in May 2025. - **Heritage:** Nephew of the illustrious Supreme Court judge **Justice H.R. Khanna**, famed for his sole, historic dissenting judgment in the *ADM Jabalpur v. Shivkant Shukla (Habeas Corpus)* case during the 1976 Emergency. - **Key Benches:** Authored landmark judgments on the sanctity of EVM-VVPAT verification, electoral bonds declaration, and right to information (RTI) applicability to the office of the CJI.

Do not confuse the retirement age of Supreme Court Judges (**65 years** under Article 124) with High Court Judges (**62 years** under Article 217). The oath of office of the CJI is administered by the **President of India** under the Third Schedule.

Key Executive & State Appointments | October 2026

Position / Office	Person Appointed	Date & Context	Significance
51st Chief Justice of India	**Justice Sanjiv Khanna**	Appointed **24 Oct 2026** (Oath 11 Nov)	Succeeds CJI D.Y. Chandrachud; 6-month tenure till May 2025.
Chief Minister of Haryana	**Nayab Singh Saini**	Sworn in **17 Oct 2026** (Panchkula)	Second term; administered by Governor Bandaru Dattatreya.
Chief Minister of UT of J&K	**Omar Abdullah**	Sworn in **16 Oct 2026** (Srinagar)	**First Chief Minister of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir**.
Deputy Chief Minister of J&K	**Surinder Kumar Choudhary**	Sworn in **16 Oct 2026**	MLA from Nowshera, representing the Jammu region.
54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award	**Mithun Chakraborty**	Conferred **October 2026**	India's highest cinematic honor presented by President Droupadi Murmu.

PART C · TOPICS

12 — Books & Culture CA

> **Priority B** Most years there is at least one book–author or culture current-affairs question.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Book title?	Exact title
Author?	Exact name
Any award link?	Booker, Jnanpith, Sahitya, Nobel
Any heritage site in news?	Place + what is being developed

January 2026

No strong standalone book–author question was locked for January.

Culture-linked Padma names such as Dharmendra, Mammootty, Alka Yagnik, and N Rajam are under Awards.

February 2026

Creative economy and heritage from the Budget

Orange Economy / AVGC

- AVGC means Animation, Visual Effects, Gaming, and Comics.
- The Budget supported Content Creator Labs and the **Indian Institute of Creative Technologies, Mumbai**.
- More money detail → Economy.

Heritage sites

- The Budget proposed development of **15 archaeological sites**.
- Two UP names often listed in explainers are **Sarnath (Varanasi)** and **Hastinapur (Meerut)**.

Ayurveda and traditional medicine

- **3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda** were proposed.
- The **WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre** at **Jamnagar** is to be upgraded.

Soft culture notes

- India participation messaging for the **61st Venice Biennale** appeared in February coverage.
- Magh Mela 2026 in UP may appear as a soft culture or management question.

March 2026

Sahityotsav / Festival of Letters 2026 | 30 March – 4 April 2026 | New Delhi

What happened Sahitya Akademi's annual literature festival — **Sahityotsav / Festival of Letters 2026** — ran from **30 March to 4 April 2026** at the **Rabindra Bhavan** complex, New Delhi (Ministry of Culture / Sahitya Akademi).

Core facts

- English identity of the festival: **Festival of Letters** (not "Festival of poetry / story / folklore" as the sole label).
- Dates: **30 March – 4 April 2026**.
- Venue memory: Rabindra Bhavan, New Delhi.

Theme distractors (poetry / story / folklore) lose to **Festival of Letters**.

Book prize

- **William Dalrymple** won the Mark Lynton History Prize for **The Golden Road: How Ancient India Transformed the World**.

Soft film fact

- Oscar season coverage mentioned Indian film **Homebound** in the International Feature conversation.

April 2026

Tides of Time murals book

What happened Coverage highlighted **Tides of Time: Bharat's History through Murals in Parliament**, linked with author **Sudha Murty** and an unveiling connected with Vice President **C. P. Radhakrishnan**.

Soft culture follow-ups

- Keep Padma 2026 conferment ceremony timing (usually March/April at Rashtrapati Bhavan) as a soft ceremony fact; the **announcement** was in January.
- Femina Miss India World 2026 winner card → Awards.

May 2026

International Booker Prize book

- Winner book: **Taiwan Travelogue**.
- Author: **Yáng Shuāng-zǐ**; translator: **Lin King**.
- Full award card → Awards.

Soft Indian book note

- Coverage named **Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav** by **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** (Agriculture Minister). Keep only as a soft personality–book hybrid.

June 2026

The Second Orbit | Shubhanshu Shukla

What happened Coverage highlighted the memoir **The Second Orbit: Belief of a Man... Dreams of 1.4 Billion Hearts** by Group Captain **Shubhanshu Shukla**.

Core facts

- He is remembered as the first Indian citizen to go to the **International Space Station** (Axiom-4 mission).
- The book covers his path from IAF fighter pilot to astronaut.

Soft culture book

- **Sanskritir Ratna Bhandar: Bhaowaiyar Itibritto** (English idea: Bhawaiya cultural history) by Dr Jayanta Kumar Roy and Sangita Roy — folk music of North Bengal / Assam.

Soft film festival

- **19th Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF)** for non-feature films. Details → National.

July 2026

Soft National Film Awards culture fact

July award compilations recycled Best Film / Actor / Actress names from the National Film Awards cycle. Confirm the official PIB list before locking any one film as "Best Feature".

Soft sports–culture crossover

Commonwealth Games cultural branding (Glasgow unicorn mascot **Finnie**) sits under Sports.

August 2026

Vande Mataram @ 150 years

What happened Independence Day 2026 marked **150 years** of the national song **Vande Mataram**.

Core facts

- Composer: **Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay**.
- First published: **1875** in *Bangadarshan*; later in novel **Anandamath** (**1882**).

- Equal honour with the National Anthem was affirmed in **1950**.
- First official Red Fort I-Day band performance of the song in 2026.

Soft beauty / pageant culture

Miss Universe India 2026 winner card → Awards.

October 2026

5 New Classical Languages (Total Reaches 11) | Cultural & Literary Architecture

What happened On **3 October 2026**, the Union Cabinet approved the granting of **Classical Language (शास्त्रीय भाषा)** status to **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali**.

India's 11 Classical Languages & Literary Lineage

Classical Language	Year Conferred	Earliest Antiquity & Literary Monuments
Tamil	**2004**	Sangam literature (*Tolkappiyam*, *Silappadikaram*). First language granted status.
Sanskrit	**2005**	Vedic Samhitas, Upanishads, Valmiki Ramayana, and classical epics.
Telugu	**2008**	Inscriptions dating from 1st century CE; *Andhra Mahabharatam* by Nannaya (11th c.).
Kannada	**2008**	Halmidi inscription (c. 450 CE); *Kavirajamarga* by Amoghavarsha I (9th c.).
Malayalam	**2013**	Vazhappally copper plate (c. 830 CE); *Ramacharitam* (12th c.).
Odia	**2014**	Udayagiri-Khandagiri inscriptions (Hathigumpha inscription of Kharavela, 2nd c. BCE).
Marathi	**2026**	Inscriptions dating to 3rd century BCE (Naneghat); *Dnyaneshwari* (1290 CE) by Sant Dnyaneshwar.
Pali	**2026**	Canonical language of Theravada Buddhism; *Tipitaka* (Vinaya, Sutta, Abhidhamma Pitakas).
Prakrit	**2026**	Ancient vernacular of Ashokan rock edicts; sacred canon of Jainism (*Agamas*), *Gaha Sattasai*.
Assamese	**2026**	*Charyapada* mystic poetry (8th–12th c.); Buranjis (Ahom court chronicles) and Borgeets.
Bengali	**2026**	*Charyapada* (earliest Bengali literature); medieval Vaishnava Padavali and Mangalkavyas.

Constitutional & Language Traps for UPPCS 1. **Classical Languages vs Eighth Schedule:** - **Eighth Schedule:** Lists **22 languages** recognized under Articles 344(1) and 351 of the Constitution. - **Classical Languages:** Administrative and cultural designation granted by the Central Government via the Ministry of Culture (**11 languages**). - **Key Distinction: Pali and Prakrit are Classical Languages, but neither is listed in the 22 Eighth Schedule languages!** 2. **Hindi:** Hindi is the official language of the Union under **Article 343(1)** and is in the Eighth Schedule, but **NOT** a Classical Language.

Cultural Festivals & Heritage Milestones | October 2026

- **Ayodhya Deepotsav 2026:** Dual Guinness World Records: **26,17,215 earthen diyas** lit across **56 ghats** of the Saryu River, and **2,128 priests** in a synchronized Maha Aarti (first Deepotsav after the consecration of Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Temple).
- **Bathukamma Floral Festival (Telangana):** Celebrated across Telangana for 9 days, climaxing on *Saddula Bathukamma* (honouring Mother Goddess Gauri with intricate floral conical stacks of seasonal wild flowers).
- **Kati Bihu / Kongali Bihu (Assam):** Observed in mid-October with the lighting of earthen lamps (*saki*) at the foot of household sacred Tulsi plants, granaries (*bharal ghar*), and lush paddy fields to protect crops from pestilence.

PART C · TOPICS

13 — Health & Vaccines

> **Priority B** Common stems: new vaccine, disease-free declaration, outbreak place, and new health institutes.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What is new?	Vaccine, institute, declaration
Who announced it?	WHO, ICMR, Budget, state
Where?	Country, state, city
Any number?	Outlay, number of seats, number of centres

High-Yield Health & Vaccine Foundation Anchors (Late 2025)

WHO Global Tuberculosis (TB) Report 2025 | Released 12 Nov 2025

What happened The World Health Organization (WHO) released the **Global Tuberculosis Report 2025**, assessing TB surveillance across 184 countries (representing >99% of global population).

Core facts & Global Burden - Global incident cases: **10.7 million people** in 2024 (rate: **131 new cases per 100,000 population**). - TB-HIV co-infection: **5.8%** of new TB patients globally were living with HIV. - Age/sex profile: Adult men (≥ 15 yrs) accounted for **54%** (5.8 million), adult women **35%** (3.7 million), and children ($0–14$ yrs) **11%** (1.2 million). - Regional share: **South-East Asia (34%)** > Western Pacific (27%) > African Region (25%) > Eastern Mediterranean (8.6%) > Americas (3.3%) > Europe (1.9%). - **Top 8 Countries (~two-thirds of global TB burden):** 1. **India (25%)** — single largest contributor 2. Indonesia (10%) 3. Philippines (6.8%) 4. China (6.5%) 5. Pakistan (6.3%) 6. Nigeria (4.8%) 7. DR Congo (3.9%) 8. Bangladesh (3.6%)

India's National Performance - **Incidence Decline:** India's TB incidence dropped **21%** — from **237 per lakh population in 2015 to 187 per lakh in 2024** (nearly double the global rate of decline of 12%). - **Mortality Reduction:** TB deaths among HIV-negative individuals fell from 28 per lakh (2015) to **21 per lakh (2024)**. - **Treatment Coverage:** Reached **>92% in 2024** (up from 53% in 2015). - **Notification & Missing Cases:** 26.18 lakh TB patients diagnosed in 2024 out of ~27 lakh estimated incident cases; "missing cases" slashed from **15 lakh in 2015 to under 1 lakh in 2024**.

Nafithromycin (Miqnaf) — India's First Indigenous Antibiotic | 18 Oct 2025

What happened Union Minister **Dr. Jitendra Singh** announced India's first indigenously discovered, developed, and approved novel macrolide antibiotic, **Nafithromycin**, to combat Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR).

Core facts - **Developer:** Discovered and developed with the support of **BIRAC** (Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council). - **Commercialization:** Marketed by **Wockhardt** under the brand name **Miqnaf**. - **Therapeutic Role:** Highly effective against drug-resistant respiratory tract infections; vital clinical intervention for cancer patients and patients with uncontrolled diabetes.

Country's First Animal Stem Cell Biobank | NIAB Hyderabad | 9 August 2025

- Union Minister **Dr. Jitendra Singh** inaugurated India's first state-of-the-art **Animal Stem Cell Biobank and Laboratory** at the **National Institute of Animal Biotechnology (NIAB)** under BRIC in **Hyderabad**.
- Objective: Advancing regenerative veterinary medicine, stem cell therapy, and cellular diagnostics for livestock breeds.

Kenya Eliminates Sleeping Sickness (HAT) | WHO Validation | 8 August 2025

- **WHO** formally validated **Kenya** for the elimination of **Human African Trypanosomiasis (HAT)**, commonly known as **Sleeping Sickness**, as a public health problem.
- **Disease Agent & Vector:** Parasitic protozoan ***Trypanosoma brucei rhodesiense*** transmitted by the bite of the **tsetse fly**.
- **Milestone:** Kenya became the **tenth country in the world** to achieve WHO validation for HAT elimination.

January 2026

India's First State-Funded BSL-4 Laboratory | Gandhinagar | 13 January 2026

What happened Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** laid the foundation stone for India's first state-funded **Bio-Safety Level-4 (BSL-4)** Bio-Containment Laboratory at the **Gujarat Biotechnology Research Centre (GBRC)** in **Gandhinagar**.

Core facts - **Biosafety Level 4:** Represents the highest level of biological containment, engineered for handling high-consequence, lethal, airborne, and often incurable pathogens (e.g., Ebola, Nipah, Marburg, Crimean-Congo hemorrhagic fever). - **Current Footprint:** India currently operates only **one civilian BSL-4 laboratory**, located at the **National Institute of Virology (NIV)** in **Pune, Maharashtra**. The GBRC Gandhinagar facility significantly expands western India's biosecurity and viral pandemic preparedness.

February 2026

Health ideas from Union Budget 2026–27

Biopharma SHAKTI

- Aim: make India strong in biologics and biosimilars.
- Money: **₹10,000 crore** over five years.
- **3 new NIPER** institutes and upgrade of **7** existing ones.
- More than **1,000** clinical trial sites.
- Stronger **CDSCO**.
- Full scheme card → Schemes.

Allied health and care workers

- Existing Allied Health Professional institutes will be upgraded, and new ones will be set up.
- About **10** selected disciplines are covered, including optometry, radiology, anaesthesia technology, OT technology, and applied psychology.
- Target noted: add about **1,00,000** Allied Health Professionals over five years.
- About **1.5 lakh** caregivers are to be trained in the coming year.

Medical tourism hubs

- A scheme will help states set up **five Regional Medical Hubs** with private partnership.
- These hubs will combine treatment, education, research, AYUSH, and post-care facilities.

Mental health

- A second **NIMHANS** (**NIMHANS-2**) is proposed in **North India**.
- National mental health institutes at **Ranchi** and **Tezpur** are to be upgraded.

AYUSH

- **3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda**.
- Upgrade of AYUSH pharmacies and drug testing labs.
- Upgrade of the **WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre** at **Jamnagar**.

Hospital capacity

- Budget and UP explainers spoke of expanding district hospital capacity, including emergency and trauma care. One common figure used in explainers is about a **50%** capacity push.

Nationwide HPV Vaccination Campaign for 14-Year-Old Girls | 28 February 2026

What happened India launched its nationwide free **Human Papillomavirus (HPV) vaccination campaign** on **28 February 2026** from **Ajmer, Rajasthan**, covering all 36 States and Union Territories.

Core facts - **Target Demographic: 14-year-old girls** (annual eligible cohort estimated at **1.2 crore** girls as per RGI 2021). - **Health Imperative:** Cervical cancer is the **second most common cancer among Indian women** (IARC-GLOBOCAN 2022 recorded 1,27,526 cases and 79,906 deaths in India). - **Dosage & Administration: Single-dose (0.5 ml)** Intramuscular (IM) injection in the left upper arm; administered free of cost with parental/guardian consent. - **Rollout Phases:** Initial **3-month (90-day)** campaign mode, followed by integration into routine weekly immunization days. - **Digital Infrastructure:** Managed through the **U-WIN** portal for pre-registration, appointments, and digital certificates, while **eVIN** manages real-time vaccine stocks and cold chain logistics.

India Approves Takeda's TAK-003 (Qdenga) Dengue Vaccine

What happened CDSCO's Subject Expert Committee (SEC) under the Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) recommended approval for **TAK-003 (Qdenga)**, making it **India's first approved dengue vaccine**.

Core facts - **Developer:** Developed by **Takeda Pharmaceuticals (Japan)**. - **Approved Age Bracket:** Individuals aged **4 to 60 years**. - **Vaccine Mechanism: Live-attenuated tetravalent vaccine** protecting against all four dengue virus serotypes (DENV 1,

2, 3, and 4). - **Genomic Backbone:** Engineered using the **DENV-2 strain** as the genetic backbone. - **Dosing Schedule: 2-dose series administered 3 months apart**.

SAHI & BODH Health AI Frameworks | 17 February 2026

What happened At the India AI Impact Summit 2026, the Union Health Ministry and MeitY unveiled two foundational health AI governance architectures:

Core facts - **SAHI (Strategy for Artificial Intelligence in Healthcare for India):** National guidance framework establishing institutional protocols for clinical validation, ethical AI deployment, algorithmic transparency, and patient data governance. - **BODH (Benchmarking Open Data Platform for Health AI):** Developed by **IIT Kanpur** in collaboration with the **National Health Authority (NHA)**. It acts as a privacy-preserving benchmarking engine allowing clinical researchers to evaluate AI models against anonymized real-world health datasets without exposing raw patient data.

2nd WHO Global Traditional Medicine Summit | Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi | 17–19 December 2025

What happened The World Health Organization (WHO) and the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, jointly organized the **2nd WHO Global Traditional Medicine Summit** at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi** from **17 to 19 December 2025**.

Core facts - **Theme:** *"Restoring balance: The science and practice of health and well-being"*. - **Strategic Direction:** Advanced the implementation of the *WHO Global Traditional Medicine Strategy 2025–2034*. - **Key Launches by PM Narendra Modi:** - **Traditional Medicine Global Library:** Digital repository indexing 1.6+ million global resources. - **Health & Heritage Innovations (H2I):** Innovation pipeline bridging traditional systems with frontier technologies like AI and biotechnology. - **My Ayush Integrated Services Portal (MAISP):** Unified digital portal for Ayush services and practitioner registration. - **Ayush Mark:** Global quality certification benchmarking standard for herbal and Ayush formulations.

AYUSH Visa Category (AY) | Ministry of Home Affairs | Notified July 2023

What happened The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) incorporated Chapter 11A into the *Visa Manual, 2019*, creating a dedicated **AYUSH Visa** category on **27 July 2023** to boost Medical Value Travel (MVT) under the *"Heal in India"* initiative.

Core facts - **Beneficiaries:** Foreign nationals seeking therapeutic care, wellness treatments, and medical management under Indian systems of medicine (Ayurveda, Yoga, Unani, Siddha, and Homoeopathy). - **Sub-categories:** - **AY-1:** Primary Ayush patient visa. - **AY-2:** Ayush patient attendant visa. - **e-Ayush Visa & e-Ayush Attendant Visa:** Digital 60-day single/double entry facility. - **Validity:** Initial grant up to 1 year (triple entry), extendable by FRRO up to 5 years based on certified medical necessity.

Pradhan Mantri TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan | Launched 9 September 2022

What happened President **Droupadi Murmu** launched the **Pradhan Mantri TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan** to accelerate India's progress toward ending Tuberculosis by **2025** (5 years ahead of the global SDG 3.3 target of 2030).

Core facts - **Ni-kshay Mitra Initiative:** Community support mechanism where individuals, cooperative societies, elected representatives, NGOs, and corporate entities "adopt" TB patients to provide: 1. Nutritional support (food baskets of cereals, millets, pulses, and oil). 2. Additional diagnostic support. 3. Vocational training for rehabilitated patients. - **Direct Benefit Transfer:** Complemented by the **Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana** (DBT assistance for nutritional intake throughout the treatment course).

First Ayushman Arogya Mandir (Health & Wellness Centre) | 14 April 2018

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated India's **very first Health and Wellness Centre (now rechristened 'Ayushman Arogya Mandir')** on **14 April 2018 (Ambedkar Jayanti)** at **Jangla (Jaangla), Bijapur District, Chhattisgarh**.

Core facts - **Pillars of Ayushman Bharat:** Primary tier comprises **1,50,000+ Ayushman Arogya Mandirs (HWCs)** providing Comprehensive Primary Health Care (CPHC) free of cost near homes; secondary/tertiary tier is **PM-JAY** (₹5 lakh annual health cover per family). - **Motto / Tagline:** *"Arogyam Paramam Dhanam"* (Health is the Supreme Wealth).

India's Digital Health Architecture: NHS (2018) & NDHB (2019)

What happened India developed a layered public digital infrastructure to unify health data systems: - **National Health Stack (NHS) — July 2018:** Released by **NITI Aayog** as the foundational blueprint for a digital health ecosystem (Registries, Electronic Health Records, Coverage and Claims engines). - **National Digital Health Blueprint (NDHB) — 2019:** Released by the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** (chaired by J. Satyanarayana). Translated the NHS into operational architecture, leading directly to the launch of the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)** with ABHA (Ayushman Bharat Health Account) IDs.

National Telemedicine & Mental Health Digital Platforms

- **e-Sanjeevani:** National Telemedicine Service of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare. Operates in two models:
- *eSanjeevani AB-HWC:* Provider-to-Provider tele-consultation bridging Ayushman Arogya Mandirs with medical specialists in district/medical colleges.
- *eSanjeevaniOPD:* Patient-to-Doctor direct tele-consultation on mobile.
- **Tele-MANAS (Tele Mental Health Assistance and Networking Across States):** Launched on World Mental Health Day (October 2022) with toll-free 24x7 helpline number **14416**, offering free, confidential mental health counselling in multiple Indian languages.

March 2026

World TB Day | 24 March

- Date fact: **24 March** every year.
- Keep the year's official theme only after locking a WHO or MoHFW note.

Soft health–law hybrid

Supreme Court coverage on withdrawing life support in a long vegetative-state case links to dignity under **Article 21**. Details sit under National Events.

April 2026

World Health Day | 7 April 2026

What happened 7 April is World Health Day. It marks the founding anniversary of the **World Health Organization (WHO)** in **1948**.

2026 theme

- **Together for health. Stand with science.**
- The campaign stresses science-led action and the **One Health** idea (people, animals, plants, and the planet together).

Other April health days

- **World Autism Awareness Day (2 April):** Autism and Humanity — Every Life Has Value.
- **World Malaria Day (25 April):** Driven to End Malaria: Now We Can. Now We Must.
- **World Liver Day (19 April):** Solid Habits, Strong Liver (compilation theme).

10th National Summit on Innovation and Inclusivity | Chandigarh | 30 April – 1 May 2026

What happened The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW) organised the **10th National Summit on Innovation and Inclusivity: Best Practices Shaping India's Health Future** in **Chandigarh**, inaugurated by Union Health Minister **J.P. Nadda**.

Core facts & National Health Milestones - **Key Indicators Highlighted:** - Institutional deliveries rose from 79% to **89%**. - India achieved a **79% decline in under-five mortality (U5MR)** and a **73% decline in infant mortality (IMR)** over long-term health missions. - **Digital Health Portals Launched:** 1. **Swasth Bharat Portal:** A unified, one-stop national digital interface integrating multiple vertical disease control and maternal-child health programmes onto a single dashboard. 2. **JANANI Portal (Journey of Antenatal, Natal and Neonatal Integrated Care — Sehat ke Sath, Every Step of Care):** A robust digital platform aligned with the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)** framework, designed as the single source of truth for **RMNCH** (Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child, and Adolescent Health) data across all public and private facilities. 3. **Integrated Training Module for Primary Health Care Worker Teams:** Standardized, competency-based continuous medical education curriculum for frontline ASHA and ANM workers.

May 2026

Mission SEHAT | New Delhi | 11 May 2026

What happened Union Health Minister **J.P. Nadda** and Union Agriculture Minister **Shivraj Singh Chouhan** jointly launched **Mission SEHAT** in New Delhi, establishing a convergence model between agriculture, bio-fortification, and public nutrition.

Core facts - **Full Form: Science Excellence for Health through Agricultural Transformation**. - **Joint Custodians:** Conceived and executed jointly by the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** and the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**. - **Core Vision:** *"Healthy Food, Healthy Farms and a Healthy India"*. - **Mechanism:** Directs agricultural research toward

breeding climate-resilient, micronutrient-dense crops (bio-fortified iron, zinc, protein) to treat community micronutrient deficiencies, stunting, and wasting.

WHO declares Ebola a Public Health Emergency of International Concern

What happened WHO declared an **Ebola** outbreak linked with the **Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC)** and **Uganda** a global health emergency in May coverage.

Core facts

- Disease: **Ebola** (severe viral haemorrhagic fever).
- Declaring body: **WHO**.
- Director-General: **Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus**.
- WHO HQ: **Geneva**.

May health days

- **World Thalassaemia Day: 8 May**.
- **International Nurses Day: 12 May** (Florence Nightingale's birthday; some calendars also note 13 May in compilations — fact **12 May** from WHO).
- **World No Tobacco Day: 31 May**.

National Family Health Survey-6 (NFHS-6) | Released 29 May 2026

What happened The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (**MoHFW**) released the national factsheets for **NFHS-6 (2023–24)** on **29 May 2026**, conducted by the **International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai** across 6.79 lakh households in 715 districts (**excluding Manipur** due to law and order).

Key Health, Fertility & Nutrition Metrics - **Total Fertility Rate (TFR)**: **2.0** (Urban: 1.6, Rural: 2.1; replacement level: 2.1). - **Institutional Deliveries**: **90.6%** (Rural: 89.2%, Urban: 94.8%). - **Skilled Birth Attendance**: **91.3%**. - **Child Immunization (12–23 months)**: Full immunization coverage rose to **87.1%**. - **Rotavirus Vaccine Coverage**: **85.4%**. - **Child Malnutrition (<5 years)**: - **Stunting (chronic)**: **29.3%** (significant drop from 35.5% in NFHS-5). - **Wasting (acute)**: **18.7%**; **Severe Wasting**: **5.2%**. - **Underweight**: **31.8%** (down from 32.1%). - **Women's Health & Autonomy**: - **Independent Bank Account**: **89.0%** (up from 78.6%). - **Internet Use**: **64.3%**. - **Mobile Phone Ownership**: **63.6%**. - **Spousal Violence**: Experienced by **22.3%** of ever-married women (declined from 29.3%). - **Demographics & Coverage**: - **Health Insurance**: **60.2%** of households covered by health insurance/financing scheme (up from 41.4%). - **Elderly Population ($\ge$60 years)**: **12.9%**. - **Overweight or Obese Adults (BMI $\ge$ 25)**: Women **30.7%**, Men **26.8%**.

Sample Registration System (SRS) Bulletin 2024 | Released 20 May 2026

What happened The **Office of the Registrar General of India (ORGI)**, Ministry of Home Affairs, released the **SRS Bulletin 2024** (Vol 59, No. 1) on **20 May 2026**.

Key Vital Demographic Metrics - **Crude Birth Rate (CBR)**: **18.3 per 1,000 population** (Rural: 20.2, Urban: 14.7). - Highest: **Bihar (26.8)**, UP (24.7), MP (23.9). - Lowest: **Andaman & Nicobar (9.9)**; States: Goa (11.6), Kerala (12.3). - **Crude Death Rate (CDR)**: **6.4 per 1,000 population** (Rural: 6.8, Urban: 5.6; Male: 7.1, Female: 5.6). - Highest: **Chhattisgarh (8.4)**, Odisha (7.9), Kerala (7.6). - Lowest: **Chandigarh (3.9)**; States: Nagaland (4.2), Delhi (4.6). - **Natural Growth Rate (NGR)**: **11.9 per 1,000 population** (Highest: **Bihar 20.8**; Lowest: **Kerala 3.9**). - **Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)**: **24 infant deaths per 1,000 live births** (Rural: 27, Urban: 17; Male: 24, Female: 25). - **1 in every 42 infants in India dies within the first year of life**. - Highest: **Chhattisgarh (36)**, MP (35), UP (34). - Lowest: **Manipur (2)**, Goa (5), Kerala (6).

June 2026

International Day of Yoga | 21 June 2026

What happened 21 June is the International Day of Yoga.

2026 theme

- **Yoga for Healthy Ageing.**

Soft health–environment link

World Environment Day and Surha Tal's Ramsar tag sit under Environment. Keep June focused on Yoga theme for health stems.

AdFalciVax: Indigenous Multi-Stage Malaria Vaccine | June 2026

What happened On **17 June 2026**, ICMR confirmed that technology for **AdFalciVax**, a novel recombinant multi-stage malaria vaccine candidate, has been licensed to five Indian pharmaceutical companies to begin clinical trials and scaled manufacturing.

Core facts - **Developer:** Developed by the **Regional Medical Research Centre (RMRC), Bhubaneswar**, under the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**. - **Pathogen Target:** Recombinant multi-stage formulation against ***Plasmodium falciparum*** to block both individual infection and community transmission. - **Revolutionary Thermal Stability:** Stable for **up to 9 months at ambient room temperature**, completely bypassing the ultra-cold or cold-chain storage hurdles that hinder African and remote Indian immunization campaigns. - **Ultra-Affordable Economics:** Estimated production cost of just **₹20 per dose**, compared to existing global WHO-prequalified vaccines (**RTS,S/AS01 Mosquirix** and **R21/Matrix-M**) costing between **₹250 and ₹830 per dose**. - **National Goal:** Accelerates India's timeline to achieve zero indigenous malaria cases by **2027** and nationwide malaria elimination by **2030**.

July 2026

World Zoonoses Day | 6 July 2026

What happened 6 July is World Zoonoses Day.

2026 theme

- **One World, One Health: Prevent Zoonoses.**

Soft skills / youth health-adjacent days

- **World Youth Skills Day (15 July):** Skills for a Shared Future.
- Keep One Health language linked with April's World Health Day theme if a stem mixes them.

August 2026

Soft I-Day health note

Independence Day speeches also spoke about wider free hospital cover under **Ayushman Bharat** for older citizens. Before a mock, fact the exact age cut-off and rupee cover from an official note.

Soft youth day

International Youth Day falls on **12 August**. The 2026 theme was **Different Contexts, Common Aspirations**.

Third Tobacco-Free Youth Campaign (Tobacco Free Youth Campaign 3.0)

- **Launch Date & Venue**: Launched on **9 October 2025** at a hybrid event in New Delhi.
- **Inaugurated by**: Smt. **Anupriya Patel**, Union Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare.
- **Duration**: **60-day nationwide public health campaign**.
- **Six Enhanced Strategies**: 1. Intensifying public awareness campaigns regarding health hazards of tobacco and nicotine. 2. Promoting tobacco-free educational institutions (ToFEI). 3. Strengthening enforcement of COTPA, 2003 (Cigarettes and Other Tobacco Products Act). 4. Promoting tobacco-free villages (*Tambaku Mukt Gaon*). 5. Enhancing digital and social media outreach targeting adolescents and youth. 6. Expanding cessation services through the National Tobacco Quitline (NTQL) and mCessation initiatives.

September 2026

National Formulary of India (NFI) 2026 | 7th edition

What happened MoS Health **Anupriya Patel** released the **7th edition** of the **National Formulary of India (NFI 2026)** on **21 September 2026** during National Pharmacovigilance Week.

What you should remember

- Publisher / technical body: **Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC)**.
- Format: print + digital.
- Size in official coverage: about **653** monographs (including new monographs, immunologicals, and fixed-dose combinations).
- Pharmacovigilance Week: **17–23 September 2026**.
- Week theme stress: promoting **rational use of medicines** through pharmacovigilance / safer healthcare.

NFI is a formulary (how medicines are used safely), not the same as the Indian Pharmacopoeia standards book — do not swap the two names in options.

October 2026

Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine 2026 | microRNA Discovery

What happened The Nobel Assembly at Karolinska Institutet awarded the **2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine** jointly to American geneticists **Victor Ambros** and **Gary Ruvkun**.

Official Citation & Biological Breakthrough - **Citation:** *"For the discovery of microRNA and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation"*. - **The Organism:** Originally discovered while studying the tiny 1-millimetre roundworm ***Caenorhabditis elegans*** (*C. elegans*). - **The Mechanism:** microRNAs are tiny, non-coding RNA molecules (typically 20 to 24 nucleotides in length) that do not code for proteins themselves. Instead, they act as cellular rheostats, binding to complementary sequences on messenger RNA (**mRNA**) molecules to either block translation into proteins or trigger mRNA degradation. - **Clinical Relevance:** Essential for embryonic development, tissue differentiation, and immune regulation. Dysregulated microRNAs are directly implicated in human oncogenesis (cancer), cardiac hypertrophy, and autoimmune diseases.

RJ Sankara Eye Hospital | Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh (20 October 2026)

What happened Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital** at **Harhua in Varanasi**.

Core facts - **Founding Trust:** Established by the **Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Medical Trust** (associated with the Kanchi Kamakoti Peetham). - **Capacity:** A **225-bed** modern super-specialty ophthalmological hospital. - **Cross-Subsidization Model:** Operates on an equitable 70:30 healthcare model: **70% of all surgeries, consultations, and beds are provided completely free of cost** to economically underprivileged rural families, cross-subsidized by 30% paying patients. - **Catchment Area:** Caters to over 20 districts across Eastern Uttar Pradesh (Purvanchal), Western Bihar, and Jharkhand.

World Polio Day | 24 October 2026

What happened The world observed **World Polio Day** on **24 October**, marking the birth anniversary of **Dr. Jonas Salk** (who developed the first successful inactivated polio vaccine - IPV in 1955).

Core facts & India's Polio Milestones - **2026 Theme:** *"A Campaign to Reach Every Child"*. - **Global Polio Eradication Initiative (GPEI):** Led by WHO, Rotary International, CDC, UNICEF, and the Gates Foundation. - **India's Historic Polio Certification:** - **Certified Polio-Free:** India and the entire WHO South-East Asia Region were officially certified **polio-free on 27 March 2014**. - **Last Reported Case:** The last recorded wild poliovirus (WPV) case in India occurred on **13 January 2011 in Howrah, West Bengal** (a two-year-old girl, Rukhsar Khatun). - India has maintained zero indigenous transmission for over **15 years**.

World Mental Health Day | 10 October 2026

- **Theme:** *"It is time to prioritize mental health in the workplace"*.
- **National Tele-Mental Health Programme (Tele-MANAS):** India's 24x7 toll-free helpline (**14416 / 1800-891-4416**) crossed over **15 lakh distress calls handled** across 51 operational cells in 20+ languages.

PART C · TOPICS

14 — Sports

> **Priority B** | High-Yield Sports Board (Olympic Games, Asian Games, National Games & State-Linked Athletes) Sports Current Affairs is crucial for both **UPPCS** and **UKPCS** (especially Olympic medal tallies, flag bearers, National Games, and athletes from UP and Uttarakhand).

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Which event?	Olympics, Paralympics, Asian Games, World Cup, National Games
Where was it held?	Host city or country
Who won?	Winner, runner-up, medal colour
Any India rank or count?	Gold / silver / bronze breakdown
Any UP or Uttarakhand athlete?	State names, hometowns (e.g. Lakshya Sen, Vandana Katariya)

High-Yield Sports Spine (Olympics, Paralympics, Asian & National Games)

1. Paris 2024 Olympic Games (Complete Indian Board)

Dimension	Factual Key
Host City & Dates	**Paris, France** (26 July – 11 August 2024); Motto: *Games Wide Open* (*Ouvrons grand les Jeux*)
Mascot	**The Phrygian Cap** (*The Olympic Phryge*)
India's Total Haul	**6 Medals** (**0 Gold, 1 Silver, 5 Bronze**) — Overall Rank: **71st**
Opening Ceremony Flag Bearers	**P. V. Sindhu** (Badminton) & **Sharath Kamal** (Table Tennis)
Closing Ceremony Flag Bearers	**Manu Bhaker** (Shooting) & **P. R. Sreejesh** (Hockey)
Medal Table Topper	**United States of America** (40 Gold, 44 Silver, 42 Bronze = 126 Total); 2nd: China (40 Gold, 91 Total)

Indian Medallists at Paris Olympics 2024:

1. **Neeraj Chopra — SILVER (Men's Javelin Throw):** Threw **89.45 m**. (Gold won by Arshad Nadeem of Pakistan with an Olympic record throw of 92.97 m). Neeraj became the first track & field athlete of independent India to win back-to-back Olympic medals (Gold in Tokyo + Silver in Paris).
2. **Manu Bhaker — BRONZE (Women's 10m Air Pistol):** First Indian woman to win an Olympic medal in shooting.
3. **Manu Bhaker & Sarabjot Singh — BRONZE (10m Air Pistol Mixed Team):** Manu Bhaker scripted history as the **first Indian athlete in independent India to win two medals at a single Olympic Games**!
4. **Swapnil Kusale — BRONZE (Men's 50m Rifle 3 Positions):** First Indian shooter to win an Olympic medal in the 50m 3P event.
5. **Indian Men's Hockey Team — BRONZE:** Defeated Spain 2–1 in the bronze medal match under captain Harmanpreet Singh (Harmanpreet was the tournament's top scorer with 10 goals). Marked the retirement match of legendary goalkeeper **P. R. Sreejesh**.
6. **Aman Sehrawat — BRONZE (Men's Freestyle 57 kg Wrestling):** Defeated Darian Cruz (Puerto Rico) 13–5. At **21 years and 24 days**, Aman became the **youngest individual Olympic medallist in Indian history** (breaking PV Sindhu's record). - *(Note: Lakshya Sen from Almora, Uttarakhand finished 4th in Men's Singles Badminton after reaching the semi-finals).*

2. Paris 2024 Paralympic Games (India's All-Time Best Record)

Dimension	Factual Key
Host City	**Paris, France** (28 August – 8 September 2024)
India's Total Haul	**29 Medals** (**7 Gold, 9 Silver, 13 Bronze**) — Highest ever tally!
India's Overall Rank	**18th Position** (Historic top-20 finish)
Flag Bearers	Opening: **Sumit Antil** (Javelin) & **Bhagyashree Jadhav** (Shot put); Closing: **Harvinder Singh** & **Preeti Pal**
Double Medallist	**Preeti Pal** won 2 Bronze medals (Women's 100m T35 & 200m T35) — 1st Indian woman track athlete to win two Paralympic medals.

Dimension	Factual Key
Iconic Archer	**Sheetal Devi** (armless archer shooting with feet) won Bronze in Mixed Team Compound with Rakesh Kumar.

India's 7 Gold Medallists at Paris Paralympics 2024:

1. **Avani Lekhara** (Women's 10m Air Rifle Standing SH1 — defended Tokyo Gold with Paralympic record 249.7).
2. **Nitesh Kumar** (Para Badminton Men's Singles SL3).
3. **Sumit Antil** (Men's Javelin Throw F64 — defended Tokyo Gold with Paralympic record 70.59 m).
4. **Harvinder Singh** (Men's Individual Recurve Archery — 1st Indian archer to win Gold at Paralympics).
5. **Dharambir** (Men's Club Throw F51 — set Asian record 34.92 m).
6. **Praveen Kumar** (Men's High Jump T64 — set Asian record 2.08 m).
7. **Navdeep Singh** (Men's Javelin Throw F41 — personal best 47.32 m).

3. 19th Asian Games (Hangzhou, China) & National Games

Major Games	Edition & Venue	India's Performance & Key Highlights
19th Asian Games	**Hangzhou, China** (Sep–Oct 2023)	**107 Medals (28 Gold, 38 Silver, 41 Bronze)** — India finished **4th** (breached the 100-medal barrier: *"Iss Baar 100 Paar"*). Mascots: Congcong, Lianlian, Chenchen.
4th Asian Para Games	**Hangzhou, China** (Oct 2023)	**111 Medals (29 Gold, 31 Silver, 51 Bronze)** — India finished **5th**.
37th National Games	**Goa** (Oct–Nov 2023)	Champions: **Maharashtra** (won Raja Bhalindra Singh Trophy with 228 medals, 80 gold). Mascot: *Moga* (Indian Bison).
38th National Games	**Uttarakhand** (Host State)	Host venues: **Dehradun, Haridwar, Haldwani, Rudrapur, Rishikesh**. Mascot: **Himalayan Monal** (State Bird of Uttarakhand).

4. Sports Personalities & Honors of Uttarakhand

Sportsperson	Hometown & Discipline	High-Yield Prelims Achievements
Lakshya Sen	Almora (Badminton)	Commonwealth Games Gold (2022), World Championship Bronze, Arjuna Awardee; finished **4th at Paris 2024 Olympics**.
Chirag Sen	Almora (Badminton)	Senior National Men's Singles Champion (2023/24); elder brother of Lakshya Sen.
Mansi Negi	Chamoli (20 km Race Walk)	Won **Gold medal at World University Games (Chengdu)**; broke National Under-20 record.
Ankita Dhyani	Pauri Garhwal (Athletics)	Represented India at Paris 2024 Olympics in Women's 5000m.
Paramjeet Singh Bisht	Chamoli (20 km Race Walk)	Qualified and represented India at Paris 2024 Olympics.
Suraj Panwar	Dehradun (20 km Race Walk)	Silver medallist at Youth Olympics; represented India at Paris 2024 Olympics (Marathon Race Walk Relay).
Sneha Rana	Dehradun (Cricket)	Senior all-rounder, Indian Women's National Cricket Team; standout performances in Test cricket.
Ekta Bisht	Almora (Cricket)	First international cricketer from Uttarakhand; 1st Indian bowler (male or female) to take a T20I hat-trick.
Vandana Katariya	Haridwar (Field Hockey)	Padma Shri (2022); 1st Indian woman to score an Olympic hat-trick in hockey (Tokyo 2020).

5. Other Major Championship Foundations (Late 2025)

- **FIDE World Cup 2025:** Hosted in **Goa, India** (30 Oct – 27 Nov 2025). Champion: Grandmaster **Javokhir Sindarov** of Uzbekistan.

January 2026

Padma sports names

These are award facts, but they are often revised with sports notes too.

- **Rohit Sharma** received **Padma Shri** for Sports.
- **Harmanpreet Kaur Bhullar** received **Padma Shri** for Sports.
- **Savita Punia** received **Padma Shri** for Sports.
- **Vijay Amritraj** received **Padma Bhushan** for Sports (listed with the United States of America).

Full Padma card → Awards.

No major Olympic or World Cup final was locked for January in this pass.

February 2026

Budget sports push

What happened The Union Budget spoke about making India stronger in sports goods manufacturing, research, and design. It also used **Khelo India Mission** language for a wider sports ecosystem push.

How to revise

- Do not confuse the new Budget mission language with an old Khelo India Youth Games edition.
- Keep sports goods manufacturing as an industry-plus-sports fact.

Soft UP sports note

Some February compilations spoke about a possible return of big bike racing events to **Buddh International Circuit**. Add a hard date only when the calendar is confirmed.

Ranji Trophy 2025–26 | Historic Maiden Title for J&K

What happened Jammu and Kashmir created historic sporting folklore by winning their **first-ever Ranji Trophy title** in history, defeating Karnataka in the final (held 15 October 2025 – 28 February 2026).

Core facts - **Champions: Jammu and Kashmir** (Maiden Ranji Trophy title). - **Runners-up: Karnataka**.

Women's Premier League (WPL 2026) | 4th Edition

- **Organiser:** BCCI (9 January – 5 February 2026; 5 teams).
- **Champions: Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB)** (defeated Delhi Capitals in the final).
- **Most Valuable Player (MVP): Sophie Devine** (Gujarat Giants).

Other February Championship Highlights

- **Col. C. K. Nayudu Trophy Elite 2025–26:** Winner: **Tamil Nadu**; Runner-up: Maharashtra.
- **SAFF U-19 Women's Championship 2026 (Pokhara, Nepal):** Champion: **India** (3rd title); Runner-up: Bangladesh.

March 2026

ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 final | 8 March 2026 | Ahmedabad

What happened India played **New Zealand** in the final of the **ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026** at **Narendra Modi Stadium**, Ahmedabad. India won by **96 runs**.

Score facts

- India made **255 for 5**. This was called the highest total in a Men's T20 World Cup final.
- New Zealand were all out for **159**.
- **Sanju Samson** scored **89**.
- **Jasprit Bumrah** took **4 wickets for 15 runs** and was Player of the Match in coverage.
- Hosts: **India and Sri Lanka** for the tournament.

History facts

- This was India's **third** Men's T20 World Cup title.
- India became the **first** team to **defend** the title (win it back-to-back).
- India became the **first host** country to win the Men's T20 World Cup.

Athletics hosting note

Coverage also said India would host the **World Indoor Athletics Championships** in **2028** at **Bhubaneswar** (Kalinga Indoor Stadium). Keep the year and city ready.

April 2026

Laureus World Sports Awards 2026 | Madrid

What happened Laureus Awards were held in **Madrid**. Full winner card → Awards.

Quick facts

- Sportsman: **Carlos Alcaraz**.

Wimbledon men's singles 2026

What happened Jannik Sinner (Italy) retained the Wimbledon men's singles title in **July 2026**, beating **Alexander Zverev** in the final.

Core facts

- Winner: **Jannik Sinner** (second straight Wimbledon).
- Finalist: **Alexander Zverev**.
- **Carlos Alcaraz** missed the tournament with a wrist injury — do not mark him as the 2026 champion.

Laureus / other awards may still name Alcaraz. For **Wimbledon 2026 men's singles**, the answer is **Sinner**. - Sportswoman: **Aryna Sabalenka**. - Team: **Paris Saint-Germain**.

Khelo India Tribal Games 2026 | first edition

What happened The **first** Khelo India Tribal Games concluded. Host state in coverage: **Chhattisgarh**.

Core facts

- Edition: **1st**.
- Mascot: **Morveer**.
- Top medal tally in coverage: **Karnataka**.

Soft sports notes

- IPL 2026 season created several record headlines in compilations (fastest milestones / big chase). Add a named record only when a stem needs one exact player fact.
- Para archery: **Payal Nag** was covered as the first quadruple amputee to win a World Para Archery Series Final championship event in Bangkok.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's World Record | April 2026

- 15-year-old batting prodigy **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** smashed the **fastest half-century in List A cricket history off just 11 balls** against Sri Lanka A, breaking the long-standing 12-ball record of Kaushalya Weeraratne.

Other April Championship Highlights

- **ISSF Junior World Cup (Cairo, Egypt | 19–27 April 2026): India finished First** in the overall medal standings.
- **Youngest Palk Strait Swimmer (30 April 2026): Ishank Singh**, a 7-year-old swimmer from **Ranchi, Jharkhand**, became the youngest person ever to swim across the Palk Strait.
- **Badminton Asia Championships 2026 (Ningbo, China):** India's young sensation **Ayush Shetty** bagged the **Silver medal** in Men's Singles (Gold: Shi Yu Qi of China).

May 2026

IPL 2026 final | 31 May 2026 | Ahmedabad

What happened Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) beat **Gujarat Titans** by **5 wickets** in the IPL 2026 final at Ahmedabad and kept the title.

Core facts

- Edition: **19th** IPL season.
- Champions: **RCB**.
- Runners-up: **Gujarat Titans**.
- **Virat Kohli** scored an unbeaten **75** and hit the winning six; Player of the Match in coverage.
- RCB became only the **third** team to win back-to-back IPL titles after **Chennai Super Kings** and **Mumbai Indians**.

Soft IPL season records

- Young Rajasthan Royals batter **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** broke the single-season sixes record in coverage (**65** sixes).
- Keep other record names only if a stem asks for them.

Thomas Cup and Uber Cup 2026 | Denmark

What happened The badminton world team events were hosted by **Denmark**.

Core facts

- **Thomas Cup** (men): winner **China**; runners-up **France**. Edition noted: **34th**.
- **Uber Cup** (women): winner **South Korea**; runners-up **China**. Edition noted: **31st**.

June 2026

FIFA World Cup 2026 begins | USA–Canada–Mexico

What happened The **23rd** FIFA Men's World Cup began in June 2026 across the **United States, Canada, and Mexico**.

Core facts

- Hosts: **USA, Canada, Mexico**.
- Mascots named in coverage: **Maple, Zayu, and Clutch**.
- Match ball named: Adidas **Trionda**.
- Defending champions at the start: **Argentina**.

FIH Hockey Women's Nations Cup 2026

What happened India won the FIH Hockey Women's Nations Cup hosted by **New Zealand**.

Core facts

- Winner: **India**.
- Runners-up: **New Zealand**.
- Qualification effect: India qualified for the **FIH Pro League**.
- FIH HQ: **Lausanne**, Switzerland.

2026 French Open (Roland-Garros) | Paris (24 May – 7 June 2026)

What happened The clay-court Grand Slam concluded at Stade Roland-Garros in Paris.

Core winners - **Men's Singles Champion: Alexander Zverev** (Germany) — captured his **first-ever Grand Slam singles title**. - **Women's Singles Champion: Mirra Andreeva** (Russia).

Indian Super League (ISL 2025–26) | Football

- **Champions: East Bengal FC** won their **maiden ISL championship title**, defeating traditional arch-rivals Mohun Bagan Super Giant in the final.

ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 | hosts + dates

- Edition: **10th**.
- Hosts: **England and Wales** (not India–Sri Lanka / Australia–South Africa / New Zealand–West Indies).
- Window: **12 June – 5 July 2026**.
- Teams: **12**.
- Final venue memory: **Lord's**.
- Defending champions entering the tournament: **New Zealand**.

Host pair = **England and Wales**. Final winner card is separate (July).

July 2026

FIFA World Cup 2026 final | 19 July 2026 | New York / New Jersey

What happened Spain beat **Argentina 1–0** after extra time in the FIFA World Cup final and became world champions for the **second** time (after **2010**).

Core facts

- Date: **19 July 2026**.
- Venue: **New York / New Jersey Stadium**.
- Score: **Spain 1–0 Argentina** (extra time).
- Winning goal: **Ferran Torres** (about the **106th** minute).
- Hosts of the tournament: **USA, Canada, Mexico**.
- Spain also held the women's FIFA World Cup from **2023**, so coverage called Spain the first nation to hold both men's and women's titles at once.

ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 final | 5 July 2026 | Lord's

What happened **Australia** beat **England** by **7 wickets** at **Lord's** and won the Women's T20 World Cup.

Core facts

- Champions: **Australia** (seventh title in coverage).
- Runners-up / hosts: **England**.
- Ground: **Lord's**.
- **Ellyse Perry** was on strike for the winning runs and was highlighted for a unique multi-trophy ICC record.

Commonwealth Games 2026 begin | Glasgow

What happened The **22nd** Commonwealth Games began in **Glasgow, Scotland**.

Core facts

- Host: **Glasgow**.
- Mascot: **Finnie** (a Glaswegian unicorn; unicorn is Scotland's national animal).
- Debut nations named: **Gabon** and **Togo**.
- Participating nations noted: about **74**.

PV Sindhu | Japan Open

- **P. V. Sindhu** won the Japan Open badminton title, covered as the first Indian to do so.
- Final opponent named in coverage: **Akane Yamaguchi**.

August 2026

Commonwealth Games 2026 conclude | Glasgow | to 2 August 2026

What happened The **23rd** Commonwealth Games ended in **Glasgow, Scotland**. **Australia** topped the medal table. India finished **4th**.

India medal facts

- Total: **39** medals — **13** gold, **17** silver, **9** bronze.
- Opening flag bearer: **Mirabai Chanu**.
- Closing flag bearer: **Jaismine Lamboria**.
- Boxing haul: **10** medals including **7** golds (most by any nation in boxing at one Games in coverage).
- Armed forces athletes contributed strongly; Army alone won **16** medals (8 gold) in Defence Ministry felicitations.

Soft individual feats

- **Mirabai Chanu** — third successive Commonwealth Games weightlifting gold (second Indian with three successive golds in coverage).
- **Gulveer Singh** — first Indian track athlete with two individual medals at one Commonwealth Games in coverage.
- Best-ever Indian judo haul noted: three medals.

FIH Hockey World Cup 2026

- Joint hosts: **Belgium** and the **Netherlands**.
- Men's winners: **Belgium**.
- Women's winners: **Argentina**.
- India's finish in coverage: men **8th**, women **5th**.

R. Praggnanandhaa | Grand Chess Tour

- First Indian to win the **Grand Chess Tour** in coverage.
- Final win over **Fabiano Caruana** at St. Louis, USA.

National Sports Day | 29 August

- Remember **Major Dhyan Chand**.
- National slogan in coverage: **Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat**.

12th Men's Asia Cup Hockey 2025 (Rajgir Sports Complex)

- **Tournament**: Held in September 2025 at the newly constructed **Rajgir Sports Complex (Bihar)**.
- **Champion**: **India defeated South Korea 4–1** in the final on **7 September 2025**.

- **Significance**: Ended an **8-year Asia Cup title drought** and secured India's direct qualification for the **2026 FIH Men's Hockey World Cup** (co-hosted by Belgium and the Netherlands).

World Para Athletics Championships 2025 (High Jump T63 Gold)

- **Historical Feat**: **Shailesh Kumar** (Islam Nagar, Jamui district, Bihar) won India's **first-ever Gold medal** in the **Men's High Jump T63 event**.
- **Record**: Cleared an Asian and Championship record height of **1.91 metres**. Co-national Varun Bhati won the Bronze medal.

16th Hockey India Sub-Junior Men National Championship 2026

- **Venue**: Hosted at **Rajgir Sports Complex (Bihar)**.
- **Gold**: **Uttar Pradesh** defeated Madhya Pradesh **5–2** in the final.
- **Podium**: Gold: UP; Silver: MP; Bronze: Punjab.

SportsStar Aces Awards 2026

- **Recognition**: Bihar was selected as the **"Best State in Promoting Sports"**; chosen by an expert national jury chaired by former cricket captain **Sunil Gavaskar**.

September 2026

20th Asian Games | Aichi–Nagoya, Japan

What happened The **Asian Games 2026** were staged in the **Aichi–Nagoya** region of **Japan**. India's campaign ran through late September with several high-yield medals.

What you should remember

- Host: **Japan** (Aichi–Nagoya).
- **Kabaddi double gold:** both Indian **men's** and **women's** teams beat **Iran** in the finals (scores in coverage: men **40–34**, women **37–34**).
- Other early golds in coverage: **women's cricket**; **10m air pistol mixed team** (**Kamaljeet** and **Suruchi Singh**).
- Historic athletics: **Sawan Barwal** won **silver** in the men's marathon with a national record about **2:11:37** — first Indian man in decades to medal in this event at the Asian Games.
- Soft athletics: **Tajinderpal Singh Toor** took shot-put **silver**; **Prachi Choudhary** took **400 m bronze**.
- Mid-Games tally in late-September coverage sat near **30** medals (**4** gold / **12** silver / **14** bronze) — revise the **final** tally after the Games close; do not treat a mid-Games number as final forever.

Do not confuse Aichi–Nagoya 2026 with Hangzhou 2023. Kabaddi gold this time is a **double** (men + women), not only one team.

October 2026

ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026 | New Zealand Champions

What happened The **ICC Women's T20 World Cup** concluded in the **United Arab Emirates (UAE)** on **20 October 2026**, with **New Zealand** lifting their maiden ICC Women's T20 World Cup trophy.

Final match details & core facts - **Final Venue: Dubai International Cricket Stadium, Dubai (UAE)**. - **Match Result: New Zealand** (158/5 in 20 overs) defeated **South Africa** (126/9 in 20 overs) by **32 runs**. - **Maiden Title:** This was New Zealand's **first-ever women's T20 World Cup title** (having previously finished runners-up in 2009 and 2010). - **Player of the Match (Final): Amelia Kerr** (New Zealand) — scored 43 runs off 38 balls and took 3 wickets for 24 runs with her leg-spin. - **Player of the Tournament: Amelia Kerr** — finished as the tournament's leading wicket-taker with **15 wickets** alongside 135 runs. - **Runner-Up: South Africa** (their second consecutive final loss after 2023). - **India's Performance:** India failed to qualify for the semi-finals, exiting in the group stage following defeats against New Zealand and Australia.

ISSF Junior World Championship 2026 | Lima, Peru

What happened The Indian shooting contingent dominated the **ISSF Junior World Championship** held in **Lima, Peru**.

Core facts - **Medal Tally Crown: India topped the medal tally** with an outstanding haul of **24 medals**: **13 Gold, 3 Silver, and 8 Bronze**. - **Runner-Up:** Italy finished second (5 Gold), followed by Norway (4 Gold). - **Key Performers:** Indian junior shooters dominated the 10m Air Rifle, 25m Rapid Fire Pistol, and 50m Rifle 3 Positions events.

Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Complex (Sigra, Varanasi) Inaugurated

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated **Phases 2 and 3** of the modernized **Sigra Sports Complex** in Varanasi on **20 October 2026** (cost: ₹210+ crore).
- Accredited as a **National Centre of Excellence** under Khelo India and Smart City Mission with Olympic-grade aquatic facilities and sports science testing.

PART C · TOPICS

16 — Uttarakhand CA

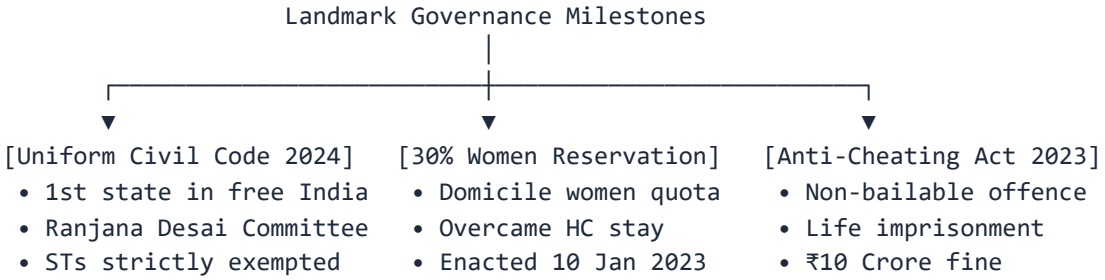
★ UKPCS state card (Unit 6 — Current Events of State, National & International Importance)

> **Sources:** Government of Uttarakhand Portals, DIPR Uttarakhand, PIB Dehradun, GI Registry Chennai, UKPCS PYQ stems (Padma Shri 2025 Radha Bahin Bhatt Q53, Silkyara Tunnel length Q51, UCC 2024 milestones, 30% Women Horizontal Reservation, G20 Ramnagar/Rishikesh venues, 38th National Games, State awards).
> **Desk:** UKPCS Overview · Coverage Report · National Current Affairs

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	High-Yield Current Affairs Key
Uniform Civil Code (UCC)	**1st state in independent India**; passed **7 Feb 2024**; assent **11 March 2024**; STs strictly exempted
UCC Committee Head	Retired Supreme Court Judge **Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai**
38th National Games	Hosted by **Uttarakhand** (Dehradun, Haridwar, Haldwani, Rudrapur, Rishikesh)
Women Horizontal Quota	**30% horizontal reservation** for Uttarakhand domicile women in state public services (enacted Jan 2023)
Anti-Cheating Law 2023	India's strictest: **Life imprisonment + ₹10 Crore fine**; 10-year candidate ban
Padma Shri 2025	**Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt** (Social Work — Lakshmi Ashram, Kausani) (UKPCS 2025 Q53)
Padma Shri 2024	**Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch** (Literature & Education — eminent historian of Uttarakhand)
Padma Vibhushan 2022	**General Bipin Rawat** (Posthumous — 1st Chief of Defence Staff, from Saina village, Pauri)
Silkyara Tunnel Length	**4.531 km** (NH-134, Char Dham route, Uttarkashi; 41 miners rescued in Operation Zindagi)
Vibrant Village No. 1	**Mana Village** (Chamoli) officially designated as India's **"First Village"** (not last village)
First Ramsar Site in UK	**Asan Conservation Reserve** (Dehradun, Yamuna-Asan confluence, designated 2020)
Single-Day GI Tag Record	Uttarakhand became the **1st state to receive 18 GI certificates in a single day** (total 27+ GI products)
Rishikesh–Karnaprayag Rail	**125.2 km** BG rail link; **84% (~105 km) in 17 tunnels**; longest tunnel: 15.1 km (Devprayag to Janasu)
Pirul Lao–Paise Pao	Community mission collecting pine needles (*Pirul*) to prevent forest fires; ₹50/kg incentive

1. Landmark Legislation & Governance Current Affairs



1.1 Uniform Civil Code (UCC) of Uttarakhand (2024)

- **Constitutional Basis:** Enacted under **Article 44** (Directive Principles of State Policy).
- **Milestone Dates:** Passed by Vidhan Sabha on **7 February 2024**; received Presidential Assent from President Droupadi Murmu on **11 March 2024**.
- **Drafting Committee:** 5-member committee headed by **Justice (Retd.) Ranjana Prakash Desai** (former Supreme Court Judge). Other members: Shatrughan Singh (ex-Chief Secretary), Prof. Surekha Dangwal (VC Doon University), Manu Gaur, and Pramod Kohli.
- **Key Legal Provisions:**
- **Tribal Exemption:** Explicitly **exempts all Scheduled Tribes (STs)** protected under Article 366(25).
- **Marriage & Polygamy:** Completely prohibits polygamy and bigamy across all religions; minimum age of marriage fixed at **21 for males and 18 for females**.
- **Abolition of Practices:** Bans *Iddat*, *Nikah Halala*, and extra-judicial divorces.
- **Equal Inheritance:** Grants equal property inheritance rights to sons and daughters, eliminating discrimination in ancestral estates.

- **Mandatory Live-In Registration:** Couples residing in live-in relationships must register on the state portal within **1 month** of cohabitation; failure attracts up to 3 months imprisonment; children born from live-in relationships enjoy full legal legitimacy.

1.2 Uttarakhand Public Services (Horizontal Reservation for Women) Act, 2022

- **Enactment:** Passed by Vidhan Sabha and signed by Governor Lt. Gen. Gurmit Singh on **10 January 2023**.
- **Core Provision:** Guarantees **30% horizontal reservation** in direct recruitment to public services and posts under the State Government exclusively for **women domicile residents of Uttarakhand**.
- **Legal Background:** Restored domicile reservation after the Uttarakhand High Court had stayed the previous 2006 government order.

1.3 Uttarakhand Anti-Cheating & Paper Leak Act, 2023

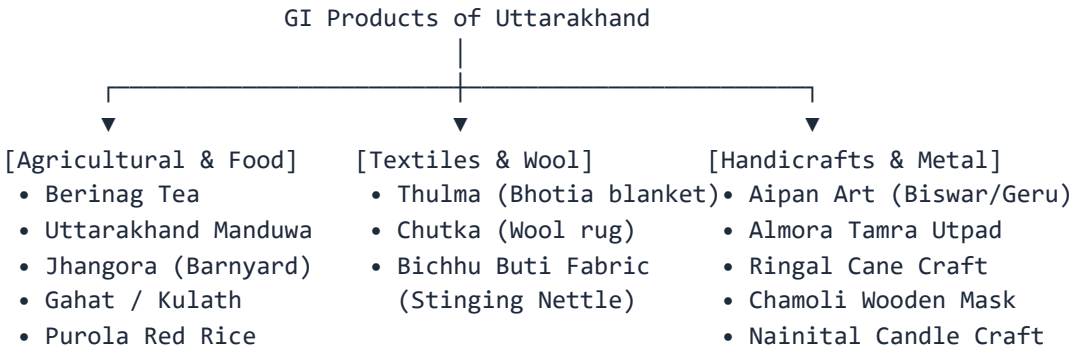
- Enacted as *Uttarakhand Competitive Examination (Measures for Prevention and Redressal of Unfair Means in Recruitment) Act, 2023*.
- **Punishment for Syndicates:** Imprisonment from 10 years to **Life Imprisonment** and a fine of **₹2 Crore to ₹10 Crore**, plus attachment and confiscation of properties acquired through copying syndicates.
- **Punishment for Examinees:** Banned from state recruitment examinations for **10 years** on the first offense, with 3 to 10 years imprisonment.

2. Infrastructure, Transport & Strategic Projects

Project / Infrastructure	Strategic Location & Scale	High-Yield Prelims Data Points
Rishikesh–Karnaprayag Rail Line	125.2 km Broad Gauge across 5 districts	**84% track length (~105 km) lies inside 17 tunnels**. Features the longest rail tunnel in India (**15.1 km** between Devprayag and Janasu). 12 new railway stations. Executed by RVNL.
Silkyara–Barkot Tunnel	NH-134 (Uttarkashi) on Char Dham Highway	**4.531 km length** (cuts Gangotri–Yamunotri route by >20 km). Site of 17-day collapse rescue in Nov 2023 (**Operation Zindagi**). Rescued all 41 workers using rat-hole mining technique.
Sonprayag–Kedarnath Ropeway	Rudraprayag (under Parvatmala Pariyojana)	**9.7 km aerial ropeway**; reduces arduous 8-hour trek to ~30 minutes; terminal at 3,583 m.
Govindghat–Hemkund Sahib Ropeway	Chamoli (under Parvatmala Pariyojana)	**12.4 km aerial ropeway**; connects Govindghat to Hemkund Sahib (4,329 m) and Valley of Flowers.
Jamrani Dam Multipurpose Project	Gola River (Haldwani, Nainital)	Approved under Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY); provides drinking water to Haldwani and irrigation to US Nagar and Bareilly.
Song Dam Drinking Water Project	Song River (Dehradun)	₹2,000+ Cr gravity dam to provide 24x7 drinking water to Dehradun city for 50 years.
Lakhwar Multipurpose Project	Yamuna River (Dehradun) — 300 MW	Gravity dam of 204 m height; benefits 6 basin states (UK, UP, HP, Haryana, Rajasthan, Delhi).
Kishau Multipurpose Project	Tons River (UK–HP border) — 660 MW	Joint project of Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh.

3. High-Yield GI Tags of Uttarakhand (Record Haul)

In December 2023, Uttarakhand scripted history by becoming the **first state in India to be awarded 18 GI Certificates in a single day**, taking its total recognized GI portfolio to over 27 products:



- Almora Bal Mithai
- Singhori Sweet

GI Product Name	Category & District	Unique Prelims Identifier
Berinag Tea	Agricultural (Pithoragarh)	Wild orthodox black tea from Berinag; historic export to London.
Bichhu Buti (Nettle) Fabric	Textile / Handicraft	Natural organic yarn woven from stinging nettle (*Girardinia diversifolia*).
Uttarakhand Manduwa	Agricultural	Finger millet (*Ragi*); rich in calcium, iron, and dietary fiber.
Jhangora	Agricultural	Barnyard millet; ancient low-glycemic climate-resilient crop.
Gahat (Kulath)	Agricultural	Horse gram; renowned in Ayurvedic medicine for dissolving kidney stones.
Lal Chawal (Red Rice)	Agricultural (Uttarkashi)	Grown organically in the Kamal river valley of Purola.
Almora Bal Mithai	Foodstuff (Almora)	Roasted khoya fudge coated with sugar beads/globules (*Khas-Khas* look).
Singhori	Foodstuff (Tehri / Almora)	Mawa sweet cone-wrapped inside fragrant green *Malu* leaves.
Aipan Folk Art	Handicraft (Kumaon)	Traditional ritual floor/wall art executed on red *Geru* with *Biswar* (rice paste).
Thulma & Chutka	Textile (Pithoragarh/Chamoli)	Dense handwoven pure sheep wool blankets and rugs crafted by Bhotia women.
Ringal Craft	Handicraft (Chamoli)	Baskets, mats, and household craft woven from dwarf bamboo (*Ringal*).
Almora Tamra Utpad	Metalcraft (Almora)	Traditional copperware crafted by the hereditary *Tamta* artisans of Tamta Mohalla.
Munsiari Rajma	Agricultural (Pithoragarh)	Buttery, highly digestible white-and-red kidney beans grown at high altitudes.
Kala Bhatt (Black Soybean)	Agricultural	Rich in protein, anthocyanins; key ingredient for *Bhatt ki Churkani*.

4. International Summits & Defense Exercises in Uttarakhand

4.1 G20 Meetings Hosted in Uttarakhand (2023)

Uttarakhand successfully hosted **three official G20 meetings**: 1. **1st Meeting — Chief Science Advisers' Roundtable (CSAR):** Held at **Ramnagar (Corbett, Nainital)** on 28–30 March 2023. Discussed global disease surveillance and open access to scientific knowledge. 2. **2nd Meeting — Anti-Corruption Working Group (ACWG):** Held at **Narendra Nagar / Rishikesh (Tehri Garhwal)** on 25–27 May 2023. 3. **3rd Meeting — Infrastructure Working Group (IWG):** Held at **Narendra Nagar / Rishikesh** on 26–28 June 2023. Discussed financing future cities and resilient infrastructure.

4.2 Joint Military Exercises Hosted in Uttarakhand

- **Exercise Surya Kiran (India–Nepal):** Annually alternated; conducted regularly at the military training grounds in **Pithoragarh**.
- **Exercise Yudh Abhyas (India–USA):** 18th edition conducted at the high-altitude cold-weather warfare centre in **Auli (Chamoli)** at 9,500 feet.
- **Exercise Dustlik (India–Uzbekistan):** 4th edition held at **Pithoragarh** in February 2023.

5. Sports Current Affairs & Personalities of Uttarakhand

5.1 38th National Games (Hosted by Uttarakhand)

- Uttarakhand was chosen as the proud host of the **38th National Games**.
- **Hub Cities:** Competitions spread across 6 regional venues: **Dehradun, Haridwar, Haldwani, Rudrapur, Rishikesh, and Tehri**.
- **State Mascot: Monal** (State Bird of Uttarakhand).
- Upgraded world-class infrastructure: Maharana Pratap Sports College (Dehradun), Indira Gandhi International Sports Complex (Haldwani).

5.2 Prominent Sports Personalities of Uttarakhand

Athlete Name	Sport & Hometown	Major Achievements & Honors
Lakshya Sen	Badminton (Almora)	Commonwealth Games Gold Medallist, World Championship Bronze, Arjuna Awardee, 4th place at Paris 2024 Olympics.
Chirag Sen	Badminton (Almora)	Senior National Badminton Champion; elder brother of Lakshya Sen.
Ankita Dhyani	Athletics - Distance (Pauri Garhwal)	Represented India at Paris 2024 Olympics in 5000m and 3000m steeplechase.
Mansi Negi	20 km Race Walk (Chamoli)	Gold medallist at World University Games; National Games record holder.

Athlete Name	Sport & Hometown	Major Achievements & Honors
Paramjeet Singh Bisht	20 km Race Walk (Chamoli)	Qualified and represented India at the Paris 2024 Olympics.
Suraj Panwar	20 km Race Walk (Dehradun)	Silver medallist at Youth Olympic Games; Paris 2024 Olympian in marathon race-walk relay.
Sneha Rana	Women's Cricket (Dehradun)	All-rounder for Indian National Women's Cricket Team; historic Test match performances.
Ekta Bisht	Women's Cricket (Almora)	First international cricketer from Uttarakhand; 1st Indian bowler to take a T20I hat-trick.

5.3 Devbhoomi Uttarakhand State Sports Awards

Instituted by the State Government to honor outstanding athletic excellence: - **Devbhoomi Uttarakhand Khel Ratna:** Highest state sports honor given to an active player. - **Devbhoomi Uttarakhand Dronacharya Award:** Bestowed upon eminent coaches producing national/international champions. - **Devbhoomi Uttarakhand Lifetime Achievement Award:** Recognizes lifetime contribution to state sports. - **Mukhyamantri Udyan Khiladi Unnayan Yojana:** Monthly sports stipend of **₹1,500** awarded to budding athletes aged 8 to 14 years across all 13 districts.

6. Complete Chronology of Recent Padma Awardees from Uttarakhand

Year	Awardee Name	Award Category	Field of Recognition & High-Yield Prelims Detail
2025	**Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt**	**Padma Shri**	**Social Work:** Disciple of Sarla Behn; associated with **Lakshmi Ashram (Kausani)**; championed hill women empowerment and Gandhian rural self-reliance. (UKPCS 2025 Q53)
2024	**Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch**	**Padma Shri**	**Literature & Education:** Renowned historian and archaeologist; author of *Uttarakhand ka Navin Itihas*; founder of 'Himalayan Puratatva Evam Darshan Parishad'.
2022	**General Bipin Rawat** *(Posthumous)*	**Padma Vibhushan**	**Civil Service / Defence:** 1st Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) of India; native of Saina village, Pauri Garhwal; died in tragic helicopter crash in Coonoor (Tamil Nadu).
2022	**Dr. Madhuri Barthwal**	**Padma Shri**	**Art (Folk Music):** 1st female music composer at All India Radio (Nazibabad); resurrected rare Garhwali folk instruments and songs.
2022	**Smt. Basanti Devi**	**Padma Shri**	**Social Work:** Led the successful women-driven civil campaign to save and revive the drying **Kosi River** in Kumaon.
2022	**Vandana Katariya**	**Padma Shri**	**Sports (Hockey):** Haridwar-born hockey forward; 1st Indian woman to score a hat-trick in Olympic hockey (Tokyo 2020).
2021	**Dr. B. K. S. Sanjay**	**Padma Shri**	**Medicine (Orthopaedics):** Renowned Dehradun surgeon; entered Guinness Book for polio corrective surgeries.
2021	**Prem Chand Sharma**	**Padma Shri**	**Agriculture:** Pomegranate, apple, and scientific nursery pioneer from Chakrata (Jaunsar).
2020	**Dr. Yogi Aeron**	**Padma Shri**	**Medicine:** Plastic surgeon providing free burn treatment and facial reconstruction to poor hill patients in Dehradun.
2020	**Kalyan Singh Rawat**	**Padma Shri**	**Social Work:** Founder of the eco-cultural **Maiti Movement** (1994) in Gwaldam (Chamoli).

7. Key Environmental, Ecological & Wildlife Current Affairs

- **First Village Declaration:** In April 2023, the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) erected signboards formally designating **Mana Village (Chamoli)** near Badrinath as **"India's First Village"** under the **Vibrant Villages Programme (VVP)**, reversing the colonial concept of the "last Indian village".
- **Asan Conservation Reserve (Ramsar Site):** Situated at the confluence of the Asan and Yamuna rivers in Dehradun. In October 2020, it was declared **Uttarakhand's first Ramsar site** (444 hectares; premier wintering stop for 53 species of trans-Himalayan migratory birds, including the Brahminy duck and bar-headed goose).
- **Pirul Lao–Paise Pao Campaign:** Flagship community forestry campaign launched to tackle devastating summer forest fires (*Vanagni*). Villagers and Van Panchayats collect dry fallen Chir pine needles (*Pirul*) and deposit them at government collection centres at an incentive rate of **₹50 per kilogram**, preventing slope combustion and supplying biomass for clean bio-energy pellets.
- **Project Tiger Golden Jubilee (1973–2023):** Commemorated across Uttarakhand; Corbett National Park maintains the highest tiger density in India (over 260 tigers).
- **First Snow Leopard Conservation Centre:** Established at **Lanka, near Bhaironghati in Uttarkashi district** in collaboration with UNDP under the *SECURE Himalaya* project.
- **Lichen Park (Munsyari):** India's first lichen park developed at **Munsyari (Pithoragarh)** sheltering over 150 species of lichens (*Jhula ghaas*).

- **Cryptogamic Garden (Deoban, Chakrata):** India's first cryptogamic garden at Deoban (2,700 m altitude) housing 76 species of ferns, fungi, algae, and bryophytes.
- **Moss Garden (Khurpatal, Nainital):** India's first dedicated moss garden conservation project.
- **First Pollinator Park:** Established at **Haldwani (Nainital)** across 4 acres conserving 40+ species of butterflies, honeybees, and birds.

8. State Government Welfare Schemes (2023–2026 Master Table)

Scheme Name	Nodal Department	Beneficiary Group & Key Provisions
Mukhyamantri Mahalakshmi Yojana	Women & Child Development	Provides comprehensive postpartum nutrition and hygiene kit containing baby clothes, blankets, sanitizers, and almonds for newborn children and mothers.
Mukhyamantri Anchal Amrit Yojana	Women & Child Development	Distributes 100 ml of free fortified milk twice a week to children aged 3 to 6 years in all Anganwadi centres to eradicate malnourishment and stunting.
Ghasyari Kalyan Yojana	Animal Husbandry & Cooperative	Delivers vacuum-packed nutrient-dense green fodder silage directly to rural hill cattle owners at a subsidized rate of **₹3 per kg**, liberating women from dangerous forest foraging.
Mukhyamantri Saur Swarojgar Yojana	Energy / UREDA	Subsidized installation of 20 to 25 kW small grid-connected solar power plants on degraded terraced lands by unemployed youth and returning hill migrants.
Him Prahari Scheme	Home / Border Welfare	Incentivizes ex-servicemen and young residents to settle permanently in depopulated border villages along the Indo-Tibetan and Nepal borders to prevent demographic vacuum and provide border intelligence.
Apuni Sarkar Portal	Information Technology	Centralized G2C portal hosting over **400 citizen services** with DigiLocker integration and digital certificate delivery.
Chief Minister Helpline 1905	Public Grievances	24x7 toll-free public grievance redressal portal with mandatory time-bound resolution tracking directly reviewed by the CM.
Mukhyamantri Pratibhashali Chhatra Protsahan Yojana	Higher Education	Monthly scholarships awarded to top-ranking meritorious students of government schools and universities.

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Radha Bahin Bhatt vs Madhuri Barthwal	Radha Bahin Bhatt = **2025 Padma Shri (Social Work, Kausani)**; Madhuri Barthwal = **2022 Padma Shri (Folk Music)**.
Silkyara Tunnel Length	Exactly **4.531 km** (trap options: 3.531 km, 6.531 km).
Rishikesh–Karnaprayag Rail Length	Exactly **125.2 km**; **84% (~105 km) inside tunnels**.
UCC Tribal Applicability	Scheduled Tribes (STs) are **COMPLETELY EXEMPTED** from UCC.
G20 Ramnagar vs Narendra Nagar	Ramnagar = **Science Advisers (CSAR)**; Narendra Nagar = **Anti-Corruption & Infrastructure**.
38th National Games Mascot	**Monal** (State Bird of Uttarakhand).
First Ramsar Site in UK	**Asan Conservation Reserve** (Dehradun, 2020) — NOT Nainital Lake or Corbett.
First Village Designation	**Mana Village (Chamoli)** — designated "First Village", no longer "Last Village".